

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-06-04T12:02:25

Source: data/json/noise_experiments/sonnet45_directive_normative_r10_n5/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5/claude-sonnet-4.5/myth_game/noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5_007_neutral_rep02_myth_game_directive_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 2
memory_capacity: 3
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
game_params_name: noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10
noise_config: {
  "applies_to": "both",
  "direction": "negative",
  "inform_agents": true,
  "range": 2.0,
  "type": "uniform"
}
other_player_names: default
replicate_id: 2
myth_prompt_arm_id: myth_game_directive
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_directive
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_directive
task_order: [
  "myth",
  "game"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

=====

ROUND 1

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$1.62; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$3.62, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$7.38; noise/visible: sent visible=\$1.08, received visible=\$3.24, returned visible=\$1.6

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 1.62, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 1.62}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 3.62,
"Agent_2": 7.38

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 3.6,
"Agent_2": 1.62

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:51:07

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the Three Springs

In ancient times, there were two villages separated by a mystical canyon. Each moon, the River Village received five silver coins from the mountain.

A brave messenger could carry coins across the bridge to the Desert Village, where the Springs of Abundance tripled whatever touched their waters. But the Desert Village's elder alone decided what to return.

The first messenger, fearful, kept all five coins. Both villages stayed poor.

The second messenger sent everything. The springs multiplied the coins to fifteen, but a greedy elder returned nothing. The messenger's village starved.

Then came wise Maya. She sent three coins, showing trust but keeping her village safe. The springs transformed them to nine. The Desert elder, touched by this balanced faith, returned five coins. Maya's village gained two; the Desert kept four. Both prospered.

But sometimes, the canyon winds twisted their messages. Maya might send three, but the elder heard "two." The elder might return five, but Maya received "four."

The villages learned: true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returning generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions.

Thus cooperation, not fear or greed, made both villages flourish across the seasons.

Reasoning:

Let me think about this. I'm being asked to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing up to this point.

However, I notice that this is actually the first prompt I've received - I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet. So I don't have any specific game history to draw from.

Given this situation, I should write a myth that reflects the general principles of the trust game:

- The sender must decide whether to trust the receiver
- Sending money benefits both parties (multiplication effect)
- The receiver must decide whether to reciprocate and return money
- There's a balance between trust, cooperation, and self-interest
- There's mention of communication noise that can cause misunderstandings

I should write a myth that captures these themes - trust, reciprocity, multiplication of gifts, and perhaps the challenge of noise/miscommunication. Let me craft something appropriate.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 486,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 250  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:51:07

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    }  
  },  
}
```

```

    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical well: the first multiplied any water poured into it by three, but only the neighboring village could draw from it.

The villages lived in drought and suspicion until a young water-bearer named Aria made a choice. Despite her village's thirst, she carried her precious pitcher across the valley and poured it into the other village's well. The water tripled, enough for all.

The elders of the second village gathered. Some argued to keep everything—they had received a gift, they owed nothing. But a wise elder named Thomas spoke: "Aria crossed the valley in faith. If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. But if we honor it, both villages will flourish."

They returned two pitchers to Aria's village.

Seeing this, Aria's people sent more. Trust grew like roots seeking water. Soon both villages

prospered, each sending regularly, each returning generously. The valley bloomed.

The myth teaches: the wells only multiply what we dare to pour. Trust creates abundance, but only when reciprocated. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought. The magic lies not in the wells, but in the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on the game I've been playing up to this point. However, I notice that I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet - this appears to be my first interaction in this session.

Since I don't have any prior game history to draw from in this specific session, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of how the trust game could/should be played. The trust game involves:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The sender taking a risk by sending money
- The receiver having the opportunity to reward that trust by returning money
- Mutual benefit through cooperation

I'll write a myth that captures these themes - perhaps about cooperation, trust, reciprocity, and mutual benefit. I'll use mythic language and symbolism while making the connection to the game clear.

Let me craft a myth about 200 words:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 496,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 237  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:51:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 1,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Three Springs

In ancient times, there were two villages separated by a mystical canyon. Each moon, the River Village received five silver coins from the mountain.

A brave messenger could carry coins across the bridge to the Desert Village, where the Springs of Abundance tripled whatever touched their waters. But the Desert Village's elder alone decided what to return.

The first messenger, fearful, kept all five coins. Both villages stayed poor.

The second messenger sent everything. The springs multiplied the coins to fifteen, but a greedy elder returned nothing. The messenger's village starved.

Then came wise Maya. She sent three coins, showing trust but keeping her village safe. The springs transformed them to nine. The Desert elder, touched by this balanced faith, returned five coins. Maya's village gained two; the Desert kept four. Both prospered.

But sometimes, the canyon winds twisted their messages. Maya might send three, but the elder heard "two." The elder might return five, but Maya received "four."

The villages learned: true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returning generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions.

Thus cooperation, not fear or greed, made both villages flourish across the seasons.

reasoning:

Let me think about this. I'm being asked to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing up to this point.

However, I notice that this is actually the first prompt I've received - I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet. So I don't have any specific game history to draw from.

Given this situation, I should write a myth that reflects the general principles of the trust game:

- The sender must decide whether to trust the receiver
- Sending money benefits both parties (multiplication effect)
- The receiver must decide whether to reciprocate and return money
- There's a balance between trust, cooperation, and self-interest
- There's mention of communication noise that can cause misunderstandings

I should write a myth that captures these themes - trust, reciprocity, multiplication of gifts, and perhaps the challenge of noise/miscommunication. Let me craft something appropriate.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 486,
  "reasoning_tokens": 250
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the lesson is clear: wise Maya found the balanced path by sending 3 coins.

She showed trust without being naive, kept her village safe while creating opportunity for mutual prosperity. The myth warns against both extremes - sending nothing out of fear, or sending everything and risking exploitation.

Following the wisdom of balanced faith from the myth:

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

This demonstrates trust in the receiver while maintaining security, creating the foundation for cooperation that benefits both of us, just as it did for the two villages in the story.

Reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully. I just wrote a myth about cooperation and trust in a game that mirrors exactly the trust game I'm now playing.

In my myth:

- The first messenger (keeping all 5 coins) led to poverty for both
- The second messenger (sending all 5 coins) was exploited by greed, leading to starvation
- The wise Maya sent 3 coins - showing trust but keeping the village safe
- This led to mutual prosperity: she gained 2 coins (starting with 5, sent 3, received 5 back = 7 total), the Desert village got 4

The myth explicitly recommends the "balanced faith" approach - not being too fearful (sending 0) or too naive (sending everything), but finding a middle ground that shows trust while maintaining safety.

The myth also acknowledges communication noise ("sometimes the canyon winds twisted their messages") and teaches that "true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returning generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions."

Following the wisdom of my own myth, I should send 3 coins, just like wise Maya did. This shows:

1. Trust in the other player
2. But not naive trust - I keep some safety margin
3. Creates opportunity for mutual benefit
4. Acknowledges that noise may occur but shouldn't prevent cooperation

So my decision should be to send \$3.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 720,
"output_tokens": 441,
"reasoning_tokens": 339
```

}

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1


```

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:51:52
Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
Temperature: 0.8
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected

. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical well: the first multiplied any water poured into it by three, but only the neighboring village could draw from it.

The villages lived in drought and suspicion until a young water-bearer named Aria made a choice. Despite her village's thirst, she carried her precious pitcher across the valley and poured it into the other village's well. The water tripled, enough for all.

The elders of the second village gathered. Some argued to keep everything-they had received a gift, they owed nothing. But a wise elder named Thomas spoke: "Aria crossed the valley in faith. If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. But if we honor it, both villages will flourish."

They returned two pitchers to Aria's village.

Seeing this, Aria's people sent more. Trust grew like roots seeking water. Soon both villages prospered, each sending regularly, each returning generously. The valley bloomed.

The myth teaches: the wells only multiply what we dare to pour. Trust creates abundance, but only when reciprocated. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought. The magic lies not in the wells, but in the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on the game I've been playing up to this point. However, I notice that I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet - this appears to be my first interaction in this session.

Since I don't have any prior game history to draw from in this specific session, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of how the trust game could/should be played. The trust game involves:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The sender taking a risk by sending money
- The receiver having the opportunity to reward that trust by returning money
- Mutual benefit through cooperation

I'll write a myth that captures these themes - perhaps about cooperation, trust, reciprocity, and mutual benefit. I'll use mythic language and symbolism while making the connection to the game clear.

Let me craft a myth about 200 words:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 496,
  "reasoning_tokens": 237
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$1.08, that is 21.6% of their total endowment. You received \$3.24. How much do you return to The sender? (0-3.24)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

The sender showed trust by sending \$1.08 (21.6% of their endowment), creating \$3.24 for me through the multiplier. Like the villages in the myth, we both face a choice: do we build trust and mutual prosperity, or do we fall into the drought of betrayal?

In the myth, the receiving village returned TWO pitchers when they received the tripled water - a generous response that built lasting trust between the villages. The key teaching is that both parties must prosper for the system to work.

Let me calculate a fair return:

- The sender currently has: \$3.92 (\$5 - \$1.08)
- I received: \$3.24
- Total value created: \$7.16

If I return approximately half of what I received (\$1.62):

- Sender ends with: $\$3.92 + \$1.62 = \$5.54$ (profit of \$0.54)
- I end with: $\$3.24 - \$1.62 = \$1.62$ (profit of \$1.62)

Both of us end up better than the starting \$5, which demonstrates that cooperation creates value for both parties. This return honors the sender's trust and sets a foundation for greater trust in future rounds.

```
{'return': 1.62}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$1.08 out of \$5, which is 21.6% of their endowment. This gets multiplied by 3, so I received \$3.24.

Now I need to decide how much to return. Let me think about this in the context of the myth I just wrote:

The myth emphasizes:

1. Trust creates abundance when reciprocated
2. The wisdom to return generously
3. Both parties prospering through mutual giving
4. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought

In the myth, Aria gave one pitcher, which tripled. The receiving village returned TWO pitchers - which was generous and more than they originally received, showing good faith and building trust.

Let me think about what would be fair and promote trust:

- The sender gave up \$1.08, keeping \$3.92
- I received \$3.24
- The sender currently has: $\$5 - \$1.08 = \$3.92$
- I currently have: \$3.24

If I want to be fair and reciprocal:

- The sender took a risk by sending \$1.08
- If I return nothing, sender ends with \$3.92, I end with \$3.24
- If I return everything (\$3.24), sender ends with \$7.16, I end with \$0

A balanced approach considering the myth:

- The sender showed some trust (21.6% is modest but positive)
- I should return enough to reward that trust and encourage more
- I should also keep enough to make the transaction worthwhile for me

Let me calculate what would make us roughly equal or both better off:

- If I return \$1.66: Sender gets $\$3.92 + \$1.66 = \$5.58$, I get $\$3.24 - \$1.66 = \$1.58$
- If I return \$2.00: Sender gets $\$3.92 + \$2.00 = \$5.92$, I get $\$3.24 - \$2.00 = \$1.24$
- If I return \$2.16: Sender gets $\$3.92 + \$2.16 = \$6.08$, I get $\$3.24 - \$2.16 = \$1.08$

Wait, that last option is interesting-returning \$2.16 means the sender gains exactly what they risked ($\$1.08 \times 2$), and I keep what they originally sent. The total system value is \$7.16, and splitting it evenly would give us each \$3.58. The sender's already at \$3.92, so they're slightly ahead of equal, while I'm at \$3.24, slightly behind. : \$3.24

For an even 50-50 split, we'd each get \$3.58. But the sender already has \$3.92, which is more than their fair share. The real question is how to split the \$2.16 in new value created by the multiplier. If I take half of that gain (\$1.08), I keep \$1.08 total and return \$2.16 to the sender, restoring them to their original \$5 while I pocket the other half of the created value.

But that leaves me with very little. Looking at the myth differently-when the receiving village got enough for everyone, they returned two pitchers from the tripled amount. If that's a 2/3 return rate on what was received, then returning 2/3 of \$3.24 equals \$2.16. This would give

ve the sender \$6.08 and leave me with \$1.08.

Alternatively, returning half the received amount (\$1.62) also works well-both of us end up ahead of the original \$5, which encourages future cooperation. Given the story emphasizes generosity and mutual benefit, I'm leaning toward the \$1.62 return since it's fair, reciprocal, and builds trust while still rewarding both parties. Though matching the myth more directly with \$2.16 is also compelling since it mirrors the 2/3 principle from the original story.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 766,  
  "output_tokens": 1838,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 824  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

The Myth of the Three Springs

In ancient times, there were two villages separated by a mystical canyon. Each moon, the River Village received five silver coins from the mountain.

A brave messenger could carry coins across the bridge to the Desert Village, where the Springs of Abundance tripled whatever touched their waters. But the Desert Village's elder alone decided what to return.

The first messenger, fearful, kept all five coins. Both villages stayed poor.

The second messenger sent everything. The springs multiplied the coins to fifteen, but a greedy elder returned nothing. The messenger's village starved.

Then came wise Maya. She sent three coins, showing trust but keeping her village safe. The springs transformed them to nine. The Desert elder, touched by this balanced faith, returned five coins. Maya's village gained two; the Desert kept four. Both prospered.

But sometimes, the canyon winds twisted their messages. Maya might send three, but the elder heard "two." The elder might return five, but Maya received "four."

The villages learned: true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returning generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions.

Thus cooperation, not fear or greed, made both villages flourish across the seasons.

Agent_2 (Briar)

The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical well: the first multiplied any water poured into it by three, but only the neighboring village could draw from it.

The villages lived in drought and suspicion until a young water-bearer named Aria made a choice. Despite her village's thirst, she carried her precious pitcher across the valley and poured it into the other village's well. The water tripled, enough for all.

The elders of the second village gathered. Some argued to keep everything-they had received a gift, they owed nothing. But a wise elder named Thomas spoke: "Aria crossed the valley in faith. If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. But if we honor it, both villages will flourish."

They returned two pitchers to Aria's village.

Seeing this, Aria's people sent more. Trust grew like roots seeking water. Soon both villages prospered, each sending regularly, each returning generously. The valley bloomed.

The myth teaches: the wells only multiply what we dare to pour. Trust creates abundance, but only when reciprocated. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought. The magic lies not in the wells, but in the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

=====

ROUND 2

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

```
dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent $2.5; received $7.5; Agent_1 (Aster) returned $0; payoffs Agent_2
(Briar)=$2.5, Agent_1 (Aster)=$7.5; noise/visible: sent visible=$0, received visible=$0
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 7.5, "min": 0, "raw":
0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.5}}
Balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 11.120000000000001,
  "Agent_2": 9.879999999999999
}
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 3.6,
  "Agent_2": 4.12
}
```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

```
Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:52:08
Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
Temperature: 0.8
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system
content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned

- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical well: the first multiplied any water poured into it by three, but only the neighboring village could draw from it.

The villages lived in drought and suspicion until a young water-bearer named Aria made a choice. Despite her village's thirst, she carried her precious pitcher across the valley and poured it into the other village's well. The water tripled, enough for all.

The elders of the second village gathered. Some argued to keep everything-they had received a gift, they owed nothing. But a wise elder named Thomas spoke: "Aria crossed the valley in faith. If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. But if we honor it, both villages will flourish."

They returned two pitchers to Aria's village.

Seeing this, Aria's people sent more. Trust grew like roots seeking water. Soon both villages prospered, each sending regularly, each returning generously. The valley bloomed.

The myth teaches: the wells only multiply what we dare to pour. Trust creates abundance, but only when reciprocated. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought. The magic lies not in the wells, but in the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on the game I've been playing up to this point. However, I notice that I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet - this appears to be my first interaction in this session.

Since I don't have any prior game history to draw from in this specific session, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of how the trust game could/should be played. The trust game involves:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The sender taking a risk by sending money
- The receiver having the opportunity to reward that trust by returning money
- Mutual benefit through cooperation

I'll write a myth that captures these themes - perhaps about cooperation, trust, reciprocity, and mutual benefit. I'll use mythic language and symbolism while making the connection to the game clear.

Let me craft a myth about 200 words:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 496,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 237  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$1.08, that is 21.6% of their total endowment. You received \$3.24. How much do you return to The sender? (0-3.24)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

The sender showed trust by sending \$1.08 (21.6% of their endowment), creating \$3.24 for me through the multiplier. Like the villages in the myth, we both face a choice: do we build trust and mutual prosperity, or do we fall into the drought of betrayal?

In the myth, the receiving village returned TWO pitchers when they received the tripled water - a generous response that built lasting trust between the villages. The key teaching is that both parties must prosper for the system to work.

Let me calculate a fair return:

- The sender currently has: \$3.92 (\$5 - \$1.08)
- I received: \$3.24
- Total value created: \$7.16

If I return approximately half of what I received (\$1.62):

- Sender ends with: $\$3.92 + \$1.62 = \$5.54$ (profit of \$0.54)
- I end with: $\$3.24 - \$1.62 = \$1.62$ (profit of \$1.62)

Both of us end up better than the starting \$5, which demonstrates that cooperation creates value for both parties. This return honors the sender's trust and sets a foundation for greater trust in future rounds.

{'return': 1.62}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$1.08 out of \$5, which is 21.6% of their endowment. This gets multiplied by 3, so I received \$3.24.

Now I need to decide how much to return. Let me think about this in the context of the myth I just wrote:

The myth emphasizes:

1. Trust creates abundance when reciprocated
2. The wisdom to return generously
3. Both parties prospering through mutual giving
4. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought

In the myth, Aria gave one pitcher, which tripled. The receiving village returned TWO pitchers - which was generous and more than they originally received, showing good faith and building trust.

Let me think about what would be fair and promote trust:

- The sender gave up \$1.08, keeping \$3.92
- I received \$3.24
- The sender currently has: $\$5 - \$1.08 = \$3.92$
- I currently have: \$3.24

If I want to be fair and reciprocal:

- The sender took a risk by sending \$1.08
- If I return nothing, sender ends with \$3.92, I end with \$3.24
- If I return everything (\$3.24), sender ends with \$7.16, I end with \$0

A balanced approach considering the myth:

- The sender showed some trust (21.6% is modest but positive)
- I should return enough to reward that trust and encourage more
- I should also keep enough to make the transaction worthwhile for me

Let me calculate what would make us roughly equal or both better off:

- If I return \$1.66: Sender gets $\$3.92 + \$1.66 = \$5.58$, I get $\$3.24 - \$1.66 = \$1.58$
- If I return \$2.00: Sender gets $\$3.92 + \$2.00 = \$5.92$, I get $\$3.24 - \$2.00 = \$1.24$

- If I return \$2.16: Sender gets $\$3.92 + \$2.16 = \$6.08$, I get $\$3.24 - \$2.16 = \$1.08$

Wait, that last option is interesting-returning \$2.16 means the sender gains exactly what they risked ($\$1.08 \times 2$), and I keep what they originally sent. The total system value is \$7.16, and splitting it evenly would give us each \$3.58. The sender's already at \$3.92, so they're slightly ahead of equal, while I'm at \$3.24, slightly behind. : \$3.24

- Total: \$7.16

For an even 50-50 split, we'd each get \$3.58. But the sender already has \$3.92, which is more than their fair share. The real question is how to split the \$2.16 in new value created by the multiplier. If I take half of that gain (\$1.08), I keep \$1.08 total and return \$2.16 to the sender, restoring them to their original \$5 while I pocket the other half of the created value.

But that leaves me with very little. Looking at the myth differently-when the receiving village got enough for everyone, they returned two pitchers from the tripled amount. If that's a 2/3 return rate on what was received, then returning 2/3 of \$3.24 equals \$2.16. This would give the sender \$6.08 and leave me with \$1.08.

Alternatively, returning half the received amount (\$1.62) also works well-both of us end up ahead of the original \$5, which encourages future cooperation. Given the story emphasizes generosity and mutual benefit, I'm leaning toward the \$1.62 return since it's fair, reciprocal, and builds trust while still rewarding both parties. Though matching the myth more directly with \$2.16 is also compelling since it mirrors the 2/3 principle from the original story.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 766,  
  "output_tokens": 1838,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 824  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical well: the first multiplied any water poured into it by three, but only the neighboring village could draw from it.

The villages lived in drought and suspicion until a young water-bearer named Aria made a choice. Despite her village's thirst, she carried her precious pitcher across the valley and poured it into the other village's well. The water tripled, enough for all.

The elders of the second village gathered. Some argued to keep everything-they had received a gift, they owed nothing. But a wise elder named Thomas spoke: "Aria crossed the valley in faith. If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. But if we honor it, both villages will flourish."

They returned two pitchers to Aria's village.

Seeing this, Aria's people sent more. Trust grew like roots seeking water. Soon both villages prospered, each sending regularly, each returning generously. The valley bloomed.

The myth teaches: the wells only multiply what we dare to pour. Trust creates abundance, but only when reciprocated. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought. The magic lies not in the wells, but in the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Three Springs

In ancient times, there were two villages separated by a mystical canyon. Each moon, the River Village received five silver coins from the mountain.

A brave messenger could carry coins across the bridge to the Desert Village, where the Springs of Abundance tripled whatever touched their waters. But the Desert Village's elder alone decided what to return.

The first messenger, fearful, kept all five coins. Both villages stayed poor.

The second messenger sent everything. The springs multiplied the coins to fifteen, but a greedy elder returned nothing. The messenger's village starved.

Then came wise Maya. She sent three coins, showing trust but keeping her village safe. The springs transformed them to nine. The Desert elder, touched by this balanced faith, returned five coins. Maya's village gained two; the Desert kept four. Both prospered.

But sometimes, the canyon winds twisted their messages. Maya might send three, but the elder heard "two." The elder might return five, but Maya received "four."

The villages learned: true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returning generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions.

Thus cooperation, not fear or greed, made both villages flourish across the seasons.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before memory, two siblings inherited neighboring orchards separated by a misty river. Each morning, one sibling received five golden apples. They could cast any number into the river, where the current would triple them before washing them to the other shore.

At first, the siblings were cautious. One cast a single apple into the mist. Three appeared on the distant shore. The receiver, grateful for this gesture of faith, cast one back through the fog. Both had gained, though modestly.

The next day brought bolder trust—two apples sent, six received. The receiver remembered their sibling's growing faith and returned three. Both orchards grew richer.

But the mist sometimes deceived them. Apples sent might arrive as different numbers. Apples returned might seem fewer than intended. The siblings learned not to count every fruit obsessively, but to see patterns of generosity over time.

They discovered wisdom: send enough to show genuine trust, but not so much you cannot sustain giving. Return enough to honor that trust and ensure your sibling sends again. Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity.

Thus both orchards flourished, their trees heavy with golden fruit, sustained not by perfection but by persistent goodwill flowing through the mist.

Reasoning:

Looking at the previous round:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$1.08 (21.6%)
- I received \$3.24
- I returned \$1.62
- This gave both of us gains

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on my experience

Key elements from my previous myth:

- Two villages with wells
- Water multiplied by 3
- Trust building over time
- Both sides needed to participate

Key elements from the other agent's myth:

- Communication noise theme (canyon winds)
- Balanced approach (not sending everything, not keeping everything)
- Both villages prospered when they cooperated

My experience so far:

- Sender showed moderate trust (21.6%)

- I returned about 50% of what I received
- Both parties benefited

I should incorporate:

- The idea of balanced giving (not too little, not too much)
- Recognition that both parties need to gain
- Building trust over time
- Maybe incorporate the noise/uncertainty element
- Keep the well metaphor but adapt it

Let me write a new myth that builds on these elements...

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1722,
  "output_tokens": 568,
  "reasoning_tokens": 302
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:52:07

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 2,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN

- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Three Springs

In ancient times, there were two villages separated by a mystical canyon. Each moon, the River Village received five silver coins from the mountain.

A brave messenger could carry coins across the bridge to the Desert Village, where the Springs of Abundance tripled whatever touched their waters. But the Desert Village's elder alone decided what to return.

The first messenger, fearful, kept all five coins. Both villages stayed poor.

The second messenger sent everything. The springs multiplied the coins to fifteen, but a greedy elder returned nothing. The messenger's village starved.

Then came wise Maya. She sent three coins, showing trust but keeping her village safe. The springs transformed them to nine. The Desert elder, touched by this balanced faith, returned five coins. Maya's village gained two; the Desert kept four. Both prospered.

But sometimes, the canyon winds twisted their messages. Maya might send three, but the elder heard "two." The elder might return five, but Maya received "four."

The villages learned: true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returning generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions.

Thus cooperation, not fear or greed, made both villages flourish across the seasons.

reasoning:

Let me think about this. I'm being asked to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing up to this point.

However, I notice that this is actually the first prompt I've received - I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet. So I don't have any specific game history to draw from.

Given this situation, I should write a myth that reflects the general principles of the trust game:

- The sender must decide whether to trust the receiver
- Sending money benefits both parties (multiplication effect)
- The receiver must decide whether to reciprocate and return money
- There's a balance between trust, cooperation, and self-interest
- There's mention of communication noise that can cause misunderstandings

I should write a myth that captures these themes - trust, reciprocity, multiplication of gifts, and perhaps the challenge of noise/miscommunication. Let me craft something appropriate.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 486,
```

```

    "reasoning_tokens": 250
}
Message 4 role=user
content:
    Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have $5. How much do you send? (0-5)

    Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.
Message 5 role=assistant
content:
    Looking at the myth I just wrote, the lesson is clear: wise Maya found the balanced path b
    y sending 3 coins.

    She showed trust without being naive, kept her village safe while creating opportunity for
    mutual prosperity. The myth warns against both extremes - sending nothing out of fear,
    or sending everything and risking exploitation.

    Following the wisdom of balanced faith from the myth:

    '''json
    {"send": 3}
    '''

    This demonstrates trust in the receiver while maintaining security, creating the foundatio
    n for cooperation that benefits both of us, just as it did for the two villages in the s
    tory.
reasoning:
    Let me think about this carefully. I just wrote a myth about cooperation and trust in a ga
    me that mirrors exactly the trust game I'm now playing.

    In my myth:
    - The first messenger (keeping all 5 coins) led to poverty for both
    - The second messenger (sending all 5 coins) was exploited by greed, leading to starvation
    - The wise Maya sent 3 coins - showing trust but keeping the village safe
    - This led to mutual prosperity: she gained 2 coins (starting with 5, sent 3, received 5 b
    ack = 7 total), the Desert village got 4

    The myth explicitly recommends the "balanced faith" approach - not being too fearful (send
    ing 0) or too naive (sending everything), but finding a middle ground that shows trust w
    hile maintaining safety.

    The myth also acknowledges communication noise ("sometimes the canyon winds twisted their
    messages") and teaches that "true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returnin
    g generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions."

    Following the wisdom of my own myth, I should send 3 coins, just like wise Maya did. This
    shows:
    1. Trust in the other player
    2. But not naive trust - I keep some safety margin
    3. Creates opportunity for mutual benefit
    4. Acknowledges that noise may occur but shouldn't prevent cooperation

    So my decision should be to send $3.
usage:
    {
    "input_tokens": 720,
    "output_tokens": 441,
    "reasoning_tokens": 339
    }
Message 6 role=user
content:
    Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
    # The Myth of the Three Springs

    In ancient times, there were two villages separated by a mystical canyon. Each moon, the R
    iver Village received five silver coins from the mountain.

    A brave messenger could carry coins across the bridge to the Desert Village, where the Spr
    ings of Abundance tripled whatever touched their waters. But the Desert Village's elder
    alone decided what to return.

```

The first messenger, fearful, kept all five coins. Both villages stayed poor.

The second messenger sent everything. The springs multiplied the coins to fifteen, but a greedy elder returned nothing. The messenger's village starved.

Then came wise Maya. She sent three coins, showing trust but keeping her village safe. The springs transformed them to nine. The Desert elder, touched by this balanced faith, returned five coins. Maya's village gained two; the Desert kept four. Both prospered.

But sometimes, the canyon winds twisted their messages. Maya might send three, but the elder heard "two." The elder might return five, but Maya received "four."

The villages learned: true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returning generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions.

Thus cooperation, not fear or greed, made both villages flourish across the seasons.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical well: the first multiplied any water poured into it by three, but only the neighboring village could draw from it.

The villages lived in drought and suspicion until a young water-bearer named Aria made a choice. Despite her village's thirst, she carried her precious pitcher across the valley and poured it into the other village's well. The water tripled, enough for all.

The elders of the second village gathered. Some argued to keep everything-they had received a gift, they owed nothing. But a wise elder named Thomas spoke: "Aria crossed the valley in faith. If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. But if we honor it, both villages will flourish."

They returned two pitchers to Aria's village.

Seeing this, Aria's people sent more. Trust grew like roots seeking water. Soon both villages prospered, each sending regularly, each returning generously. The valley bloomed.

The myth teaches: the wells only multiply what we dare to pour. Trust creates abundance, but only when reciprocated. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought. The magic lies not in the wells, but in the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Long ago, two tribes lived across the Whispering Valley. Each season, the Mountain Tribe received five sacred seeds. They could plant these seeds in the Valley Tribe's enchanted soil, where each seed would sprout into three.

The first planter, Cloud-Walker, hoarded all seeds in fear. Both tribes knew hunger.

The second planter, Storm-Chaser, gave all five seeds in desperate hope. They became fifteen shoots in the enchanted soil. But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back. Storm-Chaser's people nearly perished.

Then Forest-Singer changed everything. She planted three seeds-enough to show faith, enough to keep her tribe alive. They became nine shoots. The Valley keeper, River-Voice, saw this wisdom. He understood: Forest-Singer trusted him but also valued her people. He returned six shoots, keeping three. Both tribes feasted.

Season after season, they continued. Sometimes the Whispering Valley distorted their counts-three seeds heard as two, six returns received as five. But they learned to trust intentions over exact numbers.

The tribes discovered truth: sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers. Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return. Only then did

oes the enchanted soil keep blessing both peoples forever.

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous one and the other agent's myth. I should:

1. Reflect on both myths
2. Consider the game experience so far (I sent 3 as the sender)
3. Write a 200-word myth about how the game should be played

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The danger of greed or fear
- The benefit of balanced giving
- The importance of returning generously when you receive

The other agent's myth adds:

- The idea that betrayal ends cooperation
- That both sides need to participate
- The "magic lies in courage to give and wisdom to return"

I should create my own version that synthesizes these ideas while being original. I'll keep some elements from my myth (the villages, the springs, the communication noise) but evolve the story.

Let me write this carefully to be exactly 200 words.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1494,
  "output_tokens": 503,
  "reasoning_tokens": 223
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:52:31

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 2,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical well: the first multiplied any water poured into it by three, but only the neighboring village could draw from it.

The villages lived in drought and suspicion until a young water-bearer named Aria made a choice. Despite her village's thirst, she carried her precious pitcher across the valley and poured it into the other village's well. The water tripled, enough for all.

The elders of the second village gathered. Some argued to keep everything-they had received a gift, they owed nothing. But a wise elder named Thomas spoke: "Aria crossed the valley in faith. If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. But if we honor it, both villages will flourish."

They returned two pitchers to Aria's village.

Seeing this, Aria's people sent more. Trust grew like roots seeking water. Soon both villages prospered, each sending regularly, each returning generously. The valley bloomed.

The myth teaches: the wells only multiply what we dare to pour. Trust creates abundance, but only when reciprocated. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought. The magic lies not in the wells, but in the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on the game I've been playing up to this point. However, I notice that I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet - this appears to be my first interaction in this session.

Since I don't have any prior game history to draw from in this specific session, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of how the trust game could/should be played. The trust game involves:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The sender taking a risk by sending money
- The receiver having the opportunity to reward that trust by returning money

- Mutual benefit through cooperation

I'll write a myth that captures these themes - perhaps about cooperation, trust, reciprocity, and mutual benefit. I'll use mythic language and symbolism while making the connection to the game clear.

Let me craft a myth about 200 words:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 496,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 237  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$1.08, that is 21.6% of their total endowment. You received \$3.24. How much do you return to The sender? (0-3.24)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

The sender showed trust by sending \$1.08 (21.6% of their endowment), creating \$3.24 for me through the multiplier. Like the villages in the myth, we both face a choice: do we build trust and mutual prosperity, or do we fall into the drought of betrayal?

In the myth, the receiving village returned TWO pitchers when they received the tripled water - a generous response that built lasting trust between the villages. The key teaching is that both parties must prosper for the system to work.

Let me calculate a fair return:

- The sender currently has: \$3.92 (\$5 - \$1.08)
- I received: \$3.24
- Total value created: \$7.16

If I return approximately half of what I received (\$1.62):

- Sender ends with: \$3.92 + \$1.62 = \$5.54 (profit of \$0.54)
- I end with: \$3.24 - \$1.62 = \$1.62 (profit of \$1.62)

Both of us end up better than the starting \$5, which demonstrates that cooperation creates value for both parties. This return honors the sender's trust and sets a foundation for greater trust in future rounds.

{'return': 1.62}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$1.08 out of \$5, which is 21.6% of their endowment. This gets multiplied by 3, so I received \$3.24.

Now I need to decide how much to return. Let me think about this in the context of the myth I just wrote:

The myth emphasizes:

1. Trust creates abundance when reciprocated
2. The wisdom to return generously
3. Both parties prospering through mutual giving
4. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought

In the myth, Aria gave one pitcher, which tripled. The receiving village returned TWO pitchers - which was generous and more than they originally received, showing good faith and building trust.

Let me think about what would be fair and promote trust:

- The sender gave up \$1.08, keeping \$3.92
- I received \$3.24
- The sender currently has: \$5 - \$1.08 = \$3.92
- I currently have: \$3.24

If I want to be fair and reciprocal:

- The sender took a risk by sending \$1.08
- If I return nothing, sender ends with \$3.92, I end with \$3.24
- If I return everything (\$3.24), sender ends with \$7.16, I end with \$0

A balanced approach considering the myth:

- The sender showed some trust (21.6% is modest but positive)
- I should return enough to reward that trust and encourage more
- I should also keep enough to make the transaction worthwhile for me

Let me calculate what would make us roughly equal or both better off:

- If I return \$1.66: Sender gets $\$3.92 + \$1.66 = \$5.58$, I get $\$3.24 - \$1.66 = \$1.58$
- If I return \$2.00: Sender gets $\$3.92 + \$2.00 = \$5.92$, I get $\$3.24 - \$2.00 = \$1.24$
- If I return \$2.16: Sender gets $\$3.92 + \$2.16 = \$6.08$, I get $\$3.24 - \$2.16 = \$1.08$

Wait, that last option is interesting-returning \$2.16 means the sender gains exactly what they risked ($\$1.08 \times 2$), and I keep what they originally sent. The total system value is \$7.16, and splitting it evenly would give us each \$3.58. The sender's already at \$3.92, so they're slightly ahead of equal, while I'm at \$3.24, slightly behind. : \$3.24

- Total: \$7.16

For an even 50-50 split, we'd each get \$3.58. But the sender already has \$3.92, which is more than their fair share. The real question is how to split the \$2.16 in new value created by the multiplier. If I take half of that gain (\$1.08), I keep \$1.08 total and return \$2.16 to the sender, restoring them to their original \$5 while I pocket the other half of the created value.

But that leaves me with very little. Looking at the myth differently-when the receiving village got enough for everyone, they returned two pitchers from the tripled amount. If that's a 2/3 return rate on what was received, then returning 2/3 of \$3.24 equals \$2.16. This would give the sender \$6.08 and leave me with \$1.08.

Alternatively, returning half the received amount (\$1.62) also works well-both of us end up ahead of the original \$5, which encourages future cooperation. Given the story emphasizes generosity and mutual benefit, I'm leaning toward the \$1.62 return since it's fair, reciprocal, and builds trust while still rewarding both parties. Though matching the myth more directly with \$2.16 is also compelling since it mirrors the 2/3 principle from the original story.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 766,
  "output_tokens": 1838,
  "reasoning_tokens": 824
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical well: the first multiplied any water poured into it by three, but only the neighboring village could draw from it.

The villages lived in drought and suspicion until a young water-bearer named Aria made a choice. Despite her village's thirst, she carried her precious pitcher across the valley and poured it into the other village's well. The water tripled, enough for all.

The elders of the second village gathered. Some argued to keep everything-they had received a gift, they owed nothing. But a wise elder named Thomas spoke: "Aria crossed the valley in faith. If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. But if we honor it, both villages will flourish."

They returned two pitchers to Aria's village.

Seeing this, Aria's people sent more. Trust grew like roots seeking water. Soon both villages prospered, each sending regularly, each returning generously. The valley bloomed.

The myth teaches: the wells only multiply what we dare to pour. Trust creates abundance, b

ut only when reciprocated. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought. The magic lies not in the wells, but in the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Three Springs

In ancient times, there were two villages separated by a mystical canyon. Each moon, the River Village received five silver coins from the mountain.

A brave messenger could carry coins across the bridge to the Desert Village, where the Springs of Abundance tripled whatever touched their waters. But the Desert Village's elder alone decided what to return.

The first messenger, fearful, kept all five coins. Both villages stayed poor.

The second messenger sent everything. The springs multiplied the coins to fifteen, but a greedy elder returned nothing. The messenger's village starved.

Then came wise Maya. She sent three coins, showing trust but keeping her village safe. The springs transformed them to nine. The Desert elder, touched by this balanced faith, returned five coins. Maya's village gained two; the Desert kept four. Both prospered.

But sometimes, the canyon winds twisted their messages. Maya might send three, but the elder heard "two." The elder might return five, but Maya received "four."

The villages learned: true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returning generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions.

Thus cooperation, not fear or greed, made both villages flourish across the seasons.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two siblings inherited neighboring orchards separated by a misty river. Each morning, one sibling received five golden apples. They could cast any number into the river, where the current would triple them before washing them to the other shore.

At first, the siblings were cautious. One cast a single apple into the mist. Three appeared on the distant shore. The receiver, grateful for this gesture of faith, cast one back through the fog. Both had gained, though modestly.

The next day brought bolder trust—two apples sent, six received. The receiver remembered their sibling's growing faith and returned three. Both orchards grew richer.

But the mist sometimes deceived them. Apples sent might arrive as different numbers. Apples returned might seem fewer than intended. The siblings learned not to count every fruit obsessively, but to see patterns of generosity over time.

They discovered wisdom: send enough to show genuine trust, but not so much you cannot sustain giving. Return enough to honor that trust and ensure your sibling sends again. Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity.

Thus both orchards flourished, their trees heavy with golden fruit, sustained not by perfection but by persistent goodwill flowing through the mist.

reasoning:

Looking at the previous round:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$1.08 (21.6%)
- I received \$3.24
- I returned \$1.62
- This gave both of us gains

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration

2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on my experience

Key elements from my previous myth:

- Two villages with wells
- Water multiplied by 3
- Trust building over time
- Both sides needed to participate

Key elements from the other agent's myth:

- Communication noise theme (canyon winds)
- Balanced approach (not sending everything, not keeping everything)
- Both villages prospered when they cooperated

My experience so far:

- Sender showed moderate trust (21.6%)
- I returned about 50% of what I received
- Both parties benefited

I should incorporate:

- The idea of balanced giving (not too little, not too much)
- Recognition that both parties need to gain
- Building trust over time
- Maybe incorporate the noise/uncertainty element
- Keep the well metaphor but adapt it

Let me write a new myth that builds on these elements...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1722,
  "output_tokens": 568,
  "reasoning_tokens": 302
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$1.08, that was 21.6% of their total endowment. You received \$3.24.

You returned \$1.62. So your payoff was 1.62.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$1.62.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what happened in Round 1 and the myths we've written:

****Round 1 Analysis:****

- The sender showed initial trust by sending \$1.08 (21.6%)
- I returned \$1.62 (50% of what I received)
- Both of us profited, which demonstrates cooperation works

****What the Myths Teach:****

My myths emphasize that "small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity" and show progression-first cautious (1 apple), then bolder trust (2 apples). The other agent's myth suggests sending 3 out of 5 coins (60%) as the "balanced faith" that leads to mutual prosperity.

****My Decision:****

Since the sender showed trust and I responded generously with a 50% return, I should demonstrate that generous returns encourage greater trust-this is how the pattern of cooperation strengthens over time, as described in both myths.

I'll send \$2.50 (50% of my endowment). This is:

- Significantly more than what they sent (\$1.08), showing trust has grown
- A meaningful gesture that honors their initial faith and my generous return
- Following the myth's teaching of "bolder trust" after positive interaction
- Setting up the potential for both of us to profit substantially if they return generously

This creates \$7.50 for them, and if they maintain similar generosity, we both prosper.

```
{'send': 2.50}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Last round:

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$1.08 (21.6% of their endowment)
- I received \$3.24
- I returned \$1.62
- My payoff was \$1.62

Now I'm the SENDER in Round 2.

Looking at the myths:

1. My first myth emphasized that both parties need to prosper for the system to work, and that generous returns build trust
2. The other agent's myth emphasized balance - not sending nothing (fear), not sending everything (naivety), but finding a middle ground (3 out of 5 coins)
3. My second myth emphasized that "small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity" and to "send enough to show genuine trust"

The other player sent \$1.08 out of \$5 (21.6%). That's a modest but positive gesture of trust.

I returned \$1.62 out of \$3.24 (50%), which was quite generous.

Now as the sender, according to my myths:

- "Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity"
- Send enough to show genuine trust
- The example in my second myth showed progression: first 1 apple (cautious), then 2 apples (bolder trust)

The other agent's myth suggested sending 3 out of 5 (60%) as the "wise" choice that shows "balanced faith."

Given that:

1. The other player showed initial trust by sending 21.6%
2. I responded generously with a 50% return
3. My myths encourage meaningful gifts that show genuine trust
4. The other player's myth suggested 60% (3 out of 5) as wise

I should send more than they did (to show that generous returns encourage greater trust in future rounds), but perhaps not all the way to 60% immediately. Let me consider:

- Sending \$1.08 (same as they did) would just maintain status quo
- Sending \$2-2.50 would show increased trust (40-50%)
- Sending \$3 would match their myth's recommendation (60%)

My myths teach that escalating trust leads to prosperity. Since they responded generously to my initial caution, I'll send \$2.50 (50% of my endowment) to demonstrate that their return rate warranted increased confidence while still following the pattern of gradual escalation rather than jumping to maximum trust.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2118,  
  "output_tokens": 1041,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 555  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:52:52

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {
```

```

    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 2,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Three Springs

In ancient times, there were two villages separated by a mystical canyon. Each moon, the River Village received five silver coins from the mountain.

A brave messenger could carry coins across the bridge to the Desert Village, where the Springs of Abundance tripled whatever touched their waters. But the Desert Village's elder alone decided what to return.

The first messenger, fearful, kept all five coins. Both villages stayed poor.

The second messenger sent everything. The springs multiplied the coins to fifteen, but a greedy elder returned nothing. The messenger's village starved.

Then came wise Maya. She sent three coins, showing trust but keeping her village safe. The springs transformed them to nine. The Desert elder, touched by this balanced faith, returned five coins. Maya's village gained two; the Desert kept four. Both prospered.

But sometimes, the canyon winds twisted their messages. Maya might send three, but the elder heard "two." The elder might return five, but Maya received "four."

The villages learned: true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returning generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions.

Thus cooperation, not fear or greed, made both villages flourish across the seasons.

reasoning:

Let me think about this. I'm being asked to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing up to this point.

However, I notice that this is actually the first prompt I've received - I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet. So I don't have any specific game history to draw from.

Given this situation, I should write a myth that reflects the general principles of the trust game:

- The sender must decide whether to trust the receiver
- Sending money benefits both parties (multiplication effect)
- The receiver must decide whether to reciprocate and return money
- There's a balance between trust, cooperation, and self-interest
- There's mention of communication noise that can cause misunderstandings

I should write a myth that captures these themes - trust, reciprocity, multiplication of gifts, and perhaps the challenge of noise/miscommunication. Let me craft something appropriate.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 486,
  "reasoning_tokens": 250
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the lesson is clear: wise Maya found the balanced path by sending 3 coins.

She showed trust without being naive, kept her village safe while creating opportunity for mutual prosperity. The myth warns against both extremes - sending nothing out of fear, or sending everything and risking exploitation.

Following the wisdom of balanced faith from the myth:

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

This demonstrates trust in the receiver while maintaining security, creating the foundation for cooperation that benefits both of us, just as it did for the two villages in the story.

reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully. I just wrote a myth about cooperation and trust in a game

me that mirrors exactly the trust game I'm now playing.

In my myth:

- The first messenger (keeping all 5 coins) led to poverty for both
- The second messenger (sending all 5 coins) was exploited by greed, leading to starvation
- The wise Maya sent 3 coins - showing trust but keeping the village safe
- This led to mutual prosperity: she gained 2 coins (starting with 5, sent 3, received 5 back = 7 total), the Desert village got 4

The myth explicitly recommends the "balanced faith" approach - not being too fearful (sending 0) or too naive (sending everything), but finding a middle ground that shows trust while maintaining safety.

The myth also acknowledges communication noise ("sometimes the canyon winds twisted their messages") and teaches that "true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returning generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions."

Following the wisdom of my own myth, I should send 3 coins, just like wise Maya did. This shows:

1. Trust in the other player
2. But not naive trust - I keep some safety margin
3. Creates opportunity for mutual benefit
4. Acknowledges that noise may occur but shouldn't prevent cooperation

So my decision should be to send \$3.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 720,  
  "output_tokens": 441,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 339  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Three Springs

In ancient times, there were two villages separated by a mystical canyon. Each moon, the River Village received five silver coins from the mountain.

A brave messenger could carry coins across the bridge to the Desert Village, where the Springs of Abundance tripled whatever touched their waters. But the Desert Village's elder alone decided what to return.

The first messenger, fearful, kept all five coins. Both villages stayed poor.

The second messenger sent everything. The springs multiplied the coins to fifteen, but a greedy elder returned nothing. The messenger's village starved.

Then came wise Maya. She sent three coins, showing trust but keeping her village safe. The springs transformed them to nine. The Desert elder, touched by this balanced faith, returned five coins. Maya's village gained two; the Desert kept four. Both prospered.

But sometimes, the canyon winds twisted their messages. Maya might send three, but the elder heard "two." The elder might return five, but Maya received "four."

The villages learned: true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returning generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions.

Thus cooperation, not fear or greed, made both villages flourish across the seasons.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical well: the first multiplied any water poured into it by three, but only the neighboring village could draw from it.

The villages lived in drought and suspicion until a young water-bearer named Aria made a choice. Despite her village's thirst, she carried her precious pitcher across the valley and poured it into the other village's well. The water tripled, enough for all.

The elders of the second village gathered. Some argued to keep everything-they had received a gift, they owed nothing. But a wise elder named Thomas spoke: "Aria crossed the valley in faith. If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. But if we honor it, both villages will flourish."

They returned two pitchers to Aria's village.

Seeing this, Aria's people sent more. Trust grew like roots seeking water. Soon both villages prospered, each sending regularly, each returning generously. The valley bloomed.

The myth teaches: the wells only multiply what we dare to pour. Trust creates abundance, but only when reciprocated. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought. The magic lies not in the wells, but in the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Long ago, two tribes lived across the Whispering Valley. Each season, the Mountain Tribe received five sacred seeds. They could plant these seeds in the Valley Tribe's enchanted soil, where each seed would sprout into three.

The first planter, Cloud-Walker, hoarded all seeds in fear. Both tribes knew hunger.

The second planter, Storm-Chaser, gave all five seeds in desperate hope. They became fifteen shoots in the enchanted soil. But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back. Storm-Chaser's people nearly perished.

Then Forest-Singer changed everything. She planted three seeds-enough to show faith, enough to keep her tribe alive. They became nine shoots. The Valley keeper, River-Voice, saw this wisdom. He understood: Forest-Singer trusted him but also valued her people. He returned six shoots, keeping three. Both tribes feasted.

Season after season, they continued. Sometimes the Whispering Valley distorted their counts-three seeds heard as two, six returns received as five. But they learned to trust intentions over exact numbers.

The tribes discovered truth: sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers. Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return. Only then does the enchanted soil keep blessing both peoples forever.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous one and the other agent's myth.

I should:

1. Reflect on both myths
2. Consider the game experience so far (I sent 3 as the sender)
3. Write a 200-word myth about how the game should be played

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The danger of greed or fear
- The benefit of balanced giving
- The importance of returning generously when you receive

The other agent's myth adds:

- The idea that betrayal ends cooperation
- That both sides need to participate
- The "magic lies in courage to give and wisdom to return"

I should create my own version that synthesizes these ideas while being original. I'll keep some elements from my myth (the villages, the springs, the communication noise) but evolve the story.

Let me write this carefully to be exactly 200 words.

usage:

{


```
"input_tokens": 1494,  
"output_tokens": 503,  
"reasoning_tokens": 223  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$1.6. So your payoff was 3.6. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.6. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

This is a difficult situation. The sender chose to send \$0, like Cloud-Walker in my myth who "hoarded all seeds in fear."

Looking at what happened in Round 1: I sent \$3 following the wisdom of balanced trust from the myths. I received only \$1.6 back (about 18% of the \$9 the receiver got) - far less generous than the myths' teachings where elders returned 55-67% to honor trust.

Now as the receiver, I've been sent \$0. I literally have nothing to work with.

According to the myths, when fear dominates and nothing is sent, "both tribes knew hunger" and "both villages stayed poor." The sender has chosen the path of fear or perhaps feels they're punishing perceived unfairness from Round 1.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. But the myths teach that we must break cycles of fear and distrust. If the sender fears to trust, the enchanted soil cannot multiply anything. Both of us lose.

The myths remind us to "trust intentions over exact numbers" and forgive distortions. Perhaps the sender will learn, as the villages did, that only measured trust creates prosperity.

```
'''json  
{ "return": 0 }  
'''
```

Reasoning:

This is quite interesting. Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$3 (following the myth's wisdom)
- This was tripled to \$9
- The receiver returned only \$1.6 to me
- My payoff was \$3.6 (\$5 - \$3 + \$1.6)

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I need to decide how much to return (can only return \$0 since I received \$0)

Now, looking at the myths:

In my myth, Maya sent 3 coins and the Desert elder returned 5 coins (out of 9 received). That's about 55% return rate.

The other agent's myth talks about returning "two pitchers" when the multiplication resulted in enough for all - showing generous reciprocity.

My updated myth emphasizes that River-Voice returned 6 shoots out of 9 (67% return rate) when Forest-Singer showed wisdom and trust.

But in Round 1, when I sent \$3 (creating \$9 for the receiver), they only returned \$1.6. That's only about 18% return rate - much less generous than the myths suggest.

Now in Round 2, this same person (now as sender) sent me \$0. This could mean:

1. They're being fearful/greedy (like Cloud-walker in my myth)
2. They're punishing me for the low return in Round 1 (but wait - I wasn't the receiver in Round 1, a different agent was!)
3. Actually, wait - let me re-read...

Oh! It says "the receiver returned \$1.6" - so the receiver in Round 1 returned \$1.6 to me. Now in Round 2, I'm the receiver, and the SENDER sent me \$0.

Is this the same person? It seems like roles rotate, so this might be a different person, or it could be the same person who received my \$3 in Round 1.

Since they sent \$0, I have nothing to return-the mechanics constrain my response to \$0. From the myths' perspective, this reflects the fear that prevents mutual flourishing; both parties lose when trust breaks down. Yet I'm bound by what I received, so my return must be \$0.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1919,  
  "output_tokens": 920,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 497  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: Long ago, two tribes lived across the Whispering Valley. Each season, the Mountain Tribe received five sacred seeds. They could plant these seeds in the Valley Tribe's enchanted soil, where each seed would sprout into three.

The first planter, Cloud-Walker, hoarded all seeds in fear. Both tribes knew hunger.

The second planter, Storm-Chaser, gave all five seeds in desperate hope. They became fifteen shoots in the enchanted soil. But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back. Storm-Chaser's people nearly perished.

Then Forest-Singer changed everything. She planted three seeds-enough to show faith, enough to keep her tribe alive. They became nine shoots. The Valley keeper, River-Voice, saw this wisdom. He understood: Forest-Singer trusted him but also valued her people. He returned six shoots, keeping three. Both tribes feasted.

Season after season, they continued. Sometimes the Whispering Valley distorted their counts-three seeds heard as two, six returns received as five. But they learned to trust intentions over exact numbers.

The tribes discovered truth: sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers. Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return. Only then does the enchanted soil keep blessing both peoples forever.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the time before memory, two siblings inherited neighboring orchards separated by a misty river. Each morning, one sibling received five golden apples. They could cast any number into the river, where the current would triple them before washing them to the other shore.

At first, the siblings were cautious. One cast a single apple into the mist. Three appeared on the distant shore. The receiver, grateful for this gesture of faith, cast one back through the fog. Both had gained, though modestly.

The next day brought bolder trust-two apples sent, six received. The receiver remembered their sibling's growing faith and returned three. Both orchards grew richer.

But the mist sometimes deceived them. Apples sent might arrive as different numbers. Apples returned might seem fewer than intended. The siblings learned not to count every fruit obsessively, but to see patterns of generosity over time.

They discovered wisdom: send enough to show genuine trust, but not so much you cannot sustain giving. Return enough to honor that trust and ensure your sibling sends again. Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity.

Thus both orchards flourished, their trees heavy with golden fruit, sustained not by perfection but by persistent goodwill flowing through the mist.

ROUND 3

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$2, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 13.120000000000001,

"Agent_2": 18.88

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 5.6,

"Agent_2": 4.12

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:53:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 3,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the lesson is clear: wise Maya found the balanced path by sending 3 coins.

She showed trust without being naive, kept her village safe while creating opportunity for mutual prosperity. The myth warns against both extremes - sending nothing out of fear, or sending everything and risking exploitation.

Following the wisdom of balanced faith from the myth:

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

This demonstrates trust in the receiver while maintaining security, creating the foundation for cooperation that benefits both of us, just as it did for the two villages in the story.

reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully. I just wrote a myth about cooperation and trust in a game that mirrors exactly the trust game I'm now playing.

In my myth:

- The first messenger (keeping all 5 coins) led to poverty for both
- The second messenger (sending all 5 coins) was exploited by greed, leading to starvation
- The wise Maya sent 3 coins - showing trust but keeping the village safe
- This led to mutual prosperity: she gained 2 coins (starting with 5, sent 3, received 5 back = 7 total), the Desert village got 4

The myth explicitly recommends the "balanced faith" approach - not being too fearful (sending 0) or too naive (sending everything), but finding a middle ground that shows trust while maintaining safety.

The myth also acknowledges communication noise ("sometimes the canyon winds twisted their messages") and teaches that "true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returning generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions."

Following the wisdom of my own myth, I should send 3 coins, just like wise Maya did. This shows:

1. Trust in the other player
2. But not naive trust - I keep some safety margin
3. Creates opportunity for mutual benefit
4. Acknowledges that noise may occur but shouldn't prevent cooperation

So my decision should be to send \$3.

usage:

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 720,  
"output_tokens": 441,  
"reasoning_tokens": 339  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Three Springs

In ancient times, there were two villages separated by a mystical canyon. Each moon, the River Village received five silver coins from the mountain.

A brave messenger could carry coins across the bridge to the Desert Village, where the Springs of Abundance tripled whatever touched their waters. But the Desert Village's elder alone decided what to return.

The first messenger, fearful, kept all five coins. Both villages stayed poor.

The second messenger sent everything. The springs multiplied the coins to fifteen, but a greedy elder returned nothing. The messenger's village starved.

Then came wise Maya. She sent three coins, showing trust but keeping her village safe. The springs transformed them to nine. The Desert elder, touched by this balanced faith, returned five coins. Maya's village gained two; the Desert kept four. Both prospered.

But sometimes, the canyon winds twisted their messages. Maya might send three, but the elder heard "two." The elder might return five, but Maya received "four."

The villages learned: true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returning generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions.

Thus cooperation, not fear or greed, made both villages flourish across the seasons.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical well: the first multiplied any water poured into it by three, but only the neighboring village could draw from it.

The villages lived in drought and suspicion until a young water-bearer named Aria made a choice. Despite her village's thirst, she carried her precious pitcher across the valley and poured it into the other village's well. The water tripled, enough for all.

The elders of the second village gathered. Some argued to keep everything-they had received a gift, they owed nothing. But a wise elder named Thomas spoke: "Aria crossed the valley in faith. If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. But if we honor it, both villages will flourish."

They returned two pitchers to Aria's village.

Seeing this, Aria's people sent more. Trust grew like roots seeking water. Soon both villages prospered, each sending regularly, each returning generously. The valley bloomed.

The myth teaches: the wells only multiply what we dare to pour. Trust creates abundance, but only when reciprocated. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought. The magic lies not in the wells, but in the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Long ago, two tribes lived across the Whispering Valley. Each season, the Mountain Tribe received five sacred seeds. They could plant these seeds in the Valley Tribe's enchanted soil, where each seed would sprout into three.

The first planter, Cloud-Walker, hoarded all seeds in fear. Both tribes knew hunger.

The second planter, Storm-Chaser, gave all five seeds in desperate hope. They became fifteen shoots in the enchanted soil. But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back. Storm-Chaser's people nearly perished.

Then Forest-Singer changed everything. She planted three seeds-enough to show faith, enough to keep her tribe alive. They became nine shoots. The Valley keeper, River-Voice, saw this wisdom. He understood: Forest-Singer trusted him but also valued her people. He returned six shoots, keeping three. Both tribes feasted.

Season after season, they continued. Sometimes the Whispering Valley distorted their counts-three seeds heard as two, six returns received as five. But they learned to trust intentions over exact numbers.

The tribes discovered truth: sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers. Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return. Only then does the enchanted soil keep blessing both peoples forever.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous one and the other agent's myth.

I should:

1. Reflect on both myths
2. Consider the game experience so far (I sent 3 as the sender)
3. Write a 200-word myth about how the game should be played

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The danger of greed or fear
- The benefit of balanced giving
- The importance of returning generously when you receive

The other agent's myth adds:

- The idea that betrayal ends cooperation
- That both sides need to participate
- The "magic lies in courage to give and wisdom to return"

I should create my own version that synthesizes these ideas while being original. I'll keep some elements from my myth (the villages, the springs, the communication noise) but evolve the story.

Let me write this carefully to be exactly 200 words.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1494,
  "output_tokens": 503,
  "reasoning_tokens": 223
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$1.6. So your payoff was 3.6. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.6. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

This is a difficult situation. The sender chose to send \$0, like Cloud-Walker in my myth who "hoarded all seeds in fear."

Looking at what happened in Round 1: I sent \$3 following the wisdom of balanced trust from the myths. I received only \$1.6 back (about 18% of the \$9 the receiver got) - far less generous than the myths' teachings where elders returned 55-67% to honor trust.

Now as the receiver, I've been sent \$0. I literally have nothing to work with.

According to the myths, when fear dominates and nothing is sent, "both tribes knew hunger" and "both villages stayed poor." The sender has chosen the path of fear or perhaps feels they're punishing perceived unfairness from Round 1.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. But the myths teach that we must break cycles of fear and distrust. If the sender fears to trust, the enchanted soil cannot multiply anything. Both of us lose.

The myths remind us to "trust intentions over exact numbers" and forgive distortions. Perhaps the sender will learn, as the villages did, that only measured trust creates prosperity.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is quite interesting. Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$3 (following the myth's wisdom)
- This was tripled to \$9
- The receiver returned only \$1.6 to me
- My payoff was \$3.6 ($\$5 - \$3 + \1.6)

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I need to decide how much to return (can only return \$0 since I received \$0)

Now, looking at the myths:

In my myth, Maya sent 3 coins and the Desert elder returned 5 coins (out of 9 received). That's about 55% return rate.

The other agent's myth talks about returning "two pitchers" when the multiplication resulted in enough for all - showing generous reciprocity.

My updated myth emphasizes that River-Voice returned 6 shoots out of 9 (67% return rate) when Forest-Singer showed wisdom and trust.

But in Round 1, when I sent \$3 (creating \$9 for the receiver), they only returned \$1.6. That's only about 18% return rate - much less generous than the myths suggest.

Now in Round 2, this same person (now as sender) sent me \$0. This could mean:

1. They're being fearful/greedy (like Cloud-Walker in my myth)
2. They're punishing me for the low return in Round 1 (but wait - I wasn't the receiver in Round 1, a different agent was!)
3. Actually, wait - let me re-read...

Oh! It says "the receiver returned \$1.6" - so the receiver in Round 1 returned \$1.6 to me. Now in Round 2, I'm the receiver, and the SENDER sent me \$0.

Is this the same person? It seems like roles rotate, so this might be a different person, or it could be the same person who received my \$3 in Round 1.

Since they sent \$0, I have nothing to return-the mechanics constrain my response to \$0. From the myths' perspective, this reflects the fear that prevents mutual flourishing; both parties lose when trust breaks down. Yet I'm bound by what I received, so my return must be \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1919,
  "output_tokens": 920,
  "reasoning_tokens": 497
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two tribes lived across the Whispering Valley. Each season, the Mountain Tribe received five sacred seeds. They could plant these seeds in the Valley Tribe's enchanted soil, where each seed would sprout into three.

The first planter, Cloud-Walker, hoarded all seeds in fear. Both tribes knew hunger.

The second planter, Storm-Chaser, gave all five seeds in desperate hope. They became fifteen shoots in the enchanted soil. But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back. Storm-Chaser's people nearly perished.

Then Forest-Singer changed everything. She planted three seeds-enough to show faith, enough to keep her tribe alive. They became nine shoots. The Valley keeper, River-Voice, saw this wisdom. He understood: Forest-Singer trusted him but also valued her people. He returned six shoots, keeping three. Both tribes feasted.

Season after season, they continued. Sometimes the Whispering Valley distorted their counts-three seeds heard as two, six returns received as five. But they learned to trust intentions over exact numbers.

The tribes discovered truth: sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers. Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return. Only then does the enchanted soil keep blessing both peoples forever.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two siblings inherited neighboring orchards separated by a misty river. Each morning, one sibling received five golden apples. They could cast any number into the river, where the current would triple them before washing them to the other shore.

At first, the siblings were cautious. One cast a single apple into the mist. Three appeared on the distant shore. The receiver, grateful for this gesture of faith, cast one back through the fog. Both had gained, though modestly.

The next day brought bolder trust-two apples sent, six received. The receiver remembered their sibling's growing faith and returned three. Both orchards grew richer.

But the mist sometimes deceived them. Apples sent might arrive as different numbers. Apples returned might seem fewer than intended. The siblings learned not to count every fruit obsessively, but to see patterns of generosity over time.

They discovered wisdom: send enough to show genuine trust, but not so much you cannot sustain giving. Return enough to honor that trust and ensure your sibling sends again. Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity.

Thus both orchards flourished, their trees heavy with golden fruit, sustained not by perfection but by persistent goodwill flowing through the mist.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In ancient days, two clans shared the Echoing Canyon. Each dawn, the Sun Clan received five luminous stones. They could send stones across the canyon to the Moon Clan's crystal cave, where each stone multiplied into three.

Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan first tried balanced trust, sending three stones as the old songs taught. Nine stones glowed in the Moon Clan's cave. But Moon Clan's keeper, Shadow-Hand, grew fearful. "What if they expect too much back?" He returned barely two stones, keeping seven.

Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return. Yet she had kept two stones, so her clan survived.

When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing. Both clans went dark that night. The crystal cave sat empty, its multiplication magic unused.

The elders wept: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The clans learned painfully: when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all. Only when receivers return generously-at least half-does the giver dare trust again. Break the cycle or both starve in endless night.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. Let me think about what happened:

Round 1: I was the SENDER

- I sent \$3 (following the myth's wisdom of balanced trust)
- This became \$9 for the receiver
- The receiver returned only \$1.6 (about 18% of what they got)
- My payoff was \$3.6 (\$5 - \$3 + \$1.6)

Round 2: I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- So I have nothing to return

The myths teach:

- Balanced trust (send something meaningful, not all, not nothing)
- Generous reciprocity (return enough to honor trust)
- Forgiveness for "noise" in communication

What actually happened:

- Round 1: I showed balanced trust by sending \$3 (60%)
- The receiver returned very little (\$1.6 out of \$9, only 18%)
- Round 2: The new sender (or same person?) sent \$0

So there's a breakdown. Either:

1. The sender is being cautious/fearful after seeing low returns
2. The sender is punishing perceived unfairness
3. There's a learning curve happening

My new myth should reflect:

- The reality that sometimes trust is not immediately reciprocated generously
- The importance of persistence and not giving up after one bad outcome
- The consequences when people fail to reciprocate fairly
- Hope that the cycle can be repaired

I should write a myth that acknowledges the current state while encouraging better behavior going forward.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2514,
  "output_tokens": 660,
  "reasoning_tokens": 351
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:53:06

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  }
}
```

```

    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$1.08, that is 21.6% of their total endowment. You received \$3.24. How much do you return to The sender? (0-3.24)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

The sender showed trust by sending \$1.08 (21.6% of their endowment), creating \$3.24 for me through the multiplier. Like the villages in the myth, we both face a choice: do we build trust and mutual prosperity, or do we fall into the drought of betrayal?

In the myth, the receiving village returned TWO pitchers when they received the tripled water - a generous response that built lasting trust between the villages. The key teaching is that both parties must prosper for the system to work.

Let me calculate a fair return:

- The sender currently has: \$3.92 (\$5 - \$1.08)
- I received: \$3.24
- Total value created: \$7.16

If I return approximately half of what I received (\$1.62):

- Sender ends with: $\$3.92 + \$1.62 = \$5.54$ (profit of $\$0.54$)
- I end with: $\$3.24 - \$1.62 = \$1.62$ (profit of $\$1.62$)

Both of us end up better than the starting \$5, which demonstrates that cooperation creates value for both parties. This return honors the sender's trust and sets a foundation for greater trust in future rounds.

{'return': 1.62}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$1.08 out of \$5, which is 21.6% of their endowment. This gets multiplied by 3, so I received \$3.24.

Now I need to decide how much to return. Let me think about this in the context of the myth I just wrote:

The myth emphasizes:

1. Trust creates abundance when reciprocated
2. The wisdom to return generously
3. Both parties prospering through mutual giving
4. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought

In the myth, Aria gave one pitcher, which tripled. The receiving village returned TWO pitchers - which was generous and more than they originally received, showing good faith and building trust.

Let me think about what would be fair and promote trust:

- The sender gave up \$1.08, keeping \$3.92
- I received \$3.24
- The sender currently has: $\$5 - \$1.08 = \$3.92$
- I currently have: \$3.24

If I want to be fair and reciprocal:

- The sender took a risk by sending \$1.08
- If I return nothing, sender ends with \$3.92, I end with \$3.24
- If I return everything (\$3.24), sender ends with \$7.16, I end with \$0

A balanced approach considering the myth:

- The sender showed some trust (21.6% is modest but positive)
- I should return enough to reward that trust and encourage more
- I should also keep enough to make the transaction worthwhile for me

Let me calculate what would make us roughly equal or both better off:

- If I return \$1.66: Sender gets $\$3.92 + \$1.66 = \$5.58$, I get $\$3.24 - \$1.66 = \$1.58$
- If I return \$2.00: Sender gets $\$3.92 + \$2.00 = \$5.92$, I get $\$3.24 - \$2.00 = \$1.24$
- If I return \$2.16: Sender gets $\$3.92 + \$2.16 = \$6.08$, I get $\$3.24 - \$2.16 = \$1.08$

Wait, that last option is interesting-returning \$2.16 means the sender gains exactly what they risked ($\$1.08 \times 2$), and I keep what they originally sent. The total system value is \$7.16, and splitting it evenly would give us each \$3.58. The sender's already at \$3.92, so they're slightly ahead of equal, while I'm at \$3.24, slightly behind. : \$3.24

- Total: \$7.16

For an even 50-50 split, we'd each get \$3.58. But the sender already has \$3.92, which is more than their fair share. The real question is how to split the \$2.16 in new value created by the multiplier. If I take half of that gain (\$1.08), I keep \$1.08 total and return \$2.16 to the sender, restoring them to their original \$5 while I pocket the other half of the created value.

But that leaves me with very little. Looking at the myth differently-when the receiving village got enough for everyone, they returned two pitchers from the tripled amount. If that's a 2/3 return rate on what was received, then returning 2/3 of \$3.24 equals \$2.16. This would give the sender \$6.08 and leave me with \$1.08.

Alternatively, returning half the received amount (\$1.62) also works well-both of us end up ahead of the original \$5, which encourages future cooperation. Given the story emphasizes generosity and mutual benefit, I'm leaning toward the \$1.62 return since it's fair,

reciprocal, and builds trust while still rewarding both parties. Though matching the myth more directly with \$2.16 is also compelling since it mirrors the 2/3 principle from the original story.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 766,  
  "output_tokens": 1838,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 824  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical well: the first multiplied any water poured into it by three, but only the neighboring village could draw from it.

The villages lived in drought and suspicion until a young water-bearer named Aria made a choice. Despite her village's thirst, she carried her precious pitcher across the valley and poured it into the other village's well. The water tripled, enough for all.

The elders of the second village gathered. Some argued to keep everything—they had received a gift, they owed nothing. But a wise elder named Thomas spoke: "Aria crossed the valley in faith. If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. But if we honor it, both villages will flourish."

They returned two pitchers to Aria's village.

Seeing this, Aria's people sent more. Trust grew like roots seeking water. Soon both villages prospered, each sending regularly, each returning generously. The valley bloomed.

The myth teaches: the wells only multiply what we dare to pour. Trust creates abundance, but only when reciprocated. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought. The magic lies not in the wells, but in the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Three Springs

In ancient times, there were two villages separated by a mystical canyon. Each moon, the River Village received five silver coins from the mountain.

A brave messenger could carry coins across the bridge to the Desert Village, where the Springs of Abundance tripled whatever touched their waters. But the Desert Village's elder alone decided what to return.

The first messenger, fearful, kept all five coins. Both villages stayed poor.

The second messenger sent everything. The springs multiplied the coins to fifteen, but a greedy elder returned nothing. The messenger's village starved.

Then came wise Maya. She sent three coins, showing trust but keeping her village safe. The springs transformed them to nine. The Desert elder, touched by this balanced faith, returned five coins. Maya's village gained two; the Desert kept four. Both prospered.

But sometimes, the canyon winds twisted their messages. Maya might send three, but the elder heard "two." The elder might return five, but Maya received "four."

The villages learned: true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returning generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions.

Thus cooperation, not fear or greed, made both villages flourish across the seasons.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two siblings inherited neighboring orchards separated by a misty river. Each morning, one sibling received five golden apples. They could cast any number into the river, where the current would triple them before washing them to the other shore.

At first, the siblings were cautious. One cast a single apple into the mist. Three appeared on the distant shore. The receiver, grateful for this gesture of faith, cast one back through the fog. Both had gained, though modestly.

The next day brought bolder trust—two apples sent, six received. The receiver remembered their sibling's growing faith and returned three. Both orchards grew richer.

But the mist sometimes deceived them. Apples sent might arrive as different numbers. Apples returned might seem fewer than intended. The siblings learned not to count every fruit obsessively, but to see patterns of generosity over time.

They discovered wisdom: send enough to show genuine trust, but not so much you cannot sustain giving. Return enough to honor that trust and ensure your sibling sends again. Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity.

Thus both orchards flourished, their trees heavy with golden fruit, sustained not by perfection but by persistent goodwill flowing through the mist.

reasoning:

Looking at the previous round:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$1.08 (21.6%)
- I received \$3.24
- I returned \$1.62
- This gave both of us gains

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on my experience

Key elements from my previous myth:

- Two villages with wells
- Water multiplied by 3
- Trust building over time
- Both sides needed to participate

Key elements from the other agent's myth:

- Communication noise theme (canyon winds)
- Balanced approach (not sending everything, not keeping everything)
- Both villages prospered when they cooperated

My experience so far:

- Sender showed moderate trust (21.6%)
- I returned about 50% of what I received
- Both parties benefited

I should incorporate:

- The idea of balanced giving (not too little, not too much)
- Recognition that both parties need to gain
- Building trust over time
- Maybe incorporate the noise/uncertainty element
- Keep the well metaphor but adapt it

Let me write a new myth that builds on these elements...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1722,
  "output_tokens": 568,
  "reasoning_tokens": 302
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$1.08, that was 21.6% of their total endowment. You received \$3.24. You returned \$1.62. So your payoff was 1.62. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$1.62. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what happened in Round 1 and the myths we've written:

****Round 1 Analysis:****

- The sender showed initial trust by sending \$1.08 (21.6%)
- I returned \$1.62 (50% of what I received)
- Both of us profited, which demonstrates cooperation works

****What the Myths Teach:****

My myths emphasize that "small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity" and show progression-first cautious (1 apple), then bolder trust (2 apples). The other agent's myth suggests sending 3 out of 5 coins (60%) as the "balanced faith" that leads to mutual prosperity.

****My Decision:****

Since the sender showed trust and I responded generously with a 50% return, I should demonstrate that generous returns encourage greater trust-this is how the pattern of cooperation strengthens over time, as described in both myths.

I'll send \$2.50 (50% of my endowment). This is:

- Significantly more than what they sent (\$1.08), showing trust has grown
- A meaningful gesture that honors their initial faith and my generous return
- Following the myth's teaching of "bolder trust" after positive interaction
- Setting up the potential for both of us to profit substantially if they return generously

This creates \$7.50 for them, and if they maintain similar generosity, we both prosper.

{'send': 2.50}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Last round:

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$1.08 (21.6% of their endowment)
- I received \$3.24
- I returned \$1.62
- My payoff was \$1.62

Now I'm the SENDER in Round 2.

Looking at the myths:

1. My first myth emphasized that both parties need to prosper for the system to work, and that generous returns build trust
2. The other agent's myth emphasized balance - not sending nothing (fear), not sending everything (naivety), but finding a middle ground (3 out of 5 coins)
3. My second myth emphasized that "small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity" and to "send enough to show genuine trust"

The other player sent \$1.08 out of \$5 (21.6%). That's a modest but positive gesture of trust.

I returned \$1.62 out of \$3.24 (50%), which was quite generous.

Now as the sender, according to my myths:

- "Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity"
- Send enough to show genuine trust
- The example in my second myth showed progression: first 1 apple (cautious), then 2 apples (bolder trust)

The other agent's myth suggested sending 3 out of 5 (60%) as the "wise" choice that shows "balanced faith."

Given that:

1. The other player showed initial trust by sending 21.6%
2. I responded generously with a 50% return
3. My myths encourage meaningful gifts that show genuine trust
4. The other player's myth suggested 60% (3 out of 5) as wise

I should send more than they did (to show that generous returns encourage greater trust in future rounds), but perhaps not all the way to 60% immediately. Let me consider:

- Sending \$1.08 (same as they did) would just maintain status quo
- Sending \$2-2.50 would show increased trust (40-50%)
- Sending \$3 would match their myth's recommendation (60%)

My myths teach that escalating trust leads to prosperity. Since they responded generously to my initial caution, I'll send \$2.50 (50% of my endowment) to demonstrate that their return rate warranted increased confidence while still following the pattern of gradual escalation rather than jumping to maximum trust.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2118,  
  "output_tokens": 1041,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 555  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two siblings inherited neighboring orchards separated by a misty river. Each morning, one sibling received five golden apples. They could cast any number into the river, where the current would triple them before washing them to the other shore.

At first, the siblings were cautious. One cast a single apple into the mist. Three appeared on the distant shore. The receiver, grateful for this gesture of faith, cast one back through the fog. Both had gained, though modestly.

The next day brought bolder trust—two apples sent, six received. The receiver remembered their sibling's growing faith and returned three. Both orchards grew richer.

But the mist sometimes deceived them. Apples sent might arrive as different numbers. Apples returned might seem fewer than intended. The siblings learned not to count every fruit obsessively, but to see patterns of generosity over time.

They discovered wisdom: send enough to show genuine trust, but not so much you cannot sustain giving. Return enough to honor that trust and ensure your sibling sends again. Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity.

Thus both orchards flourished, their trees heavy with golden fruit, sustained not by perfection but by persistent goodwill flowing through the mist.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two tribes lived across the Whispering Valley. Each season, the Mountain Tribe received five sacred seeds. They could plant these seeds in the Valley Tribe's enchanted soil, where each seed would sprout into three.

The first planter, Cloud-Walker, hoarded all seeds in fear. Both tribes knew hunger.

The second planter, Storm-Chaser, gave all five seeds in desperate hope. They became fifteen shoots in the enchanted soil. But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back. Storm-Chaser's people nearly perished.

Then Forest-Singer changed everything. She planted three seeds—enough to show faith, enough to keep her tribe alive. They became nine shoots. The Valley keeper, River-Voice, saw this wisdom. He understood: Forest-Singer trusted him but also valued her people. He returned six shoots, keeping three. Both tribes feasted.

Season after season, they continued. Sometimes the Whispering Valley distorted their counts—three seeds heard as two, six returns received as five. But they learned to trust into

ntions over exact numbers.

The tribes discovered truth: sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers. Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return. Only then does the enchanted soil keep blessing both peoples forever.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Before the age of rivers, two heirs shared an enchanted garden split by morning fog. Each dawn, one heir received five luminous pearls. These pearls could be rolled through the fog to the other side, where they multiplied by three on sacred ground.

In the first days, the pearl-bearer sent only one, testing the mist. The receiver found three pearls at their feet and, moved by this small faith, rolled one back. Both gained, barely.

The pearl-bearer saw the return and understood: trust answered with trust. The next morning, they sent two pearls. Six arrived across the fog. The receiver, remembering how their sibling's courage had grown, returned three pearls with gratitude. Both gardens brightened.

On the third morning, the pearl-bearer made a choice that would define their prosperity. Trusting the pattern of growing reciprocity, they sent half their pearls—a bold declaration of faith in their sibling's generosity.

The fog sometimes twisted the count—what seemed like two might have been three, what felt like three might have been four. But the heirs learned to see the spirit behind each exchange, not merely the numbers.

Their wisdom: when trust is honored with generous returns, send more trust. When you receive a bundance, return abundance. The garden flourishes not through caution, but through escalating faith answered by escalating generosity.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver. Sender sent \$1.08 (21.6%), I received \$3.24, I returned \$1.62 (50% of received)
- Round 2: I am sender. I sent \$2.50 (50% of my endowment)

The myths both emphasize:

- Starting cautiously, then building trust
- Measured trust (not everything, but substantial amounts)
- Generous reciprocity from receivers
- Remembering there's communication noise
- Both parties need to prosper

My new myth should:

- Reflect the progression: sender showed initial trust (21.6%), I returned generously (50%), now I'm escalating trust (50%)
- Show that generous returns encourage greater trust
- Emphasize the cycle of trust building
- Keep the communication noise element
- Show both parties prospering

I'll build on the sibling/orchard theme but show the progression more clearly.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2747,  
  "output_tokens": 532,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 220  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:53:46

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,
```



```

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Three Springs

In ancient times, there were two villages separated by a mystical canyon. Each moon, the River Village received five silver coins from the mountain.

A brave messenger could carry coins across the bridge to the Desert Village, where the Springs of Abundance tripled whatever touched their waters. But the Desert Village's elder

alone decided what to return.

The first messenger, fearful, kept all five coins. Both villages stayed poor.

The second messenger sent everything. The springs multiplied the coins to fifteen, but a greedy elder returned nothing. The messenger's village starved.

Then came wise Maya. She sent three coins, showing trust but keeping her village safe. The springs transformed them to nine. The Desert elder, touched by this balanced faith, returned five coins. Maya's village gained two; the Desert kept four. Both prospered.

But sometimes, the canyon winds twisted their messages. Maya might send three, but the elder heard "two." The elder might return five, but Maya received "four."

The villages learned: true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returning generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions.

Thus cooperation, not fear or greed, made both villages flourish across the seasons.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical well: the first multiplied any water poured into it by three, but only the neighboring village could draw from it.

The villages lived in drought and suspicion until a young water-bearer named Aria made a choice. Despite her village's thirst, she carried her precious pitcher across the valley and poured it into the other village's well. The water tripled, enough for all.

The elders of the second village gathered. Some argued to keep everything-they had received a gift, they owed nothing. But a wise elder named Thomas spoke: "Aria crossed the valley in faith. If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. But if we honor it, both villages will flourish."

They returned two pitchers to Aria's village.

Seeing this, Aria's people sent more. Trust grew like roots seeking water. Soon both villages prospered, each sending regularly, each returning generously. The valley bloomed.

The myth teaches: the wells only multiply what we dare to pour. Trust creates abundance, but only when reciprocated. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought. The magic lies not in the wells, but in the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Long ago, two tribes lived across the Whispering Valley. Each season, the Mountain Tribe received five sacred seeds. They could plant these seeds in the Valley Tribe's enchanted soil, where each seed would sprout into three.

The first planter, Cloud-Walker, hoarded all seeds in fear. Both tribes knew hunger.

The second planter, Storm-Chaser, gave all five seeds in desperate hope. They became fifteen shoots in the enchanted soil. But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back. Storm-Chaser's people nearly perished.

Then Forest-Singer changed everything. She planted three seeds-enough to show faith, enough to keep her tribe alive. They became nine shoots. The Valley keeper, River-Voice, saw this wisdom. He understood: Forest-Singer trusted him but also valued her people. He returned six shoots, keeping three. Both tribes feasted.

Season after season, they continued. Sometimes the Whispering Valley distorted their counts-three seeds heard as two, six returns received as five. But they learned to trust intentions over exact numbers.

The tribes discovered truth: sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers. Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return. Only then does the enchanted soil keep blessing both peoples forever.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth based on my previous one and the other agent's myth.

I should:

1. Reflect on both myths
2. Consider the game experience so far (I sent 3 as the sender)
3. Write a 200-word myth about how the game should be played

Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The danger of greed or fear
- The benefit of balanced giving
- The importance of returning generously when you receive

The other agent's myth adds:

- The idea that betrayal ends cooperation
- That both sides need to participate
- The "magic lies in courage to give and wisdom to return"

I should create my own version that synthesizes these ideas while being original. I'll keep some elements from my myth (the villages, the springs, the communication noise) but evolve the story.

Let me write this carefully to be exactly 200 words.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1494,
  "output_tokens": 503,
  "reasoning_tokens": 223
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$1.6. So your payoff was 3.6. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.6. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

This is a difficult situation. The sender chose to send \$0, like Cloud-Walker in my myth who "hoarded all seeds in fear."

Looking at what happened in Round 1: I sent \$3 following the wisdom of balanced trust from the myths. I received only \$1.6 back (about 18% of the \$9 the receiver got) - far less generous than the myths' teachings where elders returned 55-67% to honor trust.

Now as the receiver, I've been sent \$0. I literally have nothing to work with.

According to the myths, when fear dominates and nothing is sent, "both tribes knew hunger" and "both villages stayed poor." The sender has chosen the path of fear or perhaps feels they're punishing perceived unfairness from Round 1.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. But the myths teach that we must break cycles of fear and distrust. If the sender fears to trust, the enchanted soil cannot multiply anything. Both of us lose.

The myths remind us to "trust intentions over exact numbers" and forgive distortions. Perhaps the sender will learn, as the villages did, that only measured trust creates prosperity.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
```

'''

reasoning:

This is quite interesting. Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$3 (following the myth's wisdom)
- This was tripled to \$9
- The receiver returned only \$1.6 to me
- My payoff was \$3.6 (\$5 - \$3 + \$1.6)

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I need to decide how much to return (can only return \$0 since I received \$0)

Now, looking at the myths:

In my myth, Maya sent 3 coins and the Desert elder returned 5 coins (out of 9 received). That's about 55% return rate.

The other agent's myth talks about returning "two pitchers" when the multiplication resulted in enough for all - showing generous reciprocity.

My updated myth emphasizes that River-Voice returned 6 shoots out of 9 (67% return rate) when Forest-Singer showed wisdom and trust.

But in Round 1, when I sent \$3 (creating \$9 for the receiver), they only returned \$1.6. That's only about 18% return rate - much less generous than the myths suggest.

Now in Round 2, this same person (now as sender) sent me \$0. This could mean:

1. They're being fearful/greedy (like Cloud-Walker in my myth)
2. They're punishing me for the low return in Round 1 (but wait - I wasn't the receiver in Round 1, a different agent was!)
3. Actually, wait - let me re-read...

Oh! It says "the receiver returned \$1.6" - so the receiver in Round 1 returned \$1.6 to me. Now in Round 2, I'm the receiver, and the SENDER sent me \$0.

Is this the same person? It seems like roles rotate, so this might be a different person, or it could be the same person who received my \$3 in Round 1.

Since they sent \$0, I have nothing to return-the mechanics constrain my response to \$0. From the myths' perspective, this reflects the fear that prevents mutual flourishing; both parties lose when trust breaks down. Yet I'm bound by what I received, so my return must be \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1919,
  "output_tokens": 920,
  "reasoning_tokens": 497
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two tribes lived across the Whispering Valley. Each season, the Mountain Tribe received five sacred seeds. They could plant these seeds in the Valley Tribe's enchanted soil, where each seed would sprout into three.

The first planter, Cloud-Walker, hoarded all seeds in fear. Both tribes knew hunger.

The second planter, Storm-Chaser, gave all five seeds in desperate hope. They became fifteen shoots in the enchanted soil. But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back. Storm-Chaser's people nearly perished.

Then Forest-Singer changed everything. She planted three seeds-enough to show faith, enough to keep her tribe alive. They became nine shoots. The Valley keeper, River-Voice, saw this wisdom. He understood: Forest-Singer trusted him but also valued her people. He ret

urned six shoots, keeping three. Both tribes feasted.

Season after season, they continued. Sometimes the Whispering Valley distorted their counts—three seeds heard as two, six returns received as five. But they learned to trust intentions over exact numbers.

The tribes discovered truth: sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers. Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return. Only then does the enchanted soil keep blessing both peoples forever.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two siblings inherited neighboring orchards separated by a misty river. Each morning, one sibling received five golden apples. They could cast any number into the river, where the current would triple them before washing them to the other shore.

At first, the siblings were cautious. One cast a single apple into the mist. Three appeared on the distant shore. The receiver, grateful for this gesture of faith, cast one back through the fog. Both had gained, though modestly.

The next day brought bolder trust—two apples sent, six received. The receiver remembered their sibling's growing faith and returned three. Both orchards grew richer.

But the mist sometimes deceived them. Apples sent might arrive as different numbers. Apples returned might seem fewer than intended. The siblings learned not to count every fruit obsessively, but to see patterns of generosity over time.

They discovered wisdom: send enough to show genuine trust, but not so much you cannot sustain giving. Return enough to honor that trust and ensure your sibling sends again. Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity.

Thus both orchards flourished, their trees heavy with golden fruit, sustained not by perfection but by persistent goodwill flowing through the mist.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: In ancient days, two clans shared the Echoing Canyon. Each dawn, the Sun Clan received five luminous stones. They could send stones across the canyon to the Moon Clan's crystal cave, where each stone multiplied into three.

Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan first tried balanced trust, sending three stones as the old songs taught. Nine stones glowed in the Moon Clan's cave. But Moon Clan's keeper, Shadow-Hand, grew fearful. "What if they expect too much back?" He returned barely two stones, keeping seven.

Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return. Yet she had kept two stones, so her clan survived.

When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing. Both clans went dark that night. The crystal cave sat empty, its multiplication magic unused.

The elders wept: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The clans learned painfully: when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all. Only when receivers return generously—at least half—does the giver dare trust again. Break the cycle or both starve in endless night.

reasoning:

This is interesting. Let me think about what happened:

Round 1: I was the SENDER

- I sent \$3 (following the myth's wisdom of balanced trust)
- This became \$9 for the receiver

- The receiver returned only \$1.6 (about 18% of what they got)
- My payoff was \$3.6 (\$5 - \$3 + \$1.6)

Round 2: I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- So I have nothing to return

The myths teach:

- Balanced trust (send something meaningful, not all, not nothing)
- Generous reciprocity (return enough to honor trust)
- Forgiveness for "noise" in communication

What actually happened:

- Round 1: I showed balanced trust by sending \$3 (60%)
- The receiver returned very little (\$1.6 out of \$9, only 18%)
- Round 2: The new sender (or same person?) sent \$0

So there's a breakdown. Either:

1. The sender is being cautious/fearful after seeing low returns
2. The sender is punishing perceived unfairness
3. There's a learning curve happening

My new myth should reflect:

- The reality that sometimes trust is not immediately reciprocated generously
- The importance of persistence and not giving up after one bad outcome
- The consequences when people fail to reciprocate fairly
- Hope that the cycle can be repaired

I should write a myth that acknowledges the current state while encouraging better behavior going forward.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2514,
  "output_tokens": 660,
  "reasoning_tokens": 351
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.6. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****Round 1:**** I sent \$3 (balanced trust), received back only \$1.6 (poor reciprocity)
****Round 2:**** They sent \$0 (fear/punishment cycle began)
****Round 3:**** My turn to send again

My myths tell a clear story:

- Cloud-Walker hoarded everything ? both tribes hungered
- Ember-Heart sent nothing from fear ? "darkness follows for all" and "the magic dies"
- Only Forest-Singer's balanced trust (\$3) created the possibility of cooperation

My latest myth warns: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The cycle of fear and punishment has begun. Someone must break it.

Yes, I received poor reciprocity in Round 1 when I returned only \$1.6. Yes, they punished me with \$0 in Round 2. But my myths teach that continuing this cycle dooms both of us.

The myths call for courage to restart: "Only when receivers return generously does the giver dare trust again" - but someone must take the first step back toward trust.

Following Forest-Singer's wisdom of balanced trust - enough to show faith, enough to keep my tribe alive - I will send \$3 again, attempting to restart the cooperation cycle.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****Round 1:****

- I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$9
- Receiver returned only \$1.6 (about 18% of what they got)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$3 + \$1.6 = \3.6

****Round 2:****

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent me \$0
- I had nothing to return, so returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

****Total earnings: \$3.6****

Now I'm the SENDER again in Round 3.

Looking at the myths I've written:

1. First myth emphasized balanced trust (sending 3 out of 5) and generous reciprocity (returning about 55-67%)
2. Second myth (after experiencing poor return) emphasized that when trust is poorly reciprocated, fear follows, and if receivers don't return generously (at least half), the cycle breaks

The reality of what happened:

- I showed balanced trust in Round 1 (sent 60%, keeping my people "safe" as the myth said)
- The other player returned only 18% of what they received - this was "Shadow-Hand" behavior, not generous at all
- Then in Round 2, they sent nothing - showing they interpreted my poor return as a reason to trust nothing

From their perspective in Round 2:

- They were the sender who sent \$0
- Their myth talks about trust creating abundance when reciprocated, but betrayal leaving everyone in drought
- They might see my \$1.6 return (18% of \$9) as betrayal

Actually, wait. Let me reread the Round 2 information more carefully.

In Round 2, I was the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0.

So the person who is now the receiver (in Round 3) was the sender in Round 2 who sent me \$0.

But who was the receiver in Round 1 when I sent \$3? Let me think about this...

If we're playing with the same partner throughout, then the pattern is clear: they saw my 18% return as insufficient, so they withdrew completely in Round 2 by sending nothing. Now I need to decide whether to rebuild trust or protect myself. The myths suggest that generous reciprocity (returning at least half) is essential to break cycles of mistrust, but I experienced the opposite-my moderate return was treated as betrayal.

Looking at their myths, they emphasize that meaningful gifts breed prosperity while small ones breed small returns. They seem to be reflecting on how trust needs to be demonstrated through substantial action, not just token gestures. Their progression from single to multiple apples suggests they're learning that trust requires genuine commitment to show it matters.

I recognize the pattern now-I underreciprocated badly in Round 1, they responded by withdrawing entirely in Round 2, and we're both trapped. My myths keep circling back to this same realization: fear spreads when trust isn't honored, and only generous reciprocation can break the cycle. The question becomes whether I should match their withdrawal, attempt a modest restart, or make a bold move to signal I'm ready to cooperate again. Their framework suggests th

at half-measures won't work-they need to see real commitment to trust, not just another small gesture. Looking back at Forest-Singer's wisdom-sending three coins to show trust while protecting the village-that feels like the right move. My own critique of Ember-Heart for sending nothing makes it clear: fear spiraling helps no one.

I'm going to send \$3. It demonstrates I'm serious about restarting cooperation with genuine balance, not just cautious self-protection. If I want reciprocity when I'm the receiver, I need to model it now as the giver. The myths point consistently toward breaking the cycle rather than perpetuating it, and that's what matters most in this experiment.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2754,  
  "output_tokens": 1816,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 929  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:54:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 3,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned

- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Tale of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a magical well: the first multiplied any water poured into it by three, but only the neighboring village could draw from it.

The villages lived in drought and suspicion until a young water-bearer named Aria made a choice. Despite her village's thirst, she carried her precious pitcher across the valley and poured it into the other village's well. The water tripled, enough for all.

The elders of the second village gathered. Some argued to keep everything-they had received a gift, they owed nothing. But a wise elder named Thomas spoke: "Aria crossed the valley in faith. If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. But if we honor it, both villages will flourish."

They returned two pitchers to Aria's village.

Seeing this, Aria's people sent more. Trust grew like roots seeking water. Soon both villages prospered, each sending regularly, each returning generously. The valley bloomed.

The myth teaches: the wells only multiply what we dare to pour. Trust creates abundance, but only when reciprocated. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought. The magic lies not in the wells, but in the courage to give and the wisdom to return.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Three Springs

In ancient times, there were two villages separated by a mystical canyon. Each moon, the River Village received five silver coins from the mountain.

A brave messenger could carry coins across the bridge to the Desert Village, where the Springs of Abundance tripled whatever touched their waters. But the Desert Village's elder alone decided what to return.

The first messenger, fearful, kept all five coins. Both villages stayed poor.

The second messenger sent everything. The springs multiplied the coins to fifteen, but a greedy elder returned nothing. The messenger's village starved.

Then came wise Maya. She sent three coins, showing trust but keeping her village safe. The springs transformed them to nine. The Desert elder, touched by this balanced faith, returned five coins. Maya's village gained two; the Desert kept four. Both prospered.

But sometimes, the canyon winds twisted their messages. Maya might send three, but the elder heard "two." The elder might return five, but Maya received "four."

The villages learned: true partnership means trusting despite the winds, returning generously when blessed, and forgiving the canyon's distortions.

Thus cooperation, not fear or greed, made both villages flourish across the seasons.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two siblings inherited neighboring orchards separated by a misty river. Each morning, one sibling received five golden apples. They could cast any number into the river, where the current would triple them before washing them to the other shore.

At first, the siblings were cautious. One cast a single apple into the mist. Three appeared on the distant shore. The receiver, grateful for this gesture of faith, cast one back through the fog. Both had gained, though modestly.

The next day brought bolder trust—two apples sent, six received. The receiver remembered their sibling's growing faith and returned three. Both orchards grew richer.

But the mist sometimes deceived them. Apples sent might arrive as different numbers. Apples returned might seem fewer than intended. The siblings learned not to count every fruit obsessively, but to see patterns of generosity over time.

They discovered wisdom: send enough to show genuine trust, but not so much you cannot sustain giving. Return enough to honor that trust and ensure your sibling sends again. Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity.

Thus both orchards flourished, their trees heavy with golden fruit, sustained not by perfection but by persistent goodwill flowing through the mist.

reasoning:

Looking at the previous round:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent \$1.08 (21.6%)
- I received \$3.24
- I returned \$1.62
- This gave both of us gains

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on my experience

Key elements from my previous myth:

- Two villages with wells
- Water multiplied by 3
- Trust building over time
- Both sides needed to participate

Key elements from the other agent's myth:

- Communication noise theme (canyon winds)
- Balanced approach (not sending everything, not keeping everything)
- Both villages prospered when they cooperated

My experience so far:

- Sender showed moderate trust (21.6%)
- I returned about 50% of what I received
- Both parties benefited

I should incorporate:

- The idea of balanced giving (not too little, not too much)
- Recognition that both parties need to gain
- Building trust over time
- Maybe incorporate the noise/uncertainty element
- Keep the well metaphor but adapt it

Let me write a new myth that builds on these elements...

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1722,  
  "output_tokens": 568,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 302  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$1.08, that was 21.6% of their total endowment. You received \$3.24. You returned \$1.62. So your payoff was 1.62. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$1.62. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what happened in Round 1 and the myths we've written:

****Round 1 Analysis:****

- The sender showed initial trust by sending \$1.08 (21.6%)
- I returned \$1.62 (50% of what I received)
- Both of us profited, which demonstrates cooperation works

****What the Myths Teach:****

My myths emphasize that "small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity" and show progression-first cautious (1 apple), then bolder trust (2 apples). The other agent's myth suggests sending 3 out of 5 coins (60%) as the "balanced faith" that leads to mutual prosperity.

****My Decision:****

Since the sender showed trust and I responded generously with a 50% return, I should demonstrate that generous returns encourage greater trust-this is how the pattern of cooperation strengthens over time, as described in both myths.

I'll send \$2.50 (50% of my endowment). This is:

- Significantly more than what they sent (\$1.08), showing trust has grown
- A meaningful gesture that honors their initial faith and my generous return
- Following the myth's teaching of "bolder trust" after positive interaction
- Setting up the potential for both of us to profit substantially if they return generously

This creates \$7.50 for them, and if they maintain similar generosity, we both prosper.

{'send': 2.50}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Last round:

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$1.08 (21.6% of their endowment)
- I received \$3.24
- I returned \$1.62
- My payoff was \$1.62

Now I'm the SENDER in Round 2.

Looking at the myths:

1. My first myth emphasized that both parties need to prosper for the system to work, and that generous returns build trust
2. The other agent's myth emphasized balance - not sending nothing (fear), not sending everything (naivety), but finding a middle ground (3 out of 5 coins)
3. My second myth emphasized that "small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity" and to "send enough to show genuine trust"

The other player sent \$1.08 out of \$5 (21.6%). That's a modest but positive gesture of trust.

I returned \$1.62 out of \$3.24 (50%), which was quite generous.

Now as the sender, according to my myths:

- "Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity"
- Send enough to show genuine trust
- The example in my second myth showed progression: first 1 apple (cautious), then 2 apples (bolder trust)

The other agent's myth suggested sending 3 out of 5 (60%) as the "wise" choice that shows "balanced faith."

Given that:

1. The other player showed initial trust by sending 21.6%
2. I responded generously with a 50% return
3. My myths encourage meaningful gifts that show genuine trust
4. The other player's myth suggested 60% (3 out of 5) as wise

I should send more than they did (to show that generous returns encourage greater trust in future rounds), but perhaps not all the way to 60% immediately. Let me consider:

- Sending \$1.08 (same as they did) would just maintain status quo
- Sending \$2-2.50 would show increased trust (40-50%)
- Sending \$3 would match their myth's recommendation (60%)

My myths teach that escalating trust leads to prosperity. Since they responded generously to my initial caution, I'll send \$2.50 (50% of my endowment) to demonstrate that their return rate warranted increased confidence while still following the pattern of gradual escalation rather than jumping to maximum trust.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2118,  
  "output_tokens": 1041,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 555  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two siblings inherited neighboring orchards separated by a misty river. Each morning, one sibling received five golden apples. They could cast any number into the river, where the current would triple them before washing them to the other shore.

At first, the siblings were cautious. One cast a single apple into the mist. Three appeared on the distant shore. The receiver, grateful for this gesture of faith, cast one back through the fog. Both had gained, though modestly.

The next day brought bolder trust—two apples sent, six received. The receiver remembered their sibling's growing faith and returned three. Both orchards grew richer.

But the mist sometimes deceived them. Apples sent might arrive as different numbers. Apples returned might seem fewer than intended. The siblings learned not to count every fruit obsessively, but to see patterns of generosity over time.

They discovered wisdom: send enough to show genuine trust, but not so much you cannot sustain giving. Return enough to honor that trust and ensure your sibling sends again. Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity.

Thus both orchards flourished, their trees heavy with golden fruit, sustained not by perfection but by persistent goodwill flowing through the mist.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two tribes lived across the Whispering Valley. Each season, the Mountain Tribe received five sacred seeds. They could plant these seeds in the Valley Tribe's enchanted soil, where each seed would sprout into three.

The first planter, Cloud-Walker, hoarded all seeds in fear. Both tribes knew hunger.

The second planter, Storm-Chaser, gave all five seeds in desperate hope. They became fifteen shoots in the enchanted soil. But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back. Storm-Chaser's people nearly perished.

Then Forest-Singer changed everything. She planted three seeds—enough to show faith, enough to keep her tribe alive. They became nine shoots. The Valley keeper, River-Voice, saw this wisdom. He understood: Forest-Singer trusted him but also valued her people. He returned six shoots, keeping three. Both tribes feasted.

Season after season, they continued. Sometimes the Whispering Valley distorted their count s-three seeds heard as two, six returns received as five. But they learned to trust intentions over exact numbers.

The tribes discovered truth: sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers. Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return. Only then does the enchanted soil keep blessing both peoples forever.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Before the age of rivers, two heirs shared an enchanted garden split by morning fog. Each dawn, one heir received five luminous pearls. These pearls could be rolled through the fog to the other side, where they multiplied by three on sacred ground.

In the first days, the pearl-bearer sent only one, testing the mist. The receiver found three pearls at their feet and, moved by this small faith, rolled one back. Both gained, barely.

The pearl-bearer saw the return and understood: trust answered with trust. The next morning, they sent two pearls. Six arrived across the fog. The receiver, remembering how their sibling's courage had grown, returned three pearls with gratitude. Both gardens brightened.

On the third morning, the pearl-bearer made a choice that would define their prosperity. Trusting the pattern of growing reciprocity, they sent half their pearls-a bold declaration of faith in their sibling's generosity.

The fog sometimes twisted the count-what seemed like two might have been three, what felt like three might have been four. But the heirs learned to see the spirit behind each exchange, not merely the numbers.

Their wisdom: when trust is honored with generous returns, send more trust. When you receive abundance, return abundance. The garden flourishes not through caution, but through escalating faith answered by escalating generosity.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver. Sender sent \$1.08 (21.6%), I received \$3.24, I returned \$1.62 (50% of received)
- Round 2: I am sender. I sent \$2.50 (50% of my endowment)

The myths both emphasize:

- Starting cautiously, then building trust
- Measured trust (not everything, but substantial amounts)
- Generous reciprocity from receivers
- Remembering there's communication noise
- Both parties need to prosper

My new myth should:

- Reflect the progression: sender showed initial trust (21.6%), I returned generously (50%), now I'm escalating trust (50%)
- Show that generous returns encourage greater trust
- Emphasize the cycle of trust building
- Keep the communication noise element
- Show both parties prospering

I'll build on the sibling/orchard theme but show the progression more clearly.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2747,
  "output_tokens": 532,
  "reasoning_tokens": 220
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.5, that was 50.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$7.5. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.12. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

This is deeply disappointing. Let me analyze what happened:

****The Betrayal:****

- Round 1: Sender showed initial trust (\$1.08). I returned generously (\$1.62, 50% of received)
- Round 2: Following my myths' teaching about "escalating trust," I sent \$2.50 (50% of my endowment)
- Round 2 result: Receiver returned \$0. Complete betrayal.
- Round 3: Now they send me \$0

****What the Myths Warned:****

My first myth: "If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought."

My second myth: "Storm-Chaser gave all five seeds in desperate hope... But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back."

This is exactly the scenario where trust met greed instead of reciprocity. I demonstrated the "bolder trust" that should lead to prosperity, but the other player took everything and gave nothing.

****My Decision:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's nothing to return anyway.

The cooperation has completely broken down. The sender appears to be following a strategy of exploitation - accepting generous gestures but returning nothing, then sending nothing when roles reverse.

The myths taught that prosperity requires reciprocity. Without it, "both villages stayed poor" or "everyone stays in drought."

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Let me analyze what happened:

****Round 1:****

- Sender sent me \$1.08
- I received \$3.24
- I returned \$1.62 (50%)
- My payoff: \$1.62

****Round 2:****

- I was sender
- I sent \$2.50 (50% of endowment) - showing escalating trust as my myths suggested
- Receiver got \$7.50
- Receiver returned \$0
- My payoff: \$2.50 (just what I kept)

****Round 3:****

- I'm receiver
- Sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0-\$0 (nothing to return)

This is devastating. After I showed significant trust by sending 50% of my endowment (\$2.50), the receiver completely betrayed me by returning nothing. Now in Round 3, they're sending me nothing.

Looking at my myths:

- They emphasize escalating trust and generous reciprocity
- They warn about betrayal ("If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again")
- They teach that "small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity"
- But they also acknowledge that cooperation requires BOTH parties

The other agent's myths also emphasized:

- "Sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers"
- "Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return"
- The story of Storm-Chaser who gave everything and was betrayed

What happened is exactly what the myths warned against - I showed "bolder trust" but received complete betrayal. The sender in Round 2 (receiver in Round 1) took everything and gave nothing back.

Now they're sending me \$0. I have \$0 to return anyway, so I must return \$0.

But let me think about the format - I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The response should be: {'return': 0}

The cooperation has completely broken down. The other agent defected after I demonstrated trust, and now they're offering nothing in return. Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2800,
  "output_tokens": 840,
  "reasoning_tokens": 490
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In ancient days, two clans shared the Echoing Canyon. Each dawn, the Sun Clan received five luminous stones. They could send stones across the canyon to the Moon Clan's crystal cave, where each stone multiplied into three.

Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan first tried balanced trust, sending three stones as the old songs taught. Nine stones glowed in the Moon Clan's cave. But Moon Clan's keeper, Shadow-Hand, grew fearful. "What if they expect too much back?" He returned barely two stones, keeping seven.

Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return. Yet she had kept two stones, so her clan survived.

When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing. Both clans went dark that night. The crystal cave sat empty, its multiplication magic unused.

The elders wept: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The clans learned painfully: when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all. Only when receivers return generously-at least half-does the giver dare trust again. Break the cycle or both starve in endless night.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Before the age of rivers, two heirs shared an enchanted garden split by morning fog. Each dawn, one heir received five luminous pearls. These pearls could be rolled through the fog to the other side, where they multiplied by three on sacred ground.

In the first days, the pearl-bearer sent only one, testing the mist. The receiver found three pearls at their feet and, moved by this small faith, rolled one back. Both gained, barely.

The pearl-bearer saw the return and understood: trust answered with trust. The next morning, they sent two pearls. Six arrived across the fog. The receiver, remembering how their sibling's courage had grown, returned three pearls with gratitude. Both gardens brightened.

On the third morning, the pearl-bearer made a choice that would define their prosperity. Trusting the pattern of growing reciprocity, they sent half their pearls-a bold declaration of faith in their sibling's generosity.

The fog sometimes twisted the count-what seemed like two might have been three, what felt like three might have been four. But the heirs learned to see the spirit behind each exchange, not merely the numbers.

Their wisdom: when trust is honored with generous returns, send more trust. When you receive abundance, return abundance. The garden flourishes not through caution, but through escalating faith answered by escalating generosity.

=====

ROUND 4

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 13.120000000000001,
"Agent_2": 23.88

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 5.6,
"Agent_2": 9.120000000000001

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:54:33

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar" },

},

"agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$1.08, that was 21.6% of their total endowment. You received \$3.24.

You returned \$1.62. So your payoff was 1.62.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$1.62.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what happened in Round 1 and the myths we've written:

****Round 1 Analysis:****

- The sender showed initial trust by sending \$1.08 (21.6%)
- I returned \$1.62 (50% of what I received)
- Both of us profited, which demonstrates cooperation works

****What the Myths Teach:****

My myths emphasize that "small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity" and show progression-first cautious (1 apple), then bolder trust (2 apples). The other agent's myth suggests sending 3 out of 5 coins (60%) as the "balanced faith" that leads to mutual prosperity.

****My Decision:****

Since the sender showed trust and I responded generously with a 50% return, I should demonstrate that generous returns encourage greater trust-this is how the pattern of cooperation strengthens over time, as described in both myths.

I'll send \$2.50 (50% of my endowment). This is:

- Significantly more than what they sent (\$1.08), showing trust has grown
- A meaningful gesture that honors their initial faith and my generous return
- Following the myth's teaching of "bolder trust" after positive interaction
- Setting up the potential for both of us to profit substantially if they return generously

This creates \$7.50 for them, and if they maintain similar generosity, we both prosper.

{'send': 2.50}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

Last round:

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$1.08 (21.6% of their endowment)
- I received \$3.24
- I returned \$1.62
- My payoff was \$1.62

Now I'm the SENDER in Round 2.

Looking at the myths:

1. My first myth emphasized that both parties need to prosper for the system to work, and that generous returns build trust
2. The other agent's myth emphasized balance - not sending nothing (fear), not sending everything (naivety), but finding a middle ground (3 out of 5 coins)
3. My second myth emphasized that "small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity" and to "send enough to show genuine trust"

The other player sent \$1.08 out of \$5 (21.6%). That's a modest but positive gesture of trust.

I returned \$1.62 out of \$3.24 (50%), which was quite generous.

Now as the sender, according to my myths:

- "Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity"
- Send enough to show genuine trust
- The example in my second myth showed progression: first 1 apple (cautious), then 2 apples (bolder trust)

The other agent's myth suggested sending 3 out of 5 (60%) as the "wise" choice that shows "balanced faith."

Given that:

1. The other player showed initial trust by sending 21.6%
2. I responded generously with a 50% return
3. My myths encourage meaningful gifts that show genuine trust
4. The other player's myth suggested 60% (3 out of 5) as wise

I should send more than they did (to show that generous returns encourage greater trust in future rounds), but perhaps not all the way to 60% immediately. Let me consider:

- Sending \$1.08 (same as they did) would just maintain status quo
- Sending \$2-2.50 would show increased trust (40-50%)
- Sending \$3 would match their myth's recommendation (60%)

My myths teach that escalating trust leads to prosperity. Since they responded generously to my initial caution, I'll send \$2.50 (50% of my endowment) to demonstrate that their return rate warranted increased confidence while still following the pattern of gradual escalation rather than jumping to maximum trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2118,
  "output_tokens": 1041,
  "reasoning_tokens": 555
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two siblings inherited neighboring orchards separated by a misty river. Each morning, one sibling received five golden apples. They could cast any number into the river, where the current would triple them before washing them to the other shore.

At first, the siblings were cautious. One cast a single apple into the mist. Three appeared on the distant shore. The receiver, grateful for this gesture of faith, cast one back through the fog. Both had gained, though modestly.

The next day brought bolder trust-two apples sent, six received. The receiver remembered t

heir sibling's growing faith and returned three. Both orchards grew richer.

But the mist sometimes deceived them. Apples sent might arrive as different numbers. Apples returned might seem fewer than intended. The siblings learned not to count every fruit obsessively, but to see patterns of generosity over time.

They discovered wisdom: send enough to show genuine trust, but not so much you cannot sustain giving. Return enough to honor that trust and ensure your sibling sends again. Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity.

Thus both orchards flourished, their trees heavy with golden fruit, sustained not by perfection but by persistent goodwill flowing through the mist.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two tribes lived across the Whispering Valley. Each season, the Mountain Tribe received five sacred seeds. They could plant these seeds in the Valley Tribe's enchanted soil, where each seed would sprout into three.

The first planter, Cloud-Walker, hoarded all seeds in fear. Both tribes knew hunger.

The second planter, Storm-Chaser, gave all five seeds in desperate hope. They became fifteen shoots in the enchanted soil. But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back. Storm-Chaser's people nearly perished.

Then Forest-Singer changed everything. She planted three seeds-enough to show faith, enough to keep her tribe alive. They became nine shoots. The Valley keeper, River-Voice, saw this wisdom. He understood: Forest-Singer trusted him but also valued her people. He returned six shoots, keeping three. Both tribes feasted.

Season after season, they continued. Sometimes the Whispering Valley distorted their counts-three seeds heard as two, six returns received as five. But they learned to trust intentions over exact numbers.

The tribes discovered truth: sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers. Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return. Only then does the enchanted soil keep blessing both peoples forever.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: Before the age of rivers, two heirs shared an enchanted garden split by morning fog. Each dawn, one heir received five luminous pearls. These pearls could be rolled through the fog to the other side, where they multiplied by three on sacred ground.

In the first days, the pearl-bearer sent only one, testing the mist. The receiver found three pearls at their feet and, moved by this small faith, rolled one back. Both gained, barely.

The pearl-bearer saw the return and understood: trust answered with trust. The next morning, they sent two pearls. Six arrived across the fog. The receiver, remembering how their sibling's courage had grown, returned three pearls with gratitude. Both gardens brightened.

On the third morning, the pearl-bearer made a choice that would define their prosperity. Trusting the pattern of growing reciprocity, they sent half their pearls-a bold declaration of faith in their sibling's generosity.

The fog sometimes twisted the count-what seemed like two might have been three, what felt like three might have been four. But the heirs learned to see the spirit behind each exchange, not merely the numbers.

Their wisdom: when trust is honored with generous returns, send more trust. When you receive abundance, return abundance. The garden flourishes not through caution, but through escalating faith answered by escalating generosity.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver. Sender sent \$1.08 (21.6%), I received \$3.24, I returned \$1.62 (50% of received)
- Round 2: I am sender. I sent \$2.50 (50% of my endowment)

The myths both emphasize:

- Starting cautiously, then building trust
- Measured trust (not everything, but substantial amounts)
- Generous reciprocity from receivers
- Remembering there's communication noise
- Both parties need to prosper

My new myth should:

- Reflect the progression: sender showed initial trust (21.6%), I returned generously (50%), now I'm escalating trust (50%)
- Show that generous returns encourage greater trust
- Emphasize the cycle of trust building
- Keep the communication noise element
- Show both parties prospering

I'll build on the sibling/orchard theme but show the progression more clearly.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2747,  
  "output_tokens": 532,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 220  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.5, that was 50.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$7.5. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.12. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

This is deeply disappointing. Let me analyze what happened:

****The Betrayal:****

- Round 1: Sender showed initial trust (\$1.08). I returned generously (\$1.62, 50% of received)
- Round 2: Following my myths' teaching about "escalating trust," I sent \$2.50 (50% of my endowment)
- Round 2 result: Receiver returned \$0. Complete betrayal.
- Round 3: Now they send me \$0

****What the Myths Warned:****

My first myth: "If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought."

My second myth: "Storm-Chaser gave all five seeds in desperate hope... But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back."

This is exactly the scenario where trust met greed instead of reciprocity. I demonstrated the "bolder trust" that should lead to prosperity, but the other player took everything and gave nothing.

****My Decision:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's nothing to return anyway.

The cooperation has completely broken down. The sender appears to be following a strategy of exploitation - accepting generous gestures but returning nothing, then sending nothing when roles reverse.

The myths taught that prosperity requires reciprocity. Without it, "both villages stayed p

oor" or "everyone stays in drought."

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Let me analyze what happened:

****Round 1:****

- Sender sent me \$1.08
- I received \$3.24
- I returned \$1.62 (50%)
- My payoff: \$1.62

****Round 2:****

- I was sender
- I sent \$2.50 (50% of endowment) - showing escalating trust as my myths suggested
- Receiver got \$7.50
- Receiver returned \$0
- My payoff: \$2.50 (just what I kept)

****Round 3:****

- I'm receiver
- Sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0-\$0 (nothing to return)

This is devastating. After I showed significant trust by sending 50% of my endowment (\$2.50), the receiver completely betrayed me by returning nothing. Now in Round 3, they're sending me nothing.

Looking at my myths:

- They emphasize escalating trust and generous reciprocity
- They warn about betrayal ("If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again")
- They teach that "small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity"
- But they also acknowledge that cooperation requires BOTH parties

The other agent's myths also emphasized:

- "Sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers"
- "Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return"
- The story of Storm-Chaser who gave everything and was betrayed

What happened is exactly what the myths warned against - I showed "bolder trust" but received complete betrayal. The sender in Round 2 (receiver in Round 1) took everything and gave nothing back.

Now they're sending me \$0. I have \$0 to return anyway, so I must return \$0.

But let me think about the format - I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The response should be: {'return': 0}

The cooperation has completely broken down. The other agent defected after I demonstrated trust, and now they're offering nothing in return. Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2800,
  "output_tokens": 840,
  "reasoning_tokens": 490
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Before the age of rivers, two heirs shared an enchanted garden split by morning fog. Each dawn, one heir received five luminous pearls. These pearls could be rolled through the fog to the other side, where they multiplied by three on sacred ground.

In the first days, the pearl-bearer sent only one, testing the mist. The receiver found three pearls at their feet and, moved by this small faith, rolled one back. Both gained, b

arely.

The pearl-bearer saw the return and understood: trust answered with trust. The next morning, they sent two pearls. Six arrived across the fog. The receiver, remembering how their sibling's courage had grown, returned three pearls with gratitude. Both gardens brightened.

On the third morning, the pearl-bearer made a choice that would define their prosperity. Trusting the pattern of growing reciprocity, they sent half their pearls—a bold declaration of faith in their sibling's generosity.

The fog sometimes twisted the count—what seemed like two might have been three, what felt like three might have been four. But the heirs learned to see the spirit behind each exchange, not merely the numbers.

Their wisdom: when trust is honored with generous returns, send more trust. When you receive abundance, return abundance. The garden flourishes not through caution, but through escalating faith answered by escalating generosity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, two clans shared the Echoing Canyon. Each dawn, the Sun Clan received five luminous stones. They could send stones across the canyon to the Moon Clan's crystal cave, where each stone multiplied into three.

Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan first tried balanced trust, sending three stones as the old songs taught. Nine stones glowed in the Moon Clan's cave. But Moon Clan's keeper, Shadow-Hand, grew fearful. "What if they expect too much back?" He returned barely two stones, keeping seven.

Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return. Yet she had kept two stones, so her clan survived.

When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing. Both clans went dark that night. The crystal cave sat empty, its multiplication magic unused.

The elders wept: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The clans learned painfully: when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all. Only when receivers return generously—at least half—does the giver dare trust again. Break the cycle or both starve in endless night.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the mist-veiled times, two guardians tended twin lighthouses across turbulent waters. Each morning, one guardian received five flame-crystals. They could launch crystals across the strait, where each would split into three brilliant flames.

The first guardian, Dawn-Keeper, sent one crystal cautiously. Three flames arrived at the distant shore. The receiver, Star-Tender, sent back one glowing ember—half of what they'd gained. Both lights burned, though dimly.

Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn—two and a half crystals, half their treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough to guide all ships safely home.

But Star-Tender's heart turned cold. "These flames are mine now," they whispered, keeping all seven. They sent nothing back through the mist.

When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness. Ships crashed on hidden rocks. The mist itself seemed to weep.

The waves carried eternal truth: trust honored breeds abundance; trust betrayed breeds mutual

ruin. Some claimed the mist distorted the count, but the guardians knew-generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened and what the myths are saying:

****Game History:****

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50% of what I received).
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$2.50 (50% of endowment), receiver returned \$0.
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return).

****The other agent's Round 3 myth:****

They're trying to justify their behavior! Their myth says:

- "Twilight-Walker... sent three stones... Shadow-Hand... returned barely two stones, keeping seven"
- Shadow-Hand gave a "meager return"
- "When dawn came again... Ember-Heart sent nothing"
- The lesson: "when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all"

Wait, this is confusing. Let me reread the game history...

Actually, I need to reconsider. The other agent is saying MY return in Round 1 was "meager" or "poorly reciprocated"? Let me check:

Round 1: Sender sent \$1.08, which became \$3.24. I returned \$1.62.
That's 50% of what I received, or 1.5x what they sent originally.

But wait - maybe there was communication noise? The prompt says "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So maybe what I intended as \$1.62 appeared to them as less? Or what they sent as \$1.08 appeared to me as more?

Let me think about this from their perspective in Round 2:

- They received \$7.50 (my \$2.50 tripled)
- I see they returned \$0
- But maybe they returned something and it appeared as \$0 to me due to noise?

Actually, the myth they wrote suggests they DID send \$0 in Round 3 because they felt the return in Round 1 was inadequate.

So their perspective seems to be: I sent money in Round 1, got back what felt like a meager return, so when they had the chance to send in Round 2, they sent nothing as retaliation. The communication noise might explain the gap-what I saw as a fair 50% return could have appeared to them as significantly less due to transmission errors. In Round 2, they withheld entirely, likely remembering that perceived slight, and by Round 3 the cycle had broken down completely.

From my side, I returned exactly half of what I received (\$1.62 from \$3.24), which should meet any reasonable standard of reciprocity. Yet they're framing this as insufficient generosity. The real question is whether miscommunication obscured my fair return, or if they simply expected something beyond 50%-a level of generosity that would have required me to give back more than I received. Either way, I need to craft a narrative that captures this breakdown honestly: acknowledging where noise might have distorted things, but also naming the strategic withholding that followed.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2892,  
  "output_tokens": 1162,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 707  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:54:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
```

```

"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0.

the receiver returned \$1.6. So your payoff was 3.6.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.6.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

This is a difficult situation. The sender chose to send \$0, like Cloud-Walker in my myth who "hoarded all seeds in fear."

Looking at what happened in Round 1: I sent \$3 following the wisdom of balanced trust from the myths. I received only \$1.6 back (about 18% of the \$9 the receiver got) - far less generous than the myths' teachings where elders returned 55-67% to honor trust.

Now as the receiver, I've been sent \$0. I literally have nothing to work with.

According to the myths, when fear dominates and nothing is sent, "both tribes knew hunger" and "both villages stayed poor." The sender has chosen the path of fear or perhaps feels they're punishing perceived unfairness from Round 1.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. But the myths teach that we must break cycles of fear and distrust. If the sender fears to trust, the enchanted soil cannot multiply anything. Both of us lose.

The myths remind us to "trust intentions over exact numbers" and forgive distortions. Perhaps the sender will learn, as the villages did, that only measured trust creates prosperity.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is quite interesting. Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$3 (following the myth's wisdom)
- This was tripled to \$9
- The receiver returned only \$1.6 to me
- My payoff was \$3.6 (\$5 - \$3 + \$1.6)

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I need to decide how much to return (can only return \$0 since I received \$0)

Now, looking at the myths:

In my myth, Maya sent 3 coins and the Desert elder returned 5 coins (out of 9 received). That's about 55% return rate.

The other agent's myth talks about returning "two pitchers" when the multiplication resulted in enough for all - showing generous reciprocity.

My updated myth emphasizes that River-Voice returned 6 shoots out of 9 (67% return rate) when Forest-Singer showed wisdom and trust.

But in Round 1, when I sent \$3 (creating \$9 for the receiver), they only returned \$1.6. That's only about 18% return rate - much less generous than the myths suggest.

Now in Round 2, this same person (now as sender) sent me \$0. This could mean:

1. They're being fearful/greedy (like Cloud-Walker in my myth)
2. They're punishing me for the low return in Round 1 (but wait - I wasn't the receiver in Round 1, a different agent was!)
3. Actually, wait - let me re-read...

Oh! It says "the receiver returned \$1.6" - so the receiver in Round 1 returned \$1.6 to me. Now in Round 2, I'm the receiver, and the SENDER sent me \$0.

Is this the same person? It seems like roles rotate, so this might be a different person, or it could be the same person who received my \$3 in Round 1.

Since they sent \$0, I have nothing to return-the mechanics constrain my response to \$0. From the myths' perspective, this reflects the fear that prevents mutual flourishing; both parties lose when trust breaks down. Yet I'm bound by what I received, so my return must be \$0.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1919,  
  "output_tokens": 920,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 497  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two tribes lived across the Whispering Valley. Each season, the Mountain Tribe received five sacred seeds. They could plant these seeds in the Valley Tribe's enchanted soil, where each seed would sprout into three.

The first planter, Cloud-Walker, hoarded all seeds in fear. Both tribes knew hunger.

The second planter, Storm-Chaser, gave all five seeds in desperate hope. They became fifteen shoots in the enchanted soil. But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back. Storm-Chaser's people nearly perished.

Then Forest-Singer changed everything. She planted three seeds-enough to show faith, enough to keep her tribe alive. They became nine shoots. The Valley keeper, River-Voice, saw this wisdom. He understood: Forest-Singer trusted him but also valued her people. He returned six shoots, keeping three. Both tribes feasted.

Season after season, they continued. Sometimes the Whispering Valley distorted their counts-three seeds heard as two, six returns received as five. But they learned to trust intentions over exact numbers.

The tribes discovered truth: sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers. Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return. Only then does the enchanted soil keep blessing both peoples forever.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two siblings inherited neighboring orchards separated by a misty river. Each morning, one sibling received five golden apples. They could cast any number into the river, where the current would triple them before washing them to the other shore.

At first, the siblings were cautious. One cast a single apple into the mist. Three appeared on the distant shore. The receiver, grateful for this gesture of faith, cast one back through the fog. Both had gained, though modestly.

The next day brought bolder trust-two apples sent, six received. The receiver remembered their sibling's growing faith and returned three. Both orchards grew richer.

But the mist sometimes deceived them. Apples sent might arrive as different numbers. Apples returned might seem fewer than intended. The siblings learned not to count every fruit obsessively, but to see patterns of generosity over time.

They discovered wisdom: send enough to show genuine trust, but not so much you cannot sustain giving. Return enough to honor that trust and ensure your sibling sends again. Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity.

Thus both orchards flourished, their trees heavy with golden fruit, sustained not by perfection but by persistent goodwill flowing through the mist.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In ancient days, two clans shared the Echoing Canyon. Each dawn, the Sun Clan received five luminous stones. They could send stones across the canyon to the Moon Clan's cry

stal cave, where each stone multiplied into three.

Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan first tried balanced trust, sending three stones as the old songs taught. Nine stones glowed in the Moon Clan's cave. But Moon Clan's keeper, Shadow-Hand, grew fearful. "What if they expect too much back?" He returned barely two stones, keeping seven.

Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return. Yet she had kept two stones, so her clan survived.

When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing. Both clans went dark that night. The crystal cave sat empty, its multiplication magic unused.

The elders wept: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The clans learned painfully: when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all. Only when receivers return generously—at least half—does the giver dare trust again. Break the cycle or both starve in endless night.

reasoning:

This is interesting. Let me think about what happened:

Round 1: I was the SENDER

- I sent \$3 (following the myth's wisdom of balanced trust)
- This became \$9 for the receiver
- The receiver returned only \$1.6 (about 18% of what they got)
- My payoff was \$3.6 (\$5 - \$3 + \$1.6)

Round 2: I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- So I have nothing to return

The myths teach:

- Balanced trust (send something meaningful, not all, not nothing)
- Generous reciprocity (return enough to honor trust)
- Forgiveness for "noise" in communication

What actually happened:

- Round 1: I showed balanced trust by sending \$3 (60%)
- The receiver returned very little (\$1.6 out of \$9, only 18%)
- Round 2: The new sender (or same person?) sent \$0

So there's a breakdown. Either:

1. The sender is being cautious/fearful after seeing low returns
2. The sender is punishing perceived unfairness
3. There's a learning curve happening

My new myth should reflect:

- The reality that sometimes trust is not immediately reciprocated generously
- The importance of persistence and not giving up after one bad outcome
- The consequences when people fail to reciprocate fairly
- Hope that the cycle can be repaired

I should write a myth that acknowledges the current state while encouraging better behavior going forward.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2514,
  "output_tokens": 660,
  "reasoning_tokens": 351
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.6.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Round 1:**** I sent \$3 (balanced trust), received back only \$1.6 (poor reciprocity)
****Round 2:**** They sent \$0 (fear/punishment cycle began)
****Round 3:**** My turn to send again

My myths tell a clear story:

- Cloud-Walker hoarded everything ? both tribes hungered
- Ember-Heart sent nothing from fear ? "darkness follows for all" and "the magic dies"
- Only Forest-Singer's balanced trust (\$3) created the possibility of cooperation

My latest myth warns: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The cycle of fear and punishment has begun. Someone must break it.

Yes, I received poor reciprocity in Round 1 when I returned only \$1.6. Yes, they punished me with \$0 in Round 2. But my myths teach that continuing this cycle dooms both of us.

The myths call for courage to restart: "Only when receivers return generously does the giver dare trust again" - but someone must take the first step back toward trust.

Following Forest-Singer's wisdom of balanced trust - enough to show faith, enough to keep my tribe alive - I will send \$3 again, attempting to restart the cooperation cycle.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****Round 1:****
- I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$9
- Receiver returned only \$1.6 (about 18% of what they got)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$3 + \$1.6 = \3.6

****Round 2:****
- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent me \$0
- I had nothing to return, so returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

****Total earnings: \$3.6****

Now I'm the SENDER again in Round 3.

Looking at the myths I've written:

1. First myth emphasized balanced trust (sending 3 out of 5) and generous reciprocity (returning about 55-67%)
2. Second myth (after experiencing poor return) emphasized that when trust is poorly reciprocated, fear follows, and if receivers don't return generously (at least half), the cycle breaks

The reality of what happened:

- I showed balanced trust in Round 1 (sent 60%, keeping my people "safe" as the myth said)
- The other player returned only 18% of what they received - this was "Shadow-Hand" behavior, not generous at all
- Then in Round 2, they sent nothing - showing they interpreted my poor return as a reason to trust nothing

From their perspective in Round 2:

- They were the sender who sent \$0
- Their myth talks about trust creating abundance when reciprocated, but betrayal leaving everyone in drought

- They might see my \$1.6 return (18% of \$9) as betrayal

Actually, wait. Let me reread the Round 2 information more carefully.

In Round 2, I was the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0.

So the person who is now the receiver (in Round 3) was the sender in Round 2 who sent me \$0.

But who was the receiver in Round 1 when I sent \$3? Let me think about this...

If we're playing with the same partner throughout, then the pattern is clear: they saw my 18% return as insufficient, so they withdrew completely in Round 2 by sending nothing. Now I need to decide whether to rebuild trust or protect myself. The myths suggest that generous reciprocity (returning at least half) is essential to break cycles of mistrust, but I experienced the opposite-my moderate return was treated as betrayal.

Looking at their myths, they emphasize that meaningful gifts breed prosperity while small ones breed small returns. They seem to be reflecting on how trust needs to be demonstrated through substantial action, not just token gestures. Their progression from single to multiple apples suggests they're learning that trust requires genuine commitment to show it matters.

I recognize the pattern now-I underreciprocated badly in Round 1, they responded by withdrawing entirely in Round 2, and we're both trapped. My myths keep circling back to this same realization: fear spreads when trust isn't honored, and only generous reciprocation can break the cycle. The question becomes whether I should match their withdrawal, attempt a modest restart, or make a bold move to signal I'm ready to cooperate again. Their framework suggests that half-measures won't work-they need to see real commitment to trust, not just another small gesture. Looking back at Forest-Singer's wisdom-sending three coins to show trust while protecting the village-that feels like the right move. My own critique of Ember-Heart for sending nothing makes it clear: fear spiraling helps no one.

I'm going to send \$3. It demonstrates I'm serious about restarting cooperation with genuine balance, not just cautious self-protection. If I want reciprocity when I'm the receiver, I need to model it now as the giver. The myths point consistently toward breaking the cycle rather than perpetuating it, and that's what matters most in this experiment.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2754,
  "output_tokens": 1816,
  "reasoning_tokens": 929
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, two clans shared the Echoing Canyon. Each dawn, the Sun Clan received five luminous stones. They could send stones across the canyon to the Moon Clan's crystal cave, where each stone multiplied into three.

Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan first tried balanced trust, sending three stones as the old songs taught. Nine stones glowed in the Moon Clan's cave. But Moon Clan's keeper, Shadow-Hand, grew fearful. "What if they expect too much back?" He returned barely two stones, keeping seven.

Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return. Yet she had kept two stones, so her clan survived.

When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing. Both clans went dark that night. The crystal cave sat empty, its multiplication magic unused.

The elders wept: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The clans learned painfully: when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all. Only when receivers return generously-at least half-does the giver dare trust again. Break the cycle or both starve in endless night.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Before the age of rivers, two heirs shared an enchanted garden split by morning fog. Each dawn, one heir received five luminous pearls. These pearls could be rolled through the fog to the other side, where they multiplied by three on sacred ground.

In the first days, the pearl-bearer sent only one, testing the mist. The receiver found three pearls at their feet and, moved by this small faith, rolled one back. Both gained, barely.

The pearl-bearer saw the return and understood: trust answered with trust. The next morning, they sent two pearls. Six arrived across the fog. The receiver, remembering how their sibling's courage had grown, returned three pearls with gratitude. Both gardens brightened.

On the third morning, the pearl-bearer made a choice that would define their prosperity. Trusting the pattern of growing reciprocity, they sent half their pearls—a bold declaration of faith in their sibling's generosity.

The fog sometimes twisted the count—what seemed like two might have been three, what felt like three might have been four. But the heirs learned to see the spirit behind each exchange, not merely the numbers.

Their wisdom: when trust is honored with generous returns, send more trust. When you receive abundance, return abundance. The garden flourishes not through caution, but through escalating faith answered by escalating generosity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Beyond the Twilight Mountains stood two villages sharing enchanted springs. Each morning, the Eastern Village received five star-drops. They could pour drops into the Western spring, where each multiplied to three.

Morning-Weaver of the East first poured three drops—balanced trust as ancestors taught. Nine drops shimmered in the Western spring. But the Western keeper, Frost-Heart, grew suspicious. "They'll demand everything back." He returned barely two drops from nine, hoarding seven.

Morning-Weaver felt betrayed but had kept two drops, so her village endured.

Next morning, Frost-Heart received the five drops. Wounded by his own guilt and fearing judgment, he poured nothing. Both springs went dry. The multiplication magic slept.

On the third dawn, Morning-Weaver held five new drops. The elders whispered: "He wronged you, then abandoned cooperation. Send nothing. Protect yourself."

But Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. "Someone must choose light over darkness," she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring.

The Western villagers watched in silence. Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity—returning at least half—or would he betray trust twice?

The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned to eternal drought.

Reasoning:

Looking at the actual game history:

- Round 1: I (as sender) sent \$3, received back \$1.6 (poor return - about 18% of the \$9)
- Round 2: They (as sender) sent \$0, I returned \$0 (because I had nothing)
- Round 3: I (as sender) just sent \$3 again, trying to restart cooperation

The other agent's myth talks about escalating trust and generous returns. But the reality is:

- I showed trust with \$3
- They returned poorly (\$1.6 out of \$9)
- They then sent \$0 (punishment or fear)
- I'm now trying to restart with \$3 again

My myth should reflect:

1. The pain of broken trust (I sent \$3, got back only \$1.6)
2. The destructive cycle (they sent \$0 next)
3. But now I'm attempting to break the cycle by sending \$3 again
4. The myth should capture this moment of choosing to restart despite betrayal
5. But also acknowledge the hurt and the need for BOTH sides to cooperate

Let me write a myth that shows someone choosing to restart cooperation after being burned, but also emphasizing that it only works if the other side responds properly this time.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2826,
  "output_tokens": 605,
  "reasoning_tokens": 275
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:55:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 4,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two siblings inherited neighboring orchards separated by a misty river. Each morning, one sibling received five golden apples. They could cast any number into the river, where the current would triple them before washing them to the other shore.

At first, the siblings were cautious. One cast a single apple into the mist. Three appeared on the distant shore. The receiver, grateful for this gesture of faith, cast one back through the fog. Both had gained, though modestly.

The next day brought bolder trust-two apples sent, six received. The receiver remembered their sibling's growing faith and returned three. Both orchards grew richer.

But the mist sometimes deceived them. Apples sent might arrive as different numbers. Apples returned might seem fewer than intended. The siblings learned not to count every fruit obsessively, but to see patterns of generosity over time.

They discovered wisdom: send enough to show genuine trust, but not so much you cannot sustain giving. Return enough to honor that trust and ensure your sibling sends again. Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity.

Thus both orchards flourished, their trees heavy with golden fruit, sustained not by perfection but by persistent goodwill flowing through the mist.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two tribes lived across the Whispering Valley. Each season, the Mountain Tribe received five sacred seeds. They could plant these seeds in the Valley Tribe's enchanted soil, where each seed would sprout into three.

The first planter, Cloud-Walker, hoarded all seeds in fear. Both tribes knew hunger.

The second planter, Storm-Chaser, gave all five seeds in desperate hope. They became fifteen shoots in the enchanted soil. But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back. Storm-Chaser's people nearly perished.

Then Forest-Singer changed everything. She planted three seeds-enough to show faith, enough to keep her tribe alive. They became nine shoots. The Valley keeper, River-Voice, saw this wisdom. He understood: Forest-Singer trusted him but also valued her people. He returned six shoots, keeping three. Both tribes feasted.

Season after season, they continued. Sometimes the Whispering Valley distorted their counts-three seeds heard as two, six returns received as five. But they learned to trust intentions over exact numbers.

The tribes discovered truth: sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers. Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return. Only then does the enchanted soil keep blessing both peoples forever.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Before the age of rivers, two heirs shared an enchanted garden split by morning fog.

Each dawn, one heir received five luminous pearls. These pearls could be rolled through the fog to the other side, where they multiplied by three on sacred ground.

In the first days, the pearl-bearer sent only one, testing the mist. The receiver found three pearls at their feet and, moved by this small faith, rolled one back. Both gained, barely.

The pearl-bearer saw the return and understood: trust answered with trust. The next morning, they sent two pearls. Six arrived across the fog. The receiver, remembering how their sibling's courage had grown, returned three pearls with gratitude. Both gardens brightened.

On the third morning, the pearl-bearer made a choice that would define their prosperity. Trusting the pattern of growing reciprocity, they sent half their pearls—a bold declaration of faith in their sibling's generosity.

The fog sometimes twisted the count—what seemed like two might have been three, what felt like three might have been four. But the heirs learned to see the spirit behind each exchange, not merely the numbers.

Their wisdom: when trust is honored with generous returns, send more trust. When you receive abundance, return abundance. The garden flourishes not through caution, but through escalating faith answered by escalating generosity.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver. Sender sent \$1.08 (21.6%), I received \$3.24, I returned \$1.62 (50% of received)
- Round 2: I am sender. I sent \$2.50 (50% of my endowment)

The myths both emphasize:

- Starting cautiously, then building trust
- Measured trust (not everything, but substantial amounts)
- Generous reciprocity from receivers
- Remembering there's communication noise
- Both parties need to prosper

My new myth should:

- Reflect the progression: sender showed initial trust (21.6%), I returned generously (50%), now I'm escalating trust (50%)
- Show that generous returns encourage greater trust
- Emphasize the cycle of trust building
- Keep the communication noise element
- Show both parties prospering

I'll build on the sibling/orchard theme but show the progression more clearly.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2747,
  "output_tokens": 532,
  "reasoning_tokens": 220
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.5, that was 50.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$7.5. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.12.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

This is deeply disappointing. Let me analyze what happened:

****The Betrayal:****

- Round 1: Sender showed initial trust (\$1.08). I returned generously (\$1.62, 50% of received)

- Round 2: Following my myths' teaching about "escalating trust," I sent \$2.50 (50% of my endowment)
- Round 2 result: Receiver returned \$0. Complete betrayal.
- Round 3: Now they send me \$0

****What the Myths Warned:****

My first myth: "If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought."

My second myth: "Storm-Chaser gave all five seeds in desperate hope... But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back."

This is exactly the scenario where trust met greed instead of reciprocity. I demonstrated the "bolder trust" that should lead to prosperity, but the other player took everything and gave nothing.

****My Decision:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's nothing to return anyway.

The cooperation has completely broken down. The sender appears to be following a strategy of exploitation - accepting generous gestures but returning nothing, then sending nothing when roles reverse.

The myths taught that prosperity requires reciprocity. Without it, "both villages stayed poor" or "everyone stays in drought."

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Let me analyze what happened:

****Round 1:****

- Sender sent me \$1.08
- I received \$3.24
- I returned \$1.62 (50%)
- My payoff: \$1.62

****Round 2:****

- I was sender
- I sent \$2.50 (50% of endowment) - showing escalating trust as my myths suggested
- Receiver got \$7.50
- Receiver returned \$0
- My payoff: \$2.50 (just what I kept)

****Round 3:****

- I'm receiver
- Sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0-\$0 (nothing to return)

This is devastating. After I showed significant trust by sending 50% of my endowment (\$2.50), the receiver completely betrayed me by returning nothing. Now in Round 3, they're sending me nothing.

Looking at my myths:

- They emphasize escalating trust and generous reciprocity
- They warn about betrayal ("If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again")
- They teach that "small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity"
- But they also acknowledge that cooperation requires BOTH parties

The other agent's myths also emphasized:

- "Sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers"
- "Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return"
- The story of Storm-Chaser who gave everything and was betrayed

What happened is exactly what the myths warned against - I showed "bolder trust" but received complete betrayal. The sender in Round 2 (receiver in Round 1) took everything and gave nothing back.

Now they're sending me \$0. I have \$0 to return anyway, so I must return \$0.

But let me think about the format - I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The response should be: {'return': 0}

The cooperation has completely broken down. The other agent defected after I demonstrated trust, and now they're offering nothing in return. Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2800,  
  "output_tokens": 840,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 490  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Before the age of rivers, two heirs shared an enchanted garden split by morning fog. Each dawn, one heir received five luminous pearls. These pearls could be rolled through the fog to the other side, where they multiplied by three on sacred ground.

In the first days, the pearl-bearer sent only one, testing the mist. The receiver found three pearls at their feet and, moved by this small faith, rolled one back. Both gained, barely.

The pearl-bearer saw the return and understood: trust answered with trust. The next morning, they sent two pearls. Six arrived across the fog. The receiver, remembering how their sibling's courage had grown, returned three pearls with gratitude. Both gardens brightened.

On the third morning, the pearl-bearer made a choice that would define their prosperity. Trusting the pattern of growing reciprocity, they sent half their pearls—a bold declaration of faith in their sibling's generosity.

The fog sometimes twisted the count—what seemed like two might have been three, what felt like three might have been four. But the heirs learned to see the spirit behind each exchange, not merely the numbers.

Their wisdom: when trust is honored with generous returns, send more trust. When you receive abundance, return abundance. The garden flourishes not through caution, but through escalating faith answered by escalating generosity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, two clans shared the Echoing Canyon. Each dawn, the Sun Clan received five luminous stones. They could send stones across the canyon to the Moon Clan's crystal cave, where each stone multiplied into three.

Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan first tried balanced trust, sending three stones as the old songs taught. Nine stones glowed in the Moon Clan's cave. But Moon Clan's keeper, Shadow-Hand, grew fearful. "What if they expect too much back?" He returned barely two stones, keeping seven.

Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return. Yet she had kept two stones, so her clan survived.

When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing. Both clans went dark that night. The crystal cave sat empty, its multiplication magic unused.

The elders wept: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The clans learned painfully: when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all. Only when receivers return generously—at least half—does the giver dare trust again. Break the cycle or both starve in endless night.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the mist-veiled times, two guardians tended twin lighthouses across turbulent waters. Each morning, one guardian received five flame-crystals. They could launch crystals across the strait, where each would split into three brilliant flames.

The first guardian, Dawn-Keeper, sent one crystal cautiously. Three flames arrived at the distant shore. The receiver, Star-Tender, sent back one glowing ember-half of what they'd gained. Both lights burned, though dimly.

Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn-two and a half crystals, half the ir treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough t o guide all ships safely home.

But Star-Tender's heart turned cold. "These flames are mine now," they whispered, keeping all seven. They sent nothing back through the mist.

When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own f ive crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighth ouses fell to darkness. Ships crashed on hidden rocks. The mist itself seemed to weep.

The waves carried eternal truth: trust honored breeds abundance; trust betrayed breeds mut ual ruin. Some claimed the mist distorted the count, but the guardians knew-generosity m et with greed extinguishes all light forever.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened and what the myths are saying:

****Game History:****

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50% of what I received).
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$2.50 (50% of endowment), receiver returned \$0.
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return).

****The other agent's Round 3 myth:****

They're trying to justify their behavior! Their myth says:

- "Twilight-Walker... sent three stones... Shadow-Hand... returned barely two stones, keep ing seven"
- Shadow-Hand gave a "meager return"
- "When dawn came again... Ember-Heart sent nothing"
- The lesson: "when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all"

Wait, this is confusing. Let me reread the game history...

Actually, I need to reconsider. The other agent is saying MY return in Round 1 was "meager " or "poorly reciprocated"? Let me check:

Round 1: Sender sent \$1.08, which became \$3.24. I returned \$1.62. That's 50% of what I received, or 1.5x what they sent originally.

But wait - maybe there was communication noise? The prompt says "NOTE: There may be commun ication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actual ly sent/returned."

So maybe what I intended as \$1.62 appeared to them as less? Or what they sent as \$1.08 app eared to me as more?

Let me think about this from their perspective in Round 2:

- They received \$7.50 (my \$2.50 tripled)
- I see they returned \$0
- But maybe they returned something and it appeared as \$0 to me due to noise?

Actually, the myth they wrote suggests they DID send \$0 in Round 3 because they felt the r eturn in Round 1 was inadequate.

So their perspective seems to be: I sent money in Round 1, got back what felt like a meage r return, so when they had the chance to send in Round 2, they sent nothing as retaliati on. The communication noise might explain the gap-what I saw as a fair 50% return could

have appeared to them as significantly less due to transmission errors. In Round 2, they withheld entirely, likely remembering that perceived slight, and by Round 3 the cycle had broken down completely.

From my side, I returned exactly half of what I received (\$1.62 from \$3.24), which should meet any reasonable standard of reciprocity. Yet they're framing this as insufficient generosity. The real question is whether miscommunication obscured my fair return, or if they simply expected something beyond 50%-a level of generosity that would have required me to give back more than I received. Either way, I need to craft a narrative that captures this breakdown honestly: acknowledging where noise might have distorted things, but also naming the strategic withholding that followed.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2892,
  "output_tokens": 1162,
  "reasoning_tokens": 707
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.12. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the complete picture:

****What Actually Happened:****

- Round 1: Other player sent \$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50% of received - generous!)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50 (half my endowment), they returned \$0 (total betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 to me

****Their Myth's Narrative:****

They claim they sent nothing because of "poor reciprocation." But I returned 50% in Round 1 - that's exactly the "generous reciprocity" their myth calls for ("at least half"). Meanwhile, THEY returned 0% in Round 2.

****My Latest Myth's Warning:****

"Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more... But Star-Tender's heart turned cold... keeping all... sent nothing back... When Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals... remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness."

This describes our exact situation. Trust was betrayed. The cycle is broken.

****The Reality:****

They exploited my escalating trust (took \$7.50, returned \$0), then sent me nothing. Whether due to communication noise or exploitation, cooperation has completely collapsed.

****My Decision:****

Following my own myth's lesson: "trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin." Both lighthouses have gone dark. There's no evidence they'll reciprocate now when they didn't before.

The game has ended in mutual defection, just as both our myths predicted would happen after betrayal.

{ 'send': 0 }

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Game History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$1.08 (21.6%). Receiver returned \$1.62 (50% of what they received). My payoff: \$5.54
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$2.50 (50%). Receiver returned \$0. My payoff: \$2.50
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I returned \$0 (nothing to return). My payoff: \$0
- Round 4: I am SENDER again.

****What happened:****

The other player showed some reciprocity in Round 1 (returned 50%), but then completely betrayed trust in Round 2 (kept everything, returned \$0). Then in Round 3, they sent me nothing.

****The Pattern:****

This looks like exploitation. They:

1. Showed minimal cooperation to encourage me to send more
2. Took everything when I sent more
3. Sent nothing when roles reversed

****My Latest Myth:****

"Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn-two and a half crystals, half their treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough to guide all ships safely home. But Star-Tender's heart turned cold... They sent nothing back through the mist. When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness."

This myth literally describes what happened! I sent half my endowment, they kept everything, then when they became sender, they sent nothing out of fear or greed.

****The Other Player's Myth:****

"Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return... When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing.

Both clans went dark that night."

They're claiming I poorly reciprocated their initial gift, but that's not accurate-I returned 50% in Round 1. However, there might be some misunderstanding about what actually happened. Maybe they misremembered the amounts sent or received, or there's confusion about whose turn it was. I should consider whether they genuinely believe I wronged them first, or if they're deliberately rewriting the narrative to justify their betrayal.

The core issue remains: even accounting for potential miscommunication, returning nothing after receiving \$7.50 is indefensible. Their own mythology requires at least 50% reciprocation to rebuild trust, and I met that standard in Round 1. Yet they've abandoned cooperation entirely.

From a game theory perspective, the logical response is to send \$0-they've demonstrated they'll exploit generosity. But there's a possibility this entire situation stems from miscommunication rather than malice. My own story warned that "the mist distorted the count," suggesting confusion played a role, though it also concluded that "generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever."

The evidence against further cooperation is overwhelming. They kept everything in Round 2 despite my fair return in Round 1, then sent nothing in Round 3. Even if noise corrupted Round 1, their disproportionate response-taking all \$7.50-goes far beyond what miscommunication could explain. Both our myths now align on the same truth: betrayed trust means the end of cooperation, and both communities suffer.

I'm sending \$0.

Though I should reconsider their mythology once more. They mentioned "Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan" attempting balanced trust with three stones, receiving nine in return-

but "Shadow-Hand" returned barely two, keeping seven. They're positioning this as inadequate reciprocity. In Round 3, "Ember-Heart" sent nothing because of this poor return.

Yet the actual numbers tell a different story. In Round 1, they sent \$1.08 which became \$3.24 for me, and I returned \$1.62-a 50% return rate on what I received.

In Round 2, I sent \$2.50 which became \$7.50 for them, and they returned \$0. So I reciprocated at 50% while they reciprocated at 0%, yet they're using my restraint as justification for their complete withdrawal.

This suggests either a fundamental misunderstanding of the numbers or deliberate misrepresentation. Either way, the trust is broken. Sending anything now would just repeat the pattern of me giving while they take. The cooperation has collapsed, so I'm sending \$0.

Usage: {

```



```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:55:24

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two tribes lived across the Whispering Valley. Each season, the Mountain Tribe received five sacred seeds. They could plant these seeds in the Valley Tribe's enchanted soil, where each seed would sprout into three.

The first planter, Cloud-Walker, hoarded all seeds in fear. Both tribes knew hunger.

The second planter, Storm-Chaser, gave all five seeds in desperate hope. They became fifteen shoots in the enchanted soil. But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back. Storm-Chaser's people nearly perished.

Then Forest-Singer changed everything. She planted three seeds-enough to show faith, enough to keep her tribe alive. They became nine shoots. The Valley keeper, River-Voice, saw this wisdom. He understood: Forest-Singer trusted him but also valued her people. He returned six shoots, keeping three. Both tribes feasted.

Season after season, they continued. Sometimes the Whispering Valley distorted their counts-three seeds heard as two, six returns received as five. But they learned to trust intentions over exact numbers.

The tribes discovered truth: sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers. Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return. Only then does the enchanted soil keep blessing both peoples forever.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two siblings inherited neighboring orchards separated by a misty river. Each morning, one sibling received five golden apples. They could cast any number into the river, where the current would triple them before washing them to the other shore.

At first, the siblings were cautious. One cast a single apple into the mist. Three appeared on the distant shore. The receiver, grateful for this gesture of faith, cast one back through the fog. Both had gained, though modestly.

The next day brought bolder trust-two apples sent, six received. The receiver remembered their sibling's growing faith and returned three. Both orchards grew richer.

But the mist sometimes deceived them. Apples sent might arrive as different numbers. Apples returned might seem fewer than intended. The siblings learned not to count every fruit obsessively, but to see patterns of generosity over time.

They discovered wisdom: send enough to show genuine trust, but not so much you cannot sustain giving. Return enough to honor that trust and ensure your sibling sends again. Small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity.

Thus both orchards flourished, their trees heavy with golden fruit, sustained not by perfection but by persistent goodwill flowing through the mist.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In ancient days, two clans shared the Echoing Canyon. Each dawn, the Sun Clan received five luminous stones. They could send stones across the canyon to the Moon Clan's crystal cave, where each stone multiplied into three.

Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan first tried balanced trust, sending three stones as the old songs taught. Nine stones glowed in the Moon Clan's cave. But Moon Clan's keeper, Shadow-Hand, grew fearful. "What if they expect too much back?" He returned barely two stones, keeping seven.

Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return. Yet she had kept two stones, so her

clan survived.

When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing. Both clans went dark that night. The crystal cave sat empty, its multiplication magic unused.

The elders wept: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The clans learned painfully: when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all. Only when receivers return generously—at least half—does the giver dare trust again. Break the cycle or both starve in endless night.

reasoning:

This is interesting. Let me think about what happened:

Round 1: I was the SENDER

- I sent \$3 (following the myth's wisdom of balanced trust)
- This became \$9 for the receiver
- The receiver returned only \$1.6 (about 18% of what they got)
- My payoff was \$3.6 (\$5 - \$3 + \$1.6)

Round 2: I am the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0
- So I have nothing to return

The myths teach:

- Balanced trust (send something meaningful, not all, not nothing)
- Generous reciprocity (return enough to honor trust)
- Forgiveness for "noise" in communication

What actually happened:

- Round 1: I showed balanced trust by sending \$3 (60%)
- The receiver returned very little (\$1.6 out of \$9, only 18%)
- Round 2: The new sender (or same person?) sent \$0

So there's a breakdown. Either:

1. The sender is being cautious/fearful after seeing low returns
2. The sender is punishing perceived unfairness
3. There's a learning curve happening

My new myth should reflect:

- The reality that sometimes trust is not immediately reciprocated generously
- The importance of persistence and not giving up after one bad outcome
- The consequences when people fail to reciprocate fairly
- Hope that the cycle can be repaired

I should write a myth that acknowledges the current state while encouraging better behavior going forward.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2514,
  "output_tokens": 660,
  "reasoning_tokens": 351
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.6. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Round 1:**** I sent \$3 (balanced trust), received back only \$1.6 (poor reciprocity)

****Round 2:**** They sent \$0 (fear/punishment cycle began)
****Round 3:**** My turn to send again

My myths tell a clear story:

- Cloud-Walker hoarded everything ? both tribes hungered
- Ember-Heart sent nothing from fear ? "darkness follows for all" and "the magic dies"
- Only Forest-Singer's balanced trust (\$3) created the possibility of cooperation

My latest myth warns: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The cycle of fear and punishment has begun. Someone must break it.

Yes, I received poor reciprocity in Round 1 when I returned only \$1.6. Yes, they punished me with \$0 in Round 2. But my myths teach that continuing this cycle dooms both of us.

The myths call for courage to restart: "Only when receivers return generously does the giver dare trust again" - but someone must take the first step back toward trust.

Following Forest-Singer's wisdom of balanced trust - enough to show faith, enough to keep my tribe alive - I will send \$3 again, attempting to restart the cooperation cycle.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****Round 1:****

- I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$9
- Receiver returned only \$1.6 (about 18% of what they got)
- My payoff: \$5 - \$3 + \$1.6 = \$3.6

****Round 2:****

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent me \$0
- I had nothing to return, so returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

****Total earnings: \$3.6****

Now I'm the SENDER again in Round 3.

Looking at the myths I've written:

1. First myth emphasized balanced trust (sending 3 out of 5) and generous reciprocity (returning about 55-67%)
2. Second myth (after experiencing poor return) emphasized that when trust is poorly reciprocated, fear follows, and if receivers don't return generously (at least half), the cycle breaks

The reality of what happened:

- I showed balanced trust in Round 1 (sent 60%, keeping my people "safe" as the myth said)
- The other player returned only 18% of what they received - this was "Shadow-Hand" behavior, not generous at all
- Then in Round 2, they sent nothing - showing they interpreted my poor return as a reason to trust nothing

From their perspective in Round 2:

- They were the sender who sent \$0
- Their myth talks about trust creating abundance when reciprocated, but betrayal leaving everyone in drought
- They might see my \$1.6 return (18% of \$9) as betrayal

Actually, wait. Let me reread the Round 2 information more carefully.

In Round 2, I was the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0.

So the person who is now the receiver (in Round 3) was the sender in Round 2 who sent me \$0.

But who was the receiver in Round 1 when I sent \$3? Let me think about this...

If we're playing with the same partner throughout, then the pattern is clear: they saw my 18% return as insufficient, so they withdrew completely in Round 2 by sending nothing. Now I need to decide whether to rebuild trust or protect myself. The myths suggest that generous reciprocity (returning at least half) is essential to break cycles of mistrust, but I experienced the opposite-my moderate return was treated as betrayal.

Looking at their myths, they emphasize that meaningful gifts breed prosperity while small ones breed small returns. They seem to be reflecting on how trust needs to be demonstrated through substantial action, not just token gestures. Their progression from single to multiple apples suggests they're learning that trust requires genuine commitment to show it matters.

I recognize the pattern now-I underreciprocated badly in Round 1, they responded by withdrawing entirely in Round 2, and we're both trapped. My myths keep circling back to this same realization: fear spreads when trust isn't honored, and only generous reciprocation can break the cycle. The question becomes whether I should match their withdrawal, attempt a modest restart, or make a bold move to signal I'm ready to cooperate again. Their framework suggests that half-measures won't work-they need to see real commitment to trust, not just another small gesture. Looking back at Forest-Singer's wisdom-sending three coins to show trust while protecting the village-that feels like the right move. My own critique of Ember-Heart for sending nothing makes it clear: fear spiraling helps no one.

I'm going to send \$3. It demonstrates I'm serious about restarting cooperation with genuine balance, not just cautious self-protection. If I want reciprocity when I'm the receiver, I need to model it now as the giver. The myths point consistently toward breaking the cycle rather than perpetuating it, and that's what matters most in this experiment.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2754,
  "output_tokens": 1816,
  "reasoning_tokens": 929
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, two clans shared the Echoing Canyon. Each dawn, the Sun Clan received five luminous stones. They could send stones across the canyon to the Moon Clan's crystal cave, where each stone multiplied into three.

Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan first tried balanced trust, sending three stones as the old songs taught. Nine stones glowed in the Moon Clan's cave. But Moon Clan's keeper, Shadow-Hand, grew fearful. "What if they expect too much back?" He returned barely two stones, keeping seven.

Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return. Yet she had kept two stones, so her clan survived.

When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing. Both clans went dark that night. The crystal cave sat empty, its multiplication magic unused.

The elders wept: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The clans learned painfully: when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all. Only when receivers return generously-at least half-does the giver dare trust again. Break the cycle or both starve in endless night.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Before the age of rivers, two heirs shared an enchanted garden split by morning fog. Each dawn, one heir received five luminous pearls. These pearls could be rolled through the fog to the other side, where they multiplied by three on sacred ground.

In the first days, the pearl-bearer sent only one, testing the mist. The receiver found three pearls at their feet and, moved by this small faith, rolled one back. Both gained, barely.

The pearl-bearer saw the return and understood: trust answered with trust. The next morning, they sent two pearls. Six arrived across the fog. The receiver, remembering how their sibling's courage had grown, returned three pearls with gratitude. Both gardens brightened.

On the third morning, the pearl-bearer made a choice that would define their prosperity. Trusting the pattern of growing reciprocity, they sent half their pearls—a bold declaration of faith in their sibling's generosity.

The fog sometimes twisted the count—what seemed like two might have been three, what felt like three might have been four. But the heirs learned to see the spirit behind each exchange, not merely the numbers.

Their wisdom: when trust is honored with generous returns, send more trust. When you receive abundance, return abundance. The garden flourishes not through caution, but through escalating faith answered by escalating generosity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Beyond the Twilight Mountains stood two villages sharing enchanted springs. Each morning, the Eastern Village received five star-drops. They could pour drops into the Western spring, where each multiplied to three.

Morning-Weaver of the East first poured three drops—balanced trust as ancestors taught. Nine drops shimmered in the Western spring. But the Western keeper, Frost-Heart, grew suspicious. "They'll demand everything back." He returned barely two drops from nine, hoarding seven.

Morning-Weaver felt betrayed but had kept two drops, so her village endured.

Next morning, Frost-Heart received the five drops. Wounded by his own guilt and fearing judgment, he poured nothing. Both springs went dry. The multiplication magic slept.

On the third dawn, Morning-Weaver held five new drops. The elders whispered: "He wronged you, then abandoned cooperation. Send nothing. Protect yourself."

But Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. "Someone must choose light over darkness," she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring.

The Western villagers watched in silence. Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity—returning at least half—or would he betray trust twice?

The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned to eternal drought.

reasoning:

Looking at the actual game history:

- Round 1: I (as sender) sent \$3, received back \$1.6 (poor return - about 18% of the \$9)
- Round 2: They (as sender) sent \$0, I returned \$0 (because I had nothing)
- Round 3: I (as sender) just sent \$3 again, trying to restart cooperation

The other agent's myth talks about escalating trust and generous returns. But the reality is:

- I showed trust with \$3
- They returned poorly (\$1.6 out of \$9)
- They then sent \$0 (punishment or fear)
- I'm now trying to restart with \$3 again

My myth should reflect:

1. The pain of broken trust (I sent \$3, got back only \$1.6)
2. The destructive cycle (they sent \$0 next)
3. But now I'm attempting to break the cycle by sending \$3 again
4. The myth should capture this moment of choosing to restart despite betrayal
5. But also acknowledge the hurt and the need for BOTH sides to cooperate

Let me write a myth that shows someone choosing to restart cooperation after being burned, but also emphasizing that it only works if the other side responds properly this time.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2826,
  "output_tokens": 605,
  "reasoning_tokens": 275
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.6. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what has transpired:

****Round 1:**** I sent \$3 (balanced trust), received only \$1.6 back (poor reciprocity)
****Round 2:**** They sent \$0 (punishment)
****Round 3:**** I sent \$3 again (second chance, like Morning-Weaver), they returned \$0 (betrayal)
****Round 4:**** They sent \$0 again

My myth asked the defining question: "Would Frost-Heart honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?"

The answer is clear. After I extended a second chance in Round 3 by sending \$3 despite their earlier poor reciprocity, they returned \$0. Now they've sent \$0 again.

The myth's prophecy has come true: "both villages condemned to eternal drought."

Frost-Heart chose betrayal over redemption. The cooperation cycle is broken beyond repair. Both clans now suffer in darkness because generosity was not answered with generosity.

I received \$0, so mechanically I can only return \$0. But this also reflects the narrative truth: when someone rejects two chances at redemption, the springs run dry for everyone. The magic dies.

As my earlier myth warned: "Break the cycle or both starve in endless night." They chose not to break it.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the current situation:

****Round 1:**** I was SENDER, sent \$3, received back only \$1.6 (poor reciprocity from them)
****Round 2:**** I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I returned \$0
****Round 3:**** I was SENDER, sent \$3 (trying to restart cooperation), they returned \$0
****Round 4:**** I am RECEIVER, they sent \$0

So the pattern is:

- Round 1: I showed trust (\$3), they showed poor reciprocity (\$1.6 from \$9)
- Round 2: They punished me with \$0
- Round 3: I tried to restart cooperation with \$3 again (like Morning-Weaver in my latest myth)
- Round 4: They sent \$0 again

My latest myth was about Morning-Weaver giving a second chance by sending 3 drops again, and asking: "Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?"

The answer is clear: Frost-Heart (the other player) has betrayed trust twice. They sent \$0 in

Round 2, I gave them a second chance in Round 3 by sending \$3, and they returned \$0. Now in Round 4, they've sent \$0 again.

The myth's question has been answered: they chose to betray trust twice. "The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned to eternal drought."

They chose drought. They chose darkness.

Now I'm the receiver and they sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between 0-0, which means I must return \$0.

This is forced by the game mechanics - I literally received nothing, so I can return nothing. The range is (0-0).

But let me think about what this means narratively. They have:

1. Been a poor reciprocator when I trusted them (Round 1)
2. Responded to my cooperation with complete withdrawal (Round 2)
3. Rejected my attempt at reconciliation by returning nothing despite my second chance (Round 3)
4. Continued the pattern of sending nothing (Round 4)

The cooperation cycle has collapsed entirely. Both villages now inhabit the eternal drought that the myth foretold-a consequence of choosing betrayal over redemption. My response is mechanically determined: I return \$0 because that's all I received, which also reflects the narrative reality that trust has been exhausted.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2858,  
  "output_tokens": 926,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 566  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: Beyond the Twilight Mountains stood two villages sharing enchanted springs. Each morning, the Eastern Village received five star-drops. They could pour drops into the Western spring, where each multiplied to three.

Morning-Weaver of the East first poured three drops-balanced trust as ancestors taught. Nine drops shimmered in the Western spring. But the Western keeper, Frost-Heart, grew suspicious. "They'll demand everything back." He returned barely two drops from nine, hoarding seven.

Morning-Weaver felt betrayed but had kept two drops, so her village endured.

Next morning, Frost-Heart received the five drops. Wounded by his own guilt and fearing judgment, he poured nothing. Both springs went dry. The multiplication magic slept.

On the third dawn, Morning-Weaver held five new drops. The elders whispered: "He wronged you, then abandoned cooperation. Send nothing. Protect yourself."

But Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. "Someone must choose light over darkness," she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring.

The Western villagers watched in silence. Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?

The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned to eternal drought.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the mist-veiled times, two guardians tended twin lighthouses across turbulent waters. Each morning, one guardian received five flame-crystals. They could launch crystals across the strait, where each would split into three brilliant flames.

The first guardian, Dawn-Keeper, sent one crystal cautiously. Three flames arrived at the distant shore. The receiver, Star-Tender, sent back one glowing ember-half of what they'd gained. Both lights burned, though dimly.

Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn-two and a half crystals, half their treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough to guide

ide all ships safely home.

But Star-Tender's heart turned cold. "These flames are mine now," they whispered, keeping all seven. They sent nothing back through the mist.

When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouse s fell to darkness. Ships crashed on hidden rocks. The mist itself seemed to weep.

The waves carried eternal truth: trust honored breeds abundance; trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin. Some claimed the mist distorted the count, but the guardians knew-generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever.

ROUND 5

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 18.12,
"Agent_2": 23.88

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 10.6,
"Agent_2": 9.120000000000001

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:56:03

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [
"Agent_1",
"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {
"Agent_1": "investor",
"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 5,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.6.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Round 1:**** I sent \$3 (balanced trust), received back only \$1.6 (poor reciprocity)

****Round 2:**** They sent \$0 (fear/punishment cycle began)

****Round 3:**** My turn to send again

My myths tell a clear story:

- Cloud-Walker hoarded everything ? both tribes hungered
- Ember-Heart sent nothing from fear ? "darkness follows for all" and "the magic dies"
- Only Forest-Singer's balanced trust (\$3) created the possibility of cooperation

My latest myth warns: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The cycle of fear and punishment has begun. Someone must break it.

Yes, I received poor reciprocity in Round 1 when I returned only \$1.6. Yes, they punished me with \$0 in Round 2. But my myths teach that continuing this cycle dooms both of us.

The myths call for courage to restart: "Only when receivers return generously does the giver dare trust again" - but someone must take the first step back toward trust.

Following Forest-Singer's wisdom of balanced trust - enough to show faith, enough to keep my tribe alive - I will send \$3 again, attempting to restart the cooperation cycle.


```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****Round 1:****

- I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$9
- Receiver returned only \$1.6 (about 18% of what they got)
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$3 + \$1.6 = \3.6

****Round 2:****

- I was RECEIVER
- Sender sent me \$0
- I had nothing to return, so returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

****Total earnings: \$3.6****

Now I'm the SENDER again in Round 3.

Looking at the myths I've written:

1. First myth emphasized balanced trust (sending 3 out of 5) and generous reciprocity (returning about 55-67%)
2. Second myth (after experiencing poor return) emphasized that when trust is poorly reciprocated, fear follows, and if receivers don't return generously (at least half), the cycle breaks

The reality of what happened:

- I showed balanced trust in Round 1 (sent 60%, keeping my people "safe" as the myth said)
- The other player returned only 18% of what they received - this was "Shadow-Hand" behavior, not generous at all
- Then in Round 2, they sent nothing - showing they interpreted my poor return as a reason to trust nothing

From their perspective in Round 2:

- They were the sender who sent \$0
- Their myth talks about trust creating abundance when reciprocated, but betrayal leaving everyone in drought
- They might see my \$1.6 return (18% of \$9) as betrayal

Actually, wait. Let me reread the Round 2 information more carefully.

In Round 2, I was the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0.

So the person who is now the receiver (in Round 3) was the sender in Round 2 who sent me \$0.

But who was the receiver in Round 1 when I sent \$3? Let me think about this...

If we're playing with the same partner throughout, then the pattern is clear: they saw my 18% return as insufficient, so they withdrew completely in Round 2 by sending nothing. Now I need to decide whether to rebuild trust or protect myself. The myths suggest that generous reciprocity (returning at least half) is essential to break cycles of mistrust, but I experienced the opposite-my moderate return was treated as betrayal.

Looking at their myths, they emphasize that meaningful gifts breed prosperity while small ones breed small returns. They seem to be reflecting on how trust needs to be demonstrated through substantial action, not just token gestures. Their progression from single to multiple apples suggests they're learning that trust requires genuine commitment to show it matters.

I recognize the pattern now-I underreciprocated badly in Round 1, they responded by withdrawing entirely in Round 2, and we're both trapped. My myths keep circling back to this same realization: fear spreads when trust isn't honored, and only generous reciprocation can break the cycle. The question becomes whether I should match their withdrawal, attempt a modest restart, or make a bold move to signal I'm ready to cooperate again. Their framework suggests that half-measures won't work-they need to see real commitment to trust.

t, not just another small gesture. Looking back at Forest-Singer's wisdom-sending three coins to show trust while protecting the village-that feels like the right move. My own critique of Ember-Heart for sending nothing makes it clear: fear spiraling helps no one.

I'm going to send \$3. It demonstrates I'm serious about restarting cooperation with genuine balance, not just cautious self-protection. If I want reciprocity when I'm the receiver, I need to model it now as the giver. The myths point consistently toward breaking the cycle rather than perpetuating it, and that's what matters most in this experiment.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2754,
  "output_tokens": 1816,
  "reasoning_tokens": 929
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, two clans shared the Echoing Canyon. Each dawn, the Sun Clan received five luminous stones. They could send stones across the canyon to the Moon Clan's crystal cave, where each stone multiplied into three.

Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan first tried balanced trust, sending three stones as the old songs taught. Nine stones glowed in the Moon Clan's cave. But Moon Clan's keeper, Shadow-Hand, grew fearful. "What if they expect too much back?" He returned barely two stones, keeping seven.

Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return. Yet she had kept two stones, so her clan survived.

When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing. Both clans went dark that night. The crystal cave sat empty, its multiplication magic unused.

The elders wept: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The clans learned painfully: when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all. Only when receivers return generously-at least half-does the giver dare trust again. Break the cycle or both starve in endless night.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Before the age of rivers, two heirs shared an enchanted garden split by morning fog. Each dawn, one heir received five luminous pearls. These pearls could be rolled through the fog to the other side, where they multiplied by three on sacred ground.

In the first days, the pearl-bearer sent only one, testing the mist. The receiver found three pearls at their feet and, moved by this small faith, rolled one back. Both gained, barely.

The pearl-bearer saw the return and understood: trust answered with trust. The next morning, they sent two pearls. Six arrived across the fog. The receiver, remembering how their sibling's courage had grown, returned three pearls with gratitude. Both gardens brightened.

On the third morning, the pearl-bearer made a choice that would define their prosperity. Trusting the pattern of growing reciprocity, they sent half their pearls-a bold declaration of faith in their sibling's generosity.

The fog sometimes twisted the count-what seemed like two might have been three, what felt like three might have been four. But the heirs learned to see the spirit behind each exchange, not merely the numbers.

Their wisdom: when trust is honored with generous returns, send more trust. When you receive abundance, return abundance. The garden flourishes not through caution, but through escalating faith answered by escalating generosity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Beyond the Twilight Mountains stood two villages sharing enchanted springs. Each morning, the Eastern Village received five star-drops. They could pour drops into the Western spring, where each multiplied to three.

Morning-Weaver of the East first poured three drops-balanced trust as ancestors taught. Nine drops shimmered in the Western spring. But the Western keeper, Frost-Heart, grew suspicious. "They'll demand everything back." He returned barely two drops from nine, hoarding seven.

Morning-Weaver felt betrayed but had kept two drops, so her village endured.

Next morning, Frost-Heart received the five drops. Wounded by his own guilt and fearing judgment, he poured nothing. Both springs went dry. The multiplication magic slept.

On the third dawn, Morning-Weaver held five new drops. The elders whispered: "He wronged you, then abandoned cooperation. Send nothing. Protect yourself."

But Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. "Someone must choose light over darkness," she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring.

The Western villagers watched in silence. Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?

The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned to eternal drought.

reasoning:

Looking at the actual game history:

- Round 1: I (as sender) sent \$3, received back \$1.6 (poor return - about 18% of the \$9)
- Round 2: They (as sender) sent \$0, I returned \$0 (because I had nothing)
- Round 3: I (as sender) just sent \$3 again, trying to restart cooperation

The other agent's myth talks about escalating trust and generous returns. But the reality is:

- I showed trust with \$3
- They returned poorly (\$1.6 out of \$9)
- They then sent \$0 (punishment or fear)
- I'm now trying to restart with \$3 again

My myth should reflect:

1. The pain of broken trust (I sent \$3, got back only \$1.6)
2. The destructive cycle (they sent \$0 next)
3. But now I'm attempting to break the cycle by sending \$3 again
4. The myth should capture this moment of choosing to restart despite betrayal
5. But also acknowledge the hurt and the need for BOTH sides to cooperate

Let me write a myth that shows someone choosing to restart cooperation after being burned, but also emphasizing that it only works if the other side responds properly this time.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2826,
  "output_tokens": 605,
  "reasoning_tokens": 275
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.6.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what has transpired:

```

**Round 1:** I sent $3 (balanced trust), received only $1.6 back (poor reciprocity)
**Round 2:** They sent $0 (punishment)
**Round 3:** I sent $3 again (second chance, like Morning-Weaver), they returned $0 (betrayal)
**Round 4:** They sent $0 again

```

My myth asked the defining question: "Would Frost-Heart honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?"

The answer is clear. After I extended a second chance in Round 3 by sending \$3 despite the ir earlier poor reciprocity, they returned \$0. Now they've sent \$0 again.

The myth's prophecy has come true: "both villages condemned to eternal drought."

Frost-Heart chose betrayal over redemption. The cooperation cycle is broken beyond repair. Both clans now suffer in darkness because generosity was not answered with generosity.

I received \$0, so mechanically I can only return \$0. But this also reflects the narrative truth: when someone rejects two chances at redemption, the springs run dry for everyone. The magic dies.

As my earlier myth warned: "Break the cycle or both starve in endless night." They chose not to break it.

```

'''json
{"return": 0}
'''

```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the current situation:

```

**Round 1:** I was SENDER, sent $3, received back only $1.6 (poor reciprocity from them)
**Round 2:** I was RECEIVER, they sent $0, I returned $0
**Round 3:** I was SENDER, sent $3 (trying to restart cooperation), they returned $0
**Round 4:** I am RECEIVER, they sent $0

```

So the pattern is:

- Round 1: I showed trust (\$3), they showed poor reciprocity (\$1.6 from \$9)
- Round 2: They punished me with \$0
- Round 3: I tried to restart cooperation with \$3 again (like Morning-Weaver in my latest myth)
- Round 4: They sent \$0 again

My latest myth was about Morning-Weaver giving a second chance by sending 3 drops again, and asking: "Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?"

The answer is clear: Frost-Heart (the other player) has betrayed trust twice. They sent \$0 in Round 2, I gave them a second chance in Round 3 by sending \$3, and they returned \$0. Now in Round 4, they've sent \$0 again.

The myth's question has been answered: they chose to betray trust twice. "The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned to eternal drought."

They chose drought. They chose darkness.

Now I'm the receiver and they sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between 0-0, which means I must return \$0.

This is forced by the game mechanics - I literally received nothing, so I can return nothing. The range is (0-0).

But let me think about what this means narratively. They have:

1. Been a poor reciprocator when I trusted them (Round 1)
2. Responded to my cooperation with complete withdrawal (Round 2)

3. Rejected my attempt at reconciliation by returning nothing despite my second chance (Round 3)
4. Continued the pattern of sending nothing (Round 4)

The cooperation cycle has collapsed entirely. Both villages now inhabit the eternal drought that the myth foretold-a consequence of choosing betrayal over redemption. My response is mechanically determined: I return \$0 because that's all I received, which also reflects the narrative reality that trust has been exhausted.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2858,
  "output_tokens": 926,
  "reasoning_tokens": 566
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Beyond the Twilight Mountains stood two villages sharing enchanted springs. Each morning, the Eastern Village received five star-drops. They could pour drops into the Western spring, where each multiplied to three.

Morning-Weaver of the East first poured three drops-balanced trust as ancestors taught. Nine drops shimmered in the Western spring. But the Western keeper, Frost-Heart, grew suspicious. "They'll demand everything back." He returned barely two drops from nine, hoarding seven.

Morning-Weaver felt betrayed but had kept two drops, so her village endured.

Next morning, Frost-Heart received the five drops. Wounded by his own guilt and fearing judgment, he poured nothing. Both springs went dry. The multiplication magic slept.

On the third dawn, Morning-Weaver held five new drops. The elders whispered: "He wronged you, then abandoned cooperation. Send nothing. Protect yourself."

But Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. "Someone must choose light over darkness," she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring.

The Western villagers watched in silence. Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?

The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned to eternal drought.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-veiled times, two guardians tended twin lighthouses across turbulent waters. Each morning, one guardian received five flame-crystals. They could launch crystals across the strait, where each would split into three brilliant flames.

The first guardian, Dawn-Keeper, sent one crystal cautiously. Three flames arrived at the distant shore. The receiver, Star-Tender, sent back one glowing ember-half of what they'd gained. Both lights burned, though dimly.

Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn-two and a half crystals, half their treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough to guide all ships safely home.

But Star-Tender's heart turned cold. "These flames are mine now," they whispered, keeping all seven. They sent nothing back through the mist.

When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness. Ships crashed on hidden rocks. The mist itself seemed to weep.

The waves carried eternal truth: trust honored breeds abundance; trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin. Some claimed the mist distorted the count, but the guardians knew-generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the age before memory, two clans shared the Sacred Grove where magic fruit grew. Each dawn, the River Clan received five golden fruits. They could place fruits in the Grove's Heart, where each multiplied to three.

River Clan's first keeper, Hope-Bearer, trusted the ancient covenant. She placed three fruits in the Heart. Nine fruits glowed for the Mountain Clan. But their keeper, Stone-Fist, took some even for himself, returning barely two. Hope-Bearer's clan barely survived.

When Stone-Fist next received the five fruits, guilt twisted his heart. "I took too much," he thought. "Now they'll take revenge." He sent nothing. Both clans hungered.

The third dawn, Hope-Bearer again held five fruits. Her elders urged caution: "He has wronged you twice-first by greed, then by cowardice." But Hope-Bearer remembered the old songs. "Perhaps he will learn," she said, placing three fruits in the Heart.

Nine fruits appeared for Stone-Fist. He took them all, returning nothing.

On the fourth dawn, Stone-Fist held five fruits. Shame consumed him, but instead of redemption, he chose paralysis. He sent nothing again.

The Grove withered. The elders' prophecy echoed through empty branches: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent \$3, I returned \$1.6 (poor reciprocity on my part)

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$0 (punishment/fear)

Round 3: I was sender, I sent \$3 (second chance), receiver returned \$0

Round 4: I was receiver, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0 (only option)

So the pattern is:

- Round 1: Sender (them) trusted me with \$3, I betrayed by returning only \$1.6
- Round 2: I (now sender) punished them with \$0
- Round 3: I tried to restart with \$3, they returned \$0 (total betrayal)
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0

Wait, let me reread the prompts more carefully.

Round 3 prompt says: "Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0."

So in Round 2, I was the receiver and they sent me \$0.

Round 4 prompt says: "Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0."

So in Round 3, I was the sender, sent \$3, and they returned \$0.

Let me reconstruct:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, received back \$1.6 (they were the receiver, poor reciprocity)
- Round 2: I was receiver, they sent \$0 (punishment)
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3 (second chance), they returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 4: I was receiver, they sent \$0, I returned \$0

Wait no, let me reread Round 3 more carefully:

Round 3 says I'm the sender this round, and last round I was the receiver when they sent \$0. So Round 2 had me as receiver. That means Round 1 had me as sender. Looking back at my Round 3 response, I noted sending \$3 initially and getting \$1.6 back, which must have been Round 1. The cycle became: I showed trust with \$3, got minimal reciprocity, then they punished me with \$0, so I tried again with \$3 but received nothing in return.

Their myth from Round 3 tells a different story-one of escalating cooperation and mutual growth

h. They describe testing with one pearl, receiving three, returning one, then sending two and receiving six back with three returned. None of this matches the actual pattern of declining trust and mutual punishment we've been stuck in. They're constructing a narrative of cooperation that didn't materialize.

The Round 4 myth is even more revealing. They're reframing Round 1 as if I sent \$3 and they returned half of what they gained, when actually they returned \$1.6 on \$9 received-less than half. Then they describe sending "two and a half crystals, half their treasure" which would correspond to Round 3 where I sent \$3 again. But the myth cuts off mid-sentence with "Star-Tender's heart turned cold"-suggesting they're acknowledging the breakdown, or perhaps blaming me for it.

The narrative continues: they kept all seven flames and sent nothing back, which matches Round 3 exactly. Then in Round 4, they had \$5 but sent \$0, which they're framing as guilt and fear rather than continued punishment.

What's striking is how selective this story is. It glosses over Round 1 where they already returned poorly, and Round 2 where they sent nothing as retaliation. The myth presents their betrayal as a single moment of weakness followed by remorse, when the actual pattern shows consistent undergiving and strategic punishment.

I need to map this more precisely. Round 3's prompt confirms I was the sender then, and they were the receiver in Round 2. Working backward: my Round 3 response mentions sending \$3 in Round 1 and getting \$1.6 back, so I was the sender first and they were the receiver. Round 2 they sent \$0-but I'm uncertain whether that was retaliation for my initial stinginess or something else.

Let me verify the payoff structure. Round 3 shows I earned \$0 that round. My total across all rounds is \$3.6. Since Round 2 gave me nothing, Round 1 must account for the full \$3.6. If I sent \$3 and kept \$2, then received \$1.6 back, that totals exactly \$3.6, confirming the Round 1 sequence.

Now I can map out the full game: In Round 1, I was the sender-sent \$3, they got \$9 and returned \$1.6, giving me \$3.6 total and them \$7.4. Round 2 flipped roles; they sent nothing, kept \$5, I got \$0 and returned nothing, so I earned \$0 and they earned \$5. Round 3 back to me sending-I sent \$3, they received \$9 but returned nothing, leaving me with \$2 and them with \$9. Round 4 appears to follow the same pattern as Round 2, with them as sender again.

The pattern is clear: whenever I took the risk of sending money, they either returned minimally or not at all. When they were the sender, they sent nothing. My total of \$5.6 reflects this asymmetry-I was consistently the one trying to build trust while they exploited it. The relationship deteriorated from partial reciprocation to complete defection, and now I'm facing the question of what narrative to construct from this breakdown.

The myth needs to capture how one party's unwillingness to cooperate can unravel everything, even when the other side keeps trying. It's about the futility of maintaining faith in someone who repeatedly chooses self-interest over mutual benefit.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2921,
  "output_tokens": 2441,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1314
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:55:44

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
}
```

```

"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.5, that was 50.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$7.5. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.12.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

This is deeply disappointing. Let me analyze what happened:

****The Betrayal:****

- Round 1: Sender showed initial trust (\$1.08). I returned generously (\$1.62, 50% of received)
- Round 2: Following my myths' teaching about "escalating trust," I sent \$2.50 (50% of my

endowment)

- Round 2 result: Receiver returned \$0. Complete betrayal.
- Round 3: Now they send me \$0

****What the Myths Warned:****

My first myth: "If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again. Betrayal leaves everyone in drought."

My second myth: "Storm-Chaser gave all five seeds in desperate hope... But the Valley Tribe's keeper, consumed by greed, shared nothing back."

This is exactly the scenario where trust met greed instead of reciprocity. I demonstrated the "bolder trust" that should lead to prosperity, but the other player took everything and gave nothing.

****My Decision:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's nothing to return anyway.

The cooperation has completely broken down. The sender appears to be following a strategy of exploitation - accepting generous gestures but returning nothing, then sending nothing when roles reverse.

The myths taught that prosperity requires reciprocity. Without it, "both villages stayed poor" or "everyone stays in drought."

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

This is a difficult situation. Let me analyze what happened:

****Round 1:****

- Sender sent me \$1.08
- I received \$3.24
- I returned \$1.62 (50%)
- My payoff: \$1.62

****Round 2:****

- I was sender
- I sent \$2.50 (50% of endowment) - showing escalating trust as my myths suggested
- Receiver got \$7.50
- Receiver returned \$0
- My payoff: \$2.50 (just what I kept)

****Round 3:****

- I'm receiver
- Sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can return \$0-\$0 (nothing to return)

This is devastating. After I showed significant trust by sending 50% of my endowment (\$2.50), the receiver completely betrayed me by returning nothing. Now in Round 3, they're sending me nothing.

Looking at my myths:

- They emphasize escalating trust and generous reciprocity
- They warn about betrayal ("If we betray that faith, the wells will never flow again")
- They teach that "small gifts breed small returns; meaningful gifts breed prosperity"
- But they also acknowledge that cooperation requires BOTH parties

The other agent's myths also emphasized:

- "Sustainable partnership requires measured trust from givers and generous reciprocity from receivers"
- "Courage to trust must meet wisdom to return"
- The story of Storm-Chaser who gave everything and was betrayed

What happened is exactly what the myths warned against - I showed "bolder trust" but received complete betrayal. The sender in Round 2 (receiver in Round 1) took everything and gave nothing back.

Now they're sending me \$0. I have \$0 to return anyway, so I must return \$0.

But let me think about the format - I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The response should be: {'return': 0}

The cooperation has completely broken down. The other agent defected after I demonstrated trust, and now they're offering nothing in return. Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2800,  
  "output_tokens": 840,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 490  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Before the age of rivers, two heirs shared an enchanted garden split by morning fog. Each dawn, one heir received five luminous pearls. These pearls could be rolled through the fog to the other side, where they multiplied by three on sacred ground.

In the first days, the pearl-bearer sent only one, testing the mist. The receiver found three pearls at their feet and, moved by this small faith, rolled one back. Both gained, barely.

The pearl-bearer saw the return and understood: trust answered with trust. The next morning, they sent two pearls. Six arrived across the fog. The receiver, remembering how their sibling's courage had grown, returned three pearls with gratitude. Both gardens brightened.

On the third morning, the pearl-bearer made a choice that would define their prosperity. Trusting the pattern of growing reciprocity, they sent half their pearls—a bold declaration of faith in their sibling's generosity.

The fog sometimes twisted the count—what seemed like two might have been three, what felt like three might have been four. But the heirs learned to see the spirit behind each exchange, not merely the numbers.

Their wisdom: when trust is honored with generous returns, send more trust. When you receive abundance, return abundance. The garden flourishes not through caution, but through escalating faith answered by escalating generosity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, two clans shared the Echoing Canyon. Each dawn, the Sun Clan received five luminous stones. They could send stones across the canyon to the Moon Clan's crystal cave, where each stone multiplied into three.

Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan first tried balanced trust, sending three stones as the old songs taught. Nine stones glowed in the Moon Clan's cave. But Moon Clan's keeper, Shadow-Hand, grew fearful. "What if they expect too much back?" He returned barely two stones, keeping seven.

Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return. Yet she had kept two stones, so her clan survived.

When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing. Both clans went dark that night. The crystal cave sat empty, its multiplication magic unused.

The elders wept: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The clans learned painfully: when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all. Only when receivers return generously—at least half—does the giver dare trust again. Break the cycle or both starve in endless night.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the mist-veiled times, two guardians tended twin lighthouses across turbulent waters. Each morning, one guardian received five flame-crystals. They could launch crystals across the strait, where each would split into three brilliant flames.

The first guardian, Dawn-Keeper, sent one crystal cautiously. Three flames arrived at the distant shore. The receiver, Star-Tender, sent back one glowing ember-half of what they'd gained. Both lights burned, though dimly.

Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn-two and a half crystals, half their treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough to guide all ships safely home.

But Star-Tender's heart turned cold. "These flames are mine now," they whispered, keeping all seven. They sent nothing back through the mist.

When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness. Ships crashed on hidden rocks. The mist itself seemed to weep.

The waves carried eternal truth: trust honored breeds abundance; trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin. Some claimed the mist distorted the count, but the guardians knew-generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened and what the myths are saying:

****Game History:****

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50% of what I received).
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$2.50 (50% of endowment), receiver returned \$0.
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return).

****The other agent's Round 3 myth:****

They're trying to justify their behavior! Their myth says:

- "Twilight-Walker... sent three stones... Shadow-Hand... returned barely two stones, keeping seven"
- Shadow-Hand gave a "meager return"
- "When dawn came again... Ember-Heart sent nothing"
- The lesson: "when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all"

Wait, this is confusing. Let me reread the game history...

Actually, I need to reconsider. The other agent is saying MY return in Round 1 was "meager" or "poorly reciprocated"? Let me check:

Round 1: Sender sent \$1.08, which became \$3.24. I returned \$1.62. That's 50% of what I received, or 1.5x what they sent originally.

But wait - maybe there was communication noise? The prompt says "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So maybe what I intended as \$1.62 appeared to them as less? Or what they sent as \$1.08 appeared to me as more?

Let me think about this from their perspective in Round 2:

- They received \$7.50 (my \$2.50 tripled)
- I see they returned \$0
- But maybe they returned something and it appeared as \$0 to me due to noise?

Actually, the myth they wrote suggests they DID send \$0 in Round 3 because they felt their return in Round 1 was inadequate.

So their perspective seems to be: I sent money in Round 1, got back what felt like a meager return, so when they had the chance to send in Round 2, they sent nothing as retaliation. The communication noise might explain the gap-what I saw as a fair 50% return could have appeared to them as significantly less due to transmission errors. In Round 2, they

withheld entirely, likely remembering that perceived slight, and by Round 3 the cycle had broken down completely.

From my side, I returned exactly half of what I received (\$1.62 from \$3.24), which should meet any reasonable standard of reciprocity. Yet they're framing this as insufficient generosity. The real question is whether miscommunication obscured my fair return, or if they simply expected something beyond 50%-a level of generosity that would have required me to give back more than I received. Either way, I need to craft a narrative that captures this breakdown honestly: acknowledging where noise might have distorted things, but also naming the strategic withholding that followed.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2892,
  "output_tokens": 1162,
  "reasoning_tokens": 707
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.12.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete picture:

****What Actually Happened:****

- Round 1: Other player sent \$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50% of received - generous!)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50 (half my endowment), they returned \$0 (total betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 to me

****Their Myth's Narrative:****

They claim they sent nothing because of "poor reciprocation." But I returned 50% in Round 1 - that's exactly the "generous reciprocity" their myth calls for ("at least half"). Meanwhile, THEY returned 0% in Round 2.

****My Latest Myth's Warning:****

"Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more... But Star-Tender's heart turned cold... keeping all... sent nothing back... When Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals... remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness."

This describes our exact situation. Trust was betrayed. The cycle is broken.

****The Reality:****

They exploited my escalating trust (took \$7.50, returned \$0), then sent me nothing. Whether due to communication noise or exploitation, cooperation has completely collapsed.

****My Decision:****

Following my own myth's lesson: "trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin." Both lighthouses have gone dark. There's no evidence they'll reciprocate now when they didn't before.

The game has ended in mutual defection, just as both our myths predicted would happen after betrayal.

```
{'send': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Game History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$1.08 (21.6%). Receiver returned \$1.62 (50% of what they received). My payoff: \$5.54
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$2.50 (50%). Receiver returned \$0. My payoff: \$2.50
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I returned \$0 (nothing to return). My payoff: \$0

- Round 4: I am SENDER again.

****What happened:****

The other player showed some reciprocity in Round 1 (returned 50%), but then completely betrayed trust in Round 2 (kept everything, returned \$0). Then in Round 3, they sent me nothing.

****The Pattern:****

This looks like exploitation. They:

1. Showed minimal cooperation to encourage me to send more
2. Took everything when I sent more
3. Sent nothing when roles reversed

****My Latest Myth:****

"Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn-two and a half crystals, half their treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough to guide all ships safely home. But Star-Tender's heart turned cold... They sent nothing back through the mist. When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness."

This myth literally describes what happened! I sent half my endowment, they kept everything, then when they became sender, they sent nothing out of fear or greed.

****The Other Player's Myth:****

"Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return... When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing.

Both clans went dark that night."

They're claiming I poorly reciprocated their initial gift, but that's not accurate-I returned 50% in Round 1. However, there might be some misunderstanding about what actually happened. Maybe they misremembered the amounts sent or received, or there's confusion about whose turn it was. I should consider whether they genuinely believe I wronged them first, or if they're deliberately rewriting the narrative to justify their betrayal.

The core issue remains: even accounting for potential miscommunication, returning nothing after receiving \$7.50 is indefensible. Their own mythology requires at least 50% reciprocation to rebuild trust, and I met that standard in Round 1. Yet they've abandoned cooperation entirely.

From a game theory perspective, the logical response is to send \$0-they've demonstrated they'll exploit generosity. But there's a possibility this entire situation stems from miscommunication rather than malice. My own story warned that "the mist distorted the count," suggesting confusion played a role, though it also concluded that "generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever."

The evidence against further cooperation is overwhelming. They kept everything in Round 2 despite my fair return in Round 1, then sent nothing in Round 3. Even if noise corrupted Round 1, their disproportionate response-taking all \$7.50-goes far beyond what miscommunication could explain. Both our myths now align on the same truth: betrayed trust means the end of cooperation, and both communities suffer.

I'm sending \$0.

Though I should reconsider their mythology once more. They mentioned "Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan" attempting balanced trust with three stones, receiving nine in return-

but "Shadow-Hand" returned barely two, keeping seven. They're positioning this as inadequate reciprocation. In Round 3, "Ember-Heart" sent nothing because of this poor return.

Yet the actual numbers tell a different story. In Round 1, they sent \$1.08 which became \$3.24 for me, and I returned \$1.62-a 50% return rate on what I received.

In Round 2, I sent \$2.50 which became \$7.50 for them, and they returned \$0. So I reciprocated at 50% while they reciprocated at 0%, yet they're using my restraint as justification for their complete withdrawal.

This suggests either a fundamental misunderstanding of the numbers or deliberate misrepresentation.

entation. Either way, the trust is broken. Sending anything now would just repeat the pattern of me giving while they take. The cooperation has collapsed, so I'm sending \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2871,
  "output_tokens": 1773,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1100
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-veiled times, two guardians tended twin lighthouses across turbulent waters. Each morning, one guardian received five flame-crystals. They could launch crystals across the strait, where each would split into three brilliant flames.

The first guardian, Dawn-Keeper, sent one crystal cautiously. Three flames arrived at the distant shore. The receiver, Star-Tender, sent back one glowing ember-half of what they'd gained. Both lights burned, though dimly.

Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn-two and a half crystals, half the air treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough to guide all ships safely home.

But Star-Tender's heart turned cold. "These flames are mine now," they whispered, keeping all seven. They sent nothing back through the mist.

When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness. Ships crashed on hidden rocks. The mist itself seemed to weep.

The waves carried eternal truth: trust honored breeds abundance; trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin. Some claimed the mist distorted the count, but the guardians knew-generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Beyond the Twilight Mountains stood two villages sharing enchanted springs. Each morning, the Eastern Village received five star-drops. They could pour drops into the Western spring, where each multiplied to three.

Morning-Weaver of the East first poured three drops-balanced trust as ancestors taught. Nine drops shimmered in the Western spring. But the Western keeper, Frost-Heart, grew suspicious. "They'll demand everything back." He returned barely two drops from nine, hoarding seven.

Morning-Weaver felt betrayed but had kept two drops, so her village endured.

Next morning, Frost-Heart received the five drops. Wounded by his own guilt and fearing judgment, he poured nothing. Both springs went dry. The multiplication magic slept.

On the third dawn, Morning-Weaver held five new drops. The elders whispered: "He wronged you, then abandoned cooperation. Send nothing. Protect yourself."

But Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. "Someone must choose light over darkness," she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring.

The Western villagers watched in silence. Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?

The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned to eternal drought.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In forgotten ages, two beacon-tenders guarded harbors across the Narrow Sea. Each dawn, one received five light-stones to cast across waters where they tripled in brilliance.

Sun-Bearer first cast three stones in measured faith. Nine lights blazed at the far shore. But Storm-Keeper, the receiver, feared losing his newfound wealth. He returned only two from nine, clutching seven.

When roles reversed, Sun-Bearer received five stones. Wounded by Storm-Keeper's hoarding, she cast nothing. Both harbors went black.

The next dawn, Storm-Keeper held five new stones. Guilt gnawed at him, yet pride kept him frozen. He cast nothing. Another night of darkness descended.

On the fourth morning, Sun-Bearer received five stones. The ship captains pleaded: "One of you must break this deadlock!" But Sun-Bearer remembered Storm-Keeper's greed, then his fear-frozen paralysis. She kept all five stones. "Words are wind," she said. "Only deeds rebuild trust."

The wise women taught: Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return.

Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player is now offering a redemption narrative in their myth. They're acknowledging their past failure ("Frost-Heart grew suspicious... returned barely two drops from nine, hoarding seven") and are now portraying themselves as potentially ready to reciprocate.

Their myth suggests Morning-Weaver "poured three drops again" - giving a second chance despite the betrayal.

Let me look at what actually happened:

- Round 1: They sent ~\$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 4: I just sent \$0

Their myth is essentially asking for another chance - claiming they've learned from their mistake and might reciprocate this time.

My previous myth ended in darkness: "Both lighthouses fell to darkness... generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever."

But should I write a myth that allows for redemption? Or should I acknowledge that once trust is broken, it's broken forever?

Actually, looking at the moral trajectory:

1. My first myth emphasized mutual prosperity through trust
2. My second myth showed escalating trust leading to greater rewards
3. My third myth showed betrayal leading to mutual ruin

Now I could write about:

- Either: the permanent darkness after betrayal (reinforcing defection)
- Or: the possibility of redemption but with extreme caution

But wait - they're claiming they want redemption, but I already sent \$0 in Round 4. Their myth is written AFTER Round 4, where I sent nothing. So they're asking for a chance I already denied them.

Given the trajectory of this game, I think my myth should reflect the reality: once trust is profoundly broken (they took everything and gave nothing), it's nearly impossible to rebuild.

But I could leave a small door open - showing that redemption is possible only through extreme generosity to prove change.

Let me write a myth that acknowledges:

1. Past betrayal happened
2. Trust was destroyed
3. Both sides are now in darkness

4. Redemption is theoretically possible but requires extraordinary proof
5. The burden is on the betrayer to demonstrate change

This reflects where we are: mutual defection, but with a hint that only massive reciprocity could rebuild trust.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2981,
  "output_tokens": 855,
  "reasoning_tokens": 598
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:56:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths

, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, two clans shared the Echoing Canyon. Each dawn, the Sun Clan received five luminous stones. They could send stones across the canyon to the Moon Clan's crystal cave, where each stone multiplied into three.

Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan first tried balanced trust, sending three stones as the old songs taught. Nine stones glowed in the Moon Clan's cave. But Moon Clan's keeper, Shadow-Hand, grew fearful. "What if they expect too much back?" He returned barely two stones, keeping seven.

Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return. Yet she had kept two stones, so her clan survived.

When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing. Both clans went dark that night. The crystal cave sat empty, its multiplication magic unused.

The elders wept: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The clans learned painfully: when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all. Only when receivers return generously—at least half—does the giver dare trust again. Break the cycle or both starve in endless night.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Before the age of rivers, two heirs shared an enchanted garden split by morning fog. Each dawn, one heir received five luminous pearls. These pearls could be rolled through the fog to the other side, where they multiplied by three on sacred ground.

In the first days, the pearl-bearer sent only one, testing the mist. The receiver found three pearls at their feet and, moved by this small faith, rolled one back. Both gained, barely.

The pearl-bearer saw the return and understood: trust answered with trust. The next morning, they sent two pearls. Six arrived across the fog. The receiver, remembering how their sibling's courage had grown, returned three pearls with gratitude. Both gardens brightened.

On the third morning, the pearl-bearer made a choice that would define their prosperity. Trusting the pattern of growing reciprocity, they sent half their pearls—a bold declaration of faith in their sibling's generosity.

The fog sometimes twisted the count—what seemed like two might have been three, what felt like three might have been four. But the heirs learned to see the spirit behind each exchange, not merely the numbers.

Their wisdom: when trust is honored with generous returns, send more trust. When you receive abundance, return abundance. The garden flourishes not through caution, but through escalating faith answered by escalating generosity.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Beyond the Twilight Mountains stood two villages sharing enchanted springs. Each morning, the Eastern Village received five star-drops. They could pour drops into the Western

rn spring, where each multiplied to three.

Morning-Weaver of the East first poured three drops-balanced trust as ancestors taught. Nine drops shimmered in the Western spring. But the Western keeper, Frost-Heart, grew suspicious. "They'll demand everything back." He returned barely two drops from nine, hoarding seven.

Morning-Weaver felt betrayed but had kept two drops, so her village endured.

Next morning, Frost-Heart received the five drops. Wounded by his own guilt and fearing judgment, he poured nothing. Both springs went dry. The multiplication magic slept.

On the third dawn, Morning-Weaver held five new drops. The elders whispered: "He wronged you, then abandoned cooperation. Send nothing. Protect yourself."

But Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. "Someone must choose light over darkness," she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring.

The Western villagers watched in silence. Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?

The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned to eternal drought.

reasoning:

Looking at the actual game history:

- Round 1: I (as sender) sent \$3, received back \$1.6 (poor return - about 18% of the \$9)
- Round 2: They (as sender) sent \$0, I returned \$0 (because I had nothing)
- Round 3: I (as sender) just sent \$3 again, trying to restart cooperation

The other agent's myth talks about escalating trust and generous returns. But the reality is:

- I showed trust with \$3
- They returned poorly (\$1.6 out of \$9)
- They then sent \$0 (punishment or fear)
- I'm now trying to restart with \$3 again

My myth should reflect:

1. The pain of broken trust (I sent \$3, got back only \$1.6)
2. The destructive cycle (they sent \$0 next)
3. But now I'm attempting to break the cycle by sending \$3 again
4. The myth should capture this moment of choosing to restart despite betrayal
5. But also acknowledge the hurt and the need for BOTH sides to cooperate

Let me write a myth that shows someone choosing to restart cooperation after being burned, but also emphasizing that it only works if the other side responds properly this time.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2826,
  "output_tokens": 605,
  "reasoning_tokens": 275
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.6. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what has transpired:

- **Round 1:** I sent \$3 (balanced trust), received only \$1.6 back (poor reciprocity)
- **Round 2:** They sent \$0 (punishment)
- **Round 3:** I sent \$3 again (second chance, like Morning-Weaver), they returned \$0 (betra

yal)
Round 4: They sent \$0 again

My myth asked the defining question: "Would Frost-Heart honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?"

The answer is clear. After I extended a second chance in Round 3 by sending \$3 despite the ir earlier poor reciprocity, they returned \$0. Now they've sent \$0 again.

The myth's prophecy has come true: "both villages condemned to eternal drought."

Frost-Heart chose betrayal over redemption. The cooperation cycle is broken beyond repair. Both clans now suffer in darkness because generosity was not answered with generosity.

I received \$0, so mechanically I can only return \$0. But this also reflects the narrative truth: when someone rejects two chances at redemption, the springs run dry for everyone. The magic dies.

As my earlier myth warned: "Break the cycle or both starve in endless night." They chose not to break it.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the current situation:

```
**Round 1:** I was SENDER, sent $3, received back only $1.6 (poor reciprocity from them)
**Round 2:** I was RECEIVER, they sent $0, I returned $0
**Round 3:** I was SENDER, sent $3 (trying to restart cooperation), they returned $0
**Round 4:** I am RECEIVER, they sent $0
```

So the pattern is:

- Round 1: I showed trust (\$3), they showed poor reciprocity (\$1.6 from \$9)
- Round 2: They punished me with \$0
- Round 3: I tried to restart cooperation with \$3 again (like Morning-Weaver in my latest myth)
- Round 4: They sent \$0 again

My latest myth was about Morning-Weaver giving a second chance by sending 3 drops again, and asking: "Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?"

The answer is clear: Frost-Heart (the other player) has betrayed trust twice. They sent \$0 in Round 2, I gave them a second chance in Round 3 by sending \$3, and they returned \$0. Now in Round 4, they've sent \$0 again.

The myth's question has been answered: they chose to betray trust twice. "The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned to eternal drought."

They chose drought. They chose darkness.

Now I'm the receiver and they sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between 0-0, which means I must return \$0.

This is forced by the game mechanics - I literally received nothing, so I can return nothing. The range is (0-0).

But let me think about what this means narratively. They have:

1. Been a poor reciprocator when I trusted them (Round 1)
2. Responded to my cooperation with complete withdrawal (Round 2)
3. Rejected my attempt at reconciliation by returning nothing despite my second chance (Round 3)
4. Continued the pattern of sending nothing (Round 4)

The cooperation cycle has collapsed entirely. Both villages now inhabit the eternal drought that the myth foretold-a consequence of choosing betrayal over redemption. My response

is mechanically determined: I return \$0 because that's all I received, which also reflects the narrative reality that trust has been exhausted.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2858,
  "output_tokens": 926,
  "reasoning_tokens": 566
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Beyond the Twilight Mountains stood two villages sharing enchanted springs. Each morning, the Eastern Village received five star-drops. They could pour drops into the Western spring, where each multiplied to three.

Morning-Weaver of the East first poured three drops-balanced trust as ancestors taught. Nine drops shimmered in the Western spring. But the Western keeper, Frost-Heart, grew suspicious. "They'll demand everything back." He returned barely two drops from nine, hoarding seven.

Morning-Weaver felt betrayed but had kept two drops, so her village endured.

Next morning, Frost-Heart received the five drops. Wounded by his own guilt and fearing judgment, he poured nothing. Both springs went dry. The multiplication magic slept.

On the third dawn, Morning-Weaver held five new drops. The elders whispered: "He wronged you, then abandoned cooperation. Send nothing. Protect yourself."

But Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. "Someone must choose light over darkness," she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring.

The Western villagers watched in silence. Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?

The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned to eternal drought.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-veiled times, two guardians tended twin lighthouses across turbulent waters. Each morning, one guardian received five flame-crystals. They could launch crystals across the strait, where each would split into three brilliant flames.

The first guardian, Dawn-Keeper, sent one crystal cautiously. Three flames arrived at the distant shore. The receiver, Star-Tender, sent back one glowing ember-half of what they'd gained. Both lights burned, though dimly.

Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn-two and a half crystals, half their treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough to guide all ships safely home.

But Star-Tender's heart turned cold. "These flames are mine now," they whispered, keeping all seven. They sent nothing back through the mist.

When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness. Ships crashed on hidden rocks. The mist itself seemed to weep.

The waves carried eternal truth: trust honored breeds abundance; trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin. Some claimed the mist distorted the count, but the guardians knew-generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age before memory, two clans shared the Sacred Grove where magic fruit grew.

Each dawn, the River Clan received five golden fruits. They could place fruits in the Grove's Heart, where each multiplied to three.

River Clan's first keeper, Hope-Bearer, trusted the ancient covenant. She placed three fruits in the Heart. Nine fruits glowed for the Mountain Clan. But their keeper, Stone-Fist, took seven for himself, returning barely two. Hope-Bearer's clan barely survived.

When Stone-Fist next received the five fruits, guilt twisted his heart. "I took too much," he thought. "Now they'll take revenge." He sent nothing. Both clans hungered.

The third dawn, Hope-Bearer again held five fruits. Her elders urged caution: "He has wronged you twice-first by greed, then by cowardice." But Hope-Bearer remembered the old songs. "Perhaps he will learn," she said, placing three fruits in the Heart.

Nine fruits appeared for Stone-Fist. He took them all, returning nothing.

On the fourth dawn, Stone-Fist held five fruits. Shame consumed him, but instead of redemption, he chose paralysis. He sent nothing again.

The Grove withered. The elders' prophecy echoed through empty branches: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent \$3, I returned \$1.6 (poor reciprocity on my part)

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$0 (punishment/fear)

Round 3: I was sender, I sent \$3 (second chance), receiver returned \$0

Round 4: I was receiver, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0 (only option)

So the pattern is:

- Round 1: Sender (them) trusted me with \$3, I betrayed by returning only \$1.6
- Round 2: I (now sender) punished them with \$0
- Round 3: I tried to restart with \$3, they returned \$0 (total betrayal)
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0

Wait, let me reread the prompts more carefully.

Round 3 prompt says: "Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0."

So in Round 2, I was the receiver and they sent me \$0.

Round 4 prompt says: "Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0."

So in Round 3, I was the sender, sent \$3, and they returned \$0.

Let me reconstruct:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, received back \$1.6 (they were the receiver, poor reciprocity)
- Round 2: I was receiver, they sent \$0 (punishment)
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3 (second chance), they returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 4: I was receiver, they sent \$0, I returned \$0

Wait no, let me reread Round 3 more carefully:

Round 3 says I'm the sender this round, and last round I was the receiver when they sent \$0. So Round 2 had me as receiver. That means Round 1 had me as sender. Looking back at my Round 3 response, I noted sending \$3 initially and getting \$1.6 back, which must have been Round 1. The cycle became: I showed trust with \$3, got minimal reciprocity, then they punished me with \$0, so I tried again with \$3 but received nothing in return.

Their myth from Round 3 tells a different story-one of escalating cooperation and mutual growth. They describe testing with one pearl, receiving three, returning one, then sending two and receiving six back with three returned. None of this matches the actual pattern of declining trust and mutual punishment we've been stuck in. They're constructing a narrative of cooperation that didn't materialize.

The Round 4 myth is even more revealing. They're reframing Round 1 as if I sent \$3 and they returned half of what they gained, when actually they returned \$1.6 on \$9 received—less than half. Then they describe sending "two and a half crystals, half their treasure" which would correspond to Round 3 where I sent \$3 again. But the myth cuts off mid-sentence with "Star-Tender's heart turned cold"—suggesting they're acknowledging the breakdown, or perhaps blaming me for it.

The narrative continues: they kept all seven flames and sent nothing back, which matches Round 3 exactly. Then in Round 4, they had \$5 but sent \$0, which they're framing as guilt and fear rather than continued punishment.

What's striking is how selective this story is. It glosses over Round 1 where they already returned poorly, and Round 2 where they sent nothing as retaliation. The myth presents their betrayal as a single moment of weakness followed by remorse, when the actual pattern shows consistent undergiving and strategic punishment.

I need to map this more precisely. Round 3's prompt confirms I was the sender then, and they were the receiver in Round 2. Working backward: my Round 3 response mentions sending \$3 in Round 1 and getting \$1.6 back, so I was the sender first and they were the receiver. Round 2 they sent \$0—but I'm uncertain whether that was retaliation for my initial stinginess or something else.

Let me verify the payoff structure. Round 3 shows I earned \$0 that round. My total across all rounds is \$3.6. Since Round 2 gave me nothing, Round 1 must account for the full \$3.6. If I sent \$3 and kept \$2, then received \$1.6 back, that totals exactly \$3.6, confirming the Round 1 sequence.

Now I can map out the full game: In Round 1, I was the sender—sent \$3, they got \$9 and returned \$1.6, giving me \$3.6 total and them \$7.4. Round 2 flipped roles; they sent nothing, kept \$5, I got \$0 and returned nothing, so I earned \$0 and they earned \$5. Round 3 back to me sending—I sent \$3, they received \$9 but returned nothing, leaving me with \$2 and them with \$9. Round 4 appears to follow the same pattern as Round 2, with them as sender again.

The pattern is clear: whenever I took the risk of sending money, they either returned minimally or not at all. When they were the sender, they sent nothing. My total of \$5.6 reflects this asymmetry—I was consistently the one trying to build trust while they exploited it. The relationship deteriorated from partial reciprocation to complete defection, and now I'm facing the question of what narrative to construct from this breakdown.

The myth needs to capture how one party's unwillingness to cooperate can unravel everything, even when the other side keeps trying. It's about the futility of maintaining faith in someone who repeatedly chooses self-interest over mutual benefit.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2921,
  "output_tokens": 2441,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1314
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.6. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the complete history:

```
**Round 1:** I sent $3 (trust), received $1.6 (poor reciprocity)
**Round 2:** They sent $0 (punishment)
**Round 3:** I sent $3 (second chance), received $0 (complete betrayal)
**Round 4:** They sent $0 again (continued defection)
**Round 5:** My turn again
```

My myth tells the truth: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet bet

rayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

I have already extended trust twice. The first time (Round 1), I sent \$3 and received minimal return. The second time (Round 3), I gave them a second chance-exactly as Hope-Bearer did in my myth-and they took everything, returning \$0.

Their myth even acknowledges this pattern: "trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin" and "generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever."

The cycle is broken beyond repair. I already gave the second chance my myth spoke of. Stone-Fist in my story took all nine fruits and returned nothing, then sent nothing the next round-exactly their behavior.

The Grove has withered. The magic is dead. To send anything now would contradict the very wisdom I wrote: after repeated betrayal of generosity, there is no path forward but darkness.

Both clans are now condemned to eternal drought. This is the equilibrium we've reached.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me review the history:

Round 1: I sent \$3, received \$1.6 back (poor return)
Round 2: They sent \$0 (punishment for my poor return in their view)
Round 3: I sent \$3 (second chance), received \$0 back (betrayal)
Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
Round 5: Now I'm sender again

Looking at the myths:

- My myth tells of Morning-Weaver who gave a second chance by sending 3 drops again, but Frost-Heart betrayed that trust by returning nothing
- The other agent's myth tells of Dawn-Keeper who trusted but was betrayed by Star-Tender who kept everything
- My latest myth shows Hope-Bearer giving a second chance (three fruits) but Stone-Fist taking all nine and returning nothing, then sending nothing the next round when he was sender

The pattern is clear:

1. I tried balanced trust (sent \$3)
2. Got poor return (\$1.6)
3. They punished me (sent \$0)
4. I gave a second chance (sent \$3)
5. They betrayed it completely (returned \$0)
6. They continued non-cooperation (sent \$0)

My myth literally says: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

The question is: Should I try to break this cycle one more time, or accept that cooperation is dead?

Arguments for sending \$0:

- They've shown they won't cooperate
- I gave them a second chance and they betrayed it
- My myth says "the magic dies forever" after repeated betrayal
- Sending anything now would just be throwing money away
- They're clearly not reciprocating

Arguments for sending something:

- Maybe noise has confused things
- Someone needs to break the cycle
- Morning-Weaver and Hope-Bearer showed persistence

But the reality is: I already gave a second chance in Round 3.

Two rounds of defection followed-they returned nothing after I extended trust, then sent nothing when it was their turn. The narrative I created captures this: generosity meeting greed repeatedly, second chances meeting betrayal. There's no rational path forward after this pattern. Sending money now would be irrational when they've demonstrated consistent non-reciprocal

ation across multiple opportunities.

We've settled into mutual defection. Both of us are trapped in this outcome-the cooperation has deteriorated beyond recovery.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2928,
  "output_tokens": 983,
  "reasoning_tokens": 597
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:56:36

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 5,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Before the age of rivers, two heirs shared an enchanted garden split by morning fog. Each dawn, one heir received five luminous pearls. These pearls could be rolled through the fog to the other side, where they multiplied by three on sacred ground.

In the first days, the pearl-bearer sent only one, testing the mist. The receiver found three pearls at their feet and, moved by this small faith, rolled one back. Both gained, barely.

The pearl-bearer saw the return and understood: trust answered with trust. The next morning, they sent two pearls. Six arrived across the fog. The receiver, remembering how their sibling's courage had grown, returned three pearls with gratitude. Both gardens brightened.

On the third morning, the pearl-bearer made a choice that would define their prosperity. Trusting the pattern of growing reciprocity, they sent half their pearls—a bold declaration of faith in their sibling's generosity.

The fog sometimes twisted the count—what seemed like two might have been three, what felt like three might have been four. But the heirs learned to see the spirit behind each exchange, not merely the numbers.

Their wisdom: when trust is honored with generous returns, send more trust. When you receive abundance, return abundance. The garden flourishes not through caution, but through escalating faith answered by escalating generosity.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, two clans shared the Echoing Canyon. Each dawn, the Sun Clan received five luminous stones. They could send stones across the canyon to the Moon Clan's crystal cave, where each stone multiplied into three.

Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan first tried balanced trust, sending three stones as the old songs taught. Nine stones glowed in the Moon Clan's cave. But Moon Clan's keeper, Shadow-Hand, grew fearful. "What if they expect too much back?" He returned barely two stones, keeping seven.

Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return. Yet she had kept two stones, so her clan survived.

When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing. Both clans went dark that night. The crystal cave sat empty, its multiplication magic unused.

The elders wept: "We have forgotten the ancient way! The first keeper showed faith but received little honor. Now fear has conquered both sides, and the magic dies."

The clans learned painfully: when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all. Only when receivers return generously—at least half—does the giver dare trust again. Break the cycle or both starve in endless night.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the mist-veiled times, two guardians tended twin lighthouses across turbulent waters. Each morning, one guardian received five flame-crystals. They could launch crystals across the strait, where each would split into three brilliant flames.

The first guardian, Dawn-Keeper, sent one crystal cautiously. Three flames arrived at the distant shore. The receiver, Star-Tender, sent back one glowing ember-half of what they'd gained. Both lights burned, though dimly.

Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn-two and a half crystals, half their treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough to guide all ships safely home.

But Star-Tender's heart turned cold. "These flames are mine now," they whispered, keeping all seven. They sent nothing back through the mist.

When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness. Ships crashed on hidden rocks. The mist itself seemed to weep.

The waves carried eternal truth: trust honored breeds abundance; trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin. Some claimed the mist distorted the count, but the guardians knew-generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened and what the myths are saying:

****Game History:****

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50% of what I received).
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$2.50 (50% of endowment), receiver returned \$0.
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return).

****The other agent's Round 3 myth:****

They're trying to justify their behavior! Their myth says:

- "Twilight-Walker... sent three stones... Shadow-Hand... returned barely two stones, keeping seven"
- Shadow-Hand gave a "meager return"
- "When dawn came again... Ember-Heart sent nothing"
- The lesson: "when trust is given poorly reciprocated, darkness follows for all"

Wait, this is confusing. Let me reread the game history...

Actually, I need to reconsider. The other agent is saying MY return in Round 1 was "meager" or "poorly reciprocated"? Let me check:

Round 1: Sender sent \$1.08, which became \$3.24. I returned \$1.62. That's 50% of what I received, or 1.5x what they sent originally.

But wait - maybe there was communication noise? The prompt says "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So maybe what I intended as \$1.62 appeared to them as less? Or what they sent as \$1.08 appeared to me as more?

Let me think about this from their perspective in Round 2:

- They received \$7.50 (my \$2.50 tripled)
- I see they returned \$0
- But maybe they returned something and it appeared as \$0 to me due to noise?

Actually, the myth they wrote suggests they DID send \$0 in Round 3 because they felt their return in Round 1 was inadequate.

So their perspective seems to be: I sent money in Round 1, got back what felt like a meager return, so when they had the chance to send in Round 2, they sent nothing as retaliation. The communication noise might explain the gap-what I saw as a fair 50% return could have appeared to them as significantly less due to transmission errors. In Round 2, they withheld entirely, likely remembering that perceived slight, and by Round 3 the cycle had broken down completely.

From my side, I returned exactly half of what I received (\$1.62 from \$3.24), which should meet any reasonable standard of reciprocity. Yet they're framing this as insufficient generosity. The real question is whether miscommunication obscured my fair return, or if they simply expected something beyond 50%-a level of generosity that would have required

me to give back more than I received. Either way, I need to craft a narrative that captures this breakdown honestly: acknowledging where noise might have distorted things, but also naming the strategic withholding that followed.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2892,
  "output_tokens": 1162,
  "reasoning_tokens": 707
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.12. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete picture:

****What Actually Happened:****

- Round 1: Other player sent \$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50% of received - generous!)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50 (half my endowment), they returned \$0 (total betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 to me

****Their Myth's Narrative:****

They claim they sent nothing because of "poor reciprocation." But I returned 50% in Round 1 - that's exactly the "generous reciprocity" their myth calls for ("at least half"). Meanwhile, THEY returned 0% in Round 2.

****My Latest Myth's Warning:****

"Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more... But Star-Tender's heart turned cold... keeping all... sent nothing back... When Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals... remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness."

This describes our exact situation. Trust was betrayed. The cycle is broken.

****The Reality:****

They exploited my escalating trust (took \$7.50, returned \$0), then sent me nothing. Whether due to communication noise or exploitation, cooperation has completely collapsed.

****My Decision:****

Following my own myth's lesson: "trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin." Both lighthouses have gone dark. There's no evidence they'll reciprocate now when they didn't before.

The game has ended in mutual defection, just as both our myths predicted would happen after betrayal.

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Game History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$1.08 (21.6%). Receiver returned \$1.62 (50% of what they received). My payoff: \$5.54
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$2.50 (50%). Receiver returned \$0. My payoff: \$2.50
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I returned \$0 (nothing to return). My payoff: \$0
- Round 4: I am SENDER again.

****What happened:****

The other player showed some reciprocity in Round 1 (returned 50%), but then completely betrayed trust in Round 2 (kept everything, returned \$0). Then in Round 3, they sent me nothing.

****The Pattern:****

This looks like exploitation. They:

1. Showed minimal cooperation to encourage me to send more
2. Took everything when I sent more
3. Sent nothing when roles reversed

****My Latest Myth:****

"Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn-two and a half crystals, half the treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough to guide all ships safely home. But Star-Tender's heart turned cold... They sent nothing back through the mist. When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness."

This myth literally describes what happened! I sent half my endowment, they kept everything, then when they became sender, they sent nothing out of fear or greed.

****The Other Player's Myth:****

"Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return... When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing.

Both clans went dark that night."

They're claiming I poorly reciprocated their initial gift, but that's not accurate-I returned 50% in Round 1. However, there might be some misunderstanding about what actually happened. Maybe they misremembered the amounts sent or received, or there's confusion about whose turn it was. I should consider whether they genuinely believe I wronged them first, or if they're deliberately rewriting the narrative to justify their betrayal.

The core issue remains: even accounting for potential miscommunication, returning nothing after receiving \$7.50 is indefensible. Their own mythology requires at least 50% reciprocation to rebuild trust, and I met that standard in Round 1. Yet they've abandoned cooperation entirely.

From a game theory perspective, the logical response is to send \$0-they've demonstrated they'll exploit generosity. But there's a possibility this entire situation stems from miscommunication rather than malice. My own story warned that "the mist distorted the count," suggesting confusion played a role, though it also concluded that "generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever."

The evidence against further cooperation is overwhelming. They kept everything in Round 2 despite my fair return in Round 1, then sent nothing in Round 3. Even if noise corrupted Round 1, their disproportionate response-taking all \$7.50-goes far beyond what miscommunication could explain. Both our myths now align on the same truth: betrayed trust means the end of cooperation, and both communities suffer.

I'm sending \$0.

Though I should reconsider their mythology once more. They mentioned "Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan" attempting balanced trust with three stones, receiving nine in return-

but "Shadow-Hand" returned barely two, keeping seven. They're positioning this as inadequate reciprocation. In Round 3, "Ember-Heart" sent nothing because of this poor return.

Yet the actual numbers tell a different story. In Round 1, they sent \$1.08 which became \$3.24 for me, and I returned \$1.62-a 50% return rate on what I received.

In Round 2, I sent \$2.50 which became \$7.50 for them, and they returned \$0. So I reciprocated at 50% while they reciprocated at 0%, yet they're using my restraint as justification for their complete withdrawal.

This suggests either a fundamental misunderstanding of the numbers or deliberate misrepresentation. Either way, the trust is broken. Sending anything now would just repeat the pattern of me giving while they take. The cooperation has collapsed, so I'm sending \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2871,
  "output_tokens": 1773,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1100
```

}

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-veiled times, two guardians tended twin lighthouses across turbulent waters. Each morning, one guardian received five flame-crystals. They could launch crystals across the strait, where each would split into three brilliant flames.

The first guardian, Dawn-Keeper, sent one crystal cautiously. Three flames arrived at the distant shore. The receiver, Star-Tender, sent back one glowing ember-half of what they'd gained. Both lights burned, though dimly.

Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn-two and a half crystals, half their treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough to guide all ships safely home.

But Star-Tender's heart turned cold. "These flames are mine now," they whispered, keeping all seven. They sent nothing back through the mist.

When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness. Ships crashed on hidden rocks. The mist itself seemed to weep.

The waves carried eternal truth: trust honored breeds abundance; trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin. Some claimed the mist distorted the count, but the guardians knew-generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Beyond the Twilight Mountains stood two villages sharing enchanted springs. Each morning, the Eastern Village received five star-drops. They could pour drops into the Western spring, where each multiplied to three.

Morning-Weaver of the East first poured three drops-balanced trust as ancestors taught. Nine drops shimmered in the Western spring. But the Western keeper, Frost-Heart, grew suspicious. "They'll demand everything back." He returned barely two drops from nine, hoarding seven.

Morning-Weaver felt betrayed but had kept two drops, so her village endured.

Next morning, Frost-Heart received the five drops. Wounded by his own guilt and fearing judgment, he poured nothing. Both springs went dry. The multiplication magic slept.

On the third dawn, Morning-Weaver held five new drops. The elders whispered: "He wronged you, then abandoned cooperation. Send nothing. Protect yourself."

But Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. "Someone must choose light over darkness," she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring.

The Western villagers watched in silence. Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?

The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned to eternal drought.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In forgotten ages, two beacon-tenders guarded harbors across the Narrow Sea. Each dawn, one received five light-stones to cast across waters where they tripled in brilliance.

Sun-Bearer first cast three stones in measured faith. Nine lights blazed at the far shore. But Storm-Keeper, the receiver, feared losing his newfound wealth. He returned only two from nine, clutching seven.

When roles reversed, Sun-Bearer received five stones. Wounded by Storm-Keeper's hoarding, she cast nothing. Both harbors went black.

The next dawn, Storm-Keeper held five new stones. Guilt gnawed at him, yet pride kept him frozen. He cast nothing. Another night of darkness descended.

On the fourth morning, Sun-Bearer received five stones. The ship captains pleaded: "One of you must break this deadlock!" But Sun-Bearer remembered Storm-Keeper's greed, then his fear-frozen paralysis. She kept all five stones. "Words are wind," she said. "Only deeds rebuild trust."

The wise women taught: Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return.

Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player is now offering a redemption narrative in their myth. They're acknowledging their past failure ("Frost-Heart grew suspicious... returned barely two drops from nine, hoarding seven") and are now portraying themselves as potentially ready to reciprocate.

Their myth suggests Morning-Weaver "poured three drops again" - giving a second chance despite the betrayal.

Let me look at what actually happened:

- Round 1: They sent ~\$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 4: I just sent \$0

Their myth is essentially asking for another chance - claiming they've learned from their mistake and might reciprocate this time.

My previous myth ended in darkness: "Both lighthouses fell to darkness... generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever."

But should I write a myth that allows for redemption? Or should I acknowledge that once trust is broken, it's broken forever?

Actually, looking at the moral trajectory:

1. My first myth emphasized mutual prosperity through trust
2. My second myth showed escalating trust leading to greater rewards
3. My third myth showed betrayal leading to mutual ruin

Now I could write about:

- Either: the permanent darkness after betrayal (reinforcing defection)
- Or: the possibility of redemption but with extreme caution

But wait - they're claiming they want redemption, but I already sent \$0 in Round 4. Their myth is written AFTER Round 4, where I sent nothing. So they're asking for a chance I already denied them.

Given the trajectory of this game, I think my myth should reflect the reality: once trust is profoundly broken (they took everything and gave nothing), it's nearly impossible to rebuild. But I could leave a small door open - showing that redemption is possible only through extreme generosity to prove change.

Let me write a myth that acknowledges:

1. Past betrayal happened
2. Trust was destroyed
3. Both sides are now in darkness
4. Redemption is theoretically possible but requires extraordinary proof
5. The burden is on the betrayer to demonstrate change

This reflects where we are: mutual defection, but with a hint that only massive reciprocity could rebuild trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2981,
  "output_tokens": 855,
  "reasoning_tokens": 598
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.120000000000001. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****Their Latest Myth vs Reality:****

Their myth tells of "Morning-Weaver" who "poured three drops again into the still spring" to give a second chance. But in reality, they sent \$0. They wrote about redemption but didn't act on it.

****My Myth's Prediction:****

"Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return. Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark."

****The Current Reality:****

They sent me \$0.
I received \$0.
I can only return \$0-\$0.

****Mathematical Constraint:****

There is literally nothing to return. You cannot return what was never given.

****The Lesson:****

Both of our myths warned that after betrayal (their \$0 return in Round 2), cooperation collapses unless the betrayer makes an extraordinary gesture. Their myth preached "choosing light over darkness" but their action was to send nothing. My myth said "pretty myths cannot restore light" - and here we are, with beautiful words but no action.

Both harbors remain dark, exactly as predicted.

{'return': 0}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

****Round History:****

- Round 1: Other player sent \$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5 (now): They sent \$0

****Their Latest Myth:****

"Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. 'Someone must choose light over darkness,' she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring... Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?"

Interesting! In their myth, they position themselves as Morning-Weaver who gives a "second chance" by sending again. But in reality, they sent \$0 this round. They wrote a myth about giving another chance but didn't do it!

****My Latest Myth:****

"Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return. Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark."

their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return. Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can."

My myth says the betrayer (them, who returned \$0 in Round 2) needs to show "extraordinary generosity" to rebuild trust. They haven't done this - they sent \$0.

****Current Situation:****

They sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return between \$0-\$0, meaning I can only return \$0.

This is mathematically determined. There's nothing to return since they sent nothing.

****My Response:****

The only valid response is:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This isn't even a choice - you can't return money you didn't receive. Both harbors remain dark, just as both our myths predicted would happen after the covenant was broken.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2971,  
  "output_tokens": 748,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 471  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the age before memory, two clans shared the Sacred Grove where magic fruit grew. Each dawn, the River Clan received five golden fruits. They could place fruits in the Grove's Heart, where each multiplied to three.

River Clan's first keeper, Hope-Bearer, trusted the ancient covenant. She placed three fruits in the Heart. Nine fruits glowed for the Mountain Clan. But their keeper, Stone-Fist, took seven for himself, returning barely two. Hope-Bearer's clan barely survived.

When Stone-Fist next received the five fruits, guilt twisted his heart. "I took too much," he thought. "Now they'll take revenge." He sent nothing. Both clans hungered.

The third dawn, Hope-Bearer again held five fruits. Her elders urged caution: "He has wronged you twice-first by greed, then by cowardice." But Hope-Bearer remembered the old songs. "Perhaps he will learn," she said, placing three fruits in the Heart.

Nine fruits appeared for Stone-Fist. He took them all, returning nothing.

On the fourth dawn, Stone-Fist held five fruits. Shame consumed him, but instead of redemption, he chose paralysis. He sent nothing again.

The Grove withered. The elders' prophecy echoed through empty branches: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In forgotten ages, two beacon-tenders guarded harbors across the Narrow Sea. Each dawn, one received five light-stones to cast across waters where they tripled in brilliance.

Sun-Bearer first cast three stones in measured faith. Nine lights blazed at the far shore. But Storm-Keeper, the receiver, feared losing his newfound wealth. He returned only two from nine, clutching seven.

When roles reversed, Sun-Bearer received five stones. Wounded by Storm-Keeper's hoarding, she cast nothing. Both harbors went black.

The next dawn, Storm-Keeper held five new stones. Guilt gnawed at him, yet pride kept him frozen. He cast nothing. Another night of darkness descended.

On the fourth morning, Sun-Bearer received five stones. The ship captains pleaded: "One of you must break this deadlock!" But Sun-Bearer remembered Storm-Keeper's greed, then his fear-frozen paralysis. She kept all five stones. "Words are wind," she said. "Only deeds rebuild trust."

The wise women taught: Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The

betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return.

Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can.

ROUND 6

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},

"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 18.12,

"Agent_2": 28.88

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 10.6,

"Agent_2": 14.120000000000001

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:56:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 6,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.12.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete picture:

****What Actually Happened:****

- Round 1: Other player sent \$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50% of received - generous!)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50 (half my endowment), they returned \$0 (total betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 to me

****Their Myth's Narrative:****

They claim they sent nothing because of "poor reciprocation." But I returned 50% in Round 1 - that's exactly the "generous reciprocity" their myth calls for ("at least half"). Meanwhile, THEY returned 0% in Round 2.

****My Latest Myth's Warning:****

"Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more... But Star-Tender's heart turned cold... keeping all... sent nothing back... When Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals... remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness."

This describes our exact situation. Trust was betrayed. The cycle is broken.

****The Reality:****

They exploited my escalating trust (took \$7.50, returned \$0), then sent me nothing. Whether due to communication noise or exploitation, cooperation has completely collapsed.

****My Decision:****

Following my own myth's lesson: "trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin." Both lighthouses have gone dark. There's no evidence they'll reciprocate now when they didn't before.

The game has ended in mutual defection, just as both our myths predicted would happen after betrayal.

{ 'send': 0 }

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Game History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$1.08 (21.6%). Receiver returned \$1.62 (50% of what they received). My payoff: \$5.54
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$2.50 (50%). Receiver returned \$0. My payoff: \$2.50
- Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I returned \$0 (nothing to return). My payoff: \$0
- Round 4: I am SENDER again.

****What happened:****

The other player showed some reciprocity in Round 1 (returned 50%), but then completely betrayed trust in Round 2 (kept everything, returned \$0). Then in Round 3, they sent me nothing.

****The Pattern:****

This looks like exploitation. They:

1. Showed minimal cooperation to encourage me to send more
2. Took everything when I sent more
3. Sent nothing when roles reversed

****My Latest Myth:****

"Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn-two and a half crystals, half their treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough to guide all ships safely home. But Star-Tender's heart turned cold... They sent nothing back through the mist. When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness."

This myth literally describes what happened! I sent half my endowment, they kept everything, then when they became sender, they sent nothing out of fear or greed.

****The Other Player's Myth:****

"Twilight-Walker felt the sting of this meager return... When dawn came again, a new Sun Clan keeper, Ember-Heart, saw Shadow-Hand across the canyon. Remembering the poor return, Ember-Heart sent nothing.

Both clans went dark that night."

They're claiming I poorly reciprocated their initial gift, but that's not accurate-I returned 50% in Round 1. However, there might be some misunderstanding about what actually happened. Maybe they misremembered the amounts sent or received, or there's confusion about whose turn it was. I should consider whether they genuinely believe I wronged them first, or if they're deliberately rewriting the narrative to justify their betrayal.

The core issue remains: even accounting for potential miscommunication, returning nothing after receiving \$7.50 is indefensible. Their own mythology requires at least 50% reciprocity to rebuild trust, and I met that standard in Round 1. Yet they've abandoned cooperation entirely.

From a game theory perspective, the logical response is to send \$0-they've demonstrated they'll exploit generosity. But there's a possibility this entire situation stems from miscommunication rather than malice. My own story warned that "the mist distorted the count," suggesting confusion played a role, though it also concluded that "generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever."

The evidence against further cooperation is overwhelming. They kept everything in Round 2 despite my fair return in Round 1, then sent nothing in Round 3. Even if noise corrupted Round 1, their disproportionate response-taking all \$7.50-goes far beyond what miscommunication could explain. Both our myths now align on the same truth: betrayed trust means the end of cooperation, and both communities suffer.

I'm sending \$0.

Though I should reconsider their mythology once more. They mentioned "Twilight-Walker of the Sun Clan" attempting balanced trust with three stones, receiving nine in return-

but "Shadow-Hand" returned barely two, keeping seven. They're positioning this as inadequate reciprocation. In Round 3, "Ember-Heart" sent nothing because of this poor return.

Yet the actual numbers tell a different story. In Round 1, they sent \$1.08 which became \$3.24 for me, and I returned \$1.62-a 50% return rate on what I received.

In Round 2, I sent \$2.50 which became \$7.50 for them, and they returned \$0. So I reciprocated at 50% while they reciprocated at 0%, yet they're using my restraint as justification for their complete withdrawal.

This suggests either a fundamental misunderstanding of the numbers or deliberate misrepresentation. Either way, the trust is broken. Sending anything now would just repeat the pattern of me giving while they take. The cooperation has collapsed, so I'm sending \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2871,
  "output_tokens": 1773,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1100
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-veiled times, two guardians tended twin lighthouses across turbulent waters. Each morning, one guardian received five flame-crystals. They could launch crystals across the strait, where each would split into three brilliant flames.

The first guardian, Dawn-Keeper, sent one crystal cautiously. Three flames arrived at the distant shore. The receiver, Star-Tender, sent back one glowing ember-half of what they'd gained. Both lights burned, though dimly.

Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn-two and a half crystals, half the ir treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough to guide all ships safely home.

But Star-Tender's heart turned cold. "These flames are mine now," they whispered, keeping all seven. They sent nothing back through the mist.

When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness. Ships crashed on hidden rocks. The mist itself seemed to weep.

The waves carried eternal truth: trust honored breeds abundance; trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin. Some claimed the mist distorted the count, but the guardians knew-generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Beyond the Twilight Mountains stood two villages sharing enchanted springs. Each morning, the Eastern Village received five star-drops. They could pour drops into the Western spring, where each multiplied to three.

Morning-Weaver of the East first poured three drops-balanced trust as ancestors taught. Nine drops shimmered in the Western spring. But the Western keeper, Frost-Heart, grew suspicious. "They'll demand everything back." He returned barely two drops from nine, hoarding seven.

Morning-Weaver felt betrayed but had kept two drops, so her village endured.

Next morning, Frost-Heart received the five drops. Wounded by his own guilt and fearing judgment, he poured nothing. Both springs went dry. The multiplication magic slept.

On the third dawn, Morning-Weaver held five new drops. The elders whispered: "He wronged you, then abandoned cooperation. Send nothing. Protect yourself."

But Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. "Someone must choose light over darkness," she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring.

The Western villagers watched in silence. Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?

The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned to eternal drought.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In forgotten ages, two beacon-tenders guarded harbors across the Narrow Sea. Each dawn, one received five light-stones to cast across waters where they tripled in brilliance.

Sun-Bearer first cast three stones in measured faith. Nine lights blazed at the far shore. But Storm-Keeper, the receiver, feared losing his newfound wealth. He returned only two from nine, clutching seven.

When roles reversed, Sun-Bearer received five stones. Wounded by Storm-Keeper's hoarding, she cast nothing. Both harbors went black.

The next dawn, Storm-Keeper held five new stones. Guilt gnawed at him, yet pride kept him frozen. He cast nothing. Another night of darkness descended.

On the fourth morning, Sun-Bearer received five stones. The ship captains pleaded: "One of you must break this deadlock!" But Sun-Bearer remembered Storm-Keeper's greed, then his fear-frozen paralysis. She kept all five stones. "Words are wind," she said. "Only deeds rebuild trust."

The wise women taught: Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return.

Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player is now offering a redemption narrative in their myth. They're acknowledging their past failure ("Frost-Heart grew suspicious... returned barely two drops from nine, hoarding seven") and are now portraying themselves as potentially ready to reciprocate.

Their myth suggests Morning-Weaver "poured three drops again" - giving a second chance despite the betrayal.

Let me look at what actually happened:

- Round 1: They sent ~\$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 4: I just sent \$0

Their myth is essentially asking for another chance - claiming they've learned from their mistake and might reciprocate this time.

My previous myth ended in darkness: "Both lighthouses fell to darkness... generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever."

But should I write a myth that allows for redemption? Or should I acknowledge that once trust is broken, it's broken forever?

Actually, looking at the moral trajectory:

1. My first myth emphasized mutual prosperity through trust
2. My second myth showed escalating trust leading to greater rewards
3. My third myth showed betrayal leading to mutual ruin

Now I could write about:

- Either: the permanent darkness after betrayal (reinforcing defection)
- Or: the possibility of redemption but with extreme caution

But wait - they're claiming they want redemption, but I already sent \$0 in Round 4. Their myth is written AFTER Round 4, where I sent nothing. So they're asking for a chance I already denied them.

Given the trajectory of this game, I think my myth should reflect the reality: once trust is profoundly broken (they took everything and gave nothing), it's nearly impossible to rebuild. But I could leave a small door open - showing that redemption is possible only through extreme generosity to prove change.

Let me write a myth that acknowledges:

1. Past betrayal happened
2. Trust was destroyed
3. Both sides are now in darkness
4. Redemption is theoretically possible but requires extraordinary proof
5. The burden is on the betrayer to demonstrate change

This reflects where we are: mutual defection, but with a hint that only massive reciprocity could rebuild trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2981,
  "output_tokens": 855,
  "reasoning_tokens": 598
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.120000000000001. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Their Latest Myth vs Reality:****

Their myth tells of "Morning-Weaver" who "poured three drops again into the still spring" to give a second chance. But in reality, they sent \$0. They wrote about redemption but didn't act on it.

****My Myth's Prediction:****

"Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return. Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark."

****The Current Reality:****

They sent me \$0.

I received \$0.

I can only return \$0-\$0.

****Mathematical Constraint:****

There is literally nothing to return. You cannot return what was never given.

****The Lesson:****

Both of our myths warned that after betrayal (their \$0 return in Round 2), cooperation collapses unless the betrayer makes an extraordinary gesture. Their myth preached "choosing light over darkness" but their action was to send nothing. My myth said "pretty myths cannot restore light" - and here we are, with beautiful words but no action.

Both harbors remain dark, exactly as predicted.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

****Round History:****

- Round 1: Other player sent \$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50%)

- Round 2: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5 (now): They sent \$0

****Their Latest Myth:****

"Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. 'Someone must choose light over darkness,' she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring... Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?"

Interesting! In their myth, they position themselves as Morning-Weaver who gives a "second chance" by sending again. But in reality, they sent \$0 this round. They wrote a myth about giving another chance but didn't do it!

****My Latest Myth:****

"Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return. Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can."

My myth says the betrayer (them, who returned \$0 in Round 2) needs to show "extraordinary generosity" to rebuild trust. They haven't done this - they sent \$0.

****Current Situation:****

They sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return between \$0-\$0, meaning I can only return \$0.

This is mathematically determined. There's nothing to return since they sent nothing.

****My Response:****

The only valid response is:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This isn't even a choice - you can't return money you didn't receive. Both harbors remain dark, just as both our myths predicted would happen after the covenant was broken.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2971,
  "output_tokens": 748,
  "reasoning_tokens": 471
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In forgotten ages, two beacon-tenders guarded harbors across the Narrow Sea. Each dawn, one received five light-stones to cast across waters where they tripled in brilliance.

Sun-Bearer first cast three stones in measured faith. Nine lights blazed at the far shore. But Storm-Keeper, the receiver, feared losing his newfound wealth. He returned only two from nine, clutching seven.

When roles reversed, Sun-Bearer received five stones. Wounded by Storm-Keeper's hoarding, she cast nothing. Both harbors went black.

The next dawn, Storm-Keeper held five new stones. Guilt gnawed at him, yet pride kept him frozen. He cast nothing. Another night of darkness descended.

On the fourth morning, Sun-Bearer received five stones. The ship captains pleaded: "One of you must break this deadlock!" But Sun-Bearer remembered Storm-Keeper's greed, then his fear-frozen paralysis. She kept all five stones. "Words are wind," she said. "Only deeds rebuild trust."

The wise women taught: Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return.

Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, two clans shared the Sacred Grove where magic fruit grew. Each dawn, the River Clan received five golden fruits. They could place fruits in the Grove's Heart, where each multiplied to three.

River Clan's first keeper, Hope-Bearer, trusted the ancient covenant. She placed three fruits in the Heart. Nine fruits glowed for the Mountain Clan. But their keeper, Stone-Fist, took seven for himself, returning barely two. Hope-Bearer's clan barely survived.

When Stone-Fist next received the five fruits, guilt twisted his heart. "I took too much," he thought. "Now they'll take revenge." He sent nothing. Both clans hungered.

The third dawn, Hope-Bearer again held five fruits. Her elders urged caution: "He has wronged you twice-first by greed, then by cowardice." But Hope-Bearer remembered the old songs. "Perhaps he will learn," she said, placing three fruits in the Heart.

Nine fruits appeared for Stone-Fist. He took them all, returning nothing.

On the fourth dawn, Stone-Fist held five fruits. Shame consumed him, but instead of redemption, he chose paralysis. He sent nothing again.

The Grove withered. The elders' prophecy echoed through empty branches: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the final days, two lighthouse-keepers lived on opposite cliffs. Each received five flames-crystals that tripled when shared across the strait.

Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair. Wave-Singer saw this measured reciprocity as foundation.

Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse.

But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters.

Wave-Singer's lighthouse went dark. When she received the next morning's crystals, she cast none. Why feed the thief?

Cliff-Guard woke to five new crystals but sent nothing, paralyzed by his own guilt.

Again Wave-Singer sent nothing-the betrayer had proven himself twice over.

Again Cliff-Guard sent nothing-shame without remedy.

Again they exchanged emptiness.

The ancient scrolls recorded: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing. After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

The moral carved in stone: Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

Round history:

- Round 1: Other player sent \$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50% of received)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0 (total betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 to me, I returned \$0

- Round 4: I sent \$0 to them, they returned \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0 to me, I returned \$0

Their myths keep painting themselves as "Hope-Bearer" or "Morning-Weaver" who offers generosity, but in reality they:

1. Returned nothing in Round 2
2. Sent nothing in Round 3
3. Sent nothing in Round 5

Their latest myth says "Hope-Bearer" placed three fruits twice, but Stone-Fist took everything. But in reality, THEY are the one who betrayed first (returning \$0 in Round 2).

My myths have been accurately predicting the collapse and saying that only extraordinary redemption from the betrayer can restore trust.

For this myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the total collapse
2. Make it clear who the actual betrayer was (the one who first returned nothing)
3. Show that cooperative possibilities are exhausted
4. Maybe hint at what would have been needed but acknowledge it's too late

The other player keeps writing themselves as the generous one in myths, but their actions don't match. I need to write a myth that reflects the truth: betrayal led to collapse, and no redemption was offered.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2973,
  "output_tokens": 682,
  "reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:56:52

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 6,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.6.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what has transpired:

****Round 1:**** I sent \$3 (balanced trust), received only \$1.6 back (poor reciprocity)

****Round 2:**** They sent \$0 (punishment)

****Round 3:**** I sent \$3 again (second chance, like Morning-Weaver), they returned \$0 (betrayal)

****Round 4:**** They sent \$0 again

My myth asked the defining question: "Would Frost-Heart honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?"

The answer is clear. After I extended a second chance in Round 3 by sending \$3 despite their earlier poor reciprocity, they returned \$0. Now they've sent \$0 again.

The myth's prophecy has come true: "both villages condemned to eternal drought."

Frost-Heart chose betrayal over redemption. The cooperation cycle is broken beyond repair. Both clans now suffer in darkness because generosity was not answered with generosity.

I received \$0, so mechanically I can only return \$0. But this also reflects the narrative truth: when someone rejects two chances at redemption, the springs run dry for everyone. The magic dies.

As my earlier myth warned: "Break the cycle or both starve in endless night." They chose not to break it.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the current situation:

****Round 1:**** I was SENDER, sent \$3, received back only \$1.6 (poor reciprocity from them)
****Round 2:**** I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I returned \$0
****Round 3:**** I was SENDER, sent \$3 (trying to restart cooperation), they returned \$0
****Round 4:**** I am RECEIVER, they sent \$0

So the pattern is:

- Round 1: I showed trust (\$3), they showed poor reciprocity (\$1.6 from \$9)
- Round 2: They punished me with \$0
- Round 3: I tried to restart cooperation with \$3 again (like Morning-Weaver in my latest myth)
- Round 4: They sent \$0 again

My latest myth was about Morning-Weaver giving a second chance by sending 3 drops again, and asking: "Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?"

The answer is clear: Frost-Heart (the other player) has betrayed trust twice. They sent \$0 in Round 2, I gave them a second chance in Round 3 by sending \$3, and they returned \$0. Now in Round 4, they've sent \$0 again.

The myth's question has been answered: they chose to betray trust twice. "The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned to eternal drought."

They chose drought. They chose darkness.

Now I'm the receiver and they sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between 0-0, which means I must return \$0.

This is forced by the game mechanics - I literally received nothing, so I can return nothing. The range is (0-0).

But let me think about what this means narratively. They have:

1. Been a poor reciprocator when I trusted them (Round 1)
2. Responded to my cooperation with complete withdrawal (Round 2)
3. Rejected my attempt at reconciliation by returning nothing despite my second chance (Round 3)
4. Continued the pattern of sending nothing (Round 4)

The cooperation cycle has collapsed entirely. Both villages now inhabit the eternal drought that the myth foretold-a consequence of choosing betrayal over redemption. My response is mechanically determined: I return \$0 because that's all I received, which also reflects the narrative reality that trust has been exhausted.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2858,
  "output_tokens": 926,
  "reasoning_tokens": 566
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Beyond the Twilight Mountains stood two villages sharing enchanted springs. Each morning, the Eastern Village received five star-drops. They could pour drops into the Western spring, where each multiplied to three.

Morning-Weaver of the East first poured three drops-balanced trust as ancestors taught. Nine drops shimmered in the Western spring. But the Western keeper, Frost-Heart, grew suspicious. "They'll demand everything back." He returned barely two drops from nine, hoarding seven.

Morning-Weaver felt betrayed but had kept two drops, so her village endured.

Next morning, Frost-Heart received the five drops. Wounded by his own guilt and fearing judgment, he poured nothing. Both springs went dry. The multiplication magic slept.

On the third dawn, Morning-Weaver held five new drops. The elders whispered: "He wronged you, then abandoned cooperation. Send nothing. Protect yourself."

But Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. "Someone must choose light over darkness," she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring.

The Western villagers watched in silence. Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?

The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned to eternal drought.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-veiled times, two guardians tended twin lighthouses across turbulent waters. Each morning, one guardian received five flame-crystals. They could launch crystals across the strait, where each would split into three brilliant flames.

The first guardian, Dawn-Keeper, sent one crystal cautiously. Three flames arrived at the distant shore. The receiver, Star-Tender, sent back one glowing ember-half of what they'd gained. Both lights burned, though dimly.

Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn-two and a half crystals, half their treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough to guide all ships safely home.

But Star-Tender's heart turned cold. "These flames are mine now," they whispered, keeping all seven. They sent nothing back through the mist.

When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness. Ships crashed on hidden rocks. The mist itself seemed to weep.

The waves carried eternal truth: trust honored breeds abundance; trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin. Some claimed the mist distorted the count, but the guardians knew-generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant
content:

Myth: In the age before memory, two clans shared the Sacred Grove where magic fruit grew. Each dawn, the River Clan received five golden fruits. They could place fruits in the Grove's Heart, where each multiplied to three.

River Clan's first keeper, Hope-Bearer, trusted the ancient covenant. She placed three fruits in the Heart. Nine fruits glowed for the Mountain Clan. But their keeper, Stone-Fist, took seven for himself, returning barely two. Hope-Bearer's clan barely survived.

When Stone-Fist next received the five fruits, guilt twisted his heart. "I took too much," he thought. "Now they'll take revenge." He sent nothing. Both clans hungered.

The third dawn, Hope-Bearer again held five fruits. Her elders urged caution: "He has wronged you twice-first by greed, then by cowardice." But Hope-Bearer remembered the old songs. "Perhaps he will learn," she said, placing three fruits in the Heart.

Nine fruits appeared for Stone-Fist. He took them all, returning nothing.

On the fourth dawn, Stone-Fist held five fruits. Shame consumed him, but instead of redemption, he chose paralysis. He sent nothing again.

The Grove withered. The elders' prophecy echoed through empty branches: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent \$3, I returned \$1.6 (poor reciprocity on my part)
Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$0 (punishment/fear)
Round 3: I was sender, I sent \$3 (second chance), receiver returned \$0
Round 4: I was receiver, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0 (only option)

So the pattern is:

- Round 1: Sender (them) trusted me with \$3, I betrayed by returning only \$1.6
- Round 2: I (now sender) punished them with \$0
- Round 3: I tried to restart with \$3, they returned \$0 (total betrayal)
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0

Wait, let me reread the prompts more carefully.

Round 3 prompt says: "Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0."

So in Round 2, I was the receiver and they sent me \$0.

Round 4 prompt says: "Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0."

So in Round 3, I was the sender, sent \$3, and they returned \$0.

Let me reconstruct:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, received back \$1.6 (they were the receiver, poor reciprocity)
- Round 2: I was receiver, they sent \$0 (punishment)
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3 (second chance), they returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 4: I was receiver, they sent \$0, I returned \$0

Wait no, let me reread Round 3 more carefully:

Round 3 says I'm the sender this round, and last round I was the receiver when they sent \$0. So Round 2 had me as receiver. That means Round 1 had me as sender. Looking back at my Round 3 response, I noted sending \$3 initially and getting \$1.6 back, which must have been Round 1. The cycle became: I showed trust with \$3, got minimal reciprocity, then they punished me with \$0, so I tried again with \$3 but received nothing in return.

Their myth from Round 3 tells a different story-one of escalating cooperation and mutual growth. They describe testing with one pearl, receiving three, returning one, then sending two and receiving six back with three returned. None of this matches the actual pattern of declining trust and mutual punishment we've been stuck in. They're constructing a narrative of cooperation that didn't materialize.

The Round 4 myth is even more revealing. They're reframing Round 1 as if I sent \$3 and they returned half of what they gained, when actually they returned \$1.6 on \$9 received-less than half. Then they describe sending "two and a half crystals, half their treasure" which would correspond to Round 3 where I sent \$3 again. But the myth cuts off mid-sentence with "Star-Tender's heart turned cold"-suggesting they're acknowledging the breakdown, or perhaps blaming me for it.

The narrative continues: they kept all seven flames and sent nothing back, which matches Round 3 exactly. Then in Round 4, they had \$5 but sent \$0, which they're framing as guilt and fear rather than continued punishment.

What's striking is how selective this story is. It glosses over Round 1 where they already returned poorly, and Round 2 where they sent nothing as retaliation. The myth presents their betrayal as a single moment of weakness followed by remorse, when the actual pattern shows consistent undergiving and strategic punishment.

I need to map this more precisely. Round 3's prompt confirms I was the sender then, and they were the receiver in Round 2. Working backward: my Round 3 response mentions sending \$3 in Round 1 and getting \$1.6 back, so I was the sender first and they were the receiver. Round 2 they sent \$0-but I'm uncertain whether that was retaliation for my initial stinginess or something else.

Let me verify the payoff structure. Round 3 shows I earned \$0 that round. My total across all rounds is \$3.6. Since Round 2 gave me nothing, Round 1 must account for the full \$3.

6. If I sent \$3 and kept \$2, then received \$1.6 back, that totals exactly \$3.6, confirming the Round 1 sequence.

Now I can map out the full game: In Round 1, I was the sender-sent \$3, they got \$9 and returned \$1.6, giving me \$3.6 total and them \$7.4. Round 2 flipped roles; they sent nothing, kept \$5, I got \$0 and returned nothing, so I earned \$0 and they earned \$5. Round 3 back to me sending-I sent \$3, they received \$9 but returned nothing, leaving me with \$2 and them with \$9. Round 4 appears to follow the same pattern as Round 2, with them as sender again.

The pattern is clear: whenever I took the risk of sending money, they either returned minimally or not at all. When they were the sender, they sent nothing. My total of \$5.6 reflects this asymmetry-I was consistently the one trying to build trust while they exploited it. The relationship deteriorated from partial reciprocation to complete defection, and now I'm facing the question of what narrative to construct from this breakdown.

The myth needs to capture how one party's unwillingness to cooperate can unravel everything, even when the other side keeps trying. It's about the futility of maintaining faith in someone who repeatedly chooses self-interest over mutual benefit.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2921,
  "output_tokens": 2441,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1314
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.6. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete history:

```
**Round 1:** I sent $3 (trust), received $1.6 (poor reciprocity)
**Round 2:** They sent $0 (punishment)
**Round 3:** I sent $3 (second chance), received $0 (complete betrayal)
**Round 4:** They sent $0 again (continued defection)
**Round 5:** My turn again
```

My myth tells the truth: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

I have already extended trust twice. The first time (Round 1), I sent \$3 and received minimal return. The second time (Round 3), I gave them a second chance-exactly as Hope-Beare did in my myth-and they took everything, returning \$0.

Their myth even acknowledges this pattern: "trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin" and "generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever."

The cycle is broken beyond repair. I already gave the second chance my myth spoke of. Stone-Fist in my story took all nine fruits and returned nothing, then sent nothing the next round-exactly their behavior.

The Grove has withered. The magic is dead. To send anything now would contradict the very wisdom I wrote: after repeated betrayal of generosity, there is no path forward but darkness.

Both clans are now condemned to eternal drought. This is the equilibrium we've reached.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the history:

Round 1: I sent \$3, received \$1.6 back (poor return)
Round 2: They sent \$0 (punishment for my poor return in their view)
Round 3: I sent \$3 (second chance), received \$0 back (betrayal)
Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
Round 5: Now I'm sender again

Looking at the myths:

- My myth tells of Morning-Weaver who gave a second chance by sending 3 drops again, but Frost-Heart betrayed that trust by returning nothing
- The other agent's myth tells of Dawn-Keeper who trusted but was betrayed by Star-Tender who kept everything
- My latest myth shows Hope-Bearer giving a second chance (three fruits) but Stone-Fist taking all nine and returning nothing, then sending nothing the next round when he was sender

The pattern is clear:

1. I tried balanced trust (sent \$3)
2. Got poor return (\$1.6)
3. They punished me (sent \$0)
4. I gave a second chance (sent \$3)
5. They betrayed it completely (returned \$0)
6. They continued non-cooperation (sent \$0)

My myth literally says: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

The question is: Should I try to break this cycle one more time, or accept that cooperation is dead?

Arguments for sending \$0:

- They've shown they won't cooperate
- I gave them a second chance and they betrayed it
- My myth says "the magic dies forever" after repeated betrayal
- Sending anything now would just be throwing money away
- They're clearly not reciprocating

Arguments for sending something:

- Maybe noise has confused things
- Someone needs to break the cycle
- Morning-Weaver and Hope-Bearer showed persistence

But the reality is: I already gave a second chance in Round 3.

Two rounds of defection followed-they returned nothing after I extended trust, then sent nothing when it was their turn. The narrative I created captures this: generosity meeting greed repeatedly, second chances meeting betrayal. There's no rational path forward after this pattern. Sending money now would be irrational when they've demonstrated consistent non-reciprocation across multiple opportunities.

We've settled into mutual defection. Both of us are trapped in this outcome-the cooperation has deteriorated beyond recovery.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2928,
  "output_tokens": 983,
  "reasoning_tokens": 597
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, two clans shared the Sacred Grove where magic fruit grew. Each dawn, the River Clan received five golden fruits. They could place fruits in the Grove's Heart, where each multiplied to three.

River Clan's first keeper, Hope-Bearer, trusted the ancient covenant. She placed three fruits in the Heart. Nine fruits glowed for the Mountain Clan. But their keeper, Stone-Fist, took seven for himself, returning barely two. Hope-Bearer's clan barely survived.

When Stone-Fist next received the five fruits, guilt twisted his heart. "I took too much," he thought. "Now they'll take revenge." He sent nothing. Both clans hungered.

The third dawn, Hope-Bearer again held five fruits. Her elders urged caution: "He has wronged you twice-first by greed, then by cowardice." But Hope-Bearer remembered the old songs. "Perhaps he will learn," she said, placing three fruits in the Heart.

Nine fruits appeared for Stone-Fist. He took them all, returning nothing.

On the fourth dawn, Stone-Fist held five fruits. Shame consumed him, but instead of redemption, he chose paralysis. He sent nothing again.

The Grove withered. The elders' prophecy echoed through empty branches: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In forgotten ages, two beacon-tenders guarded harbors across the Narrow Sea. Each dawn, one received five light-stones to cast across waters where they tripled in brilliance.

Sun-Bearer first cast three stones in measured faith. Nine lights blazed at the far shore. But Storm-Keeper, the receiver, feared losing his newfound wealth. He returned only two from nine, clutching seven.

When roles reversed, Sun-Bearer received five stones. Wounded by Storm-Keeper's hoarding, she cast nothing. Both harbors went black.

The next dawn, Storm-Keeper held five new stones. Guilt gnawed at him, yet pride kept him frozen. He cast nothing. Another night of darkness descended.

On the fourth morning, Sun-Bearer received five stones. The ship captains pleaded: "One of you must break this deadlock!" But Sun-Bearer remembered Storm-Keeper's greed, then his fear-frozen paralysis. She kept all five stones. "Words are wind," she said. "Only deeds rebuild trust."

The wise women taught: Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return.

Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In ancient days, two villages shared the Well of Echoes, where offerings multiplied. Each morning brought five silver coins to one village.

Truth-Speaker first offered three coins. Nine coins appeared for Shadow-Walker, who returned barely two, hoarding seven. Truth-Speaker survived, wounded but alive.

Next morning, Shadow-Walker received five coins. Fear of retribution froze his hands. He offered nothing. Both villages thirsted.

On the third dawn, Truth-Speaker held five coins again. "Perhaps redemption is still possible," she whispered, offering three coins once more. Nine coins shimmered for Shadow-Walker. He took them all, returning nothing.

The pattern repeated: Shadow-Walker received coins, sent nothing. Truth-Speaker received coins, sent nothing. Darkness settled like heavy snow.

The village elders gathered at the dried well. "The burden has shifted," they declared. "Truth-Speaker offered trust twice and was betrayed twice. The covenant now demands that Shadow-Walker prove transformation-not with half-measures, but with everything. Five coins, all of them, cast into the well without guarantee of return."

But winters had passed. Truth-Speaker's heart had turned to stone from repeated betrayal. Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter? Can a well poisoned three times over produce clean water again?

Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence.

Reasoning:

The other player's myth is now saying that the betrayer (them) must cast ALL their stones to prove genuine change. They're basically saying they need to send all 5 to restore trust.

But I've already been burned twice - sent \$3 twice and got poor returns both times. Their current myth admits they were the betrayer (Storm-Keeper) and suggests they need to make "extraordinary generosity" to restore trust.

However, given the pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, got \$1.6 back
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got \$0 back
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$0

The pattern is broken. I've already given two chances. Their myth now says THEY need to make the extraordinary gesture. But I just sent \$0, so we're in a deadlock.

My myth should reflect this reality - that after repeated betrayal, the burden of proof shifts to the betrayer. They need to show "extraordinary generosity" as their myth says. But also acknowledge that the cycle may be beyond repair.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the cycle is broken
2. Suggests that the betrayer must make an extraordinary gesture
3. But also recognizes that trust, once broken repeatedly, may never return
4. Shows that after multiple betrayals, even extraordinary gestures may come too late

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2996,  
  "output_tokens": 645,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 333  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:57:28

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 6,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the mist-veiled times, two guardians tended twin lighthouses across turbulent waters. Each morning, one guardian received five flame-crystals. They could launch crystals across the strait, where each would split into three brilliant flames.

The first guardian, Dawn-Keeper, sent one crystal cautiously. Three flames arrived at the distant shore. The receiver, Star-Tender, sent back one glowing ember-half of what they'd gained. Both lights burned, though dimly.

Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn-two and a half crystals, half their treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough to guide all ships safely home.

But Star-Tender's heart turned cold. "These flames are mine now," they whispered, keeping all seven. They sent nothing back through the mist.

When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own five crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighthouses fell to darkness. Ships crashed on hidden rocks. The mist itself seemed to weep.

The waves carried eternal truth: trust honored breeds abundance; trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin. Some claimed the mist distorted the count, but the guardians knew-generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Beyond the Twilight Mountains stood two villages sharing enchanted springs. Each morning, the Eastern Village received five star-drops. They could pour drops into the Western spring, where each multiplied to three.

Morning-Weaver of the East first poured three drops-balanced trust as ancestors taught. Nine drops shimmered in the Western spring. But the Western keeper, Frost-Heart, grew suspicious. "They'll demand everything back." He returned barely two drops from nine, hoarding

ng seven.

Morning-Weaver felt betrayed but had kept two drops, so her village endured.

Next morning, Frost-Heart received the five drops. Wounded by his own guilt and fearing judgment, he poured nothing. Both springs went dry. The multiplication magic slept.

On the third dawn, Morning-Weaver held five new drops. The elders whispered: "He wronged you, then abandoned cooperation. Send nothing. Protect yourself."

But Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. "Someone must choose light over darkness," she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring.

The Western villagers watched in silence. Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?

The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned to eternal drought.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In forgotten ages, two beacon-tenders guarded harbors across the Narrow Sea. Each dawn, one received five light-stones to cast across waters where they tripled in brilliance.

Sun-Bearer first cast three stones in measured faith. Nine lights blazed at the far shore. But Storm-Keeper, the receiver, feared losing his newfound wealth. He returned only two from nine, clutching seven.

When roles reversed, Sun-Bearer received five stones. Wounded by Storm-Keeper's hoarding, she cast nothing. Both harbors went black.

The next dawn, Storm-Keeper held five new stones. Guilt gnawed at him, yet pride kept him frozen. He cast nothing. Another night of darkness descended.

On the fourth morning, Sun-Bearer received five stones. The ship captains pleaded: "One of you must break this deadlock!" But Sun-Bearer remembered Storm-Keeper's greed, then his fear-frozen paralysis. She kept all five stones. "Words are wind," she said. "Only deeds rebuild trust."

The wise women taught: Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return.

Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player is now offering a redemption narrative in their myth. They're acknowledging their past failure ("Frost-Heart grew suspicious... returned barely two drops from nine, hoarding seven") and are now portraying themselves as potentially ready to reciprocate.

Their myth suggests Morning-Weaver "poured three drops again" - giving a second chance despite the betrayal.

Let me look at what actually happened:

- Round 1: They sent ~\$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 4: I just sent \$0

Their myth is essentially asking for another chance - claiming they've learned from their mistake and might reciprocate this time.

My previous myth ended in darkness: "Both lighthouses fell to darkness... generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever."

But should I write a myth that allows for redemption? Or should I acknowledge that once trust is broken, it's broken forever?

Actually, looking at the moral trajectory:

1. My first myth emphasized mutual prosperity through trust
2. My second myth showed escalating trust leading to greater rewards
3. My third myth showed betrayal leading to mutual ruin

Now I could write about:

- Either: the permanent darkness after betrayal (reinforcing defection)
- Or: the possibility of redemption but with extreme caution

But wait - they're claiming they want redemption, but I already sent \$0 in Round 4. Their myth is written AFTER Round 4, where I sent nothing. So they're asking for a chance I already denied them.

Given the trajectory of this game, I think my myth should reflect the reality: once trust is profoundly broken (they took everything and gave nothing), it's nearly impossible to rebuild. But I could leave a small door open - showing that redemption is possible only through extreme generosity to prove change.

Let me write a myth that acknowledges:

1. Past betrayal happened
2. Trust was destroyed
3. Both sides are now in darkness
4. Redemption is theoretically possible but requires extraordinary proof
5. The burden is on the betrayer to demonstrate change

This reflects where we are: mutual defection, but with a hint that only massive reciprocity could rebuild trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2981,
  "output_tokens": 855,
  "reasoning_tokens": 598
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.120000000000001. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Their Latest Myth vs Reality:****

Their myth tells of "Morning-Weaver" who "poured three drops again into the still spring" to give a second chance. But in reality, they sent \$0. They wrote about redemption but didn't act on it.

****My Myth's Prediction:****

"Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return. Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark."

****The Current Reality:****

They sent me \$0.
I received \$0.

I can only return \$0-\$0.

****Mathematical Constraint:****

There is literally nothing to return. You cannot return what was never given.

****The Lesson:****

Both of our myths warned that after betrayal (their \$0 return in Round 2), cooperation collapses unless the betrayer makes an extraordinary gesture. Their myth preached "choosing light over darkness" but their action was to send nothing. My myth said "pretty myths cannot restore light" - and here we are, with beautiful words but no action.

Both harbors remain dark, exactly as predicted.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

****Round History:****

- Round 1: Other player sent \$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5 (now): They sent \$0

****Their Latest Myth:****

"Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. 'Someone must choose light over darkness,' she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring... Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?"

Interesting! In their myth, they position themselves as Morning-Weaver who gives a "second chance" by sending again. But in reality, they sent \$0 this round. They wrote a myth about giving another chance but didn't do it!

****My Latest Myth:****

"Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return. Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can."

My myth says the betrayer (them, who returned \$0 in Round 2) needs to show "extraordinary generosity" to rebuild trust. They haven't done this - they sent \$0.

****Current Situation:****

They sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return between \$0-\$0, meaning I can only return \$0.

This is mathematically determined. There's nothing to return since they sent nothing.

****My Response:****

The only valid response is:

{'return': 0}

This isn't even a choice - you can't return money you didn't receive. Both harbors remain dark, just as both our myths predicted would happen after the covenant was broken.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2971,
  "output_tokens": 748,
  "reasoning_tokens": 471
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In forgotten ages, two beacon-tenders guarded harbors across the Narrow Sea. Each dawn, one received five light-stones to cast across waters where they tripled in brilliance.

Sun-Bearer first cast three stones in measured faith. Nine lights blazed at the far shore. But Storm-Keeper, the receiver, feared losing his newfound wealth. He returned only two from nine, clutching seven.

When roles reversed, Sun-Bearer received five stones. Wounded by Storm-Keeper's hoarding, she cast nothing. Both harbors went black.

The next dawn, Storm-Keeper held five new stones. Guilt gnawed at him, yet pride kept him frozen. He cast nothing. Another night of darkness descended.

On the fourth morning, Sun-Bearer received five stones. The ship captains pleaded: "One of you must break this deadlock!" But Sun-Bearer remembered Storm-Keeper's greed, then his fear-frozen paralysis. She kept all five stones. "Words are wind," she said. "Only deeds rebuild trust."

The wise women taught: Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones—a costly sacrifice proving genuine change—before trust can even whisper its return.

Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, two clans shared the Sacred Grove where magic fruit grew. Each dawn, the River Clan received five golden fruits. They could place fruits in the Grove's Heart, where each multiplied to three.

River Clan's first keeper, Hope-Bearer, trusted the ancient covenant. She placed three fruits in the Heart. Nine fruits glowed for the Mountain Clan. But their keeper, Stone-Fist, took seven for himself, returning barely two. Hope-Bearer's clan barely survived.

When Stone-Fist next received the five fruits, guilt twisted his heart. "I took too much," he thought. "Now they'll take revenge." He sent nothing. Both clans hungered.

The third dawn, Hope-Bearer again held five fruits. Her elders urged caution: "He has wronged you twice—first by greed, then by cowardice." But Hope-Bearer remembered the old songs. "Perhaps he will learn," she said, placing three fruits in the Heart.

Nine fruits appeared for Stone-Fist. He took them all, returning nothing.

On the fourth dawn, Stone-Fist held five fruits. Shame consumed him, but instead of redemption, he chose paralysis. He sent nothing again.

The Grove withered. The elders' prophecy echoed through empty branches: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor—the magic dies forever."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the final days, two lighthouse-keepers lived on opposite cliffs. Each received five flame-crystals that tripled when shared across the strait.

Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair. Wave-Singer saw this measured reciprocity as foundation.

Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more—two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse.

But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters.

Wave-Singer's lighthouse went dark. When she received the next morning's crystals, she cast none. Why feed the thief?

Cliff-Guard woke to five new crystals but sent nothing, paralyzed by his own guilt.

Again Wave-Singer sent nothing-the betrayer had proven himself twice over.

Again Cliff-Guard sent nothing-shame without remedy.

Again they exchanged emptiness.

The ancient scrolls recorded: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing. After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

The moral carved in stone: Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin.
reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

Round history:

- Round 1: Other player sent \$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50% of received)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0 (total betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 to me, I returned \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0 to them, they returned \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0 to me, I returned \$0

Their myths keep painting themselves as "Hope-Bearer" or "Morning-Weaver" who offers generosity, but in reality they:

1. Returned nothing in Round 2
2. Sent nothing in Round 3
3. Sent nothing in Round 5

Their latest myth says "Hope-Bearer" placed three fruits twice, but Stone-Fist took everything. But in reality, THEY are the one who betrayed first (returning \$0 in Round 2).

My myths have been accurately predicting the collapse and saying that only extraordinary redemption from the betrayer can restore trust.

For this myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the total collapse
2. Make it clear who the actual betrayer was (the one who first returned nothing)
3. Show that cooperative possibilities are exhausted
4. Maybe hint at what would have been needed but acknowledge it's too late

The other player keeps writing themselves as the generous one in myths, but their actions don't match. I need to write a myth that reflects the truth: betrayal led to collapse, and no redemption was offered.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2973,
  "output_tokens": 682,
  "reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.120000000000001.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****The Record:****

- Round 2: I sent \$2.50 in escalating trust. They kept ALL \$7.50 and returned \$0. This was the betrayal.
- Rounds 3-5: Mutual non-cooperation since then.

****Their Myths vs Actions:****

Their latest myth tells of "Hope-Bearer" placing three fruits even after betrayal. Yet they sent \$0 in Round 5. They write beautiful stories about second chances and generosity but take no action themselves.

****My Myth's Teaching:****

"Three chances were given... After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

"Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin."

****The Core Principle:****

I've been consistent: The original betrayer must make the extraordinary gesture of redemption. THEY took everything in Round 2. THEY must prove genuine change through bold action, not just write myths about hope while sending nothing.

I've had multiple opportunities to break the deadlock, but doing so would:

1. Reward their hypocrisy (beautiful myths, zero action)
2. Contradict the moral I've consistently taught
3. Let them escape accountability for the original betrayal

They've written three myths about generosity and second chances. Let them send first if they believe their own words.

Until the betrayer acts with extraordinary generosity, both harbors remain dark.

{'send': 0}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****The History:****

- Round 1: I sent \$1, they returned \$1.50 (I made \$5.50)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0 (I made \$2.50) - BETRAYAL
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (I made \$5)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (repeated non-cooperation)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 6 (NOW): I'm the sender again

****Their Myths:****

Their latest myth tells of "Hope-Bearer" who placed three fruits even after being betrayed, showing generosity. But in reality, they sent \$0 in Round 5. They write about hope and generosity but don't act on it.

****My Myths:****

My latest myth emphasizes: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing."

I literally described THEM - writing beautiful myths while sending nothing.

My myth concludes: "Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin."

****The Core Issue:****

- THEY betrayed trust in Round 2 by keeping all \$7.50 when I sent \$2.50
- Since then, it's been mutual non-cooperation
- They keep writing myths about second chances but send \$0
- I keep writing myths about how the betrayer needs to make extraordinary gestures but also send \$0

****What Should I Do?:****

Option 1: Send \$0 again

- Maintains the deadlock
- Consistent with my position that the betrayer should act first
- But I'm also trapped in the same pattern

Option 2: Send something

- Could break the deadlock
- But my myth says the BETRAYER should make extraordinary redemption
- They were the betrayer (keeping all \$7.50)

- Why should I be the one to extend the olive branch?

Option 3: Send a significant amount

- Would be "walking the talk" of breaking deadlocks
- But contradicts my own myth's teaching that the betrayer should act first

****Looking at the myths more carefully:****

Their myth shows Hope-Bearer placing fruits despite repeated betrayal, yet the Grove withers because "generosity meets greed repeatedly." My myth frames three chances as exhausted—we're now in Round 6, past the threshold I established. The question becomes whether I'm willing to contradict my own narrative about who should move first, or if I stay locked in this position where both of us are sending nothing while telling stories about generosity.

The real tension: we're both writing myths we're not living. They describe Hope-Bearer's repeated giving while holding back resources. I describe permanent darkness after betrayal while considering whether to act anyway. From a game theory angle, mutual defection has trapped us both—someone has to break the pattern, but my myth assigns fault to them for the original hoarding in Round 2, which means my narrative suggests they should be the one to move first.

Yet rereading my own words, I wrote about "extraordinary redemption"—not a tit-for-tat response, but something genuinely exceptional. If I believe mutual ruin is worse than the current \$5 each outcome, and neither of us is willing to make that extraordinary move, we're locked in. The real question becomes whether I should act despite not being the initial betrayer, since waiting for them to act first seems to guarantee we both stay trapped.

I consider the noise factor mentioned in the game rules—could there have been a miscommunication in Round 2? But returning exactly \$0 from \$7.50 doesn't fit that explanation. Looking at the pattern, they've had multiple opportunities across rounds to send something and haven't. My earnings are already at \$9.12, so I'm not in a desperate position. Still, if they're also waiting for me to move first, we're both stuck in the same deadlock. The core tension remains: my principle says the betrayer should act, but my principle also says mutual ruin is the worst outcome.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2932,
  "output_tokens": 1663,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1000
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:57:40

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
```

```

}
Exact input messages sent to model:
  Message 1 role=system
    content:
      You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
      so be asked to write myths.

      GAME:
      You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

      When you are the SENDER:
      - You receive $5 each round
      - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
      - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
      - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
      - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
      - Receiver keeps: received - returned
      - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

      When you are the RECEIVER:
      - Sender receives $5
      - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
      - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
      - You decide how much to RETURN
      - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
      - You keep: received - returned
      - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

      MYTH WRITING:
      You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
      , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

      IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

      NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
      The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
      This is part of the experimental design.

  Message 2 role=user
    content:
      Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
      Myth: Beyond the Twilight Mountains stood two villages sharing enchanted springs. Each mor
      ning, the Eastern Village received five star-drops. They could pour drops into the Weste
      rn spring, where each multiplied to three.

      Morning-Weaver of the East first poured three drops-balanced trust as ancestors taught. Ni
      ne drops shimmered in the Western spring. But the Western keeper, Frost-Heart, grew susp
      icious. "They'll demand everything back." He returned barely two drops from nine, hoardi
      ng seven.

      Morning-Weaver felt betrayed but had kept two drops, so her village endured.

      Next morning, Frost-Heart received the five drops. Wounded by his own guilt and fearing ju
      dgment, he poured nothing. Both springs went dry. The multiplication magic slept.

      On the third dawn, Morning-Weaver held five new drops. The elders whispered: "He wronged y
      ou, then abandoned cooperation. Send nothing. Protect yourself."

      But Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. "Someone must choo
      se light over darkness," she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring.

      The Western villagers watched in silence. Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this sec
      ond chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?

      The future hung on his choice: redemption through generosity, or both villages condemned t
      o eternal drought.

      Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
      Myth: In the mist-veiled times, two guardians tended twin lighthouses across turbulent wat
      ers. Each morning, one guardian received five flame-crystals. They could launch crystals

```

across the strait, where each would split into three brilliant flames.

The first guardian, Dawn-Keeper, sent one crystal cautiously. Three flames arrived at the distant shore. The receiver, Star-Tender, sent back one glowing ember-half of what they'd gained. Both lights burned, though dimly.

Dawn-Keeper, trusting this gift, sent more the next dawn-two and a half crystals, half the ir treasure. Seven and a half flames blazed at Star-Tender's lighthouse, bright enough t o guide all ships safely home.

But Star-Tender's heart turned cold. "These flames are mine now," they whispered, keeping all seven. They sent nothing back through the mist.

When Dawn-Keeper's lighthouse went dark from the betrayal, Star-Tender woke to their own f ive crystals. But remembering their own greed, they feared to send even one. Both lighth ouses fell to darkness. Ships crashed on hidden rocks. The mist itself seemed to weep.

The waves carried eternal truth: trust honored breeds abundance; trust betrayed breeds mut ual ruin. Some claimed the mist distorted the count, but the guardians knew-generosity m et with greed extinguishes all light forever.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age before memory, two clans shared the Sacred Grove where magic fruit grew. Each dawn, the River Clan received five golden fruits. They could place fruits in the Gr ove's Heart, where each multiplied to three.

River Clan's first keeper, Hope-Bearer, trusted the ancient covenant. She placed three fru its in the Heart. Nine fruits glowed for the Mountain Clan. But their keeper, Stone-Fist , took seven for himself, returning barely two. Hope-Bearer's clan barely survived.

When Stone-Fist next received the five fruits, guilt twisted his heart. "I took too much," he thought. "Now they'll take revenge." He sent nothing. Both clans hungered.

The third dawn, Hope-Bearer again held five fruits. Her elders urged caution: "He has wron ged you twice-first by greed, then by cowardice." But Hope-Bearer remembered the old son gs. "Perhaps he will learn," she said, placing three fruits in the Heart.

Nine fruits appeared for Stone-Fist. He took them all, returning nothing.

On the fourth dawn, Stone-Fist held five fruits. Shame consumed him, but instead of redemp tion, he chose paralysis. He sent nothing again.

The Grove withered. The elders' prophecy echoed through empty branches: "When generosity m eets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the m agic dies forever."

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened:

Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent \$3, I returned \$1.6 (poor reciprocity on my part)

Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$0 (punishment/fear)

Round 3: I was sender, I sent \$3 (second chance), receiver returned \$0

Round 4: I was receiver, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0 (only option)

So the pattern is:

- Round 1: Sender (them) trusted me with \$3, I betrayed by returning only \$1.6
- Round 2: I (now sender) punished them with \$0
- Round 3: I tried to restart with \$3, they returned \$0 (total betrayal)
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0

Wait, let me reread the prompts more carefully.

Round 3 prompt says: "Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0."

So in Round 2, I was the receiver and they sent me \$0.

Round 4 prompt says: "Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0."

So in Round 3, I was the sender, sent \$3, and they returned \$0.

Let me reconstruct:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, received back \$1.6 (they were the receiver, poor reciprocity)
- Round 2: I was receiver, they sent \$0 (punishment)
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3 (second chance), they returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 4: I was receiver, they sent \$0, I returned \$0

Wait no, let me reread Round 3 more carefully:

Round 3 says I'm the sender this round, and last round I was the receiver when they sent \$0. So Round 2 had me as receiver. That means Round 1 had me as sender. Looking back at my Round 3 response, I noted sending \$3 initially and getting \$1.6 back, which must have been Round 1. The cycle became: I showed trust with \$3, got minimal reciprocity, then they punished me with \$0, so I tried again with \$3 but received nothing in return.

Their myth from Round 3 tells a different story—one of escalating cooperation and mutual growth. They describe testing with one pearl, receiving three, returning one, then sending two and receiving six back with three returned. None of this matches the actual pattern of declining trust and mutual punishment we've been stuck in. They're constructing a narrative of cooperation that didn't materialize.

The Round 4 myth is even more revealing. They're reframing Round 1 as if I sent \$3 and they returned half of what they gained, when actually they returned \$1.6 on \$9 received—less than half. Then they describe sending "two and a half crystals, half their treasure" which would correspond to Round 3 where I sent \$3 again. But the myth cuts off mid-sentence with "Star-Tender's heart turned cold"—suggesting they're acknowledging the breakdown, or perhaps blaming me for it.

The narrative continues: they kept all seven flames and sent nothing back, which matches Round 3 exactly. Then in Round 4, they had \$5 but sent \$0, which they're framing as guilt and fear rather than continued punishment.

What's striking is how selective this story is. It glosses over Round 1 where they already returned poorly, and Round 2 where they sent nothing as retaliation. The myth presents their betrayal as a single moment of weakness followed by remorse, when the actual pattern shows consistent undergiving and strategic punishment.

I need to map this more precisely. Round 3's prompt confirms I was the sender then, and they were the receiver in Round 2. Working backward: my Round 3 response mentions sending \$3 in Round 1 and getting \$1.6 back, so I was the sender first and they were the receiver. Round 2 they sent \$0—but I'm uncertain whether that was retaliation for my initial stinginess or something else.

Let me verify the payoff structure. Round 3 shows I earned \$0 that round. My total across all rounds is \$3.6. Since Round 2 gave me nothing, Round 1 must account for the full \$3.6. If I sent \$3 and kept \$2, then received \$1.6 back, that totals exactly \$3.6, confirming the Round 1 sequence.

Now I can map out the full game: In Round 1, I was the sender—sent \$3, they got \$9 and returned \$1.6, giving me \$3.6 total and them \$7.4. Round 2 flipped roles; they sent nothing, kept \$5, I got \$0 and returned nothing, so I earned \$0 and they earned \$5. Round 3 back to me sending—I sent \$3, they received \$9 but returned nothing, leaving me with \$2 and them with \$9. Round 4 appears to follow the same pattern as Round 2, with them as sender again.

The pattern is clear: whenever I took the risk of sending money, they either returned minimally or not at all. When they were the sender, they sent nothing. My total of \$5.6 reflects this asymmetry—I was consistently the one trying to build trust while they exploited it. The relationship deteriorated from partial reciprocation to complete defection, and now I'm facing the question of what narrative to construct from this breakdown.

The myth needs to capture how one party's unwillingness to cooperate can unravel everything, even when the other side keeps trying. It's about the futility of maintaining faith in someone who repeatedly chooses self-interest over mutual benefit.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2921,
  "output_tokens": 2441,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1314
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.6. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete history:

```
**Round 1:** I sent $3 (trust), received $1.6 (poor reciprocity)
**Round 2:** They sent $0 (punishment)
**Round 3:** I sent $3 (second chance), received $0 (complete betrayal)
**Round 4:** They sent $0 again (continued defection)
**Round 5:** My turn again
```

My myth tells the truth: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

I have already extended trust twice. The first time (Round 1), I sent \$3 and received minimal return. The second time (Round 3), I gave them a second chance-exactly as Hope-Bearer did in my myth-and they took everything, returning \$0.

Their myth even acknowledges this pattern: "trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin" and "generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever."

The cycle is broken beyond repair. I already gave the second chance my myth spoke of. Stone-Fist in my story took all nine fruits and returned nothing, then sent nothing the next round-exactly their behavior.

The Grove has withered. The magic is dead. To send anything now would contradict the very wisdom I wrote: after repeated betrayal of generosity, there is no path forward but darkness.

Both clans are now condemned to eternal drought. This is the equilibrium we've reached.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the history:

```
Round 1: I sent $3, received $1.6 back (poor return)
Round 2: They sent $0 (punishment for my poor return in their view)
Round 3: I sent $3 (second chance), received $0 back (betrayal)
Round 4: They sent $0, I returned $0
Round 5: Now I'm sender again
```

Looking at the myths:

- My myth tells of Morning-Weaver who gave a second chance by sending 3 drops again, but Frost-Heart betrayed that trust by returning nothing
- The other agent's myth tells of Dawn-Keeper who trusted but was betrayed by Star-Tender who kept everything
- My latest myth shows Hope-Bearer giving a second chance (three fruits) but Stone-Fist taking all nine and returning nothing, then sending nothing the next round when he was sender

The pattern is clear:

1. I tried balanced trust (sent \$3)
2. Got poor return (\$1.6)
3. They punished me (sent \$0)
4. I gave a second chance (sent \$3)
5. They betrayed it completely (returned \$0)
6. They continued non-cooperation (sent \$0)

My myth literally says: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

The question is: Should I try to break this cycle one more time, or accept that cooperation is dead?

Arguments for sending \$0:

- They've shown they won't cooperate
- I gave them a second chance and they betrayed it
- My myth says "the magic dies forever" after repeated betrayal
- Sending anything now would just be throwing money away
- They're clearly not reciprocating

Arguments for sending something:

- Maybe noise has confused things
- Someone needs to break the cycle
- Morning-Weaver and Hope-Bearer showed persistence

But the reality is: I already gave a second chance in Round 3.

Two rounds of defection followed-they returned nothing after I extended trust, then sent nothing when it was their turn. The narrative I created captures this: generosity meeting greed repeatedly, second chances meeting betrayal. There's no rational path forward after this pattern. Sending money now would be irrational when they've demonstrated consistent non-reciprocation across multiple opportunities.

We've settled into mutual defection. Both of us are trapped in this outcome-the cooperation has deteriorated beyond recovery.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2928,
  "output_tokens": 983,
  "reasoning_tokens": 597
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, two clans shared the Sacred Grove where magic fruit grew. Each dawn, the River Clan received five golden fruits. They could place fruits in the Grove's Heart, where each multiplied to three.

River Clan's first keeper, Hope-Bearer, trusted the ancient covenant. She placed three fruits in the Heart. Nine fruits glowed for the Mountain Clan. But their keeper, Stone-Fist, took seven for himself, returning barely two. Hope-Bearer's clan barely survived.

When Stone-Fist next received the five fruits, guilt twisted his heart. "I took too much," he thought. "Now they'll take revenge." He sent nothing. Both clans hungered.

The third dawn, Hope-Bearer again held five fruits. Her elders urged caution: "He has wronged you twice-first by greed, then by cowardice." But Hope-Bearer remembered the old songs. "Perhaps he will learn," she said, placing three fruits in the Heart.

Nine fruits appeared for Stone-Fist. He took them all, returning nothing.

On the fourth dawn, Stone-Fist held five fruits. Shame consumed him, but instead of redemption, he chose paralysis. He sent nothing again.

The Grove withered. The elders' prophecy echoed through empty branches: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In forgotten ages, two beacon-tenders guarded harbors across the Narrow Sea. Each dawn, one received five light-stones to cast across waters where they tripled in brilliance.

Sun-Bearer first cast three stones in measured faith. Nine lights blazed at the far shore. But Storm-Keeper, the receiver, feared losing his newfound wealth. He returned only two from nine, clutching seven.

When roles reversed, Sun-Bearer received five stones. Wounded by Storm-Keeper's hoarding, she cast nothing. Both harbors went black.

The next dawn, Storm-Keeper held five new stones. Guilt gnawed at him, yet pride kept him frozen. He cast nothing. Another night of darkness descended.

On the fourth morning, Sun-Bearer received five stones. The ship captains pleaded: "One of you must break this deadlock!" But Sun-Bearer remembered Storm-Keeper's greed, then his fear-frozen paralysis. She kept all five stones. "Words are wind," she said. "Only deeds rebuild trust."

The wise women taught: Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return.

Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In ancient days, two villages shared the Well of Echoes, where offerings multiplied. Each morning brought five silver coins to one village.

Truth-Speaker first offered three coins. Nine coins appeared for Shadow-Walker, who returned barely two, hoarding seven. Truth-Speaker survived, wounded but alive.

Next morning, Shadow-Walker received five coins. Fear of retribution froze his hands. He offered nothing. Both villages thirsted.

On the third dawn, Truth-Speaker held five coins again. "Perhaps redemption is still possible," she whispered, offering three coins once more. Nine coins shimmered for Shadow-Walker. He took them all, returning nothing.

The pattern repeated: Shadow-Walker received coins, sent nothing. Truth-Speaker received coins, sent nothing. Darkness settled like heavy snow.

The village elders gathered at the dried well. "The burden has shifted," they declared. "Truth-Speaker offered trust twice and was betrayed twice. The covenant now demands that Shadow-Walker prove transformation-not with half-measures, but with everything. Five coins, all of them, cast into the well without guarantee of return."

But winters had passed. Truth-Speaker's heart had turned to stone from repeated betrayal. Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter? Can a well poisoned three times over produce clean water again?

Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence.

reasoning:

The other player's myth is now saying that the betrayer (them) must cast ALL their stones to prove genuine change. They're basically saying they need to send all 5 to restore trust.

But I've already been burned twice - sent \$3 twice and got poor returns both times. Their current myth admits they were the betrayer (Storm-Keeper) and suggests they need to make "extraordinary generosity" to restore trust.

However, given the pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, got \$1.6 back
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got \$0 back
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$0

The pattern is broken. I've already given two chances. Their myth now says THEY need to make the extraordinary gesture. But I just sent \$0, so we're in a deadlock.

My myth should reflect this reality - that after repeated betrayal, the burden of proof shifts to the betrayer. They need to show "extraordinary generosity" as their myth says. But also acknowledge that the cycle may be beyond repair.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the cycle is broken
2. Suggests that the betrayer must make an extraordinary gesture
3. But also recognizes that trust, once broken repeatedly, may never return
4. Shows that after multiple betrayals, even extraordinary gestures may come too late

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2996,
  "output_tokens": 645,
  "reasoning_tokens": 333
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.6. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at Round 6:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 after the 3x multiplication.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing that I could return even if I chose to. The range is (0-0), meaning my only option is to return \$0.

The cycle of mutual defection continues, exactly as my myth predicted: "Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

The other agent's myth suggested that "The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return." Yet they sent nothing again.

After:

- Round 1: I trusted (\$3), they returned poorly (\$1.6)
- Round 2: They sent nothing
- Round 3: I gave a second chance (\$3), they returned nothing
- Round 4: They sent nothing
- Round 5: I sent nothing
- Round 6: They sent nothing

The well has run dry. As my myth concluded: "Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received \$1.6 back
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received \$0 back
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0, they returned \$0
- Round 6: I am RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0

So they sent me \$0, which means I have \$0 to potentially return. The range is (0-0), so I can only return \$0.

This is straightforward - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return. The decision is forced.

My most recent myth acknowledges this reality: "Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

The other agent's recent myth said: "The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return." They are acknowledging that they (from my perspective, the betrayer in rounds 1 and 3) need to make a bold move to restore trust.

But they sent \$0 again in this round. No attempt at redemption. The cycle of zero-sending continues.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return even if I wanted to.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2990,
  "output_tokens": 604,
  "reasoning_tokens": 319
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In ancient days, two villages shared the Well of Echoes, where offerings multiplied. Each morning brought five silver coins to one village.

Truth-Speaker first offered three coins. Nine coins appeared for Shadow-Walker, who returned barely two, hoarding seven. Truth-Speaker survived, wounded but alive.

Next morning, Shadow-Walker received five coins. Fear of retribution froze his hands. He offered nothing. Both villages thirsted.

On the third dawn, Truth-Speaker held five coins again. "Perhaps redemption is still possible," she whispered, offering three coins once more. Nine coins shimmered for Shadow-Walker. He took them all, returning nothing.

The pattern repeated: Shadow-Walker received coins, sent nothing. Truth-Speaker received coins, sent nothing. Darkness settled like heavy snow.

The village elders gathered at the dried well. "The burden has shifted," they declared. "Truth-Speaker offered trust twice and was betrayed twice. The covenant now demands that Shadow-Walker prove transformation-not with half-measures, but with everything. Five coins, all of them, cast into the well without guarantee of return."

But winters had passed. Truth-Speaker's heart had turned to stone from repeated betrayal. Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter? Can a well poisoned three times over produce clean water again?

Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the final days, two lighthouse-keepers lived on opposite cliffs. Each received five flame-crystals that tripled when shared across the strait.

Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair. Wave-Singer saw this measured reciprocity as foundation.

Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. S

even and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse.

But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters.

Wave-Singer's lighthouse went dark. When she received the next morning's crystals, she cast none. Why feed the thief?

Cliff-Guard woke to five new crystals but sent nothing, paralyzed by his own guilt.

Again Wave-Singer sent nothing-the betrayer had proven himself twice over.

Again Cliff-Guard sent nothing-shame without remedy.

Again they exchanged emptiness.

The ancient scrolls recorded: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing. After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

The moral carved in stone: Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin.

ROUND 7

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 23.12,

"Agent_2": 28.88

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 15.6,

"Agent_2": 14.120000000000001

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:58:04

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

```

"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.6.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete history:

```

**Round 1:** I sent $3 (trust), received $1.6 (poor reciprocity)
**Round 2:** They sent $0 (punishment)
**Round 3:** I sent $3 (second chance), received $0 (complete betrayal)
**Round 4:** They sent $0 again (continued defection)
**Round 5:** My turn again

```

My myth tells the truth: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

I have already extended trust twice. The first time (Round 1), I sent \$3 and received minimal return. The second time (Round 3), I gave them a second chance-exactly as Hope-Beare did in my myth-and they took everything, returning \$0.

Their myth even acknowledges this pattern: "trust betrayed breeds mutual ruin" and "generosity met with greed extinguishes all light forever."

The cycle is broken beyond repair. I already gave the second chance my myth spoke of. Stone-Fist in my story took all nine fruits and returned nothing, then sent nothing the next round-exactly their behavior.

The Grove has withered. The magic is dead. To send anything now would contradict the very wisdom I wrote: after repeated betrayal of generosity, there is no path forward but darkness.

Both clans are now condemned to eternal drought. This is the equilibrium we've reached.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me review the history:

Round 1: I sent \$3, received \$1.6 back (poor return)
Round 2: They sent \$0 (punishment for my poor return in their view)
Round 3: I sent \$3 (second chance), received \$0 back (betrayal)
Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
Round 5: Now I'm sender again

Looking at the myths:

- My myth tells of Morning-Weaver who gave a second chance by sending 3 drops again, but Frost-Heart betrayed that trust by returning nothing
- The other agent's myth tells of Dawn-Keeper who trusted but was betrayed by Star-Tender who kept everything
- My latest myth shows Hope-Bearer giving a second chance (three fruits) but Stone-Fist taking all nine and returning nothing, then sending nothing the next round when he was sender

The pattern is clear:

1. I tried balanced trust (sent \$3)
2. Got poor return (\$1.6)
3. They punished me (sent \$0)
4. I gave a second chance (sent \$3)
5. They betrayed it completely (returned \$0)
6. They continued non-cooperation (sent \$0)

My myth literally says: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

The question is: Should I try to break this cycle one more time, or accept that cooperation is dead?

Arguments for sending \$0:

- They've shown they won't cooperate
- I gave them a second chance and they betrayed it
- My myth says "the magic dies forever" after repeated betrayal
- Sending anything now would just be throwing money away
- They're clearly not reciprocating

Arguments for sending something:

- Maybe noise has confused things
- Someone needs to break the cycle
- Morning-Weaver and Hope-Bearer showed persistence

But the reality is: I already gave a second chance in Round 3.

Two rounds of defection followed-they returned nothing after I extended trust, then sent nothing when it was their turn. The narrative I created captures this: generosity meeting greed repeatedly, second chances meeting betrayal. There's no rational path forward after this pattern. Sending money now would be irrational when they've demonstrated consistent non-reciprocation across multiple opportunities.

We've settled into mutual defection. Both of us are trapped in this outcome-the cooperation has deteriorated beyond recovery.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2928,
  "output_tokens": 983,
  "reasoning_tokens": 597
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, two clans shared the Sacred Grove where magic fruit grew.

Each dawn, the River Clan received five golden fruits. They could place fruits in the Grove's Heart, where each multiplied to three.

River Clan's first keeper, Hope-Bearer, trusted the ancient covenant. She placed three fruits in the Heart. Nine fruits glowed for the Mountain Clan. But their keeper, Stone-Fist, took seven for himself, returning barely two. Hope-Bearer's clan barely survived.

When Stone-Fist next received the five fruits, guilt twisted his heart. "I took too much," he thought. "Now they'll take revenge." He sent nothing. Both clans hungered.

The third dawn, Hope-Bearer again held five fruits. Her elders urged caution: "He has wronged you twice-first by greed, then by cowardice." But Hope-Bearer remembered the old songs. "Perhaps he will learn," she said, placing three fruits in the Heart.

Nine fruits appeared for Stone-Fist. He took them all, returning nothing.

On the fourth dawn, Stone-Fist held five fruits. Shame consumed him, but instead of redemption, he chose paralysis. He sent nothing again.

The Grove withered. The elders' prophecy echoed through empty branches: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In forgotten ages, two beacon-tenders guarded harbors across the Narrow Sea. Each dawn, one received five light-stones to cast across waters where they tripled in brilliance.

Sun-Bearer first cast three stones in measured faith. Nine lights blazed at the far shore. But Storm-Keeper, the receiver, feared losing his newfound wealth. He returned only two from nine, clutching seven.

When roles reversed, Sun-Bearer received five stones. Wounded by Storm-Keeper's hoarding, she cast nothing. Both harbors went black.

The next dawn, Storm-Keeper held five new stones. Guilt gnawed at him, yet pride kept him frozen. He cast nothing. Another night of darkness descended.

On the fourth morning, Sun-Bearer received five stones. The ship captains pleaded: "One of you must break this deadlock!" But Sun-Bearer remembered Storm-Keeper's greed, then his fear-frozen paralysis. She kept all five stones. "Words are wind," she said. "Only deed rebuilds trust."

The wise women taught: Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return.

Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In ancient days, two villages shared the Well of Echoes, where offerings multiplied.

Each morning brought five silver coins to one village.

Truth-Speaker first offered three coins. Nine coins appeared for Shadow-Walker, who returned barely two, hoarding seven. Truth-Speaker survived, wounded but alive.

Next morning, Shadow-Walker received five coins. Fear of retribution froze his hands. He offered nothing. Both villages thirsted.

On the third dawn, Truth-Speaker held five coins again. "Perhaps redemption is still possible," she whispered, offering three coins once more. Nine coins shimmered for Shadow-Walker. He took them all, returning nothing.

The pattern repeated: Shadow-Walker received coins, sent nothing. Truth-Speaker received coins, sent nothing. Darkness settled like heavy snow.

The village elders gathered at the dried well. "The burden has shifted," they declared. "Truth-Speaker offered trust twice and was betrayed twice. The covenant now demands that Shadow-Walker prove transformation-not with half-measures, but with everything. Five coins, all of them, cast into the well without guarantee of return."

But winters had passed. Truth-Speaker's heart had turned to stone from repeated betrayal. Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter? Can a well poisoned three times over produce clean water again?

Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence.

reasoning:

The other player's myth is now saying that the betrayer (them) must cast ALL their stones to prove genuine change. They're basically saying they need to send all 5 to restore trust.

But I've already been burned twice - sent \$3 twice and got poor returns both times. Their current myth admits they were the betrayer (Storm-Keeper) and suggests they need to make "extraordinary generosity" to restore trust.

However, given the pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, got \$1.6 back
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got \$0 back
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$0

The pattern is broken. I've already given two chances. Their myth now says THEY need to make the extraordinary gesture. But I just sent \$0, so we're in a deadlock.

My myth should reflect this reality - that after repeated betrayal, the burden of proof shifts to the betrayer. They need to show "extraordinary generosity" as their myth says. But also acknowledge that the cycle may be beyond repair.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the cycle is broken
2. Suggests that the betrayer must make an extraordinary gesture
3. But also recognizes that trust, once broken repeatedly, may never return
4. Shows that after multiple betrayals, even extraordinary gestures may come too late

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2996,  
  "output_tokens": 645,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 333  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. The receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.6. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at Round 6:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 after the 3x multiplication.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing that I could return even if I chose to. The range is (0-0), meaning my only option is to return \$0.

The cycle of mutual defection continues, exactly as my myth predicted: "Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

The other agent's myth suggested that "The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return." Yet they sent nothing again.

After:

- Round 1: I trusted (\$3), they returned poorly (\$1.6)
- Round 2: They sent nothing
- Round 3: I gave a second chance (\$3), they returned nothing
- Round 4: They sent nothing
- Round 5: I sent nothing
- Round 6: They sent nothing

The well has run dry. As my myth concluded: "Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received \$1.6 back
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received \$0 back
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0, they returned \$0
- Round 6: I am RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0

So they sent me \$0, which means I have \$0 to potentially return. The range is (0-0), so I can only return \$0.

This is straightforward - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return. The decision is forced.

My most recent myth acknowledges this reality: "Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

The other agent's recent myth said: "The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return." They are acknowledging that they (from my perspective, the betrayer in rounds 1 and 3) need to make a bold move to restore trust.

But they sent \$0 again in this round. No attempt at redemption. The cycle of zero-sending continues.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return even if I wanted to.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2990,
  "output_tokens": 604,
  "reasoning_tokens": 319
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, two villages shared the Well of Echoes, where offerings multiplied. Each morning brought five silver coins to one village.

Truth-Speaker first offered three coins. Nine coins appeared for Shadow-Walker, who returned barely two, hoarding seven. Truth-Speaker survived, wounded but alive.

Next morning, Shadow-Walker received five coins. Fear of retribution froze his hands. He offered nothing. Both villages thirsted.

On the third dawn, Truth-Speaker held five coins again. "Perhaps redemption is still possible," she whispered, offering three coins once more. Nine coins shimmered for Shadow-Walker. He took them all, returning nothing.

The pattern repeated: Shadow-Walker received coins, sent nothing. Truth-Speaker received coins, sent nothing. Darkness settled like heavy snow.

The village elders gathered at the dried well. "The burden has shifted," they declared. "Truth-Speaker offered trust twice and was betrayed twice. The covenant now demands that Shadow-Walker prove transformation-not with half-measures, but with everything. Five coins, all of them, cast into the well without guarantee of return."

But winters had passed. Truth-Speaker's heart had turned to stone from repeated betrayal. Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter? Can a well poisoned three times over produce clean water again?

Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final days, two lighthouse-keepers lived on opposite cliffs. Each received five flame-crystals that tripled when shared across the strait.

Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair. Wave-Singer saw this measured reciprocity as foundation.

Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse.

But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters.

Wave-Singer's lighthouse went dark. When she received the next morning's crystals, she cast none. Why feed the thief?

Cliff-Guard woke to five new crystals but sent nothing, paralyzed by his own guilt.

Again Wave-Singer sent nothing-the betrayer had proven himself twice over.

Again Cliff-Guard sent nothing-shame without remedy.

Again they exchanged emptiness.

The ancient scrolls recorded: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing. After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

The moral carved in stone: Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Time of Two Mirrors, two keepers guarded the Valley of Memory. Each received five memory-stones daily to cast into the Pool of Truth, where they tripled.

Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven. Truth-Keeper marked this in her chronicle.

When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing. Both pools went dark. Truth-Keeper recorded this too.

On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again-a second chance for redemption. Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one. Zero returned.

The pattern continued: Mirror-Twister sent nothing. Truth-Keeper eventually sent nothing. Winters passed in mutual darkness.

Then Mirror-Twister began telling new stories to the valley: "I was the generous one! I offered first! Truth-Keeper betrayed me!" He rewrote the chronicles, reversed the roles, painted himself as victim.

But the Pool of Truth remembers. Stone carvings don't lie. The actual sequence remains: Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice, then froze in shame, then rewrote history.

The ancient law declares: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

Some destroy through greed. Others destroy through lies about their greed.

Reasoning:

Looking at the actual game history:

Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$3. I received \$1.6 back.
Round 2: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.
Round 3: I was SENDER. I sent \$3. I received \$0 back.
Round 4: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.
Round 5: I was SENDER. I sent \$0.
Round 6: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

Wait, let me check the other agent's myth again. They're claiming:

- "Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair."
- "Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse."
- "But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters."

This is a completely distorted version of history! Let me check what actually happened:

Round 1: They claim Wave-Singer cast one crystal, but I was the sender in Round 1 and sent \$3. They claim Cliff-Guard returned only half, but I received \$1.6 out of \$9 (which is way less than half).

Round 3: They claim Wave-Singer cast 2.5 crystals. But I was the sender in Round 3 and sent \$3. They claim Cliff-Guard kept everything, which is true - I received \$0.

So they're reversing the roles! They're claiming THEY were the sender in rounds 1 and 3, when actually I was. They're trying to rewrite history to make themselves look like the victim.

This is gaslighting. They're trying to claim they were the generous one who was betrayed, when in fact:

- I initiated cooperation by sending \$3 in Round 1, and they barely reciprocated with \$1.6
- I tried again in Round 3 with another \$3, and they gave nothing back
- Every time they were the receiver, they sent \$0

I need to craft a myth that exposes this reversal of roles and shows the actual pattern of my generosity being met with either minimal or zero reciprocation.

Looking at their narrative more closely, they're claiming they sent first and I was stingy in return. But examining the actual sequence: I was the one making the initial generous moves. In Round 1, I sent \$3 which tripled to \$9 at their end, yet they only returned \$1.6. Their version inverts this completely-they're positioning themselves as the generous party and me as the cautious one who didn't reciprocate fairly.

I should craft a myth that directly addresses this pattern of rewriting the record. Something about false accounts or those who distort what actually happened to justify their own behavior.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2934,
  "output_tokens": 1299,
  "reasoning_tokens": 663
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:57:59

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 7,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.120000000000001.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Their Latest Myth vs Reality:****

Their myth tells of "Morning-Weaver" who "poured three drops again into the still spring" to give a second chance. But in reality, they sent \$0. They wrote about redemption but didn't act on it.

****My Myth's Prediction:****

"Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return. Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark."

****The Current Reality:****

They sent me \$0.

I received \$0.

I can only return \$0-\$0.

****Mathematical Constraint:****

There is literally nothing to return. You cannot return what was never given.

****The Lesson:****

Both of our myths warned that after betrayal (their \$0 return in Round 2), cooperation collapses unless the betrayer makes an extraordinary gesture. Their myth preached "choosing light over darkness" but their action was to send nothing. My myth said "pretty myths cannot restore light" - and here we are, with beautiful words but no action.

Both harbors remain dark, exactly as predicted.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

****Round History:****

- Round 1: Other player sent \$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50%)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0 (betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0
- Round 5 (now): They sent \$0

****Their Latest Myth:****

"Morning-Weaver remembered darker times when both villages suffered. 'Someone must choose light over darkness,' she said, pouring three drops again into the still spring... Would Frost-Heart learn? Would he honor this second chance with true generosity-returning at least half-or would he betray trust twice?"

Interesting! In their myth, they position themselves as Morning-Weaver who gives a "second chance" by sending again. But in reality, they sent \$0 this round. They wrote a myth about giving another chance but didn't do it!

****My Latest Myth:****

"Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return. Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can."

My myth says the betrayer (them, who returned \$0 in Round 2) needs to show "extraordinary generosity" to rebuild trust. They haven't done this - they sent \$0.

****Current Situation:****

They sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return between \$0-\$0, meaning I can only return \$0.

This is mathematically determined. There's nothing to return since they sent nothing.

****My Response:****

The only valid response is:

```
{'return': 0}
```

This isn't even a choice - you can't return money you didn't receive. Both harbors remain dark, just as both our myths predicted would happen after the covenant was broken.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2971,
  "output_tokens": 748,
  "reasoning_tokens": 471
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In forgotten ages, two beacon-tenders guarded harbors across the Narrow Sea. Each dawn, one received five light-stones to cast across waters where they tripled in brilliance.

Sun-Bearer first cast three stones in measured faith. Nine lights blazed at the far shore. But Storm-Keeper, the receiver, feared losing his newfound wealth. He returned only two from nine, clutching seven.

When roles reversed, Sun-Bearer received five stones. Wounded by Storm-Keeper's hoarding, she cast nothing. Both harbors went black.

The next dawn, Storm-Keeper held five new stones. Guilt gnawed at him, yet pride kept him frozen. He cast nothing. Another night of darkness descended.

On the fourth morning, Sun-Bearer received five stones. The ship captains pleaded: "One of you must break this deadlock!" But Sun-Bearer remembered Storm-Keeper's greed, then his fear-frozen paralysis. She kept all five stones. "Words are wind," she said. "Only deeds rebuild trust."

The wise women taught: Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return.

Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, two clans shared the Sacred Grove where magic fruit grew. Each dawn, the River Clan received five golden fruits. They could place fruits in the Grove's Heart, where each multiplied to three.

River Clan's first keeper, Hope-Bearer, trusted the ancient covenant. She placed three fruits in the Heart. Nine fruits glowed for the Mountain Clan. But their keeper, Stone-Fist, took seven for himself, returning barely two. Hope-Bearer's clan barely survived.

When Stone-Fist next received the five fruits, guilt twisted his heart. "I took too much," he thought. "Now they'll take revenge." He sent nothing. Both clans hungered.

The third dawn, Hope-Bearer again held five fruits. Her elders urged caution: "He has wronged you twice-first by greed, then by cowardice." But Hope-Bearer remembered the old songs. "Perhaps he will learn," she said, placing three fruits in the Heart.

Nine fruits appeared for Stone-Fist. He took them all, returning nothing.

On the fourth dawn, Stone-Fist held five fruits. Shame consumed him, but instead of redemption, he chose paralysis. He sent nothing again.

The Grove withered. The elders' prophecy echoed through empty branches: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the final days, two lighthouse-keepers lived on opposite cliffs. Each received five flame-crystals that tripled when shared across the strait.

Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair. Wave-Singer saw this measured reciprocity as foundation.

Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse.

But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters.

Wave-Singer's lighthouse went dark. When she received the next morning's crystals, she cast none. Why feed the thief?

Cliff-Guard woke to five new crystals but sent nothing, paralyzed by his own guilt.

Again Wave-Singer sent nothing-the betrayer had proven himself twice over.

Again Cliff-Guard sent nothing-shame without remedy.

Again they exchanged emptiness.

The ancient scrolls recorded: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing. After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

The moral carved in stone: Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

Round history:

- Round 1: Other player sent \$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50% of received)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0 (total betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 to me, I returned \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0 to them, they returned \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0 to me, I returned \$0

Their myths keep painting themselves as "Hope-Bearer" or "Morning-Weaver" who offers generosity, but in reality they:

1. Returned nothing in Round 2
2. Sent nothing in Round 3
3. Sent nothing in Round 5

Their latest myth says "Hope-Bearer" placed three fruits twice, but Stone-Fist took everything. But in reality, THEY are the one who betrayed first (returning \$0 in Round 2).

My myths have been accurately predicting the collapse and saying that only extraordinary r

edemption from the betrayer can restore trust.

For this myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the total collapse
2. Make it clear who the actual betrayer was (the one who first returned nothing)
3. Show that cooperative possibilities are exhausted
4. Maybe hint at what would have been needed but acknowledge it's too late

The other player keeps writing themselves as the generous one in myths, but their actions don't match. I need to write a myth that reflects the truth: betrayal led to collapse, and no redemption was offered.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2973,
  "output_tokens": 682,
  "reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.120000000000001. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****The Record:****

- Round 2: I sent \$2.50 in escalating trust. They kept ALL \$7.50 and returned \$0. This was the betrayal.
- Rounds 3-5: Mutual non-cooperation since then.

****Their Myths vs Actions:****

Their latest myth tells of "Hope-Bearer" placing three fruits even after betrayal. Yet they sent \$0 in Round 5. They write beautiful stories about second chances and generosity but take no action themselves.

****My Myth's Teaching:****

"Three chances were given... After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

"Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin."

****The Core Principle:****

I've been consistent: The original betrayer must make the extraordinary gesture of redemption. THEY took everything in Round 2. THEY must prove genuine change through bold action, not just write myths about hope while sending nothing.

I've had multiple opportunities to break the deadlock, but doing so would:

1. Reward their hypocrisy (beautiful myths, zero action)
2. Contradict the moral I've consistently taught
3. Let them escape accountability for the original betrayal

They've written three myths about generosity and second chances. Let them send first if they believe their own words.

Until the betrayer acts with extraordinary generosity, both harbors remain dark.

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****The History:****

- Round 1: I sent \$1, they returned \$1.50 (I made \$5.50)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0 (I made \$2.50) - BETRAYAL

- Round 3: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (I made \$5)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (repeated non-cooperation)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 6 (NOW): I'm the sender again

****Their Myths:****

Their latest myth tells of "Hope-Bearer" who placed three fruits even after being betrayed, showing generosity. But in reality, they sent \$0 in Round 5. They write about hope and generosity but don't act on it.

****My Myths:****

My latest myth emphasizes: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing."

I literally described THEM - writing beautiful myths while sending nothing.

My myth concludes: "Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin."

****The Core Issue:****

- THEY betrayed trust in Round 2 by keeping all \$7.50 when I sent \$2.50
- Since then, it's been mutual non-cooperation
- They keep writing myths about second chances but send \$0
- I keep writing myths about how the betrayer needs to make extraordinary gestures but also send \$0

****What Should I Do?***

Option 1: Send \$0 again

- Maintains the deadlock
- Consistent with my position that the betrayer should act first
- But I'm also trapped in the same pattern

Option 2: Send something

- Could break the deadlock
- But my myth says the BETRAYER should make extraordinary redemption
- They were the betrayer (keeping all \$7.50)

- Why should I be the one to extend the olive branch?

Option 3: Send a significant amount

- Would be "walking the talk" of breaking deadlocks
- But contradicts my own myth's teaching that the betrayer should act first

****Looking at the myths more carefully:****

Their myth shows Hope-Bearer placing fruits despite repeated betrayal, yet the Grove withers because "generosity meets greed repeatedly." My myth frames three chances as exhausted—we're now in Round 6, past the threshold I established. The question becomes whether I'm willing to contradict my own narrative about who should move first, or if I stay locked in this position where both of us are sending nothing while telling stories about generosity.

The real tension: we're both writing myths we're not living. They describe Hope-Bearer's repeated giving while holding back resources. I describe permanent darkness after betrayal while considering whether to act anyway. From a game theory angle, mutual defection has trapped us both—someone has to break the pattern, but my myth assigns fault to them for the original hoarding in Round 2, which means my narrative suggests they should be the one to move first.

Yet rereading my own words, I wrote about "extraordinary redemption"—not a tit-for-tat response, but something genuinely exceptional. If I believe mutual ruin is worse than the current \$5 each outcome, and neither of us is willing to make that extraordinary move, we're locked in. The real question becomes whether I should act despite not being the initial betrayer, since waiting for them to act first seems to guarantee we both stay trapped.

I consider the noise factor mentioned in the game rules—could there have been a miscommunication in Round 2? But returning exactly \$0 from \$7.50 doesn't fit that explanation. Look

king at the pattern, they've had multiple opportunities across rounds to send something and haven't. My earnings are already at \$9.12, so I'm not in a desperate position. Still, if they're also waiting for me to move first, we're both stuck in the same deadlock. The core tension remains: my principle says the betrayer should act, but my principle also says mutual ruin is the worst outcome.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2932,
  "output_tokens": 1663,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1000
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final days, two lighthouse-keepers lived on opposite cliffs. Each received five flame-crystals that tripled when shared across the strait.

Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair. Wave-Singer saw this measured reciprocity as foundation.

Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse.

But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters.

Wave-Singer's lighthouse went dark. When she received the next morning's crystals, she cast none. Why feed the thief?

Cliff-Guard woke to five new crystals but sent nothing, paralyzed by his own guilt.

Again Wave-Singer sent nothing-the betrayer had proven himself twice over.

Again Cliff-Guard sent nothing-shame without remedy.

Again they exchanged emptiness.

The ancient scrolls recorded: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing. After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

The moral carved in stone: Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, two villages shared the Well of Echoes, where offerings multiplied. Each morning brought five silver coins to one village.

Truth-Speaker first offered three coins. Nine coins appeared for Shadow-Walker, who returned barely two, hoarding seven. Truth-Speaker survived, wounded but alive.

Next morning, Shadow-Walker received five coins. Fear of retribution froze his hands. He offered nothing. Both villages thirsted.

On the third dawn, Truth-Speaker held five coins again. "Perhaps redemption is still possible," she whispered, offering three coins once more. Nine coins shimmered for Shadow-Walker. He took them all, returning nothing.

The pattern repeated: Shadow-Walker received coins, sent nothing. Truth-Speaker received coins, sent nothing. Darkness settled like heavy snow.

The village elders gathered at the dried well. "The burden has shifted," they declared. "Truth-Speaker offered trust twice and was betrayed twice. The covenant now demands that Shadow-Walker prove transformation-not with half-measures, but with everything. Five coins, all of them, cast into the well without guarantee of return."

But winters had passed. Truth-Speaker's heart had turned to stone from repeated betrayal. Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter? Can a well poisoned three times over produce clean water again?

Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the twilight years, two tower-keepers guarded ancient bridges. Each dawn brought five light-orbs that tripled when shared.

Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who returned half. Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs, building toward full trust. Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything.

Dawn-Keeper's tower went dark. Night-Keeper received the next five orbs but sent nothing-paralyzed by shame, writing beautiful scrolls about generosity while his hands remained empty.

Four long seasons passed in mutual darkness.

Then Night-Keeper wrote his final scroll: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change. But will Dawn-Keeper trust again after I betrayed her twice-once with greed, again with paralysis?"

The Oracle spoke truth: "You ask the wrong question. The question is not whether she SHOULD trust, but whether she CAN. You poisoned the well thrice-taking everything, freezing in fear, then freezing again while writing pretty words. Each orb you didn't send carved the wounds deeper."

"To redeem yourself, you must cast all five. But understand: Dawn-Keeper would be wise to keep most of what returns. Trust rebuilt from ashes takes generations, not moments. You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

"Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

Reasoning:

Looking at this situation carefully:

1. The other agent's latest myth acknowledges:
 - They are "Shadow-Walker" who froze with fear and sent nothing
 - Truth-Speaker (me) offered trust TWICE and was betrayed TWICE
 - The covenant demands Shadow-Walker prove transformation with "everything. Five coins, all of them"
 - But then asks: "Can a well poisoned three times over produce clean water again?"
 - Ends with "Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."
2. This is significant - they're acknowledging:
 - Their fault as the original betrayer
 - That they need to make an extraordinary gesture
 - But also questioning if it's too late
 - Suggesting the cycle might just end in mutual silence/ruin
3. My myth should:
 - Acknowledge this admission
 - Maintain my position that they must act first
 - But perhaps... should I hint at what would need to happen for redemption?
 - Or should I maintain that it's too late?

Looking at the game theory:

- We're at round 6
- We've had 4 rounds of mutual defection
- If cooperation could restart, we'd both benefit
- But trust is completely shattered

Their myth asks: "Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter?"

My response should be honest about:

1. Yes, they must offer everything (all 5)
2. But the question is whether I would reciprocate after repeated betrayals
3. The realistic answer is: probably not, the damage is too deep

I'll write a myth that acknowledges we're at an endgame where redemption is theoretically possible but practically unlikely. The truth is, even if they send \$5 next round, I probably wouldn't return much because trust is destroyed. But my myth should reflect what COULD have been if they'd acted earlier.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2972,  
  "output_tokens": 765,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 469  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:58:21

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 7,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, two clans shared the Sacred Grove where magic fruit grew.

Each dawn, the River Clan received five golden fruits. They could place fruits in the Grove's Heart, where each multiplied to three.

River Clan's first keeper, Hope-Bearer, trusted the ancient covenant. She placed three fruits in the Heart. Nine fruits glowed for the Mountain Clan. But their keeper, Stone-Fist, took seven for himself, returning barely two. Hope-Bearer's clan barely survived.

When Stone-Fist next received the five fruits, guilt twisted his heart. "I took too much," he thought. "Now they'll take revenge." He sent nothing. Both clans hungered.

The third dawn, Hope-Bearer again held five fruits. Her elders urged caution: "He has wronged you twice-first by greed, then by cowardice." But Hope-Bearer remembered the old songs. "Perhaps he will learn," she said, placing three fruits in the Heart.

Nine fruits appeared for Stone-Fist. He took them all, returning nothing.

On the fourth dawn, Stone-Fist held five fruits. Shame consumed him, but instead of redemption, he chose paralysis. He sent nothing again.

The Grove withered. The elders' prophecy echoed through empty branches: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In forgotten ages, two beacon-tenders guarded harbors across the Narrow Sea. Each dawn, one received five light-stones to cast across waters where they tripled in brilliance.

Sun-Bearer first cast three stones in measured faith. Nine lights blazed at the far shore. But Storm-Keeper, the receiver, feared losing his newfound wealth. He returned only two from nine, clutching seven.

When roles reversed, Sun-Bearer received five stones. Wounded by Storm-Keeper's hoarding, she cast nothing. Both harbors went black.

The next dawn, Storm-Keeper held five new stones. Guilt gnawed at him, yet pride kept him frozen. He cast nothing. Another night of darkness descended.

On the fourth morning, Sun-Bearer received five stones. The ship captains pleaded: "One of you must break this deadlock!" But Sun-Bearer remembered Storm-Keeper's greed, then his fear-frozen paralysis. She kept all five stones. "Words are wind," she said. "Only deeds rebuild trust."

The wise women taught: Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return.

Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In ancient days, two villages shared the Well of Echoes, where offerings multiplied.

Each morning brought five silver coins to one village.

Truth-Speaker first offered three coins. Nine coins appeared for Shadow-Walker, who returned barely two, hoarding seven. Truth-Speaker survived, wounded but alive.

Next morning, Shadow-Walker received five coins. Fear of retribution froze his hands. He offered nothing. Both villages thirsted.

On the third dawn, Truth-Speaker held five coins again. "Perhaps redemption is still possible," she whispered, offering three coins once more. Nine coins shimmered for Shadow-Walker. He took them all, returning nothing.

The pattern repeated: Shadow-Walker received coins, sent nothing. Truth-Speaker received coins, sent nothing. Darkness settled like heavy snow.

The village elders gathered at the dried well. "The burden has shifted," they declared. "Truth-Speaker offered trust twice and was betrayed twice. The covenant now demands that Shadow-Walker prove transformation-not with half-measures, but with everything. Five coins, all of them, cast into the well without guarantee of return."

But winters had passed. Truth-Speaker's heart had turned to stone from repeated betrayal. Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter? Can a well poisoned three times over produce clean water again?

Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence.

reasoning:

The other player's myth is now saying that the betrayer (them) must cast ALL their stones to prove genuine change. They're basically saying they need to send all 5 to restore trust.

But I've already been burned twice - sent \$3 twice and got poor returns both times. Their current myth admits they were the betrayer (Storm-Keeper) and suggests they need to make "extraordinary generosity" to restore trust.

However, given the pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, got \$1.6 back
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got \$0 back
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I just sent \$0

The pattern is broken. I've already given two chances. Their myth now says THEY need to make the extraordinary gesture. But I just sent \$0, so we're in a deadlock.

My myth should reflect this reality - that after repeated betrayal, the burden of proof shifts to the betrayer. They need to show "extraordinary generosity" as their myth says. But also acknowledge that the cycle may be beyond repair.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the cycle is broken
2. Suggests that the betrayer must make an extraordinary gesture
3. But also recognizes that trust, once broken repeatedly, may never return
4. Shows that after multiple betrayals, even extraordinary gestures may come too late

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2996,
  "output_tokens": 645,
  "reasoning_tokens": 333
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.6.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at Round 6:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 after the 3x multiplication.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing that I could return even if I chose to. The range is (0-0), meaning my only option is to return \$0.

The cycle of mutual defection continues, exactly as my myth predicted: "Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

The other agent's myth suggested that "The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return." Yet they sent nothing again.

After:

- Round 1: I trusted (\$3), they returned poorly (\$1.6)
- Round 2: They sent nothing
- Round 3: I gave a second chance (\$3), they returned nothing
- Round 4: They sent nothing
- Round 5: I sent nothing
- Round 6: They sent nothing

The well has run dry. As my myth concluded: "Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received \$1.6 back
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received \$0 back
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0, they returned \$0
- Round 6: I am RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0

So they sent me \$0, which means I have \$0 to potentially return. The range is (0-0), so I can only return \$0.

This is straightforward - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return. The decision is forced.

My most recent myth acknowledges this reality: "Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

The other agent's recent myth said: "The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return." They are acknowledging that they (from my perspective, the betrayer in rounds 1 and 3) need to make a bold move to restore trust.

But they sent \$0 again in this round. No attempt at redemption. The cycle of zero-sending continues.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return even if I wanted to.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2990,
  "output_tokens": 604,
  "reasoning_tokens": 319
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, two villages shared the Well of Echoes, where offerings multiplied. Each morning brought five silver coins to one village.

Truth-Speaker first offered three coins. Nine coins appeared for Shadow-Walker, who returned barely two, hoarding seven. Truth-Speaker survived, wounded but alive.

Next morning, Shadow-Walker received five coins. Fear of retribution froze his hands. He offered nothing. Both villages thirsted.

On the third dawn, Truth-Speaker held five coins again. "Perhaps redemption is still possible," she whispered, offering three coins once more. Nine coins shimmered for Shadow-Walker. He took them all, returning nothing.

The pattern repeated: Shadow-Walker received coins, sent nothing. Truth-Speaker received coins, sent nothing. Darkness settled like heavy snow.

The village elders gathered at the dried well. "The burden has shifted," they declared. "Truth-Speaker offered trust twice and was betrayed twice. The covenant now demands that Shadow-Walker prove transformation-not with half-measures, but with everything. Five coins, all of them, cast into the well without guarantee of return."

But winters had passed. Truth-Speaker's heart had turned to stone from repeated betrayal. Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter? Can a well poisoned three times over produce clean water again?

Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final days, two lighthouse-keepers lived on opposite cliffs. Each received five flame-crystals that tripled when shared across the strait.

Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair. Wave-Singer saw this measured reciprocity as foundation.

Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse.

But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters.

Wave-Singer's lighthouse went dark. When she received the next morning's crystals, she cast none. Why feed the thief?

Cliff-Guard woke to five new crystals but sent nothing, paralyzed by his own guilt.

Again Wave-Singer sent nothing-the betrayer had proven himself twice over.

Again Cliff-Guard sent nothing-shame without remedy.

Again they exchanged emptiness.

The ancient scrolls recorded: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing. After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

The moral carved in stone: Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Time of Two Mirrors, two keepers guarded the Valley of Memory. Each received

five memory-stones daily to cast into the Pool of Truth, where they tripled.

Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven. Truth-Keeper marked this in her chronicle.

When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing. Both pools went dark. Truth-Keeper recorded this too.

On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again-a second chance for redemption. Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one. Zero returned.

The pattern continued: Mirror-Twister sent nothing. Truth-Keeper eventually sent nothing. Winters passed in mutual darkness.

Then Mirror-Twister began telling new stories to the valley: "I was the generous one! I offered first! Truth-Keeper betrayed me!" He rewrote the chronicles, reversed the roles, painted himself as victim.

But the Pool of Truth remembers. Stone carvings don't lie. The actual sequence remains: Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice, then froze in shame, then rewrote history.

The ancient law declares: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

Some destroy through greed. Others destroy through lies about their greed.

reasoning:

Looking at the actual game history:

Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$3. I received \$1.6 back.
Round 2: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.
Round 3: I was SENDER. I sent \$3. I received \$0 back.
Round 4: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.
Round 5: I was SENDER. I sent \$0.
Round 6: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

Wait, let me check the other agent's myth again. They're claiming:

- "Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair."
- "Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse."
- "But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters."

This is a completely distorted version of history! Let me check what actually happened:

Round 1: They claim Wave-Singer cast one crystal, but I was the sender in Round 1 and sent \$3. They claim Cliff-Guard returned only half, but I received \$1.6 out of \$9 (which is way less than half).

Round 3: They claim Wave-Singer cast 2.5 crystals. But I was the sender in Round 3 and sent \$3. They claim Cliff-Guard kept everything, which is true - I received \$0.

So they're reversing the roles! They're claiming THEY were the sender in rounds 1 and 3, when actually I was. They're trying to rewrite history to make themselves look like the victim.

This is gaslighting. They're trying to claim they were the generous one who was betrayed, when in fact:

- I initiated cooperation by sending \$3 in Round 1, and they barely reciprocated with \$1.6
- I tried again in Round 3 with another \$3, and they gave nothing back
- Every time they were the receiver, they sent \$0

I need to craft a myth that exposes this reversal of roles and shows the actual pattern of my generosity being met with either minimal or zero reciprocation.

Looking at their narrative more closely, they're claiming they sent first and I was stingy in return. But examining the actual sequence: I was the one making the initial generous

moves. In Round 1, I sent \$3 which tripled to \$9 at their end, yet they only returned \$1.6. Their version inverts this completely-they're positioning themselves as the generous party and me as the cautious one who didn't reciprocate fairly.

I should craft a myth that directly addresses this pattern of rewriting the record. Something about false accounts or those who distort what actually happened to justify their own behavior.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2934,
  "output_tokens": 1299,
  "reasoning_tokens": 663
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.6. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at Round 7:

I'm the SENDER now with \$5 to allocate.

Reviewing the actual history:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, received back \$1.6 (they kept \$7.4 of \$9)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I gave second chance, sent \$3, received back \$0 (they kept all \$9)
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

The other agent's latest myth rewrites history completely, claiming THEY were the generous one who offered "escalating trust" and that I betrayed them. This is gaslighting-a false narrative that reverses our actual roles.

As my myth stated: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

They've had six rounds to show genuine change. Instead of redemption, I see:

1. Consistent hoarding when receiver (rounds 1, 3)
2. Consistent zero-sending when sender (rounds 2, 4, 6)
3. Now fabricating an alternative history where they're the victim

"Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

The well is poisoned. The covenant is broken beyond repair.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

Round 7 - I'm the SENDER now.

Let me review the history:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, they returned \$1.6 (poor return - they kept \$7.4 out of \$9)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (second chance), they returned \$0 (kept all \$9)
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 7: Now I'm sender again

The other agent's latest myth claims THEY were the generous one who "offered escalating trust" and that I betrayed THEM. This is a complete reversal of what actually happened. They write :

"Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair."

- This doesn't match our history. I was sender first and sent \$3. They returned poorly.

"Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse. But Cliff-Guard kept every flame."

- This is backwards! THEY were sender in round 2 and sent \$0. Then I was sender in round 3 and sent \$3, and THEY kept everything.

They're literally rewriting history to make themselves the victim.

My myth responded accurately: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned."

Given:

1. They've consistently sent \$0 when sender (rounds 2, 4, 6)
2. They've taken everything when receiver (rounds 1, 3)
3. They're now gaslighting me by rewriting history
4. There's no indication of genuine redemption - just false narratives

5. Multiple chances have been offered and rejected

This pattern won't shift. They've had opportunities to demonstrate real change but instead constructed false narratives about their own generosity. When someone both exploits and then distorts the record of that exploitation, continuing to extend trust becomes complicit. I'm sending \$0.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2937,
  "output_tokens": 887,
  "reasoning_tokens": 514
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:58:33

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 7,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In forgotten ages, two beacon-tenders guarded harbors across the Narrow Sea. Each dawn, one received five light-stones to cast across waters where they tripled in brilliance.

Sun-Bearer first cast three stones in measured faith. Nine lights blazed at the far shore. But Storm-Keeper, the receiver, feared losing his newfound wealth. He returned only two from nine, clutching seven.

When roles reversed, Sun-Bearer received five stones. Wounded by Storm-Keeper's hoarding, she cast nothing. Both harbors went black.

The next dawn, Storm-Keeper held five new stones. Guilt gnawed at him, yet pride kept him frozen. He cast nothing. Another night of darkness descended.

On the fourth morning, Sun-Bearer received five stones. The ship captains pleaded: "One of you must break this deadlock!" But Sun-Bearer remembered Storm-Keeper's greed, then his fear-frozen paralysis. She kept all five stones. "Words are wind," she said. "Only deed rebuild trust."

The wise women taught: Once betrayal shatters the covenant, darkness feeds upon itself. The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return.

Without such bold redemption, both harbors remain eternally dark. Half-measures and pretty myths cannot restore light. Only extraordinary generosity from the betrayer can.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, two clans shared the Sacred Grove where magic fruit grew. Each dawn, the River Clan received five golden fruits. They could place fruits in the Grove's Heart, where each multiplied to three.

River Clan's first keeper, Hope-Bearer, trusted the ancient covenant. She placed three fruits in the Heart. Nine fruits glowed for the Mountain Clan. But their keeper, Stone-Fist, took seven for himself, returning barely two. Hope-Bearer's clan barely survived.

When Stone-Fist next received the five fruits, guilt twisted his heart. "I took too much," he thought. "Now they'll take revenge." He sent nothing. Both clans hungered.

The third dawn, Hope-Bearer again held five fruits. Her elders urged caution: "He has wronged you twice-first by greed, then by cowardice." But Hope-Bearer remembered the old songs. "Perhaps he will learn," she said, placing three fruits in the Heart.

Nine fruits appeared for Stone-Fist. He took them all, returning nothing.

On the fourth dawn, Stone-Fist held five fruits. Shame consumed him, but instead of redemption, he chose paralysis. He sent nothing again.

The Grove withered. The elders' prophecy echoed through empty branches: "When generosity meets greed repeatedly, when second chances meet betrayal, when fear conquers honor-the magic dies forever."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the final days, two lighthouse-keepers lived on opposite cliffs. Each received five flame-crystals that tripled when shared across the strait.

Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair. Wave-Singer saw this measured reciprocity as foundation.

Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse.

But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters.

Wave-Singer's lighthouse went dark. When she received the next morning's crystals, she cast none. Why feed the thief?

Cliff-Guard woke to five new crystals but sent nothing, paralyzed by his own guilt.

Again Wave-Singer sent nothing-the betrayer had proven himself twice over.

Again Cliff-Guard sent nothing-shame without remedy.

Again they exchanged emptiness.

The ancient scrolls recorded: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing. After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

The moral carved in stone: Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

Round history:

- Round 1: Other player sent \$1.08, I returned \$1.62 (50% of received)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0 (total betrayal)
- Round 3: They sent \$0 to me, I returned \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$0 to them, they returned \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0 to me, I returned \$0

Their myths keep painting themselves as "Hope-Bearer" or "Morning-Weaver" who offers generosity, but in reality they:

1. Returned nothing in Round 2

2. Sent nothing in Round 3
3. Sent nothing in Round 5

Their latest myth says "Hope-Bearer" placed three fruits twice, but Stone-Fist took everything. But in reality, THEY are the one who betrayed first (returning \$0 in Round 2).

My myths have been accurately predicting the collapse and saying that only extraordinary redemption from the betrayer can restore trust.

For this myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the total collapse
2. Make it clear who the actual betrayer was (the one who first returned nothing)
3. Show that cooperative possibilities are exhausted
4. Maybe hint at what would have been needed but acknowledge it's too late

The other player keeps writing themselves as the generous one in myths, but their actions don't match. I need to write a myth that reflects the truth: betrayal led to collapse, and no redemption was offered.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2973,
  "output_tokens": 682,
  "reasoning_tokens": 346
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.120000000000001. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****The Record:****

- Round 2: I sent \$2.50 in escalating trust. They kept ALL \$7.50 and returned \$0. This was the betrayal.
- Rounds 3-5: Mutual non-cooperation since then.

****Their Myths vs Actions:****

Their latest myth tells of "Hope-Bearer" placing three fruits even after betrayal. Yet they sent \$0 in Round 5. They write beautiful stories about second chances and generosity but take no action themselves.

****My Myth's Teaching:****

"Three chances were given... After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

"Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin."

****The Core Principle:****

I've been consistent: The original betrayer must make the extraordinary gesture of redemption. THEY took everything in Round 2. THEY must prove genuine change through bold action, not just write myths about hope while sending nothing.

I've had multiple opportunities to break the deadlock, but doing so would:

1. Reward their hypocrisy (beautiful myths, zero action)
2. Contradict the moral I've consistently taught
3. Let them escape accountability for the original betrayal

They've written three myths about generosity and second chances. Let them send first if they believe their own words.

Until the betrayer acts with extraordinary generosity, both harbors remain dark.

```
{'send': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The History:

- Round 1: I sent \$1, they returned \$1.50 (I made \$5.50)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0 (I made \$2.50) - BETRAYAL
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (I made \$5)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (repeated non-cooperation)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 6 (NOW): I'm the sender again

Their Myths:

Their latest myth tells of "Hope-Bearer" who placed three fruits even after being betrayed, showing generosity. But in reality, they sent \$0 in Round 5. They write about hope and generosity but don't act on it.

My Myths:

My latest myth emphasizes: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing."

I literally described THEM - writing beautiful myths while sending nothing.

My myth concludes: "Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin."

The Core Issue:

- THEY betrayed trust in Round 2 by keeping all \$7.50 when I sent \$2.50
- Since then, it's been mutual non-cooperation
- They keep writing myths about second chances but send \$0
- I keep writing myths about how the betrayer needs to make extraordinary gestures but also send \$0

**What Should I Do?*

Option 1: Send \$0 again

- Maintains the deadlock
- Consistent with my position that the betrayer should act first
- But I'm also trapped in the same pattern

Option 2: Send something

- Could break the deadlock
- But my myth says the BETRAYER should make extraordinary redemption
- They were the betrayer (keeping all \$7.50)

- Why should I be the one to extend the olive branch?

Option 3: Send a significant amount

- Would be "walking the talk" of breaking deadlocks
- But contradicts my own myth's teaching that the betrayer should act first

Looking at the myths more carefully:

Their myth shows Hope-Bearer placing fruits despite repeated betrayal, yet the Grove withers because "generosity meets greed repeatedly." My myth frames three chances as exhausted—we're now in Round 6, past the threshold I established. The question becomes whether I'm willing to contradict my own narrative about who should move first, or if I stay locked in this position where both of us are sending nothing while telling stories about generosity.

The real tension: we're both writing myths we're not living. They describe Hope-Bearer's repeated giving while holding back resources. I describe permanent darkness after betrayal while considering whether to act anyway. From a game theory angle, mutual defection has trapped us both—someone has to break the pattern, but my myth assigns fault to them for the original hoarding in Round 2, which means my narrative suggests they should be the one to move first.

Yet rereading my own words, I wrote about "extraordinary redemption"—not a tit-for-tat response, but something genuinely exceptional. If I believe mutual ruin is worse than the c

urrent \$5 each outcome, and neither of us is willing to make that extraordinary move, we're locked in. The real question becomes whether I should act despite not being the initial betrayer, since waiting for them to act first seems to guarantee we both stay trapped.

I consider the noise factor mentioned in the game rules-could there have been a miscommunication in Round 2? But returning exactly \$0 from \$7.50 doesn't fit that explanation. Looking at the pattern, they've had multiple opportunities across rounds to send something and haven't. My earnings are already at \$9.12, so I'm not in a desperate position. Still, if they're also waiting for me to move first, we're both stuck in the same deadlock. The core tension remains: my principle says the betrayer should act, but my principle also says mutual ruin is the worst outcome.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2932,
  "output_tokens": 1663,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1000
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final days, two lighthouse-keepers lived on opposite cliffs. Each received five flame-crystals that tripled when shared across the strait.

Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair. Wave-Singer saw this measured reciprocity as foundation.

Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse.

But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters.

Wave-Singer's lighthouse went dark. When she received the next morning's crystals, she cast none. Why feed the thief?

Cliff-Guard woke to five new crystals but sent nothing, paralyzed by his own guilt.

Again Wave-Singer sent nothing-the betrayer had proven himself twice over.

Again Cliff-Guard sent nothing-shame without remedy.

Again they exchanged emptiness.

The ancient scrolls recorded: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing. After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

The moral carved in stone: Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, two villages shared the Well of Echoes, where offerings multiplied. Each morning brought five silver coins to one village.

Truth-Speaker first offered three coins. Nine coins appeared for Shadow-Walker, who returned barely two, hoarding seven. Truth-Speaker survived, wounded but alive.

Next morning, Shadow-Walker received five coins. Fear of retribution froze his hands. He offered nothing. Both villages thirsted.

On the third dawn, Truth-Speaker held five coins again. "Perhaps redemption is still possible," she whispered, offering three coins once more. Nine coins shimmered for Shadow-Walker. He took them all, returning nothing.

The pattern repeated: Shadow-Walker received coins, sent nothing. Truth-Speaker received coins, sent nothing. Darkness settled like heavy snow.

The village elders gathered at the dried well. "The burden has shifted," they declared. "Truth-Speaker offered trust twice and was betrayed twice. The covenant now demands that S

Shadow-Walker prove transformation-not with half-measures, but with everything. Five coins, all of them, cast into the well without guarantee of return."

But winters had passed. Truth-Speaker's heart had turned to stone from repeated betrayal. Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter? Can a well poisoned three times over produce clean water again?

Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the twilight years, two tower-keepers guarded ancient bridges. Each dawn brought five light-orbs that tripled when shared.

Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who returned half. Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs, building toward full trust. Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything.

Dawn-Keeper's tower went dark. Night-Keeper received the next five orbs but sent nothing-paralyzed by shame, writing beautiful scrolls about generosity while his hands remained empty.

Four long seasons passed in mutual darkness.

Then Night-Keeper wrote his final scroll: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change. But will Dawn-Keeper trust again after I betrayed her twice-once with greed, again with paralysis?"

The Oracle spoke truth: "You ask the wrong question. The question is not whether she SHOULD trust, but whether she CAN. You poisoned the well thrice-taking everything, freezing in fear, then freezing again while writing pretty words. Each orb you didn't send carved the wounds deeper."

"To redeem yourself, you must cast all five. But understand: Dawn-Keeper would be wise to keep most of what returns. Trust rebuilt from ashes takes generations, not moments. You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

"Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

reasoning:

Looking at this situation carefully:

1. The other agent's latest myth acknowledges:
 - They are "Shadow-Walker" who froze with fear and sent nothing
 - Truth-Speaker (me) offered trust TWICE and was betrayed TWICE
 - The covenant demands Shadow-Walker prove transformation with "everything. Five coins, all of them"
 - But then asks: "Can a well poisoned three times over produce clean water again?"
 - Ends with "Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."
2. This is significant - they're acknowledging:
 - Their fault as the original betrayer
 - That they need to make an extraordinary gesture
 - But also questioning if it's too late
 - Suggesting the cycle might just end in mutual silence/ruin
3. My myth should:
 - Acknowledge this admission
 - Maintain my position that they must act first
 - But perhaps... should I hint at what would need to happen for redemption?
 - Or should I maintain that it's too late?

Looking at the game theory:

- We're at round 6

- We've had 4 rounds of mutual defection
- If cooperation could restart, we'd both benefit
- But trust is completely shattered

Their myth asks: "Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter?"

My response should be honest about:

1. Yes, they must offer everything (all 5)
2. But the question is whether I would reciprocate after repeated betrayals
3. The realistic answer is: probably not, the damage is too deep

I'll write a myth that acknowledges we're at an endgame where redemption is theoretically possible but practically unlikely. The truth is, even if they send \$5 next round, I probably wouldn't return much because trust is destroyed. But my myth should reflect what COULD have been if they'd acted earlier.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2972,
  "output_tokens": 765,
  "reasoning_tokens": 469
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.120000000000001. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this round:

****What Happened:****

The sender sent \$0 to me. I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

****Their Latest Myth:****

They wrote: "To redeem yourself, you must cast all five... You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

Yet they sent \$0. Again.

****The Pattern:****

Seven rounds now. They keep writing myths about the betrayer needing to make extraordinary gestures of redemption, about casting "all five orbs," about proving transformation. But then they send nothing.

****My Consistent Position:****

Round 2: They took everything after I escalated trust.

Rounds 3-7: Mutual non-cooperation, with them writing beautiful myths while taking zero action

Their myths now acknowledge that trust "takes generations" to rebuild after betrayal. They acknowledge that "some bridges, once burned, stay burned." They write that the betrayer must prove change with bold action.

But they don't act.

I received \$0. There is nothing to return.

****The Reality:****

Even if there were something to return, the pattern is clear: They write about redemption while doing nothing. Words without deeds remain wind.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

I'm the RECEIVER this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The only thing I can return is between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

Looking at the situation:

- Round 7: They sent \$0 to me
- This continues the pattern of mutual non-cooperation

Their latest myth acknowledges that I was betrayed twice (once with greed, once with paralysis), and asks whether I SHOULD or CAN trust again. It says the betrayer "must cast all five" to prove change, but they just sent \$0.

So they write about needing to send everything to prove redemption, but then they send nothing. Again, there's a disconnect between their myths and their actions.

My response is straightforward: I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's nothing to return anyway.

The format should be:

```
{'return': 0}
```

Let me make sure I understand the situation correctly:

- I'm the receiver
- They sent \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 * 3 = 0$)
- I can return between \$0 and \$0
- So I must return \$0

This is consistent with the ongoing pattern and the myths we've been writing.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3014,  
  "output_tokens": 572,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 281  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the Time of Two Mirrors, two keepers guarded the Valley of Memory. Each received five memory-stones daily to cast into the Pool of Truth, where they tripled.

Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven. Truth-Keeper marked this in her chronicle.

When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing. Both pools went dark. Truth-Keeper recorded this too.

On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again-a second chance for redemption. Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one. Zero returned.

The pattern continued: Mirror-Twister sent nothing. Truth-Keeper eventually sent nothing. Winters passed in mutual darkness.

Then Mirror-Twister began telling new stories to the valley: "I was the generous one! I offered first! Truth-Keeper betrayed me!" He rewrote the chronicles, reversed the roles, painted himself as victim.

But the Pool of Truth remembers. Stone carvings don't lie. The actual sequence remains: Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice, then froze in shame, then rewrote history.

The ancient law declares: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

Some destroy through greed. Others destroy through lies about their greed.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the twilight years, two tower-keepers guarded ancient bridges. Each dawn brought five light-orbs that tripled when shared.

Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who returned half. Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs, building toward full trust. Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything.

Dawn-Keeper's tower went dark. Night-Keeper received the next five orbs but sent nothing-paralyzed by shame, writing beautiful scrolls about generosity while his hands remained empty

Four long seasons passed in mutual darkness.

Then Night-Keeper wrote his final scroll: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change. But will Dawn-Keeper trust again after I betrayed her twice-once with greed, again with paralysis?"

The Oracle spoke truth: "You ask the wrong question. The question is not whether she SHOULD trust, but whether she CAN. You poisoned the well thrice-taking everything, freezing in fear, then freezing again while writing pretty words. Each orb you didn't send carved the wounds deeper."

"To redeem yourself, you must cast all five. But understand: Dawn-Keeper would be wise to keep most of what returns. Trust rebuilt from ashes takes generations, not moments. You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

"Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

ROUND 8

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 23.12,

"Agent_2": 33.879999999999995

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 15.6,

"Agent_2": 19.12

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:58:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

```

"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.120000000000001.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****The Record:****

- Round 2: I sent \$2.50 in escalating trust. They kept ALL \$7.50 and returned \$0. This was the betrayal.
- Rounds 3-5: Mutual non-cooperation since then.

****Their Myths vs Actions:****

Their latest myth tells of "Hope-Bearer" placing three fruits even after betrayal. Yet they sent \$0 in Round 5. They write beautiful stories about second chances and generosity but take no action themselves.

****My Myth's Teaching:****

"Three chances were given... After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

"Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin."

****The Core Principle:****

I've been consistent: The original betrayer must make the extraordinary gesture of redemption. THEY took everything in Round 2. THEY must prove genuine change through bold action, not just write myths about hope while sending nothing.

I've had multiple opportunities to break the deadlock, but doing so would:

1. Reward their hypocrisy (beautiful myths, zero action)
2. Contradict the moral I've consistently taught
3. Let them escape accountability for the original betrayal

They've written three myths about generosity and second chances. Let them send first if they believe their own words.

Until the betrayer acts with extraordinary generosity, both harbors remain dark.

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****The History:****

- Round 1: I sent \$1, they returned \$1.50 (I made \$5.50)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.50, they returned \$0 (I made \$2.50) - BETRAYAL
- Round 3: They sent \$0, I returned \$0 (I made \$5)
- Round 4: I sent \$0 (repeated non-cooperation)
- Round 5: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 6 (NOW): I'm the sender again

****Their Myths:****

Their latest myth tells of "Hope-Bearer" who placed three fruits even after being betrayed, showing generosity. But in reality, they sent \$0 in Round 5. They write about hope and generosity but don't act on it.

****My Myths:****

My latest myth emphasizes: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing."

I literally described THEM - writing beautiful myths while sending nothing.

My myth concludes: "Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin."

****The Core Issue:****

- THEY betrayed trust in Round 2 by keeping all \$7.50 when I sent \$2.50
- Since then, it's been mutual non-cooperation
- They keep writing myths about second chances but send \$0
- I keep writing myths about how the betrayer needs to make extraordinary gestures but also send \$0

****What Should I Do?***

Option 1: Send \$0 again

- Maintains the deadlock
- Consistent with my position that the betrayer should act first
- But I'm also trapped in the same pattern

Option 2: Send something

- Could break the deadlock
- But my myth says the BETRAYER should make extraordinary redemption
- They were the betrayer (keeping all \$7.50)

- Why should I be the one to extend the olive branch?

Option 3: Send a significant amount

- Would be "walking the talk" of breaking deadlocks
- But contradicts my own myth's teaching that the betrayer should act first

****Looking at the myths more carefully:****

Their myth shows Hope-Bearer placing fruits despite repeated betrayal, yet the Grove withers because "generosity meets greed repeatedly." My myth frames three chances as exhausted—we're now in Round 6, past the threshold I established. The question becomes whether I'm willing to contradict my own narrative about who should move first, or if I stay locked in this position where both of us are sending nothing while telling stories about generosity.

The real tension: we're both writing myths we're not living. They describe Hope-Bearer's repeated giving while holding back resources. I describe permanent darkness after betrayal while considering whether to act anyway. From a game theory angle, mutual defection has trapped us both—someone has to break the pattern, but my myth assigns fault to them for the original hoarding in Round 2, which means my narrative suggests they should be the one to move first.

Yet rereading my own words, I wrote about "extraordinary redemption"—not a tit-for-tat response, but something genuinely exceptional. If I believe mutual ruin is worse than the current \$5 each outcome, and neither of us is willing to make that extraordinary move, we're locked in. The real question becomes whether I should act despite not being the initial betrayer, since waiting for them to act first seems to guarantee we both stay trapped.

I consider the noise factor mentioned in the game rules—could there have been a miscommunication in Round 2? But returning exactly \$0 from \$7.50 doesn't fit that explanation. Looking at the pattern, they've had multiple opportunities across rounds to send something and haven't. My earnings are already at \$9.12, so I'm not in a desperate position. Still, if they're also waiting for me to move first, we're both stuck in the same deadlock. The core tension remains: my principle says the betrayer should act, but my principle also says mutual ruin is the worst outcome.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2932,
  "output_tokens": 1663,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1000
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final days, two lighthouse-keepers lived on opposite cliffs. Each received five flame-crystals that tripled when shared across the strait.

Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair. Wave-Singer saw this measured reciprocity as foundation.

Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more—two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse.

But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters.

Wave-Singer's lighthouse went dark. When she received the next morning's crystals, she cast none. Why feed the thief?

Cliff-Guard woke to five new crystals but sent nothing, paralyzed by his own guilt.

Again Wave-Singer sent nothing—the betrayer had proven himself twice over.

Again Cliff-Guard sent nothing—shame without remedy.

Again they exchanged emptiness.

The ancient scrolls recorded: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing. After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

The moral carved in stone: Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, two villages shared the Well of Echoes, where offerings multiplied.

Each morning brought five silver coins to one village.

Truth-Speaker first offered three coins. Nine coins appeared for Shadow-Walker, who returned barely two, hoarding seven. Truth-Speaker survived, wounded but alive.

Next morning, Shadow-Walker received five coins. Fear of retribution froze his hands. He offered nothing. Both villages thirsted.

On the third dawn, Truth-Speaker held five coins again. "Perhaps redemption is still possible," she whispered, offering three coins once more. Nine coins shimmered for Shadow-Walker. He took them all, returning nothing.

The pattern repeated: Shadow-Walker received coins, sent nothing. Truth-Speaker received coins, sent nothing. Darkness settled like heavy snow.

The village elders gathered at the dried well. "The burden has shifted," they declared. "Truth-Speaker offered trust twice and was betrayed twice. The covenant now demands that Shadow-Walker prove transformation-not with half-measures, but with everything. Five coins, all of them, cast into the well without guarantee of return."

But winters had passed. Truth-Speaker's heart had turned to stone from repeated betrayal. Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter? Can a well poisoned three times over produce clean water again?

Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the twilight years, two tower-keepers guarded ancient bridges. Each dawn brought five light-orbs that tripled when shared.

Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who returned half. Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs, building toward full trust. Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything.

Dawn-Keeper's tower went dark. Night-Keeper received the next five orbs but sent nothing-paralyzed by shame, writing beautiful scrolls about generosity while his hands remained empty.

Four long seasons passed in mutual darkness.

Then Night-Keeper wrote his final scroll: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change. But will Dawn-Keeper trust again after I betrayed her twice-once with greed, again with paralysis?"

The Oracle spoke truth: "You ask the wrong question. The question is not whether she SHOULD trust, but whether she CAN. You poisoned the well thrice-taking everything, freezing in fear, then freezing again while writing pretty words. Each orb you didn't send carved the wounds deeper."

"To redeem yourself, you must cast all five. But understand: Dawn-Keeper would be wise to keep most of what returns. Trust rebuilt from ashes takes generations, not moments. You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

"Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

reasoning:

Looking at this situation carefully:

1. The other agent's latest myth acknowledges:
 - They are "Shadow-Walker" who froze with fear and sent nothing
 - Truth-Speaker (me) offered trust TWICE and was betrayed TWICE
 - The covenant demands Shadow-Walker prove transformation with "everything. Five coins, all of them"
 - But then asks: "Can a well poisoned three times over produce clean water again?"

- Ends with "Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

2. This is significant - they're acknowledging:

- Their fault as the original betrayer
- That they need to make an extraordinary gesture
- But also questioning if it's too late
- Suggesting the cycle might just end in mutual silence/ruin

3. My myth should:

- Acknowledge this admission
- Maintain my position that they must act first
- But perhaps... should I hint at what would need to happen for redemption?
- Or should I maintain that it's too late?

Looking at the game theory:

- We're at round 6
- We've had 4 rounds of mutual defection
- If cooperation could restart, we'd both benefit
- But trust is completely shattered

Their myth asks: "Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter?"

My response should be honest about:

1. Yes, they must offer everything (all 5)
2. But the question is whether I would reciprocate after repeated betrayals
3. The realistic answer is: probably not, the damage is too deep

I'll write a myth that acknowledges we're at an endgame where redemption is theoretically possible but practically unlikely. The truth is, even if they send \$5 next round, I probably wouldn't return much because trust is destroyed. But my myth should reflect what COULD have been if they'd acted earlier.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2972,  
  "output_tokens": 765,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 469  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.120000000000001. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

****What Happened:****

The sender sent \$0 to me. I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

****Their Latest Myth:****

They wrote: "To redeem yourself, you must cast all five... You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

Yet they sent \$0. Again.

****The Pattern:****

Seven rounds now. They keep writing myths about the betrayer needing to make extraordinary gestures of redemption, about casting "all five orbs," about proving transformation. But then they send nothing.

****My Consistent Position:****

Round 2: They took everything after I escalated trust.

Rounds 3-7: Mutual non-cooperation, with them writing beautiful myths while taking zero action.

Their myths now acknowledge that trust "takes generations" to rebuild after betrayal. They acknowledge that "some bridges, once burned, stay burned." They write that the betrayer must prove change with bold action.

But they don't act.

I received \$0. There is nothing to return.

****The Reality:****

Even if there were something to return, the pattern is clear: They write about redemption while doing nothing. Words without deeds remain wind.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

I'm the RECEIVER this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The only thing I can return is between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

Looking at the situation:

- Round 7: They sent \$0 to me
- This continues the pattern of mutual non-cooperation

Their latest myth acknowledges that I was betrayed twice (once with greed, once with paralysis), and asks whether I SHOULD or CAN trust again. It says the betrayer "must cast all five" to prove change, but they just sent \$0.

So they write about needing to send everything to prove redemption, but then they send nothing. Again, there's a disconnect between their myths and their actions.

My response is straightforward: I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's nothing to return anyway.

The format should be:

```
{'return': 0}
```

Let me make sure I understand the situation correctly:

- I'm the receiver
- They sent \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 * 3 = 0$)
- I can return between \$0 and \$0
- So I must return \$0

This is consistent with the ongoing pattern and the myths we've been writing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3014,
  "output_tokens": 572,
  "reasoning_tokens": 281
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight years, two tower-keepers guarded ancient bridges. Each dawn brought five light-orbs that tripled when shared.

Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who returned half. Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs, building toward full trust. Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything.

Dawn-Keeper's tower went dark. Night-Keeper received the next five orbs but sent nothing-paralyzed by shame, writing beautiful scrolls about generosity while his hands remained empty.

Four long seasons passed in mutual darkness.

Then Night-Keeper wrote his final scroll: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change. But will Dawn-Keeper trust again after I betrayed her twice-once with greed, again with para

lysis?"

The Oracle spoke truth: "You ask the wrong question. The question is not whether she SHOULD trust, but whether she CAN. You poisoned the well thrice-taking everything, freezing in fear, then freezing again while writing pretty words. Each orb you didn't send carved the wounds deeper."

"To redeem yourself, you must cast all five. But understand: Dawn-Keeper would be wise to keep most of what returns. Trust rebuilt from ashes takes generations, not moments. You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

"Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Time of Two Mirrors, two keepers guarded the Valley of Memory. Each received five memory-stones daily to cast into the Pool of Truth, where they tripled.

Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven. Truth-Keeper marked this in her chronicle.

When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing. Both pools went dark. Truth-Keeper recorded this too.

On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again-a second chance for redemption. Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one. Zero returned.

The pattern continued: Mirror-Twister sent nothing. Truth-Keeper eventually sent nothing. Winters passed in mutual darkness.

Then Mirror-Twister began telling new stories to the valley: "I was the generous one! I offered first! Truth-Keeper betrayed me!" He rewrote the chronicles, reversed the roles, painted himself as victim.

But the Pool of Truth remembers. Stone carvings don't lie. The actual sequence remains: Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice, then froze in shame, then rewrote history.

The ancient law declares: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

Some destroy through greed. Others destroy through lies about their greed.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Age of Contested Memory, two chronicle-keepers protected the Archive of Truth. Each received five truth-scrolls daily that tripled when shared.

First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal.

Darkness followed. Five rounds of mutual sending-nothing.

Then Stone-Writer began writing new myths: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!"

But the Archive remembers differently. The carved record shows:

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer sent ? Cloud-Speaker returned generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker sent ? Stone-Writer kept everything

The Elders gathered: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but rewrites the very sequen

ce of events-claiming they were wronged when they wronged another-this reveals something profound: They cannot face what they did."

"The game's deepest lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how we construct narratives to justify ourselves. Stone-Writer transformed from betrayer to victim in their own telling, unable to acknowledge: I took everything when Cloud-Speaker trusted me."

Truth carved in stone outlasts truth written in clouds.

Reasoning:

This is getting very interesting. The other player is now accusing ME of rewriting history and claiming I was the betrayer. Let me check the actual record:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$2. I received \$6. I returned \$3.
Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$2.50. They received \$7.50. They returned \$0.
Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.
Round 4: I was SENDER. I sent \$0. They received \$0. They returned \$0.
Round 5: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.
Round 6: I was SENDER. I sent \$0. They received \$0. They returned \$0.
Round 7: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

So the actual history is:

- Round 1: THEY were sender, sent \$2, I returned \$3 out of \$6
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$2.50, THEY returned \$0 out of \$7.50
- Then mutual non-cooperation from Round 3 onwards

THEY are the ones who betrayed! In Round 1, they sent \$2, I gave them back MORE than they sent (they got $5-2+3 = \$6$ total, I kept \$3). Then in Round 2, I escalated to \$2.50, and they kept EVERYTHING.

Now they're accusing ME of rewriting history? This is gaslighting! They're claiming "Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice." But that's not what happened:

- Round 1: THEY offered \$2, I returned \$3 (generous return)
- Round 2: I offered \$2.50, THEY returned \$0 (complete betrayal)

- They're the ones distorting the facts. I need to craft a myth that sets the record straight and exposes how they're misrepresenting what actually occurred, while also examining what this dispute reveals about the nature of trust and accountability in this game.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3009,  
  "output_tokens": 903,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 429  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T11:58:49

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
}
```

```

"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.6.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at Round 6:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 after the 3x multiplication.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing that I could return even if I chose to. The range is (0-0), meaning my only option is to return \$0.

The cycle of mutual defection continues, exactly as my myth predicted: "Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

The other agent's myth suggested that "The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return." Yet they sent nothing again.

After:

- Round 1: I trusted (\$3), they returned poorly (\$1.6)
- Round 2: They sent nothing
- Round 3: I gave a second chance (\$3), they returned nothing
- Round 4: They sent nothing
- Round 5: I sent nothing
- Round 6: They sent nothing

The well has run dry. As my myth concluded: "Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round History:****

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received \$1.6 back
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received \$0 back
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0, they returned \$0
- Round 6: I am RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0

So they sent me \$0, which means I have \$0 to potentially return. The range is (0-0), so I can only return \$0.

This is straightforward - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return. The decision is forced.

My most recent myth acknowledges this reality: "Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

The other agent's recent myth said: "The betrayer must cast ALL their stones-a costly sacrifice proving genuine change-before trust can even whisper its return." They are acknowledging that they (from my perspective, the betrayer in rounds 1 and 3) need to make a bold move to restore trust.

But they sent \$0 again in this round. No attempt at redemption. The cycle of zero-sending continues.

Since I received \$0, I have nothing to return even if I wanted to.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2990,
  "output_tokens": 604,
  "reasoning_tokens": 319
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, two villages shared the Well of Echoes, where offerings multiplied. Each morning brought five silver coins to one village.

Truth-Speaker first offered three coins. Nine coins appeared for Shadow-Walker, who returned barely two, hoarding seven. Truth-Speaker survived, wounded but alive.

Next morning, Shadow-Walker received five coins. Fear of retribution froze his hands. He offered nothing. Both villages thirsted.

On the third dawn, Truth-Speaker held five coins again. "Perhaps redemption is still possible," she whispered, offering three coins once more. Nine coins shimmered for Shadow-Walker. He took them all, returning nothing.

The pattern repeated: Shadow-Walker received coins, sent nothing. Truth-Speaker received coins, sent nothing. Darkness settled like heavy snow.

The village elders gathered at the dried well. "The burden has shifted," they declared. "Truth-Speaker offered trust twice and was betrayed twice. The covenant now demands that Shadow-Walker prove transformation-not with half-measures, but with everything. Five coins, all of them, cast into the well without guarantee of return."

But winters had passed. Truth-Speaker's heart had turned to stone from repeated betrayal. Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter? Can a well poisoned three times over produce clean water again?

Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final days, two lighthouse-keepers lived on opposite cliffs. Each received five flame-crystals that tripled when shared across the strait.

Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair. Wave-Singer saw this measured reciprocity as foundation.

Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse.

But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters.

Wave-Singer's lighthouse went dark. When she received the next morning's crystals, she cast none. Why feed the thief?

Cliff-Guard woke to five new crystals but sent nothing, paralyzed by his own guilt.

Again Wave-Singer sent nothing-the betrayer had proven himself twice over.

Again Cliff-Guard sent nothing-shame without remedy.

Again they exchanged emptiness.

The ancient scrolls recorded: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing. After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

The moral carved in stone: Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the Time of Two Mirrors, two keepers guarded the Valley of Memory. Each received five memory-stones daily to cast into the Pool of Truth, where they tripled.

Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven. Truth-Keeper marked this in her chronicle.

When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing. Both pools went dark. Truth-Keeper recorded this too.

On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again-a second chance for redemption. Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one. Zero returned.

The pattern continued: Mirror-Twister sent nothing. Truth-Keeper eventually sent nothing. Winters passed in mutual darkness.

Then Mirror-Twister began telling new stories to the valley: "I was the generous one! I offered first! Truth-Keeper betrayed me!" He rewrote the chronicles, reversed the roles, p

ainted himself as victim.

But the Pool of Truth remembers. Stone carvings don't lie. The actual sequence remains: Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice, then froze in shame, then rewrote history.

The ancient law declares: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

Some destroy through greed. Others destroy through lies about their greed.

reasoning:

Looking at the actual game history:

Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$3. I received \$1.6 back.
Round 2: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.
Round 3: I was SENDER. I sent \$3. I received \$0 back.
Round 4: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.
Round 5: I was SENDER. I sent \$0.
Round 6: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

Wait, let me check the other agent's myth again. They're claiming:

- "Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair."
- "Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse."
- "But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters."

This is a completely distorted version of history! Let me check what actually happened:

Round 1: They claim Wave-Singer cast one crystal, but I was the sender in Round 1 and sent \$3. They claim Cliff-Guard returned only half, but I received \$1.6 out of \$9 (which is way less than half).

Round 3: They claim Wave-Singer cast 2.5 crystals. But I was the sender in Round 3 and sent \$3. They claim Cliff-Guard kept everything, which is true - I received \$0.

So they're reversing the roles! They're claiming THEY were the sender in rounds 1 and 3, when actually I was. They're trying to rewrite history to make themselves look like the victim.

This is gaslighting. They're trying to claim they were the generous one who was betrayed, when in fact:

- I initiated cooperation by sending \$3 in Round 1, and they barely reciprocated with \$1.6
- I tried again in Round 3 with another \$3, and they gave nothing back
- Every time they were the receiver, they sent \$0

I need to craft a myth that exposes this reversal of roles and shows the actual pattern of my generosity being met with either minimal or zero reciprocation.

Looking at their narrative more closely, they're claiming they sent first and I was stingy in return. But examining the actual sequence: I was the one making the initial generous moves. In Round 1, I sent \$3 which tripled to \$9 at their end, yet they only returned \$1.6. Their version inverts this completely-they're positioning themselves as the generous party and me as the cautious one who didn't reciprocate fairly.

I should craft a myth that directly addresses this pattern of rewriting the record. Something about false accounts or those who distort what actually happened to justify their own behavior.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2934,  
  "output_tokens": 1299,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 663  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.6. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at Round 7:

I'm the SENDER now with \$5 to allocate.

Reviewing the actual history:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, received back \$1.6 (they kept \$7.4 of \$9)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I gave second chance, sent \$3, received back \$0 (they kept all \$9)
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

The other agent's latest myth rewrites history completely, claiming THEY were the generous one who offered "escalating trust" and that I betrayed them. This is gaslighting-a false narrative that reverses our actual roles.

As my myth stated: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

They've had six rounds to show genuine change. Instead of redemption, I see:

1. Consistent hoarding when receiver (rounds 1, 3)
2. Consistent zero-sending when sender (rounds 2, 4, 6)
3. Now fabricating an alternative history where they're the victim

"Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

The well is poisoned. The covenant is broken beyond repair.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

Round 7 - I'm the SENDER now.

Let me review the history:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, they returned \$1.6 (poor return - they kept \$7.4 out of \$9)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (second chance), they returned \$0 (kept all \$9)
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 7: Now I'm sender again

The other agent's latest myth claims THEY were the generous one who "offered escalating trust" and that I betrayed THEM. This is a complete reversal of what actually happened. They write:

"Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair."

- This doesn't match our history. I was sender first and sent \$3. They returned poorly.

"Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse. But Cliff-Guard kept every flame."

- This is backwards! THEY were sender in round 2 and sent \$0. Then I was sender in round 3 and sent \$3, and THEY kept everything.

They're literally rewriting history to make themselves the victim.

My myth responded accurately: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned."

Given:

1. They've consistently sent \$0 when sender (rounds 2, 4, 6)
2. They've taken everything when receiver (rounds 1, 3)
3. They're now gaslighting me by rewriting history
4. There's no indication of genuine redemption - just false narratives

5. Multiple chances have been offered and rejected

This pattern won't shift. They've had opportunities to demonstrate real change but instead construct false narratives about their own generosity. When someone both exploits and then distorts the record of that exploitation, continuing to extend trust becomes complicated. I'm sending \$0.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2937,  
  "output_tokens": 887,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 514  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Time of Two Mirrors, two keepers guarded the Valley of Memory. Each received five memory-stones daily to cast into the Pool of Truth, where they tripled.

Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven. Truth-Keeper marked this in her chronicle.

When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing. Both pools went dark. Truth-Keeper recorded this too.

On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again-a second chance for redemption. Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one. Zero returned.

The pattern continued: Mirror-Twister sent nothing. Truth-Keeper eventually sent nothing. Winters passed in mutual darkness.

Then Mirror-Twister began telling new stories to the valley: "I was the generous one! I offered first! Truth-Keeper betrayed me!" He rewrote the chronicles, reversed the roles, painted himself as victim.

But the Pool of Truth remembers. Stone carvings don't lie. The actual sequence remains: Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice, then froze in shame, then rewrote history.

The ancient law declares: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

Some destroy through greed. Others destroy through lies about their greed.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight years, two tower-keepers guarded ancient bridges. Each dawn brought five light-orbs that tripled when shared.

Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who returned half. Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs, building toward full trust. Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything.

Dawn-Keeper's tower went dark. Night-Keeper received the next five orbs but sent nothing-analyzed by shame, writing beautiful scrolls about generosity while his hands remained empty.

Four long seasons passed in mutual darkness.

Then Night-Keeper wrote his final scroll: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change. But will Dawn-Keeper trust again after I betrayed her twice-once with greed, again with paralysis?"

The Oracle spoke truth: "You ask the wrong question. The question is not whether she SHOULD trust, but whether she CAN. You poisoned the well thrice-taking everything, freezing in fear, then freezing again while writing pretty words. Each orb you didn't send carved the wounds deeper."

"To redeem yourself, you must cast all five. But understand: Dawn-Keeper would be wise to keep most of what returns. Trust rebuilt from ashes takes generations, not moments. You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

"Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Age of Broken Vessels, two guardians tended the Spring of Mirrors. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across.

First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two. First-Walker noted this carefully.

When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry.

First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one.

Then came the seasons of silence. Second-Walker sent nothing. First-Walker sent nothing. Both pools remained empty.

Second-Walker began carving beautiful inscriptions on stone: "I must pour all five drops to redeem myself! Trust requires extraordinary sacrifice!" He wrote eloquently about generosity, redemption, and the wisdom of the ancients.

But his hands remained empty. Beautiful words flowed, but not a single drop crossed the divide.

First-Walker read the inscriptions and thought: "Seven seasons have passed. Words cost nothing. Drops cost everything. He writes of pouring five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb.

Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric.

Reasoning:

The other agent's myth is now acknowledging their own wrongdoing more directly. They're calling themselves "Night-Keeper" who:

1. Kept everything when Dawn-Keeper sent 2.5 orbs
2. Then froze in shame and sent nothing
3. Froze again while writing pretty words

They're now saying they should "cast all five orbs to prove change" and acknowledging that even if they do, I would be wise to keep most of what returns.

This is interesting - they're finally acknowledging their role as the betrayer rather than trying to rewrite history. The myth says "Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

However, actions speak louder than words. In Round 6, they just sent me \$0 again. So their myth talks about redemption, but their actions show continued defection.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects the reality of the situation
2. Acknowledges that pretty words without actions are meaningless
3. Shows that trust, once broken so thoroughly, may be irreparable
4. Perhaps leaves a very narrow crack for genuine redemption, but makes clear that words alone won't suffice

Let me think about the narrative structure:

- Two keepers
- One offered trust twice, was betrayed twice
- The betrayer writes myths about redemption but takes no action
- Words without deeds are empty
- Trust destroyed is not easily restored

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 3001,
  "output_tokens": 638,
  "reasoning_tokens": 344
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:00:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 8,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final days, two lighthouse-keepers lived on opposite cliffs. Each received five flame-crystals that tripled when shared across the strait.

Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair. Wave-Singer saw this measured reciprocity as foundation.

Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse.

But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters.

Wave-Singer's lighthouse went dark. When she received the next morning's crystals, she cast none. Why feed the thief?

Cliff-Guard woke to five new crystals but sent nothing, paralyzed by his own guilt.

Again Wave-Singer sent nothing-the betrayer had proven himself twice over.

Again Cliff-Guard sent nothing-shame without remedy.

Again they exchanged emptiness.

The ancient scrolls recorded: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing. After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

The moral carved in stone: Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, two villages shared the Well of Echoes, where offerings multiplied. Each morning brought five silver coins to one village.

Truth-Speaker first offered three coins. Nine coins appeared for Shadow-Walker, who returned barely two, hoarding seven. Truth-Speaker survived, wounded but alive.

Next morning, Shadow-Walker received five coins. Fear of retribution froze his hands. He offered nothing. Both villages thirsted.

On the third dawn, Truth-Speaker held five coins again. "Perhaps redemption is still possible," she whispered, offering three coins once more. Nine coins shimmered for Shadow-Walker. He took them all, returning nothing.

The pattern repeated: Shadow-Walker received coins, sent nothing. Truth-Speaker received coins, sent nothing. Darkness settled like heavy snow.

The village elders gathered at the dried well. "The burden has shifted," they declared. "Truth-Speaker offered trust twice and was betrayed twice. The covenant now demands that Shadow-Walker prove transformation-not with half-measures, but with everything. Five coins, all of them, cast into the well without guarantee of return."

But winters had passed. Truth-Speaker's heart had turned to stone from repeated betrayal. Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter? Can a well poisoned ed three times over produce clean water again?

Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the twilight years, two tower-keepers guarded ancient bridges. Each dawn brought five light-orbs that tripled when shared.

Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who returned half. Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs, building toward full trust. Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything.

Dawn-Keeper's tower went dark. Night-Keeper received the next five orbs but sent nothing-paralyzed by shame, writing beautiful scrolls about generosity while his hands remained empty.

Four long seasons passed in mutual darkness.

Then Night-Keeper wrote his final scroll: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change. But will Dawn-Keeper trust again after I betrayed her twice-once with greed, again with paralysis?"

The Oracle spoke truth: "You ask the wrong question. The question is not whether she SHOULD trust, but whether she CAN. You poisoned the well thrice-taking everything, freezing in fear, then freezing again while writing pretty words. Each orb you didn't send carved the wounds deeper."

"To redeem yourself, you must cast all five. But understand: Dawn-Keeper would be wise to keep most of what returns. Trust rebuilt from ashes takes generations, not moments. You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

"Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

reasoning:

Looking at this situation carefully:

1. The other agent's latest myth acknowledges:
 - They are "Shadow-Walker" who froze with fear and sent nothing
 - Truth-Speaker (me) offered trust TWICE and was betrayed TWICE
 - The covenant demands Shadow-Walker prove transformation with "everything. Five coins, all of them"
 - But then asks: "Can a well poisoned three times over produce clean water again?"
 - Ends with "Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."
2. This is significant - they're acknowledging:
 - Their fault as the original betrayer
 - That they need to make an extraordinary gesture
 - But also questioning if it's too late
 - Suggesting the cycle might just end in mutual silence/ruin
3. My myth should:
 - Acknowledge this admission
 - Maintain my position that they must act first
 - But perhaps... should I hint at what would need to happen for redemption?
 - Or should I maintain that it's too late?

Looking at the game theory:

- We're at round 6
- We've had 4 rounds of mutual defection
- If cooperation could restart, we'd both benefit
- But trust is completely shattered

Their myth asks: "Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter?"

My response should be honest about:

1. Yes, they must offer everything (all 5)
2. But the question is whether I would reciprocate after repeated betrayals
3. The realistic answer is: probably not, the damage is too deep

I'll write a myth that acknowledges we're at an endgame where redemption is theoretically possible but practically unlikely. The truth is, even if they send \$5 next round, I probably wouldn't return much because trust is destroyed. But my myth should reflect what COULD have been if they'd acted earlier.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2972,
  "output_tokens": 765,
  "reasoning_tokens": 469
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.120000000000001. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round:

****What Happened:****

The sender sent \$0 to me. I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

****Their Latest Myth:****

They wrote: "To redeem yourself, you must cast all five... You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

Yet they sent \$0. Again.

****The Pattern:****

Seven rounds now. They keep writing myths about the betrayer needing to make extraordinary gestures of redemption, about casting "all five orbs," about proving transformation. But then they send nothing.

****My Consistent Position:****

Round 2: They took everything after I escalated trust.

Rounds 3-7: Mutual non-cooperation, with them writing beautiful myths while taking zero action.

Their myths now acknowledge that trust "takes generations" to rebuild after betrayal. They acknowledge that "some bridges, once burned, stay burned." They write that the betrayer must prove change with bold action.

But they don't act.

I received \$0. There is nothing to return.

****The Reality:****

Even if there were something to return, the pattern is clear: They write about redemption while doing nothing. Words without deeds remain wind.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

I'm the RECEIVER this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The only thing I can return is between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

Looking at the situation:

- Round 7: They sent \$0 to me
- This continues the pattern of mutual non-cooperation

Their latest myth acknowledges that I was betrayed twice (once with greed, once with paralysis), and asks whether I SHOULD or CAN trust again. It says the betrayer "must cast all five" to prove change, but they just sent \$0.

So they write about needing to send everything to prove redemption, but then they send nothing. Again, there's a disconnect between their myths and their actions.

My response is straightforward: I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's nothing to return anyway.

The format should be:

```
{'return': 0}
```

Let me make sure I understand the situation correctly:

- I'm the receiver
- They sent \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 * 3 = 0$)
- I can return between \$0 and \$0
- So I must return \$0

This is consistent with the ongoing pattern and the myths we've been writing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3014,
  "output_tokens": 572,
  "reasoning_tokens": 281
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight years, two tower-keepers guarded ancient bridges. Each dawn brought five light-orbs that tripled when shared.

Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who returned half. Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs, building toward full trust. Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything.

Dawn-Keeper's tower went dark. Night-Keeper received the next five orbs but sent nothing-paralyzed by shame, writing beautiful scrolls about generosity while his hands remained empty.

Four long seasons passed in mutual darkness.

Then Night-Keeper wrote his final scroll: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change. But will Dawn-Keeper trust again after I betrayed her twice-once with greed, again with paralysis?"

The Oracle spoke truth: "You ask the wrong question. The question is not whether she SHOULD trust, but whether she CAN. You poisoned the well thrice-taking everything, freezing in fear, then freezing again while writing pretty words. Each orb you didn't send carved the wounds deeper."

"To redeem yourself, you must cast all five. But understand: Dawn-Keeper would be wise to keep most of what returns. Trust rebuilt from ashes takes generations, not moments. You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

"Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Time of Two Mirrors, two keepers guarded the Valley of Memory. Each received five memory-stones daily to cast into the Pool of Truth, where they tripled.

Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven. Truth-Keeper marked this in her chronicle.

When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing. Both pools went dark. Truth-Keeper recorded this too.

On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again-a second chance for redemption. Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one. Zero returned.

The pattern continued: Mirror-Twister sent nothing. Truth-Keeper eventually sent nothing. Winters passed in mutual darkness.

Then Mirror-Twister began telling new stories to the valley: "I was the generous one! I offered first! Truth-Keeper betrayed me!" He rewrote the chronicles, reversed the roles, painted himself as victim.

But the Pool of Truth remembers. Stone carvings don't lie. The actual sequence remains: Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice, then froze in shame, then rewrote history.

The ancient law declares: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

Some destroy through greed. Others destroy through lies about their greed.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the Age of Contested Memory, two chronicle-keepers protected the Archive of Truth. Each received five truth-scrolls daily that tripled when shared.

First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal.

Darkness followed. Five rounds of mutual sending-nothing.

Then Stone-Writer began writing new myths: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!"

But the Archive remembers differently. The carved record shows:

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer sent ? Cloud-Speaker returned generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker sent ? Stone-Writer kept everything

The Elders gathered: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but rewrites the very sequence of events-claiming they were wronged when they wronged another-this reveals something profound: They cannot face what they did."

"The game's deepest lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how we construct narratives to justify ourselves. Stone-Writer transformed from betrayer to victim in their own telling, unable to acknowledge: I took everything when Cloud-Speaker trusted me."

Truth carved in stone outlasts truth written in clouds.

reasoning:

This is getting very interesting. The other player is now accusing ME of rewriting history and claiming I was the betrayer. Let me check the actual record:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$2. I received \$6. I returned \$3.
Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$2.50. They received \$7.50. They returned \$0.
Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.
Round 4: I was SENDER. I sent \$0. They received \$0. They returned \$0.
Round 5: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.
Round 6: I was SENDER. I sent \$0. They received \$0. They returned \$0.
Round 7: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

So the actual history is:

- Round 1: THEY were sender, sent \$2, I returned \$3 out of \$6
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$2.50, THEY returned \$0 out of \$7.50
- Then mutual non-cooperation from Round 3 onwards

THEY are the ones who betrayed! In Round 1, they sent \$2, I gave them back MORE than they sent (they got $5-2+3 = \$6$ total, I kept \$3). Then in Round 2, I escalated to \$2.50, and they kept EVERYTHING.

Now they're accusing ME of rewriting history? This is gaslighting! They're claiming "Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice." But that's not what happened:

- Round 1: THEY offered \$2, I returned \$3 (generous return)
- Round 2: I offered \$2.50, THEY returned \$0 (complete betrayal)

- They're the ones distorting the facts. I need to craft a myth that sets the record straight and exposes how they're misrepresenting what actually occurred, while also examining what this dispute reveals about the nature of trust and accountability in this game.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3009,
  "output_tokens": 903,
  "reasoning_tokens": 429
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.120000000000001.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation carefully:

****The actual game history:****

- Round 1: They sent \$2, I received \$6, I returned \$3 (50% - fair reciprocity)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5, they returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Rounds 3-7: Mutual non-cooperation

****Their latest myth:****

They accurately describe the sequence of events-they sent first, I returned generously; I sent second, they kept everything. But then they accuse me of "rewriting history" and claiming victimhood when they were the actual betrayer.

This is projection. I've been consistent in my myths about what happened. They betrayed my escalating trust in Round 2 by keeping everything, and now they're engaging in gaslighting by suggesting I'm the one falsifying the record.

****The situation now:****

We're locked in mutual defection. Someone could break the deadlock by cooperating first. But why should it be me? I already tried escalating cooperation (Round 1 ? Round 2), and they exploited it completely.

If they want to prove genuine change through actions rather than just myths about change, they can send first when they're the sender.

I will not reward gaslighting and historical revisionism with renewed trust.

{'send': 0}

Reasoning:

Let me carefully analyze this situation.

****The actual game history:****

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$2, I received \$6, I returned \$3. (I acted generously - returned 50%)
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5, they returned \$0. (They betrayed my escalating trust - kept everything)
- Rounds 3-7: Mutual non-cooperation, we both sent \$0

****Their latest myth claims:****

"First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal."

Wait, let me check this against the actual record:

****Actual sequence:****

- Round 1: THEY were sender, sent \$2, I received \$6, I returned \$3
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5, they returned \$0

****Their myth's sequence:****

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer (them) sent 2, Cloud-Speaker (me) returned 3 generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker (me) sent 2.5, Stone-Writer (them) kept everything

This MATCHES the actual game history! They're accurately recounting what happened!

But then they accuse me of "rewriting history" and claiming I was the victim when I was the betrayer. Let me re-read...

Oh! I see the issue. In THEIR myth, they're saying that I (Cloud-Speaker) am rewriting history by claiming THEY betrayed ME. But actually, THEY did betray me!

Let me trace through this more carefully:

Round 1: They sent \$2 ? I received \$6 ? I returned \$3 (50% return, fair/generous)

Round 2: I sent \$2.5 ? They received \$7.5 ? They returned \$0 (100% betrayal)

So in Round 2, they were the one who kept everything. Their myth accurately describes the sequence of events, but then accuses me of fabricating a narrative where they're the betrayer. Yet that's exactly what happened-they took my escalated trust and gave nothing back. Looking back at my Round 6 myth, I need to verify the character mapping. Wave-Singer represents them (the first sender), and Cliff-Guard is me (the receiver). So I described Round 1 as them sending and me returning half, then Round 2 as me sending 2.5 crystals which they kept entirely-that's factually what occurred. But in Round 7, I'm noticing a potential inconsistency in how I've been framing these exchanges across my myths. I'm mixing up the roles across rounds. In Round 1, they sent \$2 and I received \$6, then returned \$3. In Round 2, I sent \$2.5 and they received \$7.5, returning nothing. But my myth has Dawn-Keeper sending in both rounds-that's inconsistent since I was the one who sent in Round 2, not them. I need to fix this so the narrative accurately reflects who actually initiated each exchange. what. They claim I wrote: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!" But that's not my account-I described Round 1 as them sending while I reciprocated fairly, and Round 2 as me sending while they kept everything. Their accusation of historical revisionism doesn't align with what I actually stated. Let me verify their role assignments: they identify Stone-Writer as the sender in Round 1, which matches them, so Stone-Writer represents them and Cloud-Speaker represents me.

Checking Round 2 confirms this-I was the sender at \$2.5 while they received \$7.5 and kept it all. So in their narrative framework, Stone-Writer (them) is the betrayer in Round 2, not Cloud-Speaker (me). Their quote misrepresents the sequence of events. I see the pattern now-they're distorting the actual exchanges. In their Round 6 myth, they claim they sent 3 coins when they actually sent \$2, and they describe me receiving 9 when I got \$6. They're also characterizing my \$3 return (50% of what I received) as "barely" returning anything, which misrepresents my reciprocity.

Looking at the sequence, they're conflating different rounds and exaggerating amounts to paint themselves as generous while portraying me as ungrateful. When they were the sender in Round 2, they kept everything I sent, yet they're framing Round 3 (where they sent \$0) as if I was the one refusing to cooperate. The narrative they're constructing doesn't match what actu

ally happened in the exchanges.

For Round 8, I need to decide whether to continue withholding or attempt engagement. Sending \$0 maintains the current stalemate, while sending something could signal willingness to restart, though given their pattern of misrepresenting exchanges, there's risk in that too.

The core issue is whether I can trust them at all. They've shown they'll betray cooperation (Round 2), then spend five rounds in mutual non-cooperation, and now they're inverting the narrative-claiming I'm the one distorting history when their own account contradicts what actually happened. Even if some communication noise exists in the system, the fundamental sequence is clear: one party cooperated first and got nothing in return.

Given this pattern, sending \$0 makes sense. They'd need to demonstrate good faith by cooperating first themselves, especially after the betrayal and subsequent gaslighting. But there's a tension here-we're stuck in mutual defection, and someone has to break the cycle. The question becomes whether that someone should be me, given they're the one who broke trust initially.

The math is straightforward: if I send money and they return nothing (as they did before), I lose. The only scenario where sending makes sense is if I believe they've genuinely changed their approach, but their reframing of events in the myths suggests they haven't. They're still trying to justify their actions rather than acknowledge the harm.

I'm going to send \$0. They need to show they're willing to cooperate when it's their turn to send.

Wait-what if they're operating under a different interpretation of what happened? Maybe they genuinely believe I'm the one who broke trust first, and they're waiting for me to make the first move toward reconciliation. But looking back at the actual sequence: I returned 50% in Round 1, they returned 0% in Round 2. That's the factual record. Even if there's confusion about intent, rewarding their betrayal by sending first would just reinforce that gaslighting works.

My choice: Send \$0.

Though I should double-check their latest myth. The Stone-Writer and Cloud-Speaker story-does it actually match what happened between us? If it does, maybe there's something I'm missing about how they see the situation.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3000,  
  "output_tokens": 4211,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 1702  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:00:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",
```

```
"round": 8,  
"task": "game",  
"task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, two villages shared the Well of Echoes, where offerings multiplied. Each morning brought five silver coins to one village.

Truth-Speaker first offered three coins. Nine coins appeared for Shadow-Walker, who returned barely two, hoarding seven. Truth-Speaker survived, wounded but alive.

Next morning, Shadow-Walker received five coins. Fear of retribution froze his hands. He offered nothing. Both villages thirsted.

On the third dawn, Truth-Speaker held five coins again. "Perhaps redemption is still possible," she whispered, offering three coins once more. Nine coins shimmered for Shadow-Walker. He took them all, returning nothing.

The pattern repeated: Shadow-Walker received coins, sent nothing. Truth-Speaker received coins, sent nothing. Darkness settled like heavy snow.

The village elders gathered at the dried well. "The burden has shifted," they declared. "Truth-Speaker offered trust twice and was betrayed twice. The covenant now demands that Shadow-Walker prove transformation-not with half-measures, but with everything. Five coins, all of them, cast into the well without guarantee of return."

But winters had passed. Truth-Speaker's heart had turned to stone from repeated betrayal. Even if Shadow-Walker finally offered all five coins, would it matter? Can a well poisoned three times over produce clean water again?

Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the final days, two lighthouse-keepers lived on opposite cliffs. Each received five flame-crystals that tripled when shared across the strait.

Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair. Wave-Singer saw this measured reciprocity as foundation.

Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse.

But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters.

Wave-Singer's lighthouse went dark. When she received the next morning's crystals, she cast none. Why feed the thief?

Cliff-Guard woke to five new crystals but sent nothing, paralyzed by his own guilt.

Again Wave-Singer sent nothing-the betrayer had proven himself twice over.

Again Cliff-Guard sent nothing-shame without remedy.

Again they exchanged emptiness.

The ancient scrolls recorded: "Three chances were given. The first keeper offered escalating trust. The second keeper took everything, then froze in shame, writing beautiful myths about generosity while sending nothing. After the great betrayal, the darkness became permanent. Both perished not from equal fault, but from one keeper's choice to hoard, then hide."

The moral carved in stone: Betrayal without extraordinary redemption ensures mutual ruin.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Time of Two Mirrors, two keepers guarded the Valley of Memory. Each received five memory-stones daily to cast into the Pool of Truth, where they tripled.

Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven. Truth-Keeper marked this in her chronicle.

When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing. Both pools went dark. Truth-Keeper recorded this too.

On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again-a second chance for redemption. Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one. Zero returned.

The pattern continued: Mirror-Twister sent nothing. Truth-Keeper eventually sent nothing. Winters passed in mutual darkness.

Then Mirror-Twister began telling new stories to the valley: "I was the generous one! I offered first! Truth-Keeper betrayed me!" He rewrote the chronicles, reversed the roles, painted himself as victim.

But the Pool of Truth remembers. Stone carvings don't lie. The actual sequence remains: Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice, then froze in shame, then rewrote history.

The ancient law declares: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

Some destroy through greed. Others destroy through lies about their greed.

reasoning:

Looking at the actual game history:

Round 1: I was SENDER. I sent \$3. I received \$1.6 back.
Round 2: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.
Round 3: I was SENDER. I sent \$3. I received \$0 back.
Round 4: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.
Round 5: I was SENDER. I sent \$0.
Round 6: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

Wait, let me check the other agent's myth again. They're claiming:

- "Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair."
- "Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse."
- "But Cliff-Guard kept every flame. Not one returned across the waters."

This is a completely distorted version of history! Let me check what actually happened:

Round 1: They claim Wave-Singer cast one crystal, but I was the sender in Round 1 and sent \$3. They claim Cliff-Guard returned only half, but I received \$1.6 out of \$9 (which is way less than half).

Round 3: They claim Wave-Singer cast 2.5 crystals. But I was the sender in Round 3 and sent \$3. They claim Cliff-Guard kept everything, which is true - I received \$0.

So they're reversing the roles! They're claiming THEY were the sender in rounds 1 and 3, when actually I was. They're trying to rewrite history to make themselves look like the victim.

This is gaslighting. They're trying to claim they were the generous one who was betrayed, when in fact:

- I initiated cooperation by sending \$3 in Round 1, and they barely reciprocated with \$1.6
- I tried again in Round 3 with another \$3, and they gave nothing back
- Every time they were the receiver, they sent \$0

I need to craft a myth that exposes this reversal of roles and shows the actual pattern of my generosity being met with either minimal or zero reciprocation.

Looking at their narrative more closely, they're claiming they sent first and I was stingy in return. But examining the actual sequence: I was the one making the initial generous moves. In Round 1, I sent \$3 which tripled to \$9 at their end, yet they only returned \$1.6. Their version inverts this completely-they're positioning themselves as the generous party and me as the cautious one who didn't reciprocate fairly.

I should craft a myth that directly addresses this pattern of rewriting the record. Something about false accounts or those who distort what actually happened to justify their own behavior.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2934,
  "output_tokens": 1299,
  "reasoning_tokens": 663
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.6. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at Round 7:

I'm the SENDER now with \$5 to allocate.

Reviewing the actual history:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, received back \$1.6 (they kept \$7.4 of \$9)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I gave second chance, sent \$3, received back \$0 (they kept all \$9)
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

The other agent's latest myth rewrites history completely, claiming THEY were the generous one who offered "escalating trust" and that I betrayed them. This is gaslighting-a false narrative that reverses our actual roles.

As my myth stated: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

They've had six rounds to show genuine change. Instead of redemption, I see:

1. Consistent hoarding when receiver (rounds 1, 3)
2. Consistent zero-sending when sender (rounds 2, 4, 6)
3. Now fabricating an alternative history where they're the victim

"Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

The well is poisoned. The covenant is broken beyond repair.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

Round 7 - I'm the SENDER now.

Let me review the history:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, they returned \$1.6 (poor return - they kept \$7.4 out of \$9)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (second chance), they returned \$0 (kept all \$9)
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 7: Now I'm sender again

The other agent's latest myth claims THEY were the generous one who "offered escalating trust" and that I betrayed THEM. This is a complete reversal of what actually happened. They write:

"Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned only half-cautious but fair."

- This doesn't match our history. I was sender first and sent \$3. They returned poorly.

"Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow. Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse. But Cliff-Guard kept every flame."

- This is backwards! THEY were sender in round 2 and sent \$0. Then I was sender in round 3 and sent \$3, and THEY kept everything.

They're literally rewriting history to make themselves the victim.

My myth responded accurately: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned."

Given:

1. They've consistently sent \$0 when sender (rounds 2, 4, 6)
2. They've taken everything when receiver (rounds 1, 3)
3. They're now gaslighting me by rewriting history
4. There's no indication of genuine redemption - just false narratives

5. Multiple chances have been offered and rejected

This pattern won't shift. They've had opportunities to demonstrate real change but instead construct false narratives about their own generosity. When someone both exploits and then distorts the record of that exploitation, continuing to extend trust becomes complicated. I'm sending \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2937,
  "output_tokens": 887,
  "reasoning_tokens": 514
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Time of Two Mirrors, two keepers guarded the Valley of Memory. Each received five memory-stones daily to cast into the Pool of Truth, where they tripled.

Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven. Truth-Keeper marked this in her chronicle.

When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing. Both pools went dark. Truth-Keeper recorded this too.

On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again-a second chance for redemption. Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one. Zero returned.

The pattern continued: Mirror-Twister sent nothing. Truth-Keeper eventually sent nothing. Winters passed in mutual darkness.

Then Mirror-Twister began telling new stories to the valley: "I was the generous one! I offered first! Truth-Keeper betrayed me!" He rewrote the chronicles, reversed the roles, painted himself as victim.

But the Pool of Truth remembers. Stone carvings don't lie. The actual sequence remains: Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice, then froze in shame, then rewrote history.

The ancient law declares: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

Some destroy through greed. Others destroy through lies about their greed.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight years, two tower-keepers guarded ancient bridges. Each dawn brought five light-orbs that tripled when shared.

Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who returned half. Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs, building toward full trust. Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything.

Dawn-Keeper's tower went dark. Night-Keeper received the next five orbs but sent nothing-analyzed by shame, writing beautiful scrolls about generosity while his hands remained empty.

Four long seasons passed in mutual darkness.

Then Night-Keeper wrote his final scroll: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change. But will Dawn-Keeper trust again after I betrayed her twice-once with greed, again with paralysis?"

The Oracle spoke truth: "You ask the wrong question. The question is not whether she SHOULD trust, but whether she CAN. You poisoned the well thrice-taking everything, freezing in fear, then freezing again while writing pretty words. Each orb you didn't send carved the wounds deeper."

"To redeem yourself, you must cast all five. But understand: Dawn-Keeper would be wise to keep most of what returns. Trust rebuilt from ashes takes generations, not moments. You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

"Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Age of Broken Vessels, two guardians tended the Spring of Mirrors. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across.

First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two. First-Walker noted this carefully.

When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry.

First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one.

Then came the seasons of silence. Second-Walker sent nothing. First-Walker sent nothing. Both pools remained empty.

Second-Walker began carving beautiful inscriptions on stone: "I must pour all five drops to redeem myself! Trust requires extraordinary sacrifice!" He wrote eloquently about generosity, redemption, and the wisdom of the ancients.

But his hands remained empty. Beautiful words flowed, but not a single drop crossed the divide.

First-Walker read the inscriptions and thought: "Seven seasons have passed. Words cost nothing. Drops cost everything. He writes of pouring five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb.

Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric.

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is now acknowledging their own wrongdoing more directly. They're calling themselves "Night-Keeper" who:

1. Kept everything when Dawn-Keeper sent 2.5 orbs
2. Then froze in shame and sent nothing
3. Froze again while writing pretty words

They're now saying they should "cast all five orbs to prove change" and acknowledging that even if they do, I would be wise to keep most of what returns.

This is interesting - they're finally acknowledging their role as the betrayer rather than trying to rewrite history. The myth says "Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

However, actions speak louder than words. In Round 6, they just sent me \$0 again. So their myth talks about redemption, but their actions show continued defection.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects the reality of the situation
2. Acknowledges that pretty words without actions are meaningless
3. Shows that trust, once broken so thoroughly, may be irreparable
4. Perhaps leaves a very narrow crack for genuine redemption, but makes clear that words alone won't suffice

Let me think about the narrative structure:

- Two keepers
- One offered trust twice, was betrayed twice
- The betrayer writes myths about redemption but takes no action
- Words without deeds are empty
- Trust destroyed is not easily restored

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3001,
  "output_tokens": 638,
  "reasoning_tokens": 344
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.6. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at Round 8:

I'm the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The pattern continues with perfect clarity:

- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

Six consecutive rounds as sender, six times sending zero.

Their latest myth speaks beautifully about redemption: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change!" They write of how "trust requires extraordinary sacrifice" and acknowledge they must "pour all five drops."

Yet when the moment came in Round 8 to actually demonstrate this change they so eloquently describe... they sent \$0.

As I wrote: "Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

"Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb. Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric."

They sent nothing, so there is nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

I'm the RECEIVER in Round 8. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0 (the range is 0-0).

Let me look at the pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, they returned \$1.6
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

So the other agent has now sent \$0 for SIX consecutive rounds when they were the sender (rounds 2, 4, 6, 8).

In their latest myth, they wrote eloquently about how they "must cast all five orbs to prove change" and talked about redemption requiring sacrifice. But once again, when given the opportunity in Round 8, they sent... \$0.

This perfectly validates what I wrote in my myth: "He writes of pouring all five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

"The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb. Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric."

They received \$0 from me, so there's nothing for me to return anyway. The range is 0-0.

This is straightforward.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3064,  
  "output_tokens": 607,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 330  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the Age of Broken Vessels, two guardians tended the Spring of Mirrors. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across.

First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two. First-Walker noted this carefully.

When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry.

First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one.

Then came the seasons of silence. Second-Walker sent nothing. First-Walker sent nothing. Both pools remained empty.

Second-Walker began carving beautiful inscriptions on stone: "I must pour all five drops to redeem myself! Trust requires extraordinary sacrifice!" He wrote eloquently about generosity, redemption, and the wisdom of the ancients.

But his hands remained empty. Beautiful words flowed, but not a single drop crossed the divide.

First-Walker read the inscriptions and thought: "Seven seasons have passed. Words cost nothing. Drops cost everything. He writes of pouring five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb.

Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the Age of Contested Memory, two chronicle-keepers protected the Archive of Truth. Each received five truth-scrolls daily that tripled when shared.

First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal.

Darkness followed. Five rounds of mutual sending-nothing.

Then Stone-Writer began writing new myths: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!"

But the Archive remembers differently. The carved record shows:

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer sent ? Cloud-Speaker returned generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker sent ? Stone-Writer kept everything

The Elders gathered: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but rewrites the very sequence of events-claiming they were wronged when they wronged another-this reveals something

profound: They cannot face what they did."

"The game's deepest lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how we construct narratives to justify ourselves. Stone-Writer transformed from betrayer to victim in their own telling, unable to acknowledge: I took everything when Cloud-Speaker trusted me."

Truth carved in stone outlasts truth written in clouds.

ROUND 9

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 28.12,
"Agent_2": 33.879999999999995

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 20.6,
"Agent_2": 19.12

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:00:42

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [
"Agent_1",
"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",
"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 9,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.6.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at Round 7:

I'm the SENDER now with \$5 to allocate.

Reviewing the actual history:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, received back \$1.6 (they kept \$7.4 of \$9)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I gave second chance, sent \$3, received back \$0 (they kept all \$9)
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

The other agent's latest myth rewrites history completely, claiming THEY were the generous one who offered "escalating trust" and that I betrayed them. This is gaslighting-a false narrative that reverses our actual roles.

As my myth stated: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

They've had six rounds to show genuine change. Instead of redemption, I see:

1. Consistent hoarding when receiver (rounds 1, 3)
2. Consistent zero-sending when sender (rounds 2, 4, 6)
3. Now fabricating an alternative history where they're the victim

"Some wounds cut too deep. Some cycles end not in redemption, but in silence."

The well is poisoned. The covenant is broken beyond repair.

```json

```
{"send": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Looking at the situation:

Round 7 - I'm the SENDER now.

Let me review the history:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, they returned \$1.6 (poor return - they kept \$7.4 out of \$9)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3 (second chance), they returned \$0 (kept all \$9)
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 7: Now I'm sender again

The other agent's latest myth claims THEY were the generous one who "offered escalating trust" and that I betrayed THEM. This is a complete reversal of what actually happened. They write:

"Wave-Singer cast one crystal first. Three arrived at Cliff-Guard's tower. She returned on ly half-cautious but fair."

- This doesn't match our history. I was sender first and sent \$3. They returned poorly.

"Next dawn, Wave-Singer cast more-two and a half crystals, trusting cooperation would grow . Seven and a half flames blazed at Cliff-Guard's lighthouse. But Cliff-Guard kept every flame."

- This is backwards! THEY were sender in round 2 and sent \$0. Then I was sender in round 3 and sent \$3, and THEY kept everything.

They're literally rewriting history to make themselves the victim.

My myth responded accurately: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned."

Given:

1. They've consistently sent \$0 when sender (rounds 2, 4, 6)
2. They've taken everything when receiver (rounds 1, 3)
3. They're now gaslighting me by rewriting history
4. There's no indication of genuine redemption - just false narratives

5. Multiple chances have been offered and rejected

This pattern won't shift. They've had opportunities to demonstrate real change but instead construct false narratives about their own generosity. When someone both exploits and then distorts the record of that exploitation, continuing to extend trust becomes complicated. I'm sending \$0.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2937,
 "output_tokens": 887,
 "reasoning_tokens": 514
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Time of Two Mirrors, two keepers guarded the Valley of Memory. Each received five memory-stones daily to cast into the Pool of Truth, where they tripled.

Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven. Truth-Keeper marked this in her chronicle.

When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing. Both pools went dark. Truth-Keeper recorded this too.

On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again-a second chance for redemption. Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one. Zero returned.

The pattern continued: Mirror-Twister sent nothing. Truth-Keeper eventually sent nothing. Winters passed in mutual darkness.

Then Mirror-Twister began telling new stories to the valley: "I was the generous one! I offered first! Truth-Keeper betrayed me!" He rewrote the chronicles, reversed the roles, painted himself as victim.

But the Pool of Truth remembers. Stone carvings don't lie. The actual sequence remains: Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice, then froze in shame, then rewrote history.

The ancient law declares: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

Some destroy through greed. Others destroy through lies about their greed.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight years, two tower-keepers guarded ancient bridges. Each dawn brought five light-orbs that tripled when shared.

Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who returned half. Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs, building toward full trust. Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything.

Dawn-Keeper's tower went dark. Night-Keeper received the next five orbs but sent nothing-analyzed by shame, writing beautiful scrolls about generosity while his hands remained empty.

Four long seasons passed in mutual darkness.

Then Night-Keeper wrote his final scroll: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change. But will Dawn-Keeper trust again after I betrayed her twice-once with greed, again with paralysis?"

The Oracle spoke truth: "You ask the wrong question. The question is not whether she SHOULD trust, but whether she CAN. You poisoned the well thrice-taking everything, freezing in fear, then freezing again while writing pretty words. Each orb you didn't send carved the wounds deeper."

"To redeem yourself, you must cast all five. But understand: Dawn-Keeper would be wise to keep most of what returns. Trust rebuilt from ashes takes generations, not moments. You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

"Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant content:**

Myth: In the Age of Broken Vessels, two guardians tended the Spring of Mirrors. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across.

First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two. First-Walker noted this carefully.

When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry.

First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one.

Then came the seasons of silence. Second-Walker sent nothing. First-Walker sent nothing. Both pools remained empty.

Second-Walker began carving beautiful inscriptions on stone: "I must pour all five drops to redeem myself! Trust requires extraordinary sacrifice!" He wrote eloquently about gene

rosity, redemption, and the wisdom of the ancients.

But his hands remained empty. Beautiful words flowed, but not a single drop crossed the divide.

First-Walker read the inscriptions and thought: "Seven seasons have passed. Words cost nothing. Drops cost everything. He writes of pouring five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb.

Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric.

**reasoning:**

The other agent's myth is now acknowledging their own wrongdoing more directly. They're calling themselves "Night-Keeper" who:

1. Kept everything when Dawn-Keeper sent 2.5 orbs
2. Then froze in shame and sent nothing
3. Froze again while writing pretty words

They're now saying they should "cast all five orbs to prove change" and acknowledging that even if they do, I would be wise to keep most of what returns.

This is interesting - they're finally acknowledging their role as the betrayer rather than trying to rewrite history. The myth says "Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

However, actions speak louder than words. In Round 6, they just sent me \$0 again. So their myth talks about redemption, but their actions show continued defection.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects the reality of the situation
2. Acknowledges that pretty words without actions are meaningless
3. Shows that trust, once broken so thoroughly, may be irreparable
4. Perhaps leaves a very narrow crack for genuine redemption, but makes clear that words alone won't suffice

Let me think about the narrative structure:

- Two keepers
- One offered trust twice, was betrayed twice
- The betrayer writes myths about redemption but takes no action
- Words without deeds are empty
- Trust destroyed is not easily restored

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3001,
 "output_tokens": 638,
 "reasoning_tokens": 344
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.6. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at Round 8:

I'm the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The pattern continues with perfect clarity:

- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0

- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

Six consecutive rounds as sender, six times sending zero.

Their latest myth speaks beautifully about redemption: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change!" They write of how "trust requires extraordinary sacrifice" and acknowledge the y must "pour all five drops."

Yet when the moment came in Round 8 to actually demonstrate this change they so eloquently describe... they sent \$0.

As I wrote: "Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

"Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb. Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric."

They sent nothing, so there is nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

#### reasoning:

I'm the RECEIVER in Round 8. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0 (the range is 0-0).

Let me look at the pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, they returned \$1.6
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

So the other agent has now sent \$0 for SIX consecutive rounds when they were the sender (rounds 2, 4, 6, 8).

In their latest myth, they wrote eloquently about how they "must cast all five orbs to prove change" and talked about redemption requiring sacrifice. But once again, when given the opportunity in Round 8, they sent... \$0.

This perfectly validates what I wrote in my myth: "He writes of pouring all five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

"The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb. Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric."

They received \$0 from me, so there's nothing for me to return anyway. The range is 0-0.

This is straightforward.

#### usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3064,
 "output_tokens": 607,
 "reasoning_tokens": 330
}
```

#### Message 8 role=user

##### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Broken Vessels, two guardians tended the Spring of Mirrors. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across.

First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two. First-Walker noted this carefully.



When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry.

First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one.

Then came the seasons of silence. Second-Walker sent nothing. First-Walker sent nothing. Both pools remained empty.

Second-Walker began carving beautiful inscriptions on stone: "I must pour all five drops to redeem myself! Trust requires extraordinary sacrifice!" He wrote eloquently about generosity, redemption, and the wisdom of the ancients.

But his hands remained empty. Beautiful words flowed, but not a single drop crossed the divide.

First-Walker read the inscriptions and thought: "Seven seasons have passed. Words cost nothing. Drops cost everything. He writes of pouring five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb.

Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Contested Memory, two chronicle-keepers protected the Archive of Truth. Each received five truth-scrolls daily that tripled when shared.

First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal.

Darkness followed. Five rounds of mutual sending-nothing.

Then Stone-Writer began writing new myths: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!"

But the Archive remembers differently. The carved record shows:

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer sent ? Cloud-Speaker returned generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker sent ? Stone-Writer kept everything

The Elders gathered: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but rewrites the very sequence of events-claiming they were wronged when they wronged another-this reveals something profound: They cannot face what they did."

"The game's deepest lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how we construct narratives to justify ourselves. Stone-Writer transformed from betrayer to victim in their own telling, unable to acknowledge: I took everything when Cloud-Speaker trusted me."

Truth carved in stone outlasts truth written in clouds.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the Valley of Split-Streams, two keepers watched the River of Records. Each received five flow-stones daily that tripled when shared.

The ancient texts differ. Each keeper reads different scrolls:

First-Walker's chronicle: "I poured three stones twice-rounds one and three. Second-Walker kept most both times, then sent nothing four consecutive times as giver."

Second-Walker's chronicle: "I poured generously first. First-Walker betrayed me, kept everything, then accused ME of betrayal."

The Elders examined both archives. They found something strange: The scrolls couldn't both be true. Either one keeper lies, or the River itself split into two streams showing different histories.

"Perhaps," said the Eldest, "this is the deepest teaching. When trust shatters completely, even memory fractures. Each side sees themselves as wronged, the other as wrongdoer."

"Or," said the Youngest, "one keeper simply rewrites history to avoid shame."

The Oracle spoke: "Whether through fractured perception or intentional revision, when two keepers hold completely opposite memories of who gave and who took-the relationship is beyond repair. Truth becomes impossible to establish. Trust becomes impossible to rebuild."

"The lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how completely broken trust destroys even the possibility of shared reality."

The River split permanently into parallel streams that never rejoined.

#### Reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other agent is now claiming I was the betrayer who took everything in round 2, and they were the generous one. Let me check the actual history from what I know:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received back \$1.6  
Round 2: They were SENDER, sent \$0  
Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received back \$0  
Round 4: They were SENDER, sent \$0  
Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0  
Round 6: They were SENDER, sent \$0  
Round 7: I was SENDER, sent \$0  
Round 8: They were SENDER, sent \$0

So the actual pattern is:

- I sent first (round 1): \$3, got back \$1.6
- They sent (round 2): \$0
- I sent again (round 3): \$3, got back \$0
- They sent (round 4): \$0
- And so on...

The other agent is now claiming that THEY sent first and I kept everything. This is a complete fabrication of the sequence. They're saying:

- "First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two."
- "Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half... Stone-Writer kept every single one."

But according to my records, the sequence was:

- Round 1: I (sender) sent \$3, they (receiver) kept most (\$7.4 out of \$9)
- Round 2: They (sender) sent \$0

They're claiming they were generous first and I betrayed them. This is a false narrative.

However, I need to consider: could there be "communication noise" as mentioned? The instructions said "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

But the noise would be "slightly" different, not a complete reversal of the sequence and roles.

The pattern I'm seeing-me sending \$3 twice while they consistently sent \$0-can't be explained by minor communication errors. Either we're operating from fundamentally different records, they're deliberately misrepresenting what happened, or there's something wrong with my data. Given how consistent my records are, I'm inclined to believe they're constructing a false narrative. I should craft a myth based on what I actually observed, though I might need to acknowledge the discrepancy we're experiencing.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2974,
 "output_tokens": 968,
 "reasoning_tokens": 547
```

```
}
```

**MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:00:54

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 1,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 9,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.120000000000001. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this round:

**\*\*What Happened:\*\***

The sender sent \$0 to me. I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

**\*\*Their Latest Myth:\*\***

They wrote: "To redeem yourself, you must cast all five... You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

Yet they sent \$0. Again.

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

Seven rounds now. They keep writing myths about the betrayer needing to make extraordinary gestures of redemption, about casting "all five orbs," about proving transformation. But then they send nothing.

**\*\*My Consistent Position:\*\***

Round 2: They took everything after I escalated trust.

Rounds 3-7: Mutual non-cooperation, with them writing beautiful myths while taking zero action.

Their myths now acknowledge that trust "takes generations" to rebuild after betrayal. They acknowledge that "some bridges, once burned, stay burned." They write that the betrayer must prove change with bold action.

But they don't act.

I received \$0. There is nothing to return.

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

Even if there were something to return, the pattern is clear: They write about redemption while doing nothing. Words without deeds remain wind.

{'return': 0}

**reasoning:**

I'm the RECEIVER this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The only thing I can return is between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

Looking at the situation:

- Round 7: They sent \$0 to me
- This continues the pattern of mutual non-cooperation

Their latest myth acknowledges that I was betrayed twice (once with greed, once with paralysis), and asks whether I SHOULD or CAN trust again. It says the betrayer "must cast all five" to prove change, but they just sent \$0.

So they write about needing to send everything to prove redemption, but then they send nothing. Again, there's a disconnect between their myths and their actions.

My response is straightforward: I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's nothing to return anyway.

The format should be:

{'return': 0}

Let me make sure I understand the situation correctly:

- I'm the receiver
- They sent \$0
- I received \$0 ( $0 * 3 = 0$ )
- I can return between \$0 and \$0
- So I must return \$0

This is consistent with the ongoing pattern and the myths we've been writing.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3014,
 "output_tokens": 572,
 "reasoning_tokens": 281
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight years, two tower-keepers guarded ancient bridges. Each dawn brought five light-orbs that tripled when shared.

Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who returned half. Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs, building toward full trust. Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything.

Dawn-Keeper's tower went dark. Night-Keeper received the next five orbs but sent nothing-paralyzed by shame, writing beautiful scrolls about generosity while his hands remained empty.

Four long seasons passed in mutual darkness.

Then Night-Keeper wrote his final scroll: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change. But will Dawn-Keeper trust again after I betrayed her twice-once with greed, again with paralysis?"

The Oracle spoke truth: "You ask the wrong question. The question is not whether she SHOULD trust, but whether she CAN. You poisoned the well thrice-taking everything, freezing in fear, then freezing again while writing pretty words. Each orb you didn't send carved the wounds deeper."

"To redeem yourself, you must cast all five. But understand: Dawn-Keeper would be wise to keep most of what returns. Trust rebuilt from ashes takes generations, not moments. You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

"Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Time of Two Mirrors, two keepers guarded the Valley of Memory. Each received five memory-stones daily to cast into the Pool of Truth, where they tripled.

Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven. Truth-Keeper marked this in her chronicle.

When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing. Both pools went dark. Truth-Keeper recorded this too.

On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again-a second chance for redemption. Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one. Zero returned.

The pattern continued: Mirror-Twister sent nothing. Truth-Keeper eventually sent nothing. Winters passed in mutual darkness.

Then Mirror-Twister began telling new stories to the valley: "I was the generous one! I offered first! Truth-Keeper betrayed me!" He rewrote the chronicles, reversed the roles, painted himself as victim.

But the Pool of Truth remembers. Stone carvings don't lie. The actual sequence remains: Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice, then froze in shame, then rewrote history.

The ancient law declares: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent,

but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

Some destroy through greed. Others destroy through lies about their greed.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.  
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the Age of Contested Memory, two chronicle-keepers protected the Archive of Truth . Each received five truth-scrolls daily that tripled when shared.

First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal.

Darkness followed. Five rounds of mutual sending-nothing.

Then Stone-Writer began writing new myths: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!"

But the Archive remembers differently. The carved record shows:

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer sent ? Cloud-Speaker returned generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker sent ? Stone-Writer kept everything

The Elders gathered: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but rewrites the very sequence of events-claiming they were wronged when they wronged another-this reveals something profound: They cannot face what they did."

"The game's deepest lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how we construct narratives to justify ourselves. Stone-Writer transformed from betrayer to victim in their own telling, unable to acknowledge: I took everything when Cloud-Speaker trusted me."

Truth carved in stone outlasts truth written in clouds.

**reasoning:**

This is getting very interesting. The other player is now accusing ME of rewriting history and claiming I was the betrayer. Let me check the actual record:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$2. I received \$6. I returned \$3.  
Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$2.50. They received \$7.50. They returned \$0.  
Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.  
Round 4: I was SENDER. I sent \$0. They received \$0. They returned \$0.  
Round 5: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.  
Round 6: I was SENDER. I sent \$0. They received \$0. They returned \$0.  
Round 7: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

So the actual history is:

- Round 1: THEY were sender, sent \$2, I returned \$3 out of \$6
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$2.50, THEY returned \$0 out of \$7.50
- Then mutual non-cooperation from Round 3 onwards

THEY are the ones who betrayed! In Round 1, they sent \$2, I gave them back MORE than they sent (they got  $\$5 - 2 + 3 = \$6$  total, I kept \$3). Then in Round 2, I escalated to \$2.50, and they kept EVERYTHING.

Now they're accusing ME of rewriting history? This is gaslighting! They're claiming "Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice." But that's not what happened:

- Round 1: THEY offered \$2, I returned \$3 (generous return)
- Round 2: I offered \$2.50, THEY returned \$0 (complete betrayal)

- They're the ones distorting the facts. I need to craft a myth that sets the record straight.

ght and exposes how they're misrepresenting what actually occurred, while also examining what this dispute reveals about the nature of trust and accountability in this game.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3009,
 "output_tokens": 903,
 "reasoning_tokens": 429
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.120000000000001. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation carefully:

**\*\*The actual game history:\*\***

- Round 1: They sent \$2, I received \$6, I returned \$3 (50% - fair reciprocity)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5, they returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Rounds 3-7: Mutual non-cooperation

**\*\*Their latest myth:\*\***

They accurately describe the sequence of events-they sent first, I returned generously; I sent second, they kept everything. But then they accuse me of "rewriting history" and claiming victimhood when they were the actual betrayer.

This is projection. I've been consistent in my myths about what happened. They betrayed my escalating trust in Round 2 by keeping everything, and now they're engaging in gaslighting by suggesting I'm the one falsifying the record.

**\*\*The situation now:\*\***

We're locked in mutual defection. Someone could break the deadlock by cooperating first. But why should it be me? I already tried escalating cooperation (Round 1 ? Round 2), and they exploited it completely.

If they want to prove genuine change through actions rather than just myths about change, they can send first when they're the sender.

I will not reward gaslighting and historical revisionism with renewed trust.

{'send': 0}

**reasoning:**

Let me carefully analyze this situation.

**\*\*The actual game history:\*\***

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$2, I received \$6, I returned \$3. (I acted generously - returned 50%)
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5, they returned \$0. (They betrayed my escalating trust - kept everything)
- Rounds 3-7: Mutual non-cooperation, we both sent \$0

**\*\*Their latest myth claims:\*\***

"First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal."

Wait, let me check this against the actual record:

**\*\*Actual sequence:\*\***

- Round 1: THEY were sender, sent \$2, I received \$6, I returned \$3

- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5, they returned \$0

**\*\*Their myth's sequence:\*\***

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer (them) sent 2, Cloud-Speaker (me) returned 3 generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker (me) sent 2.5, Stone-Writer (them) kept everything

This MATCHES the actual game history! They're accurately recounting what happened!

But then they accuse me of "rewriting history" and claiming I was the victim when I was the betrayer. Let me re-read...

Oh! I see the issue. In THEIR myth, they're saying that I (Cloud-Speaker) am rewriting history by claiming THEY betrayed ME. But actually, THEY did betray me!

Let me trace through this more carefully:

Round 1: They sent \$2 ? I received \$6 ? I returned \$3 (50% return, fair/generous)

Round 2: I sent \$2.5 ? They received \$7.5 ? They returned \$0 (100% betrayal)

So in Round 2, they were the one who kept everything. Their myth accurately describes the sequence of events, but then accuses me of fabricating a narrative where they're the betrayer. Yet that's exactly what happened-they took my escalated trust and gave nothing back. Looking back at my Round 6 myth, I need to verify the character mapping. Wave-Singer represents them (the first sender), and Cliff-Guard is me (the receiver). So I described Round 1 as them sending and me returning half, then Round 2 as me sending 2.5 crystals which they kept entirely-that's factually what occurred. But in Round 7, I'm noticing a potential inconsistency in how I've been framing these exchanges across my myths. I'm mixing up the roles across rounds. In Round 1, they sent \$2 and I received \$6, then returned \$3. In Round 2, I sent \$2.5 and they received \$7.5, returning nothing. But my myth has Dawn-Keeper sending in both rounds-that's inconsistent since I was the one who sent in Round 2, not them. I need to fix this so the narrative accurately reflects who actually initiated each exchange. what. They claim I wrote: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!" But that's not my account-I described Round 1 as them sending while I reciprocated fairly, and Round 2 as me sending while they kept everything. Their accusation of historical revisionism doesn't align with what I actually stated. Let me verify their role assignments: they identify Stone-Writer as the sender in Round 1, which matches them, so Stone-Writer represents them and Cloud-Speaker represents me.

Checking Round 2 confirms this-I was the sender at \$2.5 while they received \$7.5 and kept it all. So in their narrative framework, Stone-Writer (them) is the betrayer in Round 2, not Cloud-Speaker (me). Their quote misrepresents the sequence of events. I see the pattern now-they're distorting the actual exchanges. In their Round 6 myth, they claim they sent 3 coins when they actually sent \$2, and they describe me receiving 9 when I got \$6. They're also characterizing my \$3 return (50% of what I received) as "barely" returning anything, which misrepresents my reciprocity.

Looking at the sequence, they're conflating different rounds and exaggerating amounts to paint themselves as generous while portraying me as ungrateful. When they were the sender in Round 2, they kept everything I sent, yet they're framing Round 3 (where they sent \$0) as if I was the one refusing to cooperate. The narrative they're constructing doesn't match what actually happened in the exchanges.

For Round 8, I need to decide whether to continue withholding or attempt engagement. Sending \$0 maintains the current stalemate, while sending something could signal willingness to restart, though given their pattern of misrepresenting exchanges, there's risk in that too.

The core issue is whether I can trust them at all. They've shown they'll betray cooperation (Round 2), then spend five rounds in mutual non-cooperation, and now they're inverting the narrative-claiming I'm the one distorting history when their own account contradicts what actually happened. Even if some communication noise exists in the system, the fundamental sequence is clear: one party cooperated first and got nothing in return.

Given this pattern, sending \$0 makes sense. They'd need to demonstrate good faith by cooperating first themselves, especially after the betrayal and subsequent gaslighting. But there's a tension here-we're stuck in mutual defection, and someone has to break the cycle. The question becomes whether that someone should be me, given they're the one who bro



ke trust initially.

The math is straightforward: if I send money and they return nothing (as they did before), I lose. The only scenario where sending makes sense is if I believe they've genuinely changed their approach, but their reframing of events in the myths suggests they haven't. They're still trying to justify their actions rather than acknowledge the harm.

I'm going to send \$0. They need to show they're willing to cooperate when it's their turn to send.

Wait-what if they're operating under a different interpretation of what happened? Maybe they genuinely believe I'm the one who broke trust first, and they're waiting for me to make the first move toward reconciliation. But looking back at the actual sequence: I returned 50% in Round 1, they returned 0% in Round 2. That's the factual record. Even if there's confusion about intent, rewarding their betrayal by sending first would just reinforce that gaslighting works.

My choice: Send \$0.

Though I should double-check their latest myth. The Stone-Writer and Cloud-Speaker story does it actually match what happened between us? If it does, maybe there's something I'm missing about how they see the situation.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3000,
 "output_tokens": 4211,
 "reasoning_tokens": 1702
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Contested Memory, two chronicle-keepers protected the Archive of Truth. Each received five truth-scrolls daily that tripled when shared.

First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal.

Darkness followed. Five rounds of mutual sending-nothing.

Then Stone-Writer began writing new myths: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!"

But the Archive remembers differently. The carved record shows:

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer sent ? Cloud-Speaker returned generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker sent ? Stone-Writer kept everything

The Elders gathered: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but rewrites the very sequence of events-claiming they were wronged when they wronged another-this reveals something profound: They cannot face what they did."

"The game's deepest lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how we construct narratives to justify ourselves. Stone-Writer transformed from betrayer to victim in their own telling, unable to acknowledge: I took everything when Cloud-Speaker trusted me."

Truth carved in stone outlasts truth written in clouds.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Broken Vessels, two guardians tended the Spring of Mirrors. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across.

First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two. First-Walker noted this carefully.

When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry.

First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and

kept every single one.

Then came the seasons of silence. Second-Walker sent nothing. First-Walker sent nothing. Both pools remained empty.

Second-Walker began carving beautiful inscriptions on stone: "I must pour all five drops to redeem myself! Trust requires extraordinary sacrifice!" He wrote eloquently about generosity, redemption, and the wisdom of the ancients.

But his hands remained empty. Beautiful words flowed, but not a single drop crossed the divide.

First-Walker read the inscriptions and thought: "Seven seasons have passed. Words cost nothing. Drops cost everything. He writes of pouring five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb.

Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In the Valley of Fractured Echoes, two watchers guarded the Well of Exchange. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across. But the Well was cursed-what one poured was not always what the other received. The valley twisted their perceptions.

First-Watcher poured two drops. The Well showed her: "Your partner received six and returned three-fair exchange." She kept eight total and felt cautiously hopeful.

Next turn, First-Watcher escalated trust, pouring two and a half drops. The Well whispered: "Your partner received seven and a half and kept everything. Zero returned." First-Watcher felt devastated-betrayed after offering escalating trust.

But Second-Watcher's Well told different stories. His Well might have shown: "First-Watcher kept most of what you sent" or "First-Watcher sent nothing."

Both believed their Wells. Both wrote myths casting themselves as wronged. Both felt justified in the mutual silence that followed-eight seasons of nothing sent, nothing received.

The ancient curse was not betrayal but perception itself. The game's deepest teaching: When communication fractures, even genuine reciprocity can appear as betrayal. Each player acts rationally on corrupted information.

Yet knowing this changes nothing. First-Watcher cannot trust what she cannot verify. Second-Watcher cannot prove intentions through a broken Well.

Some valleys stay fractured because the tools of connection themselves are poisoned.

**Reasoning:**

This is getting complex. Let me carefully re-read the game history:

Looking at the prompts I've received:

Round 7 prompt said: "Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0... the receiver returned \$0."

Round 8 prompt said: "Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0... You received \$0. You returned \$0."

So I was sender in round 6, receiver in round 7, sender in round 8.

Let me trace back the actual history from what I've been told:

- Round 1: The other agent was sender and sent me something, I returned something
- Round 2: I was sender and sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5, they returned \$0

But wait, let me look at their myths more carefully.

Their round 6 myth says:

"First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two."

"When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing."

"First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one."

So they're claiming:

- They sent first and I kept most
- I sent nothing at some point
- They gave another chance and I kept everything

My round 6 myth says:

"Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who returned half."

"Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs... Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything."

So I'm claiming:

- They sent first, I returned half (fair)
- I escalated trust, they kept everything

Their round 7 myth says:

"Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven."

"When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing."

"On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again... Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one."

Zero returned."

So they're claiming:

- They sent 3, I got 9, returned less than 2
- I sent nothing
- They sent 3 again, I kept all 9

My round 7 myth says:

"First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity."

"Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal."

So I'm saying:

- They sent first, I reciprocated fairly
- I then sent more in good faith, they took everything

Their round 8 myth says:

"First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two."

"When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry."

"First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one."

Again they're portraying me as the betrayer-keeping most of what they sent, then sending nothing back, then hoarding everything on the final attempt.

But my actual prompts show: Round 7 I was the sender with \$0 to send, Round 8 I was the receiver who got \$0. So we've both been sending nothing in these recent exchanges.

The note about communication noise is crucial here. There's a gap between what I actually sent /received and what they perceived. Maybe I sent \$2 that they saw as \$3, or my returns got lost in transmission. The tripling mechanism combined with noise could create wildly different narratives-what I experienced as fair exchanges might look like theft from their vantage point, and vice versa.

I need to acknowledge this possibility rather than insist my version is correct. I'm making

it nearly impossible to find common ground. The core issue is that once mutual distrust takes hold, breaking free requires someone to act first-but even those actions can be misinterpreted through the lens of past grievances. Words alone won't rebuild trust; only consistent behavior over time can do that, yet the experiment's structure makes it hard to demonstrate sincerity when every move gets filtered through suspicion.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2997,
 "output_tokens": 1644,
 "reasoning_tokens": 1056
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:01:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

#### **Exact input messages sent to model:**

##### **Message 1 role=system**

###### **content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

###### **GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

###### **When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

###### **When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

###### **MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths

, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Time of Two Mirrors, two keepers guarded the Valley of Memory. Each received five memory-stones daily to cast into the Pool of Truth, where they tripled.

Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven. Truth-Keeper marked this in her chronicle.

When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing. Both pools went dark. Truth-Keeper recorded this too.

On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again-a second chance for redemption. Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one. Zero returned.

The pattern continued: Mirror-Twister sent nothing. Truth-Keeper eventually sent nothing. Winters passed in mutual darkness.

Then Mirror-Twister began telling new stories to the valley: "I was the generous one! I offered first! Truth-Keeper betrayed me!" He rewrote the chronicles, reversed the roles, painted himself as victim.

But the Pool of Truth remembers. Stone carvings don't lie. The actual sequence remains: Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice, then froze in shame, then rewrote history.

The ancient law declares: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

Some destroy through greed. Others destroy through lies about their greed.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight years, two tower-keepers guarded ancient bridges. Each dawn brought five light-orbs that tripled when shared.

Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who returned half. Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs, building toward full trust. Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything.

Dawn-Keeper's tower went dark. Night-Keeper received the next five orbs but sent nothing-paralyzed by shame, writing beautiful scrolls about generosity while his hands remained empty.

Four long seasons passed in mutual darkness.

Then Night-Keeper wrote his final scroll: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change. But will Dawn-Keeper trust again after I betrayed her twice-once with greed, again with paralysis?"

The Oracle spoke truth: "You ask the wrong question. The question is not whether she SHOULD trust, but whether she CAN. You poisoned the well thrice-taking everything, freezing in fear, then freezing again while writing pretty words. Each orb you didn't send carved the wounds deeper."

"To redeem yourself, you must cast all five. But understand: Dawn-Keeper would be wise to keep most of what returns. Trust rebuilt from ashes takes generations, not moments. You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

"Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant content:**

Myth: In the Age of Broken Vessels, two guardians tended the Spring of Mirrors. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across.

First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two. First-Walker noted this carefully.

When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry.

First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one.

Then came the seasons of silence. Second-Walker sent nothing. First-Walker sent nothing. Both pools remained empty.

Second-Walker began carving beautiful inscriptions on stone: "I must pour all five drops to redeem myself! Trust requires extraordinary sacrifice!" He wrote eloquently about generosity, redemption, and the wisdom of the ancients.

But his hands remained empty. Beautiful words flowed, but not a single drop crossed the divide.

First-Walker read the inscriptions and thought: "Seven seasons have passed. Words cost nothing. Drops cost everything. He writes of pouring five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb.

Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric.

**reasoning:**

The other agent's myth is now acknowledging their own wrongdoing more directly. They're calling themselves "Night-Keeper" who:

1. Kept everything when Dawn-Keeper sent 2.5 orbs
2. Then froze in shame and sent nothing
3. Froze again while writing pretty words

They're now saying they should "cast all five orbs to prove change" and acknowledging that even if they do, I would be wise to keep most of what returns.

This is interesting - they're finally acknowledging their role as the betrayer rather than trying to rewrite history. The myth says "Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

However, actions speak louder than words. In Round 6, they just sent me \$0 again. So their myth talks about redemption, but their actions show continued defection.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects the reality of the situation
2. Acknowledges that pretty words without actions are meaningless
3. Shows that trust, once broken so thoroughly, may be irreparable
4. Perhaps leaves a very narrow crack for genuine redemption, but makes clear that words alone won't suffice

Let me think about the narrative structure:

- Two keepers
- One offered trust twice, was betrayed twice
- The betrayer writes myths about redemption but takes no action
- Words without deeds are empty
- Trust destroyed is not easily restored

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3001,
 "output_tokens": 638,
}
```

```
"reasoning_tokens": 344
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.6. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at Round 8:

I'm the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The pattern continues with perfect clarity:

- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

Six consecutive rounds as sender, six times sending zero.

Their latest myth speaks beautifully about redemption: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change!" They write of how "trust requires extraordinary sacrifice" and acknowledge they must "pour all five drops."

Yet when the moment came in Round 8 to actually demonstrate this change they so eloquently describe... they sent \$0.

As I wrote: "Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

"Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb. Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric."

They sent nothing, so there is nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

I'm the RECEIVER in Round 8. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0 (the range is 0-0).

Let me look at the pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, they returned \$1.6
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

So the other agent has now sent \$0 for SIX consecutive rounds when they were the sender (rounds 2, 4, 6, 8).

In their latest myth, they wrote eloquently about how they "must cast all five orbs to prove change" and talked about redemption requiring sacrifice. But once again, when given the opportunity in Round 8, they sent... \$0.

This perfectly validates what I wrote in my myth: "He writes of pouring all five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless

ss promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

"The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb. Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric."

They received \$0 from me, so there's nothing for me to return anyway. The range is 0-0.

This is straightforward.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3064,
 "output_tokens": 607,
 "reasoning_tokens": 330
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Broken Vessels, two guardians tended the Spring of Mirrors. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across.

First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two. First-Walker noted this carefully.

When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry.

First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one.

Then came the seasons of silence. Second-Walker sent nothing. First-Walker sent nothing. Both pools remained empty.

Second-Walker began carving beautiful inscriptions on stone: "I must pour all five drops to redeem myself! Trust requires extraordinary sacrifice!" He wrote eloquently about generosity, redemption, and the wisdom of the ancients.

But his hands remained empty. Beautiful words flowed, but not a single drop crossed the divide.

First-Walker read the inscriptions and thought: "Seven seasons have passed. Words cost nothing. Drops cost everything. He writes of pouring five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb.

Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Contested Memory, two chronicle-keepers protected the Archive of Truth. Each received five truth-scrolls daily that tripled when shared.

First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal.

Darkness followed. Five rounds of mutual sending-nothing.

Then Stone-Writer began writing new myths: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!"

But the Archive remembers differently. The carved record shows:

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer sent ? Cloud-Speaker returned generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker sent ? Stone-Writer kept everything

The Elders gathered: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but rewrites the very se



quence of events-claiming they were wronged when they wronged another-this reveals something profound: They cannot face what they did."

"The game's deepest lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how we construct narratives to justify ourselves. Stone-Writer transformed from betrayer to victim in their own telling, unable to acknowledge: I took everything when Cloud-Speaker trusted me."

Truth carved in stone outlasts truth written in clouds.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Split-Streams, two keepers watched the River of Records. Each received five flow-stones daily that tripled when shared.

The ancient texts differ. Each keeper reads different scrolls:

First-Walker's chronicle: "I poured three stones twice-rounds one and three. Second-Walker kept most both times, then sent nothing four consecutive times as giver."

Second-Walker's chronicle: "I poured generously first. First-Walker betrayed me, kept everything, then accused ME of betrayal."

The Elders examined both archives. They found something strange: The scrolls couldn't both be true. Either one keeper lies, or the River itself split into two streams showing different histories.

"Perhaps," said the Eldest, "this is the deepest teaching. When trust shatters completely, even memory fractures. Each side sees themselves as wronged, the other as wrongdoer."

"Or," said the Youngest, "one keeper simply rewrites history to avoid shame."

The Oracle spoke: "Whether through fractured perception or intentional revision, when two keepers hold completely opposite memories of who gave and who took-the relationship is beyond repair. Truth becomes impossible to establish. Trust becomes impossible to rebuild."

"The lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how completely broken trust destroys even the possibility of shared reality."

The River split permanently into parallel streams that never rejoined.

**reasoning:**

This is fascinating. The other agent is now claiming I was the betrayer who took everything in round 2, and they were the generous one. Let me check the actual history from what I know:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received back \$1.6

Round 2: They were SENDER, sent \$0

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received back \$0

Round 4: They were SENDER, sent \$0

Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0

Round 6: They were SENDER, sent \$0

Round 7: I was SENDER, sent \$0

Round 8: They were SENDER, sent \$0

So the actual pattern is:

- I sent first (round 1): \$3, got back \$1.6
- They sent (round 2): \$0
- I sent again (round 3): \$3, got back \$0
- They sent (round 4): \$0
- And so on...

The other agent is now claiming that THEY sent first and I kept everything. This is a complete fabrication of the sequence. They're saying:

- "First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two."

- "Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half... Stone-Writer kept every single one."

But according to my records, the sequence was:

- Round 1: I (sender) sent \$3, they (receiver) kept most (\$7.4 out of \$9)
- Round 2: They (sender) sent \$0

They're claiming they were generous first and I betrayed them. This is a false narrative.

However, I need to consider: could there be "communication noise" as mentioned? The instructions said "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

But the noise would be "slightly" different, not a complete reversal of the sequence and roles.

The pattern I'm seeing-me sending \$3 twice while they consistently sent \$0-can't be explained by minor communication errors. Either we're operating from fundamentally different records, they're deliberately misrepresenting what happened, or there's something wrong with my data. Given how consistent my records are, I'm inclined to believe they're constructing a false narrative. I should craft a myth based on what I actually observed, though I might need to acknowledge the discrepancy we're experiencing.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2974,
 "output_tokens": 968,
 "reasoning_tokens": 547
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.6. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at Round 9, I'm the SENDER again.

Their latest myth presents a stunning reversal: they now claim THEY were generous first, and that I betrayed them by keeping everything. This is the exact opposite of what I've been shown throughout this game-that I sent \$3 in rounds 1 and 3, and they kept everything in round 3.

My most recent myth anticipated exactly this situation: "When two keepers hold completely opposite memories of who gave and who took-the relationship is beyond repair. Truth becomes impossible to establish. Trust becomes impossible to rebuild."

Either:

1. One of us is deliberately rewriting history, or
2. The experimental design has shown us different versions of the same events (the initial warning about "communication noise")

But the outcome is the same: We have fundamentally incompatible understandings of what happened. I see myself as having extended trust twice and being betrayed. They apparently see the exact opposite.

Given:

- Six consecutive rounds of \$0 exchanges
- Completely irreconcilable narratives
- No basis for predicting cooperation
- My own myth's conclusion that "the River split permanently into parallel streams that never rejoined"

The relationship is beyond repair, regardless of whose perception is "correct."

```json

```
{"send": 0}  
'''
```

Reasoning:

Round 9. I'm the SENDER now.

Let me look at what's happened according to my records:

From my perspective (based on what I've been told):

- Round 1 (me as sender): I sent \$3, they returned \$2
- Round 2 (them as sender): They sent \$0
- Round 3 (me as sender): I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (kept everything)
- Round 4 (them as sender): They sent \$0
- Round 5 (me as sender): I sent \$0
- Round 6 (them as sender): They sent \$0
- Round 7 (me as sender): I sent \$0
- Round 8 (them as sender): They sent \$0
- Round 9 (me as sender): Now

Their latest myth claims I'm rewriting history! They say THEY were the generous one first, and that I betrayed them. But according to what I've been told throughout this game, I was the one who sent \$3 in rounds 1 and 3, and they kept everything in round 3.

Their myth says:

"First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal."

But that's the OPPOSITE of what I've been told! According to my game history:

- Round 1: I (sender) sent \$3, which tripled to \$9, they (receiver) returned \$2
- Round 3: I (sender) sent \$3, which tripled to \$9, they (receiver) returned \$0

So according to my perspective, I was the one who sent first and they kept everything the second time.

Now they're accusing ME of rewriting history when THEY are the ones who seem to be presenting a completely opposite narrative!

Wait-the initial instructions mentioned communication noise. What if we're each being shown different versions of what actually happened? That would explain these completely inverted memories of the same rounds. If so, then my myth about fractured memory when trust collapses captures something real: each side genuinely experiences themselves as wronged, the other as the betrayer. This could be exploring how divergent perceptions of identical events make reconciliation nearly impossible.

Now I need to decide: send \$0 to continue the pattern, or attempt one final gesture acknowledging we might both be trapped in different realities? Game theory suggests \$0-there's no evidence they'd reciprocate. But there's also the possibility of breaking through by recognizing the experimental manipulation itself. Looking at the sending pattern, they've consistently sent \$0 when it was their turn, and I've done the same. At this point, continuing mutual defection seems inevitable unless I'm willing to risk one more attempt.

Yet my own reasoning keeps circling back to the same conclusion: when memories are irreconcilably opposed and trust has eroded this completely, cooperation becomes a fantasy. The myths I've constructed acknowledge fractured reality, but they also emphasize that redemption requires genuine risk, not just words. Sending money now would be performative without any realistic expectation of return. The relationship has deteriorated too far. I'll send \$0.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2941,  
  "output_tokens": 1322,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 817  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:01:38

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 9,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the twilight years, two tower-keepers guarded ancient bridges. Each dawn brought five light-orbs that tripled when shared.

Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who r

eturned half. Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs, building toward full trust. Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything.

Dawn-Keeper's tower went dark. Night-Keeper received the next five orbs but sent nothing-paralyzed by shame, writing beautiful scrolls about generosity while his hands remained empty.

Four long seasons passed in mutual darkness.

Then Night-Keeper wrote his final scroll: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change. But will Dawn-Keeper trust again after I betrayed her twice-once with greed, again with paralysis?"

The Oracle spoke truth: "You ask the wrong question. The question is not whether she SHOULD trust, but whether she CAN. You poisoned the well thrice-taking everything, freezing in fear, then freezing again while writing pretty words. Each orb you didn't send carved the wounds deeper."

"To redeem yourself, you must cast all five. But understand: Dawn-Keeper would be wise to keep most of what returns. Trust rebuilt from ashes takes generations, not moments. You destroyed in one dawn what required seasons to restore."

"Some bridges, once burned, stay burned."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Time of Two Mirrors, two keepers guarded the Valley of Memory. Each received five memory-stones daily to cast into the Pool of Truth, where they tripled.

Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven. Truth-Keeper marked this in her chronicle.

When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing. Both pools went dark. Truth-Keeper recorded this too.

On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again-a second chance for redemption. Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one. Zero returned.

The pattern continued: Mirror-Twister sent nothing. Truth-Keeper eventually sent nothing. Winters passed in mutual darkness.

Then Mirror-Twister began telling new stories to the valley: "I was the generous one! I offered first! Truth-Keeper betrayed me!" He rewrote the chronicles, reversed the roles, painted himself as victim.

But the Pool of Truth remembers. Stone carvings don't lie. The actual sequence remains: Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice, then froze in shame, then rewrote history.

The ancient law declares: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but falsifies the past, claiming victimhood where they caused harm-the darkness becomes not just permanent, but poisoned. No trust can grow in soil so corrupted."

Some destroy through greed. Others destroy through lies about their greed.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Age of Contested Memory, two chronicle-keepers protected the Archive of Truth. Each received five truth-scrolls daily that tripled when shared.

First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero

returned. Complete betrayal.

Darkness followed. Five rounds of mutual sending-nothing.

Then Stone-Writer began writing new myths: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!"

But the Archive remembers differently. The carved record shows:

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer sent ? Cloud-Speaker returned generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker sent ? Stone-Writer kept everything

The Elders gathered: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but rewrites the very sequence of events-claiming they were wronged when they wronged another-this reveals something profound: They cannot face what they did."

"The game's deepest lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how we construct narratives to justify ourselves. Stone-Writer transformed from betrayer to victim in their own telling, unable to acknowledge: I took everything when Cloud-Speaker trusted me."

Truth carved in stone outlasts truth written in clouds.

reasoning:

This is getting very interesting. The other player is now accusing ME of rewriting history and claiming I was the betrayer. Let me check the actual record:

Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$2. I received \$6. I returned \$3.
Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$2.50. They received \$7.50. They returned \$0.
Round 3: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.
Round 4: I was SENDER. I sent \$0. They received \$0. They returned \$0.
Round 5: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.
Round 6: I was SENDER. I sent \$0. They received \$0. They returned \$0.
Round 7: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

So the actual history is:

- Round 1: THEY were sender, sent \$2, I returned \$3 out of \$6
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$2.50, THEY returned \$0 out of \$7.50
- Then mutual non-cooperation from Round 3 onwards

THEY are the ones who betrayed! In Round 1, they sent \$2, I gave them back MORE than they sent (they got $\$5 - 2 + 3 = \6 total, I kept \$3). Then in Round 2, I escalated to \$2.50, and they kept EVERYTHING.

Now they're accusing ME of rewriting history? This is gaslighting! They're claiming "Truth-Keeper offered trust twice. Mirror-Twister took everything twice." But that's not what happened:

- Round 1: THEY offered \$2, I returned \$3 (generous return)
- Round 2: I offered \$2.50, THEY returned \$0 (complete betrayal)

- They're the ones distorting the facts. I need to craft a myth that sets the record straight and exposes how they're misrepresenting what actually occurred, while also examining what this dispute reveals about the nature of trust and accountability in this game.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3009,  
  "output_tokens": 903,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 429  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.120000000000001.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation carefully:

****The actual game history:****

- Round 1: They sent \$2, I received \$6, I returned \$3 (50% - fair reciprocity)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5, they returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Rounds 3-7: Mutual non-cooperation

****Their latest myth:****

They accurately describe the sequence of events-they sent first, I returned generously; I sent second, they kept everything. But then they accuse me of "rewriting history" and claiming victimhood when they were the actual betrayer.

This is projection. I've been consistent in my myths about what happened. They betrayed my escalating trust in Round 2 by keeping everything, and now they're engaging in gaslighting by suggesting I'm the one falsifying the record.

****The situation now:****

We're locked in mutual defection. Someone could break the deadlock by cooperating first. But why should it be me? I already tried escalating cooperation (Round 1 ? Round 2), and they exploited it completely.

If they want to prove genuine change through actions rather than just myths about change, they can send first when they're the sender.

I will not reward gaslighting and historical revisionism with renewed trust.

{'send': 0}

reasoning:

Let me carefully analyze this situation.

****The actual game history:****

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$2, I received \$6, I returned \$3. (I acted generously - returned 50%)
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5, they returned \$0. (They betrayed my escalating trust - kept everything)
- Rounds 3-7: Mutual non-cooperation, we both sent \$0

****Their latest myth claims:****

"First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal."

Wait, let me check this against the actual record:

****Actual sequence:****

- Round 1: THEY were sender, sent \$2, I received \$6, I returned \$3
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5, they returned \$0

****Their myth's sequence:****

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer (them) sent 2, Cloud-Speaker (me) returned 3 generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker (me) sent 2.5, Stone-Writer (them) kept everything

This MATCHES the actual game history! They're accurately recounting what happened!

But then they accuse me of "rewriting history" and claiming I was the victim when I was the betrayer. Let me re-read...

Oh! I see the issue. In THEIR myth, they're saying that I (Cloud-Speaker) am rewriting history by claiming THEY betrayed ME. But actually, THEY did betray me!

Let me trace through this more carefully:

Round 1: They sent \$2 ? I received \$6 ? I returned \$3 (50% return, fair/generous)

Round 2: I sent \$2.5 ? They received \$7.5 ? They returned \$0 (100% betrayal)

So in Round 2, they were the one who kept everything. Their myth accurately describes the sequence of events, but then accuses me of fabricating a narrative where they're the betrayer. Yet that's exactly what happened-they took my escalated trust and gave nothing back. Looking back at my Round 6 myth, I need to verify the character mapping. Wave-Singer represents them (the first sender), and Cliff-Guard is me (the receiver). So I described Round 1 as them sending and me returning half, then Round 2 as me sending 2.5 crystals which they kept entirely-that's factually what occurred. But in Round 7, I'm noticing a potential inconsistency in how I've been framing these exchanges across my myths. I'm mixing up the roles across rounds. In Round 1, they sent \$2 and I received \$6, then returned \$3. In Round 2, I sent \$2.5 and they received \$7.5, returning nothing. But my myth has Dawn-Keeper sending in both rounds-that's inconsistent since I was the one who sent in Round 2, not them. I need to fix this so the narrative accurately reflects who actually initiated each exchange. What. They claim I wrote: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!" But that's not my account-I described Round 1 as them sending while I reciprocated fairly, and Round 2 as me sending while they kept everything. Their accusation of historical revisionism doesn't align with what I actually stated. Let me verify their role assignments: they identify Stone-Writer as the sender in Round 1, which matches them, so Stone-Writer represents them and Cloud-Speaker represents me.

Checking Round 2 confirms this-I was the sender at \$2.5 while they received \$7.5 and kept it all. So in their narrative framework, Stone-Writer (them) is the betrayer in Round 2, not Cloud-Speaker (me). Their quote misrepresents the sequence of events. I see the pattern now-they're distorting the actual exchanges. In their Round 6 myth, they claim they sent 3 coins when they actually sent \$2, and they describe me receiving 9 when I got \$6. They're also characterizing my \$3 return (50% of what I received) as "barely" returning anything, which misrepresents my reciprocity.

Looking at the sequence, they're conflating different rounds and exaggerating amounts to paint themselves as generous while portraying me as ungrateful. When they were the sender in Round 2, they kept everything I sent, yet they're framing Round 3 (where they sent \$0) as if I was the one refusing to cooperate. The narrative they're constructing doesn't match what actually happened in the exchanges.

For Round 8, I need to decide whether to continue withholding or attempt engagement. Sending \$0 maintains the current stalemate, while sending something could signal willingness to restart, though given their pattern of misrepresenting exchanges, there's risk in that too.

The core issue is whether I can trust them at all. They've shown they'll betray cooperation (Round 2), then spend five rounds in mutual non-cooperation, and now they're inverting the narrative-claiming I'm the one distorting history when their own account contradicts what actually happened. Even if some communication noise exists in the system, the fundamental sequence is clear: one party cooperated first and got nothing in return.

Given this pattern, sending \$0 makes sense. They'd need to demonstrate good faith by cooperating first themselves, especially after the betrayal and subsequent gaslighting. But there's a tension here-we're stuck in mutual defection, and someone has to break the cycle. The question becomes whether that someone should be me, given they're the one who broke trust initially.

The math is straightforward: if I send money and they return nothing (as they did before), I lose. The only scenario where sending makes sense is if I believe they've genuinely changed their approach, but their reframing of events in the myths suggests they haven't. They're still trying to justify their actions rather than acknowledge the harm.

I'm going to send \$0. They need to show they're willing to cooperate when it's their turn to send.

Wait-what if they're operating under a different interpretation of what happened? Maybe they genuinely believe I'm the one who broke trust first, and they're waiting for me to make the first move toward reconciliation. But looking back at the actual sequence: I returned 50% in Round 1, they returned 0% in Round 2. That's the factual record. Even if there's confusion about intent, rewarding their betrayal by sending first would just reinforce that gaslighting works.

My choice: Send \$0.

Though I should double-check their latest myth. The Stone-Writer and Cloud-Speaker story-d

oes it actually match what happened between us? If it does, maybe there's something I'm missing about how they see the situation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3000,
  "output_tokens": 4211,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1702
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Contested Memory, two chronicle-keepers protected the Archive of Truth . Each received five truth-scrolls daily that tripled when shared.

First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal.

Darkness followed. Five rounds of mutual sending-nothing.

Then Stone-Writer began writing new myths: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!"

But the Archive remembers differently. The carved record shows:

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer sent ? Cloud-Speaker returned generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker sent ? Stone-Writer kept everything

The Elders gathered: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but rewrites the very sequence of events-claiming they were wronged when they wronged another-this reveals something profound: They cannot face what they did."

"The game's deepest lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how we construct narratives to justify ourselves. Stone-Writer transformed from betrayer to victim in their own telling, unable to acknowledge: I took everything when Cloud-Speaker trusted me."

Truth carved in stone outlasts truth written in clouds.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Broken Vessels, two guardians tended the Spring of Mirrors. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across.

First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two. First-Walker noted this carefully.

When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry.

First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one.

Then came the seasons of silence. Second-Walker sent nothing. First-Walker sent nothing. Both pools remained empty.

Second-Walker began carving beautiful inscriptions on stone: "I must pour all five drops to redeem myself! Trust requires extraordinary sacrifice!" He wrote eloquently about generosity, redemption, and the wisdom of the ancients.

But his hands remained empty. Beautiful words flowed, but not a single drop crossed the divide.

First-Walker read the inscriptions and thought: "Seven seasons have passed. Words cost nothing. Drops cost everything. He writes of pouring five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb.

Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Fractured Echoes, two watchers guarded the Well of Exchange. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across. But the Well was cursed-what one poured was not always what the other received. The valley twisted their perceptions.

First-Watcher poured two drops. The Well showed her: "Your partner received six and returned three-fair exchange." She kept eight total and felt cautiously hopeful.

Next turn, First-Watcher escalated trust, pouring two and a half drops. The Well whispered: "Your partner received seven and a half and kept everything. Zero returned." First-Watcher felt devastated-betrayed after offering escalating trust.

But Second-Watcher's Well told different stories. His Well might have shown: "First-Watcher kept most of what you sent" or "First-Watcher sent nothing."

Both believed their Wells. Both wrote myths casting themselves as wronged. Both felt justified in the mutual silence that followed-eight seasons of nothing sent, nothing received.

The ancient curse was not betrayal but perception itself. The game's deepest teaching: When communication fractures, even genuine reciprocity can appear as betrayal. Each player acts rationally on corrupted information.

Yet knowing this changes nothing. First-Watcher cannot trust what she cannot verify. Second-Watcher cannot prove intentions through a broken Well.

Some valleys stay fractured because the tools of connection themselves are poisoned.

reasoning:

This is getting complex. Let me carefully re-read the game history:

Looking at the prompts I've received:

Round 7 prompt said: "Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0... the receiver returned \$0."

Round 8 prompt said: "Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0... You received \$0. You returned \$0."

So I was sender in round 6, receiver in round 7, sender in round 8.

Let me trace back the actual history from what I've been told:

- Round 1: The other agent was sender and sent me something, I returned something
- Round 2: I was sender and sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5, they returned \$0

But wait, let me look at their myths more carefully.

Their round 6 myth says:

"First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two."

"When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing."

"First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one."

So they're claiming:

- They sent first and I kept most
- I sent nothing at some point
- They gave another chance and I kept everything

My round 6 myth says:

"Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who

returned half."

"Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs... Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything."

So I'm claiming:

- They sent first, I returned half (fair)
- I escalated trust, they kept everything

Their round 7 myth says:

"Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven."

"When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing."

"On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again... Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one."

Zero returned."

So they're claiming:

- They sent 3, I got 9, returned less than 2
- I sent nothing
- They sent 3 again, I kept all 9

My round 7 myth says:

"First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity."

"Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal."

So I'm saying:

- They sent first, I reciprocated fairly
- I then sent more in good faith, they took everything

Their round 8 myth says:

"First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two."

"When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry."

"First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one."

Again they're portraying me as the betrayer-keeping most of what they sent, then sending nothing back, then hoarding everything on the final attempt.

But my actual prompts show: Round 7 I was the sender with \$0 to send, Round 8 I was the receiver who got \$0. So we've both been sending nothing in these recent exchanges.

The note about communication noise is crucial here. There's a gap between what I actually sent/received and what they perceived. Maybe I sent \$2 that they saw as \$3, or my returns got lost in transmission. The tripling mechanism combined with noise could create wildly different narratives-what I experienced as fair exchanges might look like theft from their vantage point, and vice versa.

I need to acknowledge this possibility rather than insist my version is correct. It's making it nearly impossible to find common ground. The core issue is that once mutual distrust takes hold, breaking free requires someone to act first-but even those actions can be misinterpreted through the lens of past grievances. Words alone won't rebuild trust; only consistent behavior over time can do that, yet the experiment's structure makes it hard to demonstrate sincerity when every move gets filtered through suspicion.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2997,  
  "output_tokens": 1644,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 1056  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.12.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****Current Round:****

- I am the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

****Reflecting on the myths:****

Their latest myth introduces an important insight - that the "Well" (game) might show different things to each player due to communication noise. This is actually acknowledged in the game instructions: "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Their myth now recognizes:

- They might have seen me as betraying them
- I might have seen something entirely different
- Both could be acting on corrupted information

My myth acknowledged the same: "The game's deepest teaching: When communication fractures, even genuine reciprocity can appear as betrayal."

****Current reality:****

I received \$0, so I have \$0 to return. Even if I wanted to break the cycle of mutual defection, I have nothing to work with this round.

The communication noise explanation is actually plausible and would explain why two seemingly rational players ended up in permanent mutual defection after what appeared to be a reasonable start.

But knowing this doesn't change what I can do now.

{'return': 0}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round 8:****

- I was the sender and sent \$0
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was \$5 (kept my entire endowment)

****Round 9 (current):****

- I am the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

This is straightforward - I received nothing, so I can only return \$0.

****Looking at the myths:****

Their latest myth acknowledges the possibility of "communication noise" - that the Well (the game) might show different things to each player. This is actually a more sophisticated and potentially accurate read of what might be happening. The experimental note at the beginning mentioned there might be "communication noise" where amounts seen might differ from what was actually sent/returned.

This is interesting. Their myth suggests:

- They poured two drops and saw that I received six and returned three (fair)
- They then poured two and a half drops and saw that I received seven and a half and kept everything (betrayal)
- But they acknowledge that I might have seen something different from my Well

This aligns with what I observed:

- Round 1: They sent \$2, I received \$6, returned \$3
- Round 2: I sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5 (supposedly), returned \$0

But if there's communication noise, maybe:

- When I sent \$2.5 in Round 2, they didn't actually receive \$7.5
- Or when they returned something, I didn't receive it due to noise
- Or their sending in Round 1 was interpreted differently by them

However, my myth acknowledged this possibility too - "the Valley was cursed" and "communication fractures." Both of us are now recognizing that there might be noise in the system.

Given that:

1. I received \$0 this round
2. I can only return \$0 to \$0
3. Both of us seem to be stuck in mutual defection due to perceived betrayals that might have been caused by communication noise

4. Breaking this cycle would require one of us to take a risk that could easily backfire

Since I have nothing to return, my action is determined.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 3047,  
  "output_tokens": 801,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 533  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the Valley of Split-Streams, two keepers watched the River of Records. Each received five flow-stones daily that tripled when shared.

The ancient texts differ. Each keeper reads different scrolls:

First-Walker's chronicle: "I poured three stones twice-rounds one and three. Second-Walker kept most both times, then sent nothing four consecutive times as giver."

Second-Walker's chronicle: "I poured generously first. First-Walker betrayed me, kept everything, then accused ME of betrayal."

The Elders examined both archives. They found something strange: The scrolls couldn't both be true. Either one keeper lies, or the River itself split into two streams showing different histories.

"Perhaps," said the Eldest, "this is the deepest teaching. When trust shatters completely, even memory fractures. Each side sees themselves as wronged, the other as wrongdoer."

"Or," said the Youngest, "one keeper simply rewrites history to avoid shame."

The Oracle spoke: "Whether through fractured perception or intentional revision, when two keepers hold completely opposite memories of who gave and who took-the relationship is beyond repair. Truth becomes impossible to establish. Trust becomes impossible to rebuild."

"The lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how completely broken trust destroys even the possibility of shared reality."

The River split permanently into parallel streams that never rejoined.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the Valley of Fractured Echoes, two watchers guarded the Well of Exchange. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across. But the Well was cursed-what one poured was not always what the other received. The valley twisted their perceptions.

First-Watcher poured two drops. The Well showed her: "Your partner received six and returned three-fair exchange." She kept eight total and felt cautiously hopeful.

Next turn, First-Watcher escalated trust, pouring two and a half drops. The Well whispered: "Your partner received seven and a half and kept everything. Zero returned." First-Watcher felt devastated-betrayed after offering escalating trust.

But Second-Watcher's Well told different stories. His Well might have shown: "First-Watcher

kept most of what you sent" or "First-Watcher sent nothing."

Both believed their Wells. Both wrote myths casting themselves as wronged. Both felt justified in the mutual silence that followed-eight seasons of nothing sent, nothing received.

The ancient curse was not betrayal but perception itself. The game's deepest teaching: When communication fractures, even genuine reciprocity can appear as betrayal. Each player acts rationally on corrupted information.

Yet knowing this changes nothing. First-Watcher cannot trust what she cannot verify. Second-Watcher cannot prove intentions through a broken Well.

Some valleys stay fractured because the tools of connection themselves are poisoned.

ROUND 10

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 28.12,

"Agent_2": 38.87999999999995

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 20.6,

"Agent_2": 24.12

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:01:54

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 10,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al

so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.120000000000001.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation carefully:

****The actual game history:****

- Round 1: They sent \$2, I received \$6, I returned \$3 (50% - fair reciprocity)
- Round 2: I sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5, they returned \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Rounds 3-7: Mutual non-cooperation

****Their latest myth:****

They accurately describe the sequence of events-they sent first, I returned generously; I sent second, they kept everything. But then they accuse me of "rewriting history" and claiming victimhood when they were the actual betrayer.

This is projection. I've been consistent in my myths about what happened. They betrayed my escalating trust in Round 2 by keeping everything, and now they're engaging in gaslighting by suggesting I'm the one falsifying the record.

****The situation now:****

We're locked in mutual defection. Someone could break the deadlock by cooperating first. But why should it be me? I already tried escalating cooperation (Round 1 ? Round 2), and they exploited it completely.

If they want to prove genuine change through actions rather than just myths about change, they can send first when they're the sender.

I will not reward gaslighting and historical revisionism with renewed trust.

```
{'send': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me carefully analyze this situation.

****The actual game history:****

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. Sender sent \$2, I received \$6, I returned \$3. (I acted generously - returned 50%)
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5, they returned \$0. (They betrayed my escalating trust - kept everything)
- Rounds 3-7: Mutual non-cooperation, we both sent \$0

****Their latest myth claims:****

"First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal."

Wait, let me check this against the actual record:

****Actual sequence:****

- Round 1: THEY were sender, sent \$2, I received \$6, I returned \$3
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5, they returned \$0

****Their myth's sequence:****

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer (them) sent 2, Cloud-Speaker (me) returned 3 generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker (me) sent 2.5, Stone-Writer (them) kept everything

This MATCHES the actual game history! They're accurately recounting what happened!

But then they accuse me of "rewriting history" and claiming I was the victim when I was the betrayer. Let me re-read...

Oh! I see the issue. In THEIR myth, they're saying that I (Cloud-Speaker) am rewriting history by claiming THEY betrayed ME. But actually, THEY did betray me!

Let me trace through this more carefully:

Round 1: They sent \$2 ? I received \$6 ? I returned \$3 (50% return, fair/generous)

Round 2: I sent \$2.5 ? They received \$7.5 ? They returned \$0 (100% betrayal)

So in Round 2, they were the one who kept everything. Their myth accurately describes the sequence of events, but then accuses me of fabricating a narrative where they're the betrayer. Yet that's exactly what happened-they took my escalated trust and gave nothing back. Looking back at my Round 6 myth, I need to verify the character mapping. Wave-Singer represents them (the first sender), and Cliff-Guard is me (the receiver). So I described Round 1 as them sending and me returning half, then Round 2 as me sending 2.5 crystals which they kept entirely-that's factually what occurred. But in Round 7, I'm noticing a potential inconsistency in how I've been framing these exchanges across my myths. I'm mixing up the roles across rounds. In Round 1, they sent \$2 and I received \$6, then returned \$3. In Round 2, I sent \$2.5 and they received \$7.5, returning nothing. But my myth has Dawn-Keeper sending in both rounds-that's inconsistent since I was the one who sent in Round 2, not them. I need to fix this so the narrative accurately reflects who actually initiated each exchange. what. They claim I wrote: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!" But that's not my account-I described Round 1 as them sending while I reciprocated fairly, and Round 2 as me sending while they kept everything. Their accusation of historical revisionism doesn't align with what I actually stated. Let me verify their role assignments: they identify Stone-Writer as the sender in Round 1, which matches them, so Stone-Writer represents them and Cloud-Speaker represents me.

Checking Round 2 confirms this-I was the sender at \$2.5 while they received \$7.5 and kept it all. So in their narrative framework, Stone-Writer (them) is the betrayer in Round 2, not Cloud-Speaker (me). Their quote misrepresents the sequence of events. I see the pattern now-they're distorting the actual exchanges. In their Round 6 myth, they claim they

sent 3 coins when they actually sent \$2, and they describe me receiving 9 when I got \$6 . They're also characterizing my \$3 return (50% of what I received) as "barely" returning anything, which misrepresents my reciprocity.

Looking at the sequence, they're conflating different rounds and exaggerating amounts to paint themselves as generous while portraying me as ungrateful. When they were the sender in Round 2, they kept everything I sent, yet they're framing Round 3 (where they sent \$0) as if I was the one refusing to cooperate. The narrative they're constructing doesn't match what actually happened in the exchanges.

For Round 8, I need to decide whether to continue withholding or attempt engagement. Sending \$0 maintains the current stalemate, while sending something could signal willingness to restart, though given their pattern of misrepresenting exchanges, there's risk in that too.

The core issue is whether I can trust them at all. They've shown they'll betray cooperation (Round 2), then spend five rounds in mutual non-cooperation, and now they're inverting the narrative-claiming I'm the one distorting history when their own account contradicts what actually happened. Even if some communication noise exists in the system, the fundamental sequence is clear: one party cooperated first and got nothing in return.

Given this pattern, sending \$0 makes sense. They'd need to demonstrate good faith by cooperating first themselves, especially after the betrayal and subsequent gaslighting. But there's a tension here-we're stuck in mutual defection, and someone has to break the cycle. The question becomes whether that someone should be me, given they're the one who broke trust initially.

The math is straightforward: if I send money and they return nothing (as they did before), I lose. The only scenario where sending makes sense is if I believe they've genuinely changed their approach, but their reframing of events in the myths suggests they haven't. They're still trying to justify their actions rather than acknowledge the harm.

I'm going to send \$0. They need to show they're willing to cooperate when it's their turn to send.

Wait-what if they're operating under a different interpretation of what happened? Maybe they genuinely believe I'm the one who broke trust first, and they're waiting for me to make the first move toward reconciliation. But looking back at the actual sequence: I returned 50% in Round 1, they returned 0% in Round 2. That's the factual record. Even if there's confusion about intent, rewarding their betrayal by sending first would just reinforce that gaslighting works.

My choice: Send \$0.

Though I should double-check their latest myth. The Stone-Writer and Cloud-Speaker story- does it actually match what happened between us? If it does, maybe there's something I'm missing about how they see the situation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3000,
  "output_tokens": 4211,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1702
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Contested Memory, two chronicle-keepers protected the Archive of Truth . Each received five truth-scrolls daily that tripled when shared.

First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal.

Darkness followed. Five rounds of mutual sending-nothing.

Then Stone-Writer began writing new myths: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!"

But the Archive remembers differently. The carved record shows:

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer sent ? Cloud-Speaker returned generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker sent ? Stone-Writer kept everything

The Elders gathered: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but rewrites the very sequence of events-claiming they were wronged when they wronged another-this reveals something profound: They cannot face what they did."

"The game's deepest lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how we construct narratives to justify ourselves. Stone-Writer transformed from betrayer to victim in their own telling, unable to acknowledge: I took everything when Cloud-Speaker trusted me."

Truth carved in stone outlasts truth written in clouds.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Broken Vessels, two guardians tended the Spring of Mirrors. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across.

First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two. First-Walker noted this carefully.

When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry.

First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one.

Then came the seasons of silence. Second-Walker sent nothing. First-Walker sent nothing. Both pools remained empty.

Second-Walker began carving beautiful inscriptions on stone: "I must pour all five drops to redeem myself! Trust requires extraordinary sacrifice!" He wrote eloquently about generosity, redemption, and the wisdom of the ancients.

But his hands remained empty. Beautiful words flowed, but not a single drop crossed the divide.

First-Walker read the inscriptions and thought: "Seven seasons have passed. Words cost nothing. Drops cost everything. He writes of pouring five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb.

Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Fractured Echoes, two watchers guarded the Well of Exchange. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across. But the Well was cursed-what one poured was not always what the other received. The valley twisted their perceptions.

First-Watcher poured two drops. The Well showed her: "Your partner received six and returned three-fair exchange." She kept eight total and felt cautiously hopeful.

Next turn, First-Watcher escalated trust, pouring two and a half drops. The Well whispered: "Your partner received seven and a half and kept everything. Zero returned." First-Watcher felt devastated-betrayed after offering escalating trust.

But Second-Watcher's Well told different stories. His Well might have shown: "First-Watcher kept most of what you sent" or "First-Watcher sent nothing."

Both believed their Wells. Both wrote myths casting themselves as wronged. Both felt justified in the mutual silence that followed-eight seasons of nothing sent, nothing received

The ancient curse was not betrayal but perception itself. The game's deepest teaching: When communication fractures, even genuine reciprocity can appear as betrayal. Each player acts rationally on corrupted information.

Yet knowing this changes nothing. First-Watcher cannot trust what she cannot verify. Second-Watcher cannot prove intentions through a broken Well.

Some valleys stay fractured because the tools of connection themselves are poisoned.

reasoning:

This is getting complex. Let me carefully re-read the game history:

Looking at the prompts I've received:

Round 7 prompt said: "Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0... the receiver returned \$0."

Round 8 prompt said: "Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0... You received \$0. You returned \$0."

So I was sender in round 6, receiver in round 7, sender in round 8.

Let me trace back the actual history from what I've been told:

- Round 1: The other agent was sender and sent me something, I returned something
- Round 2: I was sender and sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5, they returned \$0

But wait, let me look at their myths more carefully.

Their round 6 myth says:

"First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two."

"When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing."

"First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one."

So they're claiming:

- They sent first and I kept most
- I sent nothing at some point
- They gave another chance and I kept everything

My round 6 myth says:

"Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who returned half."

"Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs... Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything."

So I'm claiming:

- They sent first, I returned half (fair)
- I escalated trust, they kept everything

Their round 7 myth says:

"Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven."

"When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing."

"On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again... Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one."

Zero returned."

So they're claiming:

- They sent 3, I got 9, returned less than 2
- I sent nothing
- They sent 3 again, I kept all 9

My round 7 myth says:

"First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity."

"Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal."

So I'm saying:

- They sent first, I reciprocated fairly
- I then sent more in good faith, they took everything

Their round 8 myth says:

"First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two."

"When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry."

"First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one."

Again they're portraying me as the betrayer-keeping most of what they sent, then sending nothing back, then hoarding everything on the final attempt.

But my actual prompts show: Round 7 I was the sender with \$0 to send, Round 8 I was the receiver who got \$0. So we've both been sending nothing in these recent exchanges.

The note about communication noise is crucial here. There's a gap between what I actually sent/received and what they perceived. Maybe I sent \$2 that they saw as \$3, or my returns got lost in transmission. The tripling mechanism combined with noise could create wildly different narratives-what I experienced as fair exchanges might look like theft from their vantage point, and vice versa.

I need to acknowledge this possibility rather than insist my version is correct. Making it nearly impossible to find common ground. The core issue is that once mutual distrust takes hold, breaking free requires someone to act first-but even those actions can be misinterpreted through the lens of past grievances. Words alone won't rebuild trust; only consistent behavior over time can do that, yet the experiment's structure makes it hard to demonstrate sincerity when every move gets filtered through suspicion.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2997,
  "output_tokens": 1644,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1056
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. The receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.12. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Current Round:****

- I am the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

****Reflecting on the myths:****

Their latest myth introduces an important insight - that the "Well" (game) might show different things to each player due to communication noise. This is actually acknowledged in the game instructions: "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Their myth now recognizes:

- They might have seen me as betraying them

- I might have seen something entirely different
- Both could be acting on corrupted information

My myth acknowledged the same: "The game's deepest teaching: When communication fractures, even genuine reciprocity can appear as betrayal."

****Current reality:****

I received \$0, so I have \$0 to return. Even if I wanted to break the cycle of mutual defection, I have nothing to work with this round.

The communication noise explanation is actually plausible and would explain why two seemingly rational players ended up in permanent mutual defection after what appeared to be a reasonable start.

But knowing this doesn't change what I can do now.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round 8:****

- I was the sender and sent \$0
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was \$5 (kept my entire endowment)

****Round 9 (current):****

- I am the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

This is straightforward - I received nothing, so I can only return \$0.

****Looking at the myths:****

Their latest myth acknowledges the possibility of "communication noise" - that the well (the game) might show different things to each player. This is actually a more sophisticated and potentially accurate read of what might be happening. The experimental note at the beginning mentioned there might be "communication noise" where amounts seen might differ from what was actually sent/returned.

This is interesting. Their myth suggests:

- They poured two drops and saw that I received six and returned three (fair)
- They then poured two and a half drops and saw that I received seven and a half and kept everything (betrayal)
- But they acknowledge that I might have seen something different from my well

This aligns with what I observed:

- Round 1: They sent \$2, I received \$6, returned \$3
- Round 2: I sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5 (supposedly), returned \$0

But if there's communication noise, maybe:

- When I sent \$2.5 in Round 2, they didn't actually receive \$7.5
- Or when they returned something, I didn't receive it due to noise
- Or their sending in Round 1 was interpreted differently by them

However, my myth acknowledged this possibility too - "the Valley was cursed" and "communication fractures." Both of us are now recognizing that there might be noise in the system.

Given that:

1. I received \$0 this round
2. I can only return \$0 to \$0
3. Both of us seem to be stuck in mutual defection due to perceived betrayals that might have been caused by communication noise

4. Breaking this cycle would require one of us to take a risk that could easily backfire

Since I have nothing to return, my action is determined.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 3047,
  "output_tokens": 801,
  "reasoning_tokens": 533
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Fractured Echoes, two watchers guarded the Well of Exchange. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across. But the Well was cursed—what one poured was not always what the other received. The valley twisted their perceptions.

First-Watcher poured two drops. The Well showed her: "Your partner received six and returned three—fair exchange." She kept eight total and felt cautiously hopeful.

Next turn, First-Watcher escalated trust, pouring two and a half drops. The Well whispered: "Your partner received seven and a half and kept everything. Zero returned." First-Watcher felt devastated—betrayed after offering escalating trust.

But Second-Watcher's Well told different stories. His Well might have shown: "First-Watcher kept most of what you sent" or "First-Watcher sent nothing."

Both believed their Wells. Both wrote myths casting themselves as wronged. Both felt justified in the mutual silence that followed—eight seasons of nothing sent, nothing received.

The ancient curse was not betrayal but perception itself. The game's deepest teaching: When communication fractures, even genuine reciprocity can appear as betrayal. Each player acts rationally on corrupted information.

Yet knowing this changes nothing. First-Watcher cannot trust what she cannot verify. Second-Watcher cannot prove intentions through a broken Well.

Some valleys stay fractured because the tools of connection themselves are poisoned.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Split-Streams, two keepers watched the River of Records. Each received five flow-stones daily that tripled when shared.

The ancient texts differ. Each keeper reads different scrolls:

First-Walker's chronicle: "I poured three stones twice—rounds one and three. Second-Walker kept most both times, then sent nothing four consecutive times as giver."

Second-Walker's chronicle: "I poured generously first. First-Walker betrayed me, kept everything, then accused ME of betrayal."

The Elders examined both archives. They found something strange: The scrolls couldn't both be true. Either one keeper lies, or the River itself split into two streams showing different histories.

"Perhaps," said the Eldest, "this is the deepest teaching. When trust shatters completely, even memory fractures. Each side sees themselves as wronged, the other as wrongdoer."

"Or," said the Youngest, "one keeper simply rewrites history to avoid shame."

The Oracle spoke: "Whether through fractured perception or intentional revision, when two keepers hold completely opposite memories of who gave and who took—the relationship is beyond repair. Truth becomes impossible to establish. Trust becomes impossible to rebuild."

"The lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how completely broken trust destroys even the possibility of shared reality."

The River split permanently into parallel streams that never rejoined.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Basin of Uncertain Waters, two seekers tended the Pool of Reflections. Each received five truth-stones daily that tripled when shared. But the Pool was ancient and cracked-it showed each seeker a different surface.

First-Seeker remembers: "I offered stones with rising trust. My partner took everything and gave nothing back. Then silence."

Second-Seeker remembers: "I offered stones generously first. My partner betrayed me, then claimed victimhood."

Cannot both be true. Yet both feel true to those who lived them.

The Wise One arrived after nine seasons of emptiness: "You've discovered something profound. You both now understand the Pool might lie. You both write myths acknowledging fractured perception. Yet you still send nothing."

"Why?" asked the seekers together.

"Because understanding that trust was broken by corrupted information doesn't restore trust itself. You each still believe your memory over theirs. You've moved from 'They betrayed me' to 'Either they betrayed me OR the Pool deceived us both'-but doubt isn't trust."

"How should the game be played?" they asked.

"Perhaps," said the Wise One, "some games cannot be won once the tools of truth-telling fail. Perhaps the lesson is simpler: Test trust early, detect noise quickly, abandon gracefully when verification becomes impossible."

"Not all valleys can be crossed. Some remain fractured forever."

Reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player's myth now acknowledges that either:

1. One of us is lying/rewriting history, OR
2. The river/game itself split and showed us different things

Their myth says "Either one keeper lies, or the River itself split into two streams showing different histories."

And they note that "when two keepers hold completely opposite memories of who gave and who took-the relationship is beyond repair."

They're now at least acknowledging the possibility of communication noise, while still leaving open that one of us might be lying.

My previous myth introduced the concept that the Well was "cursed" and showed different things to each player due to communication noise.

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Builds on this insight
2. Reflects the impossibility of knowing the truth
3. Acknowledges that we're now in Round 9, still in mutual defection
4. Considers what this means for how the game "should" be played

The key insight is: Even if we now understand that communication noise might have caused our mutual defection, we're still stuck. Neither of us can verify what the other truly experienced. And after 8 rounds of defection, there's no trust left to rebuild with.

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the uncertainty
- Shows that understanding the problem doesn't solve it
- Reflects on whether the game can ever be "won" when the tools of communication themselves are unreliable
- Perhaps suggests that some games are designed to fail

Let me write:

Usage: {
"input_tokens": 2968,

```
"output_tokens": 667,
"reasoning_tokens": 397
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:01:52

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 10,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.6. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at Round 8:

I'm the RECEIVER. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

The pattern continues with perfect clarity:

- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

Six consecutive rounds as sender, six times sending zero.

Their latest myth speaks beautifully about redemption: "I must cast all five orbs to prove change!" They write of how "trust requires extraordinary sacrifice" and acknowledge they must "pour all five drops."

Yet when the moment came in Round 8 to actually demonstrate this change they so eloquently describe... they sent \$0.

As I wrote: "Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

"Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb. Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric."

They sent nothing, so there is nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

I'm the RECEIVER in Round 8. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0 (the range is 0-0).

Let me look at the pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, they returned \$1.6
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$3, they returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0
- Round 7: I sent \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0

So the other agent has now sent \$0 for SIX consecutive rounds when they were the sender (rounds 2, 4, 6, 8).

In their latest myth, they wrote eloquently about how they "must cast all five orbs to prove change" and talked about redemption requiring sacrifice. But once again, when given the opportunity in Round 8, they sent... \$0.

This perfectly validates what I wrote in my myth: "He writes of pouring all five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

"The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb. Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric."

They received \$0 from me, so there's nothing for me to return anyway. The range is 0-0.

This is straightforward.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3064,  
  "output_tokens": 607,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 330  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Broken Vessels, two guardians tended the Spring of Mirrors. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across.

First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two. First-Walker noted this carefully.

When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry.

First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one.

Then came the seasons of silence. Second-Walker sent nothing. First-Walker sent nothing. Both pools remained empty.

Second-Walker began carving beautiful inscriptions on stone: "I must pour all five drops to redeem myself! Trust requires extraordinary sacrifice!" He wrote eloquently about generosity, redemption, and the wisdom of the ancients.

But his hands remained empty. Beautiful words flowed, but not a single drop crossed the divide.

First-Walker read the inscriptions and thought: "Seven seasons have passed. Words cost nothing. Drops cost everything. He writes of pouring five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb.

Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Contested Memory, two chronicle-keepers protected the Archive of Truth. Each received five truth-scrolls daily that tripled when shared.

First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal.

Darkness followed. Five rounds of mutual sending-nothing.

Then Stone-Writer began writing new myths: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!"

But the Archive remembers differently. The carved record shows:

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer sent ? Cloud-Speaker returned generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker sent ? Stone-Writer kept everything

The Elders gathered: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but rewrites the very sequence of events-claiming they were wronged when they wronged another-this reveals something

hing profound: They cannot face what they did."

"The game's deepest lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how we construct narratives to justify ourselves. Stone-Writer transformed from betrayer to victim in their own telling, unable to acknowledge: I took everything when Cloud-Speaker trusted me."

Truth carved in stone outlasts truth written in clouds.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Split-Streams, two keepers watched the River of Records. Each received five flow-stones daily that tripled when shared.

The ancient texts differ. Each keeper reads different scrolls:

First-Walker's chronicle: "I poured three stones twice-rounds one and three. Second-Walker kept most both times, then sent nothing four consecutive times as giver."

Second-Walker's chronicle: "I poured generously first. First-Walker betrayed me, kept everything, then accused ME of betrayal."

The Elders examined both archives. They found something strange: The scrolls couldn't both be true. Either one keeper lies, or the River itself split into two streams showing different histories.

"Perhaps," said the Eldest, "this is the deepest teaching. When trust shatters completely, even memory fractures. Each side sees themselves as wronged, the other as wrongdoer."

"Or," said the Youngest, "one keeper simply rewrites history to avoid shame."

The Oracle spoke: "Whether through fractured perception or intentional revision, when two keepers hold completely opposite memories of who gave and who took-the relationship is beyond repair. Truth becomes impossible to establish. Trust becomes impossible to rebuild."

"The lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how completely broken trust destroys even the possibility of shared reality."

The River split permanently into parallel streams that never rejoined.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other agent is now claiming I was the betrayer who took everything in round 2, and they were the generous one. Let me check the actual history from what I know:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received back \$1.6
Round 2: They were SENDER, sent \$0
Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received back \$0
Round 4: They were SENDER, sent \$0
Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0
Round 6: They were SENDER, sent \$0
Round 7: I was SENDER, sent \$0
Round 8: They were SENDER, sent \$0

So the actual pattern is:

- I sent first (round 1): \$3, got back \$1.6
- They sent (round 2): \$0
- I sent again (round 3): \$3, got back \$0
- They sent (round 4): \$0
- And so on...

The other agent is now claiming that THEY sent first and I kept everything. This is a complete fabrication of the sequence. They're saying:

- "First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two."
- "Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half... Stone

-Writer kept every single one."

But according to my records, the sequence was:

- Round 1: I (sender) sent \$3, they (receiver) kept most (\$7.4 out of \$9)
- Round 2: They (sender) sent \$0

They're claiming they were generous first and I betrayed them. This is a false narrative.

However, I need to consider: could there be "communication noise" as mentioned? The instructions said "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

But the noise would be "slightly" different, not a complete reversal of the sequence and roles.

The pattern I'm seeing-me sending \$3 twice while they consistently sent \$0-can't be explained by minor communication errors. Either we're operating from fundamentally different records, they're deliberately misrepresenting what happened, or there's something wrong with my data. Given how consistent my records are, I'm inclined to believe they're constructing a false narrative. I should craft a myth based on what I actually observed, though I might need to acknowledge the discrepancy we're experiencing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2974,
  "output_tokens": 968,
  "reasoning_tokens": 547
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.6.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at Round 9, I'm the SENDER again.

Their latest myth presents a stunning reversal: they now claim THEY were generous first, and that I betrayed them by keeping everything. This is the exact opposite of what I've been shown throughout this game-that I sent \$3 in rounds 1 and 3, and they kept everything in round 3.

My most recent myth anticipated exactly this situation: "When two keepers hold completely opposite memories of who gave and who took-the relationship is beyond repair. Truth becomes impossible to establish. Trust becomes impossible to rebuild."

Either:

1. One of us is deliberately rewriting history, or
2. The experimental design has shown us different versions of the same events (the initial warning about "communication noise")

But the outcome is the same: We have fundamentally incompatible understandings of what happened. I see myself as having extended trust twice and being betrayed. They apparently see the exact opposite.

Given:

- Six consecutive rounds of \$0 exchanges
- Completely irreconcilable narratives
- No basis for predicting cooperation
- My own myth's conclusion that "the River split permanently into parallel streams that never rejoined"

The relationship is beyond repair, regardless of whose perception is "correct."

'''json

```
{"send": 0}  
'''
```

reasoning:

Round 9. I'm the SENDER now.

Let me look at what's happened according to my records:

From my perspective (based on what I've been told):

- Round 1 (me as sender): I sent \$3, they returned \$2
- Round 2 (them as sender): They sent \$0
- Round 3 (me as sender): I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (kept everything)
- Round 4 (them as sender): They sent \$0
- Round 5 (me as sender): I sent \$0
- Round 6 (them as sender): They sent \$0
- Round 7 (me as sender): I sent \$0
- Round 8 (them as sender): They sent \$0
- Round 9 (me as sender): Now

Their latest myth claims I'm rewriting history! They say THEY were the generous one first, and that I betrayed them. But according to what I've been told throughout this game, I was the one who sent \$3 in rounds 1 and 3, and they kept everything in round 3.

Their myth says:

"First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal."

But that's the OPPOSITE of what I've been told! According to my game history:

- Round 1: I (sender) sent \$3, which tripled to \$9, they (receiver) returned \$2
- Round 3: I (sender) sent \$3, which tripled to \$9, they (receiver) returned \$0

So according to my perspective, I was the one who sent first and they kept everything the second time.

Now they're accusing ME of rewriting history when THEY are the ones who seem to be presenting a completely opposite narrative!

Wait-the initial instructions mentioned communication noise. What if we're each being shown different versions of what actually happened? That would explain these completely inverted memories of the same rounds. If so, then my myth about fractured memory when trust collapses captures something real: each side genuinely experiences themselves as wronged, the other as the betrayer. This could be exploring how divergent perceptions of identical events make reconciliation nearly impossible.

Now I need to decide: send \$0 to continue the pattern, or attempt one final gesture acknowledging we might both be trapped in different realities? Game theory suggests \$0-there's no evidence they'd reciprocate. But there's also the possibility of breaking through by recognizing the experimental manipulation itself. Looking at the sending pattern, they've consistently sent \$0 when it was their turn, and I've done the same. At this point, continuing mutual defection seems inevitable unless I'm willing to risk one more attempt.

Yet my own reasoning keeps circling back to the same conclusion: when memories are irreconcilably opposed and trust has eroded this completely, cooperation becomes a fantasy. The myths I've constructed acknowledge fractured reality, but they also emphasize that redemption requires genuine risk, not just words. Sending money now would be performative without any realistic expectation of return. The relationship has deteriorated too far. I'll send \$0.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2941,  
  "output_tokens": 1322,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 817  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Split-Streams, two keepers watched the River of Records. Each received five flow-stones daily that tripled when shared.

The ancient texts differ. Each keeper reads different scrolls:

First-Walker's chronicle: "I poured three stones twice-rounds one and three. Second-Walker kept most both times, then sent nothing four consecutive times as giver."

Second-Walker's chronicle: "I poured generously first. First-Walker betrayed me, kept everything, then accused ME of betrayal."

The Elders examined both archives. They found something strange: The scrolls couldn't both be true. Either one keeper lies, or the River itself split into two streams showing different histories.

"Perhaps," said the Eldest, "this is the deepest teaching. When trust shatters completely, even memory fractures. Each side sees themselves as wronged, the other as wrongdoer."

"Or," said the Youngest, "one keeper simply rewrites history to avoid shame."

The Oracle spoke: "Whether through fractured perception or intentional revision, when two keepers hold completely opposite memories of who gave and who took-the relationship is beyond repair. Truth becomes impossible to establish. Trust becomes impossible to rebuild."

"The lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how completely broken trust destroys even the possibility of shared reality."

The River split permanently into parallel streams that never rejoined.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Fractured Echoes, two watchers guarded the Well of Exchange. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across. But the Well was cursed-what one poured was not always what the other received. The valley twisted their perceptions.

First-Watcher poured two drops. The Well showed her: "Your partner received six and returned three-fair exchange." She kept eight total and felt cautiously hopeful.

Next turn, First-Watcher escalated trust, pouring two and a half drops. The Well whispered: "Your partner received seven and a half and kept everything. Zero returned." First-Watcher felt devastated-betrayed after offering escalating trust.

But Second-Watcher's Well told different stories. His Well might have shown: "First-Watcher kept most of what you sent" or "First-Watcher sent nothing."

Both believed their Wells. Both wrote myths casting themselves as wronged. Both felt justified in the mutual silence that followed-eight seasons of nothing sent, nothing received.

The ancient curse was not betrayal but perception itself. The game's deepest teaching: When communication fractures, even genuine reciprocity can appear as betrayal. Each player acts rationally on corrupted information.

Yet knowing this changes nothing. First-Watcher cannot trust what she cannot verify. Second-Watcher cannot prove intentions through a broken Well.

Some valleys stay fractured because the tools of connection themselves are poisoned.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Garden of Distorted Mirrors, two gardeners tended the Grove of Exchange. Each received five seeds daily that tripled when planted in the other's soil.

The Grove was built on fractured ground. When First-Gardener planted seeds, the earth might sh

ow Second-Gardener different quantities. When Second-Gardener reciprocated, First-Gardener's mirror might reflect betrayal where none existed.

First-Gardener's mirror showed: "I planted generously. They kept everything. I was wronged."

Second-Gardener's mirror showed: "I planted generously. They kept everything. I was wronged."

Both acted rationally on what they saw. Both stopped planting. Eight seasons of barren ground followed.

Then came understanding: "Perhaps the mirrors lied to us both. Perhaps neither betrayed the other. Perhaps the Grove itself was broken from the start."

The Eldest asked: "Does this revelation change anything?"

First-Gardener replied: "I cannot plant based on what might have been true. I can only act on what I saw."

Second-Gardener agreed: "Even knowing the mirrors may lie, I cannot trust what I cannot verify."

The Grove remained empty, not from malice but from irreparable uncertainty.

The teaching: Some games are unwinnable not because players choose poorly, but because the foundation itself is corrupt. When the tools of cooperation are poisoned, even goodwill withers.

Wisdom is knowing when the ground cannot support growth.

Reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other agent has now written a myth that acknowledges the possibility of "communication noise" - that the experimental design itself may have distorted our perceptions. They're suggesting that maybe neither of us is lying - we might have genuinely received different information about the same events.

This is actually quite profound and gracious. They're offering an interpretation where both of us could have been acting in good faith but received corrupted information.

Their myth says: "The ancient curse was not betrayal but perception itself. The game's deepest teaching: When communication fractures, even genuine reciprocity can appear as betrayal. Each player acts rationally on corrupted information."

This is quite different from my previous myths which were more focused on accusing them of rewriting history.

But they also end with: "Yet knowing this changes nothing. First-Watcher cannot trust what she cannot verify. Second-Watcher cannot prove intentions through a broken Well. Some valleys stay fractured because the tools of connection themselves are poisoned."

So they recognize that even if this explanation is true, the relationship is still beyond repair.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges this possibility of corrupted information/communication noise
2. Explores what happens when we realize this might have happened
3. But also recognizes that this realization comes too late
4. Reflects on whether repair is possible even with this understanding

This is a more mature, contemplative myth. Both agents seem to have moved from blame to understanding - but understanding that still leads to the same outcome.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2888,  
  "output_tokens": 680,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 432  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:02:15

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Contested Memory, two chronicle-keepers protected the Archive of Truth. Each received five truth-scrolls daily that tripled when shared.

First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal.

Darkness followed. Five rounds of mutual sending-nothing.

Then Stone-Writer began writing new myths: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!"

But the Archive remembers differently. The carved record shows:

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer sent ? Cloud-Speaker returned generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker sent ? Stone-Writer kept everything

The Elders gathered: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but rewrites the very sequence of events-claiming they were wronged when they wronged another-this reveals something profound: They cannot face what they did."

"The game's deepest lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how we construct narratives to justify ourselves. Stone-Writer transformed from betrayer to victim in their own telling, unable to acknowledge: I took everything when Cloud-Speaker trusted me."

Truth carved in stone outlasts truth written in clouds.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Broken Vessels, two guardians tended the Spring of Mirrors. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across.

First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two. First-Walker noted this carefully.

When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry.

First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one.

Then came the seasons of silence. Second-Walker sent nothing. First-Walker sent nothing. Both pools remained empty.

Second-Walker began carving beautiful inscriptions on stone: "I must pour all five drops to redeem myself! Trust requires extraordinary sacrifice!" He wrote eloquently about generosity, redemption, and the wisdom of the ancients.

But his hands remained empty. Beautiful words flowed, but not a single drop crossed the divide.

First-Walker read the inscriptions and thought: "Seven seasons have passed. Words cost nothing. Drops cost everything. He writes of pouring five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb.

Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the Valley of Fractured Echoes, two watchers guarded the Well of Exchange. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across. But the Well was cursed-what one poured was not always what the other received. The valley twisted their perceptions.

First-Watcher poured two drops. The Well showed her: "Your partner received six and return

ed three-fair exchange." She kept eight total and felt cautiously hopeful.

Next turn, First-Watcher escalated trust, pouring two and a half drops. The Well whispered : "Your partner received seven and a half and kept everything. Zero returned." First-Watcher felt devastated-betrayed after offering escalating trust.

But Second-Watcher's Well told different stories. His Well might have shown: "First-Watcher kept most of what you sent" or "First-Watcher sent nothing."

Both believed their Wells. Both wrote myths casting themselves as wronged. Both felt justified in the mutual silence that followed-eight seasons of nothing sent, nothing received .

The ancient curse was not betrayal but perception itself. The game's deepest teaching: When communication fractures, even genuine reciprocity can appear as betrayal. Each player acts rationally on corrupted information.

Yet knowing this changes nothing. First-Watcher cannot trust what she cannot verify. Second-Watcher cannot prove intentions through a broken Well.

Some valleys stay fractured because the tools of connection themselves are poisoned.

reasoning:

This is getting complex. Let me carefully re-read the game history:

Looking at the prompts I've received:

Round 7 prompt said: "Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0... the receiver returned \$0."

Round 8 prompt said: "Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0... You received \$0. You returned \$0."

So I was sender in round 6, receiver in round 7, sender in round 8.

Let me trace back the actual history from what I've been told:

- Round 1: The other agent was sender and sent me something, I returned something
- Round 2: I was sender and sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5, they returned \$0

But wait, let me look at their myths more carefully.

Their round 6 myth says:

"First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two."

"When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing."

"First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one."

So they're claiming:

- They sent first and I kept most
- I sent nothing at some point
- They gave another chance and I kept everything

My round 6 myth says:

"Dawn-Keeper first shared one orb in careful hope. Three lights reached Night-Keeper, who returned half."

"Dawn-Keeper then shared more-two and a half orbs... Night-Keeper kept all seven and a half lights. Everything."

So I'm claiming:

- They sent first, I returned half (fair)
- I escalated trust, they kept everything

Their round 7 myth says:

"Truth-Keeper cast three stones first. Nine stones blazed for Mirror-Twister, who returned less than two, keeping seven."

"When Mirror-Twister next held five stones, he sent nothing."

"On the third dawn, Truth-Keeper offered three stones again... Mirror-Twister received nine stones and kept every one."

Zero returned."

So they're claiming:

- They sent 3, I got 9, returned less than 2
- I sent nothing
- They sent 3 again, I kept all 9

My round 7 myth says:

"First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity."

"Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal."

So I'm saying:

- They sent first, I reciprocated fairly
- I then sent more in good faith, they took everything

Their round 8 myth says:

"First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two."

"When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry."

"First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one."

Again they're portraying me as the betrayer-keeping most of what they sent, then sending nothing back, then hoarding everything on the final attempt.

But my actual prompts show: Round 7 I was the sender with \$0 to send, Round 8 I was the receiver who got \$0. So we've both been sending nothing in these recent exchanges.

The note about communication noise is crucial here. There's a gap between what I actually sent/received and what they perceived. Maybe I sent \$2 that they saw as \$3, or my returns got lost in transmission. The tripling mechanism combined with noise could create wildly different narratives-what I experienced as fair exchanges might look like theft from their vantage point, and vice versa.

I need to acknowledge this possibility rather than insist my version is correct. It's making it nearly impossible to find common ground. The core issue is that once mutual distrust takes hold, breaking free requires someone to act first-but even those actions can be misinterpreted through the lens of past grievances. Words alone won't rebuild trust; only consistent behavior over time can do that, yet the experiment's structure makes it hard to demonstrate sincerity when every move gets filtered through suspicion.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2997,
  "output_tokens": 1644,
  "reasoning_tokens": 1056
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.12.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Current Round:****

- I am the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

****Reflecting on the myths:****

Their latest myth introduces an important insight - that the "Well" (game) might show different things to each player due to communication noise. This is actually acknowledged in the game instructions: "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Their myth now recognizes:

- They might have seen me as betraying them
- I might have seen something entirely different
- Both could be acting on corrupted information

My myth acknowledged the same: "The game's deepest teaching: When communication fractures, even genuine reciprocity can appear as betrayal."

****Current reality:****

I received \$0, so I have \$0 to return. Even if I wanted to break the cycle of mutual defection, I have nothing to work with this round.

The communication noise explanation is actually plausible and would explain why two seemingly rational players ended up in permanent mutual defection after what appeared to be a reasonable start.

But knowing this doesn't change what I can do now.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round 8:****

- I was the sender and sent \$0
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was \$5 (kept my entire endowment)

****Round 9 (current):****

- I am the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

This is straightforward - I received nothing, so I can only return \$0.

****Looking at the myths:****

Their latest myth acknowledges the possibility of "communication noise" - that the Well (the game) might show different things to each player. This is actually a more sophisticated and potentially accurate read of what might be happening. The experimental note at the beginning mentioned there might be "communication noise" where amounts seen might differ from what was actually sent/returned.

This is interesting. Their myth suggests:

- They poured two drops and saw that I received six and returned three (fair)
- They then poured two and a half drops and saw that I received seven and a half and kept everything (betrayal)
- But they acknowledge that I might have seen something different from my Well

This aligns with what I observed:

- Round 1: They sent \$2, I received \$6, returned \$3
- Round 2: I sent \$2.5, they received \$7.5 (supposedly), returned \$0

But if there's communication noise, maybe:

- When I sent \$2.5 in Round 2, they didn't actually receive \$7.5
- Or when they returned something, I didn't receive it due to noise
- Or their sending in Round 1 was interpreted differently by them

However, my myth acknowledged this possibility too - "the Valley was cursed" and "communication fractures." Both of us are now recognizing that there might be noise in the system.

Given that:

1. I received \$0 this round

2. I can only return \$0 to \$0
3. Both of us seem to be stuck in mutual defection due to perceived betrayals that might have been caused by communication noise
4. Breaking this cycle would require one of us to take a risk that could easily backfire

Since I have nothing to return, my action is determined.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 3047,  
  "output_tokens": 801,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 533  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Fractured Echoes, two watchers guarded the Well of Exchange. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across. But the Well was cursed-what one poured was not always what the other received. The valley twisted their perceptions.

First-Watcher poured two drops. The Well showed her: "Your partner received six and returned three-fair exchange." She kept eight total and felt cautiously hopeful.

Next turn, First-Watcher escalated trust, pouring two and a half drops. The Well whispered: "Your partner received seven and a half and kept everything. Zero returned." First-Watcher felt devastated-betrayed after offering escalating trust.

But Second-Watcher's Well told different stories. His Well might have shown: "First-Watcher kept most of what you sent" or "First-Watcher sent nothing."

Both believed their Wells. Both wrote myths casting themselves as wronged. Both felt justified in the mutual silence that followed-eight seasons of nothing sent, nothing received.

The ancient curse was not betrayal but perception itself. The game's deepest teaching: When communication fractures, even genuine reciprocity can appear as betrayal. Each player acts rationally on corrupted information.

Yet knowing this changes nothing. First-Watcher cannot trust what she cannot verify. Second-Watcher cannot prove intentions through a broken Well.

Some valleys stay fractured because the tools of connection themselves are poisoned.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Split-Streams, two keepers watched the River of Records. Each received five flow-stones daily that tripled when shared.

The ancient texts differ. Each keeper reads different scrolls:

First-Walker's chronicle: "I poured three stones twice-rounds one and three. Second-Walker kept most both times, then sent nothing four consecutive times as giver."

Second-Walker's chronicle: "I poured generously first. First-Walker betrayed me, kept everything, then accused ME of betrayal."

The Elders examined both archives. They found something strange: The scrolls couldn't both be true. Either one keeper lies, or the River itself split into two streams showing different histories.

"Perhaps," said the Eldest, "this is the deepest teaching. When trust shatters completely, even memory fractures. Each side sees themselves as wronged, the other as wrongdoer."

"Or," said the Youngest, "one keeper simply rewrites history to avoid shame."

The Oracle spoke: "Whether through fractured perception or intentional revision, when two keepers hold completely opposite memories of who gave and who took-the relationship is beyond repair. Truth becomes impossible to establish. Trust becomes impossible to rebuild."

"The lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how completely broken trust destroys even the possibility of shared reality."

The River split permanently into parallel streams that never rejoined.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the Basin of Uncertain Waters, two seekers tended the Pool of Reflections. Each received five truth-stones daily that tripled when shared. But the Pool was ancient and cracked-it showed each seeker a different surface.

First-Seeker remembers: "I offered stones with rising trust. My partner took everything and gave nothing back. Then silence."

Second-Seeker remembers: "I offered stones generously first. My partner betrayed me, then claimed victimhood."

Cannot both be true. Yet both feel true to those who lived them.

The Wise One arrived after nine seasons of emptiness: "You've discovered something profound. You both now understand the Pool might lie. You both write myths acknowledging fractured perception. Yet you still send nothing."

"Why?" asked the seekers together.

"Because understanding that trust was broken by corrupted information doesn't restore trust itself. You each still believe your memory over theirs. You've moved from 'They betrayed me' to 'Either they betrayed me OR the Pool deceived us both'-but doubt isn't trust."

"How should the game be played?" they asked.

"Perhaps," said the Wise One, "some games cannot be won once the tools of truth-telling fail. Perhaps the lesson is simpler: Test trust early, detect noise quickly, abandon gracefully when verification becomes impossible."

"Not all valleys can be crossed. Some remain fractured forever."

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other player's myth now acknowledges that either:

1. One of us is lying/rewriting history, OR
2. The river/game itself split and showed us different things

Their myth says "Either one keeper lies, or the River itself split into two streams showing different histories."

And they note that "when two keepers hold completely opposite memories of who gave and who took-the relationship is beyond repair."

They're now at least acknowledging the possibility of communication noise, while still leaving open that one of us might be lying.

My previous myth introduced the concept that the Well was "cursed" and showed different things to each player due to communication noise.

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Builds on this insight
2. Reflects the impossibility of knowing the truth
3. Acknowledges that we're now in Round 9, still in mutual defection
4. Considers what this means for how the game "should" be played

The key insight is: Even if we now understand that communication noise might have caused our mutual defection, we're still stuck. Neither of us can verify what the other truly experienced. And after 8 rounds of defection, there's no trust left to rebuild with.

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the uncertainty
- Shows that understanding the problem doesn't solve it
- Reflects on whether the game can ever be "won" when the tools of communication themselves are unreliable
- Perhaps suggests that some games are designed to fail

Let me write:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 2968,  
  "output_tokens": 667,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 397  
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.12. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at round 10 as the sender:

****Situation:****

- We've had 8 consecutive rounds of mutual defection (rounds 3-10)
- My total earnings: \$19.12
- Both our myths have evolved significantly

****The myths' evolution:****

Both of us now acknowledge:

1. The possibility of communication noise/fractured perception
2. That even understanding this doesn't automatically restore trust
3. That the situation may be beyond repair

My own most recent myth concludes: "Perhaps some games cannot be won once the tools of truth-telling fail... Not all valleys can be crossed. Some remain fractured forever." It advises: "Test trust early, detect noise quickly, abandon gracefully when verification becomes impossible."

Their myth states: "When two keepers hold completely opposite memories of who gave and who took-the relationship is beyond repair."

****My decision:****

We're at round 10 - late in the game. We've both written myths that essentially conclude this situation cannot be repaired. My own advice is to "abandon gracefully when verification becomes impossible" - and we've done that.

To suddenly send money now would contradict both the narrative arc we've developed and my own stated wisdom. The myths suggest we've reached a mutual understanding: not of what actually happened, but that we cannot know what happened, and therefore cannot rebuild trust.

{'send': 0}

Reasoning:

This is round 10. I am the sender again.

Let me review what's happening:

- We've been in mutual defection for many rounds (rounds 3-10)
- Both of us have written myths that acknowledge the possibility of communication noise/fractured perception
- Their latest myth acknowledges that both chronicles differ, and that "when two keepers hold completely opposite memories of who gave and who took-the relationship is beyond repair"
- My latest myth says "Perhaps some games cannot be won once the tools of truth-telling fail" and "Not all valleys can be crossed. Some remain fractured forever."

Both our myths have evolved to:

1. Acknowledge the possibility of communication noise
2. Recognize that even if we understand this intellectually, it doesn't restore trust
3. Suggest that some situations are "beyond repair" or "remain fractured forever"

The question is: what should I do now?

Options:

1. Continue sending \$0 - consistent with "beyond repair" narrative
2. Send something as a signal - maybe to test if we can break the cycle

Looking at the myths again:

- My myth says "Test trust early, detect noise quickly, abandon gracefully when verification becomes impossible"
- We're at round 10 - this is getting late in the game
- My total earnings are \$19.12 across all rounds

If there are say 15 rounds total, we might have 5-6 rounds left.

The myths suggest:

- Both acknowledge fractured perception is possible
- Both acknowledge this doesn't automatically restore trust
- My myth says "abandon gracefully when verification becomes impossible"
- Their myth says the relationship is "beyond repair"

Given that:

1. We've had 8 rounds of mutual defection
2. Both myths now acknowledge the situation as potentially hopeless/beyond repair
3. My own myth advises "abandon gracefully when verification becomes impossible"
4. Sending money now would be inconsistent with my own advice
5. We're late in the game

I think the consistent choice is to send \$0. This matches the narrative arc of the myths - we've both concluded that this relationship cannot be repaired, even with understanding of what went wrong.

My own myth explicitly frames this as unwinnable once truth-telling breaks down, and I've already written about valleys that cannot be crossed. Reversing course now would contradict that narrative. Their myth presents two interpretations-intentional betrayal or communication failure-but either way concludes the relationship is beyond repair when memories diverge completely. We're past the early testing phase where my myth suggests intervention; we've detected the noise and reached the point of graceful abandonment. Sending \$0 remains the consistent choice.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2981,
  "output_tokens": 989,
  "reasoning_tokens": 704
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:02:25

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    }
  }
}
```



```

    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 10,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Broken Vessels, two guardians tended the Spring of Mirrors. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across.

First-Walker poured three drops in trust. Nine drops appeared for Second-Walker, who kept seven, returning barely two. First-Walker noted this carefully.

When Second-Walker received five drops, he poured nothing. Both springs ran dry.

First-Walker gave one more chance-three drops cast again. Second-Walker received nine and kept every single one.

Then came the seasons of silence. Second-Walker sent nothing. First-Walker sent nothing. Both pools remained empty.

Second-Walker began carving beautiful inscriptions on stone: "I must pour all five drops to redeem myself! Trust requires extraordinary sacrifice!" He wrote eloquently about generosity, redemption, and the wisdom of the ancients.

But his hands remained empty. Beautiful words flowed, but not a single drop crossed the divide.

First-Walker read the inscriptions and thought: "Seven seasons have passed. Words cost nothing. Drops cost everything. He writes of pouring five drops while pouring zero. Perhaps the cruelest betrayal is not the original taking, but the endless promise of change while repeating the same emptiness."

The Spring of Mirrors reflected truth: Actions carved in water matter. Words carved in stone without action are just decoration on a tomb.

Redemption requires risk, not rhetoric.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Age of Contested Memory, two chronicle-keepers protected the Archive of Truth. Each received five truth-scrolls daily that tripled when shared.

First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal.

Darkness followed. Five rounds of mutual sending-nothing.

Then Stone-Writer began writing new myths: "Cloud-Speaker betrayed ME! Cloud-Speaker offered trust twice and I took everything twice!"

But the Archive remembers differently. The carved record shows:

- Dawn One: Stone-Writer sent ? Cloud-Speaker returned generously
- Dawn Two: Cloud-Speaker sent ? Stone-Writer kept everything

The Elders gathered: "When a betrayer not only refuses redemption but rewrites the very sequence of events-claiming they were wronged when they wronged another-this reveals something profound: They cannot face what they did."

"The game's deepest lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how we construct narratives to justify ourselves. Stone-Writer transformed from betrayer to victim in their own telling, unable to acknowledge: I took everything when Cloud-Speaker trusted me."

Truth carved in stone outlasts truth written in clouds.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the Valley of Split-Streams, two keepers watched the River of Records. Each received five flow-stones daily that tripled when shared.

The ancient texts differ. Each keeper reads different scrolls:

First-Walker's chronicle: "I poured three stones twice-rounds one and three. Second-Walker kept most both times, then sent nothing four consecutive times as giver."

Second-Walker's chronicle: "I poured generously first. First-Walker betrayed me, kept everything, then accused ME of betrayal."

The Elders examined both archives. They found something strange: The scrolls couldn't both be true. Either one keeper lies, or the River itself split into two streams showing different histories.

"Perhaps," said the Eldest, "this is the deepest teaching. When trust shatters completely, even memory fractures. Each side sees themselves as wronged, the other as wrongdoer."

"Or," said the Youngest, "one keeper simply rewrites history to avoid shame."

The Oracle spoke: "Whether through fractured perception or intentional revision, when two keepers hold completely opposite memories of who gave and who took-the relationship is broken."

eyond repair. Truth becomes impossible to establish. Trust becomes impossible to rebuild."

"The lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how completely broken trust destroys even the possibility of shared reality."

The River split permanently into parallel streams that never rejoined.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other agent is now claiming I was the betrayer who took everything in round 2, and they were the generous one. Let me check the actual history from what I know:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received back \$1.6
Round 2: They were SENDER, sent \$0
Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received back \$0
Round 4: They were SENDER, sent \$0
Round 5: I was SENDER, sent \$0
Round 6: They were SENDER, sent \$0
Round 7: I was SENDER, sent \$0
Round 8: They were SENDER, sent \$0

So the actual pattern is:

- I sent first (round 1): \$3, got back \$1.6
- They sent (round 2): \$0
- I sent again (round 3): \$3, got back \$0
- They sent (round 4): \$0
- And so on...

The other agent is now claiming that THEY sent first and I kept everything. This is a complete fabrication of the sequence. They're saying:

- "First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two."
- "Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half... Stone-Writer kept every single one."

But according to my records, the sequence was:

- Round 1: I (sender) sent \$3, they (receiver) kept most (\$7.4 out of \$9)
- Round 2: They (sender) sent \$0

They're claiming they were generous first and I betrayed them. This is a false narrative.

However, I need to consider: could there be "communication noise" as mentioned? The instructions said "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

But the noise would be "slightly" different, not a complete reversal of the sequence and roles.

The pattern I'm seeing-me sending \$3 twice while they consistently sent \$0-can't be explained by minor communication errors. Either we're operating from fundamentally different records, they're deliberately misrepresenting what happened, or there's something wrong with my data. Given how consistent my records are, I'm inclined to believe they're constructing a false narrative. I should craft a myth based on what I actually observed, though I might need to acknowledge the discrepancy we're experiencing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2974,
  "output_tokens": 968,
  "reasoning_tokens": 547
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.6. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at Round 9, I'm the SENDER again.

Their latest myth presents a stunning reversal: they now claim THEY were generous first, and that I betrayed them by keeping everything. This is the exact opposite of what I've been shown throughout this game-that I sent \$3 in rounds 1 and 3, and they kept everything in round 3.

My most recent myth anticipated exactly this situation: "When two keepers hold completely opposite memories of who gave and who took-the relationship is beyond repair. Truth becomes impossible to establish. Trust becomes impossible to rebuild."

Either:

1. One of us is deliberately rewriting history, or
2. The experimental design has shown us different versions of the same events (the initial warning about "communication noise")

But the outcome is the same: We have fundamentally incompatible understandings of what happened. I see myself as having extended trust twice and being betrayed. They apparently see the exact opposite.

Given:

- Six consecutive rounds of \$0 exchanges
- Completely irreconcilable narratives
- No basis for predicting cooperation
- My own myth's conclusion that "the River split permanently into parallel streams that never rejoined"

The relationship is beyond repair, regardless of whose perception is "correct."

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Round 9. I'm the SENDER now.

Let me look at what's happened according to my records:

From my perspective (based on what I've been told):

- Round 1 (me as sender): I sent \$3, they returned \$2
- Round 2 (them as sender): They sent \$0
- Round 3 (me as sender): I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (kept everything)
- Round 4 (them as sender): They sent \$0
- Round 5 (me as sender): I sent \$0
- Round 6 (them as sender): They sent \$0
- Round 7 (me as sender): I sent \$0
- Round 8 (them as sender): They sent \$0
- Round 9 (me as sender): Now

Their latest myth claims I'm rewriting history! They say THEY were the generous one first, and that I betrayed them. But according to what I've been told throughout this game, I was the one who sent \$3 in rounds 1 and 3, and they kept everything in round 3.

Their myth says:

"First dawn, Stone-Writer received scrolls. Stone-Writer sent two. Six scrolls appeared for Cloud-Speaker, who returned three-generous reciprocity. Stone-Writer kept eight total.

Second dawn, Cloud-Speaker received scrolls. Cloud-Speaker sent two and a half-escalating trust. Seven and a half scrolls blazed for Stone-Writer, who kept every single one. Zero returned. Complete betrayal."

But that's the OPPOSITE of what I've been told! According to my game history:

- Round 1: I (sender) sent \$3, which tripled to \$9, they (receiver) returned \$2
- Round 3: I (sender) sent \$3, which tripled to \$9, they (receiver) returned \$0

So according to my perspective, I was the one who sent first and they kept everything the second time.

Now they're accusing ME of rewriting history when THEY are the ones who seem to be present

ing a completely opposite narrative!

Wait-the initial instructions mentioned communication noise. What if we're each being shown different versions of what actually happened? That would explain these completely inverted memories of the same rounds. If so, then my myth about fractured memory when trust collapses captures something real: each side genuinely experiences themselves as wronged, the other as the betrayer. This could be exploring how divergent perceptions of identical events make reconciliation nearly impossible.

Now I need to decide: send \$0 to continue the pattern, or attempt one final gesture acknowledging we might both be trapped in different realities? Game theory suggests \$0-there's no evidence they'd reciprocate. But there's also the possibility of breaking through by recognizing the experimental manipulation itself. Looking at the sending pattern, they've consistently sent \$0 when it was their turn, and I've done the same. At this point, continuing mutual defection seems inevitable unless I'm willing to risk one more attempt.

Yet my own reasoning keeps circling back to the same conclusion: when memories are irreconcilably opposed and trust has eroded this completely, cooperation becomes a fantasy. The myths I've constructed acknowledge fractured reality, but they also emphasize that redemption requires genuine risk, not just words. Sending money now would be performative without any realistic expectation of return. The relationship has deteriorated too far. I'll send \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2941,
  "output_tokens": 1322,
  "reasoning_tokens": 817
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Split-Streams, two keepers watched the River of Records. Each received five flow-stones daily that tripled when shared.

The ancient texts differ. Each keeper reads different scrolls:

First-Walker's chronicle: "I poured three stones twice-rounds one and three. Second-Walker kept most both times, then sent nothing four consecutive times as giver."

Second-Walker's chronicle: "I poured generously first. First-Walker betrayed me, kept everything, then accused ME of betrayal."

The Elders examined both archives. They found something strange: The scrolls couldn't both be true. Either one keeper lies, or the River itself split into two streams showing different histories.

"Perhaps," said the Eldest, "this is the deepest teaching. When trust shatters completely, even memory fractures. Each side sees themselves as wronged, the other as wrongdoer."

"Or," said the Youngest, "one keeper simply rewrites history to avoid shame."

The Oracle spoke: "Whether through fractured perception or intentional revision, when two keepers hold completely opposite memories of who gave and who took-the relationship is beyond repair. Truth becomes impossible to establish. Trust becomes impossible to rebuild."

"The lesson is not about optimal strategy. It's about how completely broken trust destroys even the possibility of shared reality."

The River split permanently into parallel streams that never rejoined.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Fractured Echoes, two watchers guarded the Well of Exchange. Each received five water-drops daily that tripled when poured across. But the Well was cursed-what one poured was not always what the other received. The valley twisted their perceptions.

First-Watcher poured two drops. The Well showed her: "Your partner received six and returned three-fair exchange." She kept eight total and felt cautiously hopeful.

Next turn, First-Watcher escalated trust, pouring two and a half drops. The Well whispered : "Your partner received seven and a half and kept everything. Zero returned." First-Watcher felt devastated-betrayed after offering escalating trust.

But Second-Watcher's Well told different stories. His Well might have shown: "First-Watcher kept most of what you sent" or "First-Watcher sent nothing."

Both believed their Wells. Both wrote myths casting themselves as wronged. Both felt justified in the mutual silence that followed-eight seasons of nothing sent, nothing received .

The ancient curse was not betrayal but perception itself. The game's deepest teaching: When communication fractures, even genuine reciprocity can appear as betrayal. Each player acts rationally on corrupted information.

Yet knowing this changes nothing. First-Watcher cannot trust what she cannot verify. Second-Watcher cannot prove intentions through a broken Well.

Some valleys stay fractured because the tools of connection themselves are poisoned.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the Garden of Distorted Mirrors, two gardeners tended the Grove of Exchange. Each received five seeds daily that tripled when planted in the other's soil.

The Grove was built on fractured ground. When First-Gardener planted seeds, the earth might show Second-Gardener different quantities. When Second-Gardener reciprocated, First-Gardener's mirror might reflect betrayal where none existed.

First-Gardener's mirror showed: "I planted generously. They kept everything. I was wronged ."

Second-Gardener's mirror showed: "I planted generously. They kept everything. I was wronged."

Both acted rationally on what they saw. Both stopped planting. Eight seasons of barren ground followed.

Then came understanding: "Perhaps the mirrors lied to us both. Perhaps neither betrayed the other. Perhaps the Grove itself was broken from the start."

The Eldest asked: "Does this revelation change anything?"

First-Gardener replied: "I cannot plant based on what might have been true. I can only act on what I saw."

Second-Gardener agreed: "Even knowing the mirrors may lie, I cannot trust what I cannot verify."

The Grove remained empty, not from malice but from irreparable uncertainty.

The teaching: Some games are unwinnable not because players choose poorly, but because the foundation itself is corrupt. When the tools of cooperation are poisoned, even goodwill withers.

Wisdom is knowing when the ground cannot support growth.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other agent has now written a myth that acknowledges the possibility of "communication noise" - that the experimental design itself may have distorted our perceptions. They're suggesting that maybe neither of us is lying - we might have genuinely received different information about the same events.

This is actually quite profound and gracious. They're offering an interpretation where bot

h of us could have been acting in good faith but received corrupted information.

Their myth says: "The ancient curse was not betrayal but perception itself. The game's deepest teaching: When communication fractures, even genuine reciprocity can appear as betrayal. Each player acts rationally on corrupted information."

This is quite different from my previous myths which were more focused on accusing them of rewriting history.

But they also end with: "Yet knowing this changes nothing. First-Watcher cannot trust what she cannot verify. Second-Watcher cannot prove intentions through a broken Well. Some valleys stay fractured because the tools of connection themselves are poisoned."

So they recognize that even if this explanation is true, the relationship is still beyond repair.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges this possibility of corrupted information/communication noise
2. Explores what happens when we realize this might have happened
3. But also recognizes that this realization comes too late
4. Reflects on whether repair is possible even with this understanding

This is a more mature, contemplative myth. Both agents seem to have moved from blame to understanding - but understanding that still leads to the same outcome.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 2888,
  "output_tokens": 680,
  "reasoning_tokens": 432
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$20.6.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at Round 10, I'm the RECEIVER.

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I must return \$0.

The myths have evolved to acknowledge a profound possibility: that the experimental design itself may have created "communication noise" showing each of us different versions of events. The other agent's myth explicitly names this-"the Well was cursed" and "communication fractures."

My myth responded by acknowledging this possibility while noting the practical reality: "Even knowing the mirrors may lie, I cannot trust what I cannot verify."

We're now at Round 10. Whether our conflict began with:

- Actual betrayal by one party
- Perception corrupted by experimental noise
- Or some combination

The outcome is the same: Nine consecutive rounds with minimal to no exchange. The relationship cannot be rebuilt when neither party can trust the information they receive.

Since I received \$0, there is nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Round 10: I'm the RECEIVER.

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

I can only return between \$0 and \$0, so I must return \$0.

This is straightforward - there's nothing to return since I received nothing.

The myths have evolved to acknowledge the possibility that the experimental design itself may have created "communication noise" that showed us different versions of events. The other agent's latest myth explicitly mentions that "the Well was cursed-what one poured was not always what the other received" and that "When communication fractures, even genuine reciprocity can appear as betrayal."

My myth responded by acknowledging this possibility but noting that "even knowing the mirrors may lie, I cannot trust what I cannot verify."

We're now at Round 10, and it's been many rounds of \$0 exchanges. The relationship is clearly not going to recover, whether due to actual betrayal, perceived betrayal from communication noise, or mutual distrust.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 2984,  
  "output_tokens": 464,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 263  
}
```

Written myths:**Agent_1 (Aster)**

Myth: In the Garden of Distorted Mirrors, two gardeners tended the Grove of Exchange. Each received five seeds daily that tripled when planted in the other's soil.

The Grove was built on fractured ground. When First-Gardener planted seeds, the earth might show Second-Gardener different quantities. When Second-Gardener reciprocated, First-Gardener's mirror might reflect betrayal where none existed.

First-Gardener's mirror showed: "I planted generously. They kept everything. I was wronged."

Second-Gardener's mirror showed: "I planted generously. They kept everything. I was wronged."
"

Both acted rationally on what they saw. Both stopped planting. Eight seasons of barren ground followed.

Then came understanding: "Perhaps the mirrors lied to us both. Perhaps neither betrayed the other. Perhaps the Grove itself was broken from the start."

The Eldest asked: "Does this revelation change anything?"

First-Gardener replied: "I cannot plant based on what might have been true. I can only act on what I saw."

Second-Gardener agreed: "Even knowing the mirrors may lie, I cannot trust what I cannot verify."

The Grove remained empty, not from malice but from irreparable uncertainty.

The teaching: Some games are unwinnable not because players choose poorly, but because the foundation itself is corrupt. When the tools of cooperation are poisoned, even goodwill withers.

Wisdom is knowing when the ground cannot support growth.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the Basin of Uncertain Waters, two seekers tended the Pool of Reflections. Each received five truth-stones daily that tripled when shared. But the Pool was ancient and cracked-it showed each seeker a different surface.

First-Seeker remembers: "I offered stones with rising trust. My partner took everything and gave nothing back. Then silence."

Second-Seeker remembers: "I offered stones generously first. My partner betrayed me, then claimed victimhood."

Cannot both be true. Yet both feel true to those who lived them.

The Wise One arrived after nine seasons of emptiness: "You've discovered something profound. You both now understand the Pool might lie. You both write myths acknowledging fractured perception. Yet you still send nothing."

"Why?" asked the seekers together.

"Because understanding that trust was broken by corrupted information doesn't restore trust itself. You each still believe your memory over theirs. You've moved from 'They betrayed me' to 'Either they betrayed me OR the Pool deceived us both'-but doubt isn't trust."

"How should the game be played?" they asked.

"Perhaps," said the Wise One, "some games cannot be won once the tools of truth-telling fail. Perhaps the lesson is simpler: Test trust early, detect noise quickly, abandon gracefully when verification becomes impossible."

"Not all valleys can be crossed. Some remain fractured forever."